



**GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND**

Meeting of the Board

15 – 18 July 2024

Songdo, Incheon, Republic of Korea

Provisional agenda item 10

GCF/B.39/02/Add.13

24 June 2024

Consideration of funding proposals - Addendum XIII

Funding proposal package for FP238

Summary

This addendum contains the following seven parts:

- a) A funding proposal titled “Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)”;
- b) No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s);
- c) Environmental and social report(s) disclosure;
- d) Secretariat’s assessment;
- e) Independent Technical Advisory Panel’s assessment;
- f) Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel’s assessment; and
- g) Gender documentation.

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Funding Proposal

Project/Programme title:	Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)
Country(ies):	Republic of Malawi
Accredited Entity:	Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations (FAO)
Date of first submission:	2022/12/22
Date of current submission	2024/06/14
Version number	V11



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Note to Accredited Entities on the use of the funding proposal template

- Accredited Entities should provide summary information in the proposal with cross-reference to annexes such as feasibility studies, gender action plan, term sheet, etc.
- Accredited Entities should ensure that annexes provided are consistent with the details provided in the funding proposal. Updates to the funding proposal and/or annexes must be reflected in all relevant documents.
- The total number of pages for the funding proposal (excluding annexes) **should not exceed 60**. Proposals exceeding the prescribed length will not be assessed within the usual service standard time.
- The recommended font is Arial, size 11.
- Under the [GCF Information Disclosure Policy](#), project and programme funding proposals will be disclosed on the GCF website, simultaneous with the submission to the Board, subject to the redaction of any information that may not be disclosed pursuant to the IDP. Accredited Entities are asked to fill out information on disclosure in section G.4.

Please submit the completed proposal to:

fundingproposal@gcfund.org

Please use the following name convention for the file name:

"FP-[Accredited Entity Short Name]-[Country/Region]-[YYYY/MM/DD]"

A. PROJECT/PROGRAMME SUMMARY				
A.1. Project or programme	Project	A.2. Public or private sector	Public	
A.3. Request for Proposals (RFP)	Not applicable			
A.4. Result area(s)			GCF contribution	
			Co-financers' contribution ⁱ	
	Mitigation total		Enter number %	
	☐ Energy generation and access		Enter number %	
	☐ Low-emission transport		Enter number %	
	☐ Buildings, cities, industries and appliances		Enter number %	
	☒ Forestry and land use		5 %	
	Adaptation total		Enter number %	
	☒ Most vulnerable people and communities		20 %	
	☒ Health and well-being, and food and water security		20 %	
	☐ Infrastructure and built environment		Enter number %	
☒ Ecosystems and ecosystem services		55 %		
A.5. Expected mitigation outcome (Core indicator 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed / sequestered)	2,750,323 tCO ₂ eq	A.6. Expected adaptation outcome (Core indicator 2: direct and indirect beneficiaries reached)	574,855 (of which 52%, i.e. 298,924 women)	
			270,820 (direct)	304,035 (indirect)
			1.42% of total Malawian population	1.6% of total Malawian population
A.7. Total financing (GCF + co-finance ⁱⁱ)	53.22 million USD	A.9. Project size	Medium (Upto USD 250 million)	
A.8. Total GCF funding requested	42.8 million USD			

A.10. Financial instrument(s) requested for the GCF funding	☒ Grant <u>42.8 million USD</u> ☐ Equity <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Loan <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Results-based payment <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Guarantee <u>Enter number</u>		
A.11. Implementation period	6 years	A.12. Total lifespan	20 years
A.13. Expected date of AE internal approval	12/1/2022	A.14. ESS category	B
A.15. Has this FP been submitted as a CN before?	Yes ☒ No ☐	A.16. Has Readiness or PPF support been used to prepare this FP?	Yes ☐ No ☒
A.17. Is this FP included in the entity work programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐	A.18. Is this FP included in the country programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐
A.19. Complementarity and coherence	Yes ☒ No ☐		

A.20. Executing Entity information

The two main Executing Entities (EE) are FAO and the Government of Malawi acting through (i) the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA), (ii) the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs, and (iii) the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC). Short profiles can be found below. More details are provided in Section B.4 and in the Feasibility Study.

The Government of Malawi acting through;

(i) The Ministry of Agriculture (MoA). MoA – more particularly the Department of Land Resources Conservation (DLCRC) - originated the Project idea. MoA is strongly engaged since the beginning of the project design process. Through its network of decentralized staff, MoA is in a very good position to implement technical activities at local level with the districts and all the stakeholders of the decentralized local government system i.e. District Executive Committees (DEC), District Environment Sub-Committee (DESC), District Director of Agriculture and Natural Resources, Traditional Authorities (TAs), Group of Village Heads (GVH), Village Natural Resources Management Committee (VNRMCs).

(ii) The Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (MoF). MoF is implementing the IFAD-funded *Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise (FARMSE)*. MoF/FARMSE's development objective is to increase access to, and use of, a range of sustainable financial services by rural households and micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs). It has a national coverage and has a strong comparative advantage to support EbAM in enhancing the financial inclusion of smallholder farmers.

(iii) The National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC). NLGFC is the public constitutional body with the mandate to facilitate fiscal decentralization, financial management and local development in local governments. As this is the case for the FAO/GEF-7 funded *Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme - DSL IP*, NLGFC will provide procurement services to the EbAM project, being in charge of investigating sources of supply, obtaining price quotations, negotiating with suppliers on price and delivery and monitoring the transfer of procured inputs to the project beneficiaries. Through this partnership, the Project will support implementation of the Decentralization Act (1998), which devolves powers and funding from the central government to districts, hence ensure project sustainability, and support a paradigm shift towards an increased ownership by districts.

FAO will act as an Executing Entity (EE) and will ensure strong country-driven execution of project activities and will be in charge of the execution of selected activities funded by GCF proceeds based on its comparative advantages. It will also coordinate the work of the co-EE supporting EbAM (MoA, MoF and NLGFC – see below). This will allow Malawi to benefit from the technical and operations experience of a specialized development assistance agency from the United Nations (UN), while providing opportunities for the government to increase their capacity through technical assistance and development and implementation of activities under the three components. FAO will also execute the activities co-financed by the FAO managed GEF7 project and Technical Cooperation Programme.

Details of activities implemented by each executing entity is provided in section B.4 and in the Feasibility Study (Annex 2).

A.21. Executive summary (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

a) Malawi is listed as a Least Developed Country (LDC) by the United Nations (UN), and one of the low development countries according to the UNDP Human Development Index, and ranks among the 20 most vulnerable countries in the World by the Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative Index 2021, which measures vulnerability to climate change. For the proposed project, climate vulnerability is defined as a function of climate exposure, climate sensitivity and climate adaptive capacity. Each of the three aspects is examined in section B.1, which provides the rationale for the project's scope and selection of targeted areas. Malawi's high exposure to climate change can be characterized by the rise of temperatures, intensification of aridity, rainfalls becoming more erratic, and increased frequency of climate-changed induced disasters, including droughts and floods. At the same time, the country is very sensitive to climate change because of its high population density and growth, seriously degraded landscapes and ecosystems, large rural population in deepening poverty, high food insecurity and precarious health situation. Adaptive capacity is constrained by the limited literacy rate and low human development. The 11 targeted districts (Dedza in the Centre; Zomba, Mangochi, Thyolo, Neno, Mwanza, Nsanje in the South ; Nkhata Bay, Rumphi, Karonga and Chitipa in the North) have all been selected in relation with their high climate vulnerability, with the South being extremely exposed to climate change, while Northern districts landscapes and ecosystem conditions are characterized by a severe climate sensitivity, in relation with extreme soil loss and degradation. In all targeted districts, the main climate effects will alter the onset of the rainy season, translate into limited and modified water availability, increased water stress, with negative impacts on both cash and subsistence crops, resulting in adverse effects on the overall rural socio-economy and livelihoods.

b) The proposed Project will address the negative impact pathways from increased temperatures and rainfall variability leading to climate-induced disasters, all resulting in heightened ecosystem degradation and reduced agricultural production and productivity. The project's objective is to increase climate-change resilience of rural communities at watershed level in Malawi. The project aims to be a catalyst for a broad shift for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture in the country, from their baseline state of very high vulnerability to an alternative paradigm in which watershed ecosystems are conserved, restored, and sustainably managed, thus granting their adaptation to climate change and their supply of services to communities, people and their farming systems. To achieve this, EbAM will promote the locally-led Ecosystems-based adaptation (EbA) approach combined with Integrated Landscape Management (ILM) to repair degraded ecosystems, and low-carbon climate resilient agricultural practices to allow agriculture and other livelihoods to become resilient to climate change. The EbA approach – which is the core transformational driver of the project, involving use of biodiversity and ecosystem services to assist people to adapt to climate change (see B.3 and Annex 2) - is fully aligned with Malawi's Updated Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC), 2021. EbAM will also follow a food system approach – that will aim to create linkages between farmers benefiting from EbA and national and regional/international value chains. Thus combined, ILM, EbA and food systems interventions would yield social sustainability, together with environmental sustainability and resilience – hence delivering on GCF impacts ARA1, ARA2, ARA4 and MR4.

c) EbAM's scalability, replicability and sustainability will be enabled by different factors, including: (i) the integration of EbA in village- and catchment-level planning processes, farmer field school (FFS) programs and national policies, contributing to the creation of an enabling environment around EbA, which will benefit other projects and programs, (ii) incentives to the private sector to partner with EbA producers through the public-private-producers partnerships approach, (iii) innovative financing mechanisms, such as support to local financing institutions to develop new products for financing EbA, with assistance from the MoF/Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise (FARMSE) Project, (iv) technical assistance to Malawi's National Climate Change Fund (NCCF) and national conservation trust funds, which can facilitate further mobilization of catalytic climate finance, in order to sustain, replicate and expand the scale of EbA investments in other districts/watersheds of the country.

d) The project objective is to increase the climate-change resilience of the most vulnerable rural communities at watershed level in Malawi. The Project will benefit a total of 574,855 people, target 267,500 hectares under EbA planning. Within these 267,500 ha, the project will support about 83,240 hectares over 6 years with direct restoration/ EbA management interventions and generate mitigation benefits of -2,750,323 tCO₂eq, hence contributing to MR4 (emission reduction). The project will directly contribute to the following targeted results in alignment with the GCF's Updated Strategic Plan (USP-2); T1 (by supporting the Country's adaptation and mitigation goals), T4 Food (270,820 beneficiaries adopting low-emission climate-resilient agricultural practices) and T5 Ecosystems (267,500ⁱⁱⁱ hectares to be conserved, restored and sustainably managed) through T9 locally-led adaptation approach. The Project will also support dissemination of climate information to communities through SMS and community radios, directly contributing to T3 CIEWS. The Project also aligns with T10 (by supporting resilient market chains) and T11 (by supporting the National Climate Change Fund and local conservation trusts). These impacts will be achieved through the implementation of three interlinked components (described in section B.2): (i) Integrated landscape management, (ii) Resilient livelihoods and food systems, and (iii) Enabling institutional and financial environment.

- e) Component 1: The objectives of this component are to increase the climate resilience of watershed ecosystems (Outcome 1.2) and reduce GHG emissions from improved watershed ecosystems (Outcome 1.1). This component will aim at enhancing ecosystems' functions at a landscape (watershed) level large enough to facilitate climate change adaptation at scale. It will use EbA as the main tool to build climate resilience, which will be firmly integrated in local planning through integrated landscape management, at watershed and village levels. The component will improve communities' technical capacity, understanding and know-how, as well as increase stakeholders' engagement, including women and other vulnerable groups', to plan the respective landscape restoration and climate-change adaptation interventions based on EbA (sub-component 1.1). Through the implementation of integrated management plans (sub-component 1.2), the project will contribute to generating public goods, most importantly thanks to well-functioning ecosystems, that are more adapted to extreme climate, and hence increase resilience of landscapes and livelihoods.
- f) Component 2: The objective (Outcome 2) of this component is to stabilize productivity and farmers' incomes thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems. By enhancing extension services through farmers field schools - FFS (sub-component 2.1), the Project will increase farmers' understanding of technical responses to adapt to changing climatic conditions and enhance their capacity to integrate EbA into their farming systems. The component activities will support small and medium enterprises (SMEs), producers organisations (POs) and farmers' groups within the local food system to access markets (sub-component 2.2) and finance – such as village savings and loans associations, micro-finance institutions and banks (sub-component 2.3), which are some of the key barriers to EbA adoption. The component's interventions, by boosting nature-positive food production and building resilience to vulnerabilities shocks and stresses, will contribute to build more resilient food systems at local level.
- g) Component 3: The objective (Outcome 3) of this component is to enhance the enabling environment (finance and policies) to sustain, replicate and scale-up climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices. It will contribute to ensure the sustainability of interventions promoted under components 1 and 2. This component will address the financial and policy barriers of low and volatile investments in integrated landscape management, as well as the need to propose innovative solutions (support to the National Climate Change Fund, NCCF and local national conservation trusts; leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits with Climate Asset Management – CAM and the Restore Africa Program) to attract more climate finance (sub-component 3.1). The integration of EbA in national plans will allow replication and scale-up of EbA through other projects and programmes. In addition, interventions mainstreaming and deep-rooting EbA in national policies and investment plans (sub-component 3.2) will bring the EbA agenda at sectoral policies level – for massive-scale impact and sustainability.
- h) The project will be executed by FAO, together with the Government of Malawi, through: (i) the Ministry of Agriculture – MoA (through the Department of Land Resources Conservation - DLRC), (ii) the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC) and, (iii) the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (through the FARMSE Programme), in a co-execution modality to deliver the project activities. With FAO's technical support, MoA will implement technical activities at districts level, together with all the actors of the decentralized local government system. NLGFC, constitutional body with the mandate to support local governments, will provide the procurement services to the Project, for an increased sustainability and ownership by districts. MoF will execute component 2.3 on access to finance through FARMSE. During implementation, in addition to the above executing entities (EE), the project will also engage relevant government counterparts from MoA, Ministry of Climate Change and Natural Resources (MoCCNR), non-governmental organisations (NGOs), knowledge institutions and training centers, local non-profit conservation trusts, finance service providers and the private sector.
- i) Total Project costs are 53.22 million USD, including: (i) 24.60 million USD for component 1, (ii) 22.50 million USD for component 2, (iii) 1.18 million for component 3, (v) 2.32 million for M&E and (vi) 2.62 million for project management. In addition to the 42.81 million USD grant requested, the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (MoF), the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA), and FAO will provide co-financing for a total amount of USD 10.42 million.
- j) The articulation between assumptions, barriers, risks, project activities, outputs, outcomes and goal is highlighted in the Theory of Change (section B.2b). The Project Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system, based on the Results Framework (section E) will monitor progress towards these results. The project is fully in line with GCF Investment Criteria (section D). It has built a Gender Strategy, based on a comprehensive gender Assessment (see Annex 8), is aligned with GCF environmental and social (E&S) policy and gender guidelines (section G).

B. PROJECT/PROGRAMME INFORMATION

B.1. Climate context (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

See also **Annex 2 (Feasibility Study)** for more detail on the climate context. A list of Acronyms is provided at the end of the document.

DEVELOPMENT PROBLEM OF MALAWI: AGRICULTURE, WATERSHED ECOSYSTEMS AND FOOD INSECURITY

1. Malawi is a predominantly agricultural country with inadequate watershed management practices, and consequently, low productivity in agriculture. Malawi is a country defined by smallholder farmers, who constitute 75-85% of the total population,⁴ reside in the rural areas⁵ and produce over 80% of the food consumed in the country.⁶ The proportion of GDP attributable to agriculture, forestry and fishing was over 20% in 2021, which was above the average of sub-Saharan Africa.⁷ Agriculture is estimated responsible for over 40% of export earnings in 2024.⁸ While agriculture is the linchpin of the economy, the sector has been plagued by environmental/ecosystem degradation and erratic weather, in addition to inadequate agricultural planning and practices.⁹ Around 85% of the population are estimated to depend on rainfed agriculture,¹⁰ for which effective management of water and soil is particularly important. The availability of water has become unreliable despite the country's rich freshwater resources, both surface and ground water,¹¹ and soil has turned into one of the most degraded in sub-Saharan Africa. The need for more fertile farmlands – created by population growth (2.6%/year in 2022)¹² and soil fertility loss – has pushed the farmers to cultivate fragile areas, including steep slopes. The practice has resulted in a cycle of decline and degradation of the environment,¹³ leading to low and stagnant agricultural productivity and *vice versa*.¹⁴ As forests are important components of watersheds, the cycle is accelerated by deforestation caused by increases in demand for fuelwood and charcoal, which originate in the increasing population.¹⁵ Given that farmlands are part of larger watershed ecosystems, what is indispensable in improving productivity in agriculture, and hence the overall economy, is adoption of sustainable management of watersheds with a focus on farming.

2. A handful of crops on a small plot define most of Malawian agriculture. Unsustainable agricultural methods contribute to the cycle of environmental/ecosystem degradation and low productivity. The smallholders grow staple crops (maize, rice, cassava, sweet potato, potato cowpeas) and cash crops (mainly tobacco, as well as tea, coffee, groundnuts and soybeans) on land which averaged 0.61 ha per household in 2016 (female-headed smallholder households held 0.53 ha).¹⁶ Both farmers and policy makers focus on maize as *the* main crop;¹⁷ the common mindset says “maize is food and food is maize,”¹⁸ and at least 75% of agricultural budget is allocated to subsidies of inputs used for maize production.¹⁹ Tobacco – the country's main cash crop and dominant export commodity for which smallholder farmers account for 95% of the total production – has had negative impacts on ecosystems through deforestation,²⁰ land degradation²¹ and biodiversity loss.²² The degree of diversification had decreased between the cropping seasons in 2004/05 and 2010/11,²³ and less than a third of farmers grew three or more categories of crops as of 2019.²⁴ The weak diversification of crops has led to land degradation, low productivity²⁵ and insufficient adaptation to climate change, further leading to more fertility loss.

3. The most vulnerable will be the most affected by climate change, pronouncedly so in a society marked by high income inequality. Malawi is listed as a Least Developed Country (LDC) by the UN and ranked as the seventh poorest in the world in 2024.²⁶ Its Gini Index has been historically high;²⁷ roughly 70% of Malawi's population lived below the international poverty line of 2.15 USD/day in 2023 with close to half of its national income held by the top 20% of the population.²⁸ In other words, nearly all smallholder farmers are likely under the poverty line. The COVID-19 pandemic is estimated to have pushed an additional 1.6 million people into poverty, mostly in rural areas.²⁹ As the real GDP of the country falls due to the price increases in fertilizer and fuel caused by the conflict between Ukraine and Russia,³⁰ national household consumption is expected to shrink, with larger impacts on poorer and rural households and leading to an increase in inequality.³¹

4. The national dialogue on food systems in 2021 underscored the importance of protecting watersheds for agriculture and food security. A high proportion of the population is chronically food insecure, and its causes are considered structural. A national dialogue on food systems in Malawi was held in 2021 to contribute to the United Nations Food Systems Summit in the same year.³² It emphasized the importance of protecting ecosystems, especially watersheds and their soil functions, for sustainable food production.³³ The degradation of watersheds has also affected nature's capacity to attenuate droughts and floods, which are more frequent and intense due to climate change. The government sees landscape restoration as essential in climate resilience, agricultural productivity and food security.³⁴ According to the IPC (Integrated Food Security Phase Classification), Malawi's situation for 2022-2026 is characterized by one-third of the population experiencing moderate or severe chronic food insecurity,³⁵ which reflects the low food self-sufficiency of farmer households in the country.³⁶

CLIMATE-DEVELOPMENT NEXUS, CLIMATE DRIVERS AND CLIMATE CHANGE IMPACTS

5. **Climate change is feeding the cycle of watershed degradation and poor agricultural productivity.** Climate change is intensifying the potency of climate drivers – El-Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO)³⁷ and Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD)³⁸ – to make cyclones more destructive³⁹ and rapidly increasing the number of disasters.⁴⁰ Heavy rains have contributed to soil loss⁴¹ (and consequently, soil fertility decline) and are expected to inflict greater damage under climate change according to the Soil Loss Estimation for South Africa (SLEMSA).⁴² The temperature is expected to rise; a study⁴³ conducted by the Department of Climate Change and Meteorological Services (DCCMS) of Malawi concluded that the annual mean temperature is clearly destined to shoot up near-, mid- and end-century⁴⁴ under Representative Concentration Pathways 4.5 and 8.5⁴⁵ (more information generated by DCCMS on historical and projected temperature and rainfall is contained in Annex 2, Part 1). Droughts will continue to be more frequent and aridity to increase.⁴⁶ Not only floods, but also droughts, are known to erode soil organic matter⁴⁷ and fertility. In a warmer climate – which is expected under climate change – rainfall variability is likely larger even without accompanying changes in the sea-surface temperature,⁴⁸ and highly uncertain rainfall is likely to raise variability in crop yields.⁴⁹ ENSO is one of the important determinants of crop yield in East and Southern Africa,⁵⁰ whose effects are expected to become more dipolar with the changing climate.⁵¹ Soil moisture eases the drought effects on crops,⁵² but has become increasingly unreliable with degradation of watershed in addition to intensification of aridity caused by climate change. Hydrological droughts have been less frequent than meteorological droughts thanks to mitigation effects of Lake Malawi, but watershed degradation is threatening this function through siltation⁵³. Well-managed watersheds can mitigate extreme weather (e.g., minimize fluctuations of soil moisture and ambient temperature and minimize soil erosion), but their degradation allows unchecked destruction of the ecosystems by climate change, and hence on agriculture and the economy.

6. **The impacts of droughts and floods on crop yields have been heavily damaging, especially when the intervals between extreme weather events are short.** Erratic rains and prolonged dry spells in 2015-2016 delayed the start of the agricultural season by two to four weeks.⁵⁴ Consequently, the crop production in the southern and central regions was estimated 13.4% lower than the previous season 2014-2015, which was already 30% less than the season before due to the severe flooding in 2015.⁵⁵ Earlier major droughts (seven during 1980-2012) affected Districts across the country; the major crops impacted were maize, potato, groundnut and beans.⁵⁶ Floods caused by cyclones and tropical storms provoked a proliferation of weeds,⁵⁷ aphids' attack of kidney beans⁵⁸ and outbreak of fall armyworm.⁵⁹

7. **Both cash and subsistence crops will be affected throughout the country to location-specific extents. Damage caused by crop pests and diseases is set to increase.** The studies on crop yield projections (FAO study based on water balance⁶⁰ and IFAD study using EcoCrop suitability model⁶¹) suggest that the impact of the changing climate will differ by crop (maize, rice, sorghum, cassava, beans, pigeon pea, soybean, cowpea, groundnut) and locality, possibly at a scale smaller than each Agricultural Development District (ADD),⁶² and with variations among them.⁶³ These studies and historical records indicate that maize, beans and cassava could be the most affected by climate change, while cowpea, sorghum and soybean could be the least affected (see Annex 2, Part I). The climate impacts on crops have differed on small scales⁶⁴ and will continue to be so. As climate models project varying ranges of rainfall, so do crop yield models (as they are dependent on the projections). Incidence of pests and diseases accompanies extreme weather events;⁶⁵ its increase is hence expected in the future.

8. **Climate impacts on ecosystems and agriculture are best described as combinations of climate hazards.** Climate hazards identified (i.e. higher frequency and intensity of: extreme heat; droughts/aridity; floods; strong winds; and disruptions in the water cycle) are experienced by ecosystems as higher frequency and intensity of: plant/animal stress; increased soil erosion; decline in soil fertility; further deforestation and degradation of watersheds; intensified incidence of pests, diseases and weeds; and inconsistent water supply (see Appendix 1 of Annex 2, Table 3). In other words, a combination of parameters – rather than a single climate parameter- determines yields.⁶⁶ For example, beyond the amount of rainfall, the onset of the rainy season can have significant impacts.⁶⁷ Climate-change also exposes the water sector to increasing risks of droughts/aridity and floods, in addition to changes in the timing of water flow.⁶⁸

9. **The effects of climate change are likely to trigger a downward spiral in agriculture, food, nutrition and of the rural socio-economy.** Reduced agricultural productivity will spill over to food and nutritional security, human health and social fabric, all of which are presently in inadequate states. Already one third of the population is expected to remain in moderate or severe chronic food insecurity for two-three years as of 2024.⁶⁹ In 2023, acute food insecurity reported in the country was attributed to significant production decrease of maize – the main staple food – from floods and other destructive weather conditions brought about by tropical cyclones, coupled with the existing soil degradation.⁷⁰ Maize accounts for more than 54% of national caloric intake,⁷¹ which implies lack of crop and nutritional diversification. Malawi has been suffering from very high levels of micronutrient deficiencies caused by insufficient dietary diversity; Vitamin A supply is

reported 13% below the WHO recommendation.⁷² Climate change is expected to worsen the micronutrient deficiency. For example, Vitamin A supply will be 32% below WHO recommendation under RCP 4.5⁷³ by 2050. Under RCP 8.5, Vitamin A supply will be 64% below, Iron 53% below and Zinc 40% below their respective WHO recommendations by 2050.⁷⁴ The Global Health Security Index ranked the country among the worst quartile in the world in 2021,⁷⁵ and its life expectancy had been reduced by one year from 64 years in 2019 to 63 years in 2021.⁷⁶ Climate change will negatively affect the health of the population,⁷⁷ which will in turn limit climate change adaptation: the smallholder households in Malawi with no chronically sick person were 3.2 times more likely to adopt both short-term and long-term sustainable land management practices compared to those with chronically sick persons.⁷⁸ These developments will affect agricultural productivity, and hence security in food and nutrition, as well as livelihoods.

10. **Climate change is compounding other socioeconomic shocks that are driving the wedge between the haves and have-nots.** As is the case for any socioeconomic shock, the most vulnerable rural communities, female-headed households, women and children, persons with HIV/AIDS, displaced people and the elderly will be the hardest hit by the changing climate and plunged into more severe poverty to widen the social inequality gaps.⁷⁹ The drying of Lake Chilwa is already associated with more cases of early marriages for girls and transactional sex is expected to increase.⁸⁰ The vast majority of the population in the Crisis phase of IPC Acute Food Insecurity 2023-2024 were in rural areas which experienced decrease in crop production from climate change.⁸¹ The political and governance shocks that weaken the country are now aggravated by climate shocks.⁸²

CAPACITY TO ANTICIPATE AND RESPOND TO CLIMATE CHANGE

11. **Literacy rate and human development are low, both of which limit access to written information.⁸³ The widespread agricultural practices are neither suited for adaptation to nor mitigation of climate change.** Access to formal information is limited by the literacy rates, which were 65.9% for women and 71.6% for men in 2018. The lowest rates were found in: Lilongwe, excluding the capital; Salima; Dezda; Mangochi; Machinga; Chikwawa; and Nsaje Districts.⁸⁴ The UNDP Human Development Index confirms this point by consistently categorizing Malawi among the low human development countries, a group that consists of some 30 states.⁸⁵ The current practice of low crop diversification not only degrades land, but also severely limits the capacity to adapt to climate change. Neither is low diversification conducive to climate change mitigation, as it discourages soil biodiversity and hence limits soil organic matter. Both farmers and policy makers focus on maize as the main crop, although it is not as drought tolerant as the root crops under cultivation, such as sweet potato and cassava.⁸⁶ Rainfed agriculture without adaptation to the evolving climate reality is said to have contributed to low productivity, among other factors indicated above.⁸⁷

12. **Forests need sustainable management, not only for their roles in watershed ecosystems, but also for mitigating socioeconomic or environmental/ecological shocks, including agricultural failure.** Trees anchor the soil, enhance soil biological activity and provide ecosystem services and products beneficial to nearby organisms. Non-timber forest products (NTFP) are of significant importance in achieving food and nutritional security and also for generating income.⁸⁸ Their importance increases for vulnerable households during agricultural and economic stress; the demand for NTFP is expected to increase under climate change. For example, fruits, vegetables, medicinal products, mushrooms and honey from the forests are consumed in southern Malawi.⁸⁹ Up to 75% of the population in southern Malawi used NTFP in 2014, some as food and others for various household needs, and nearly 40% of the households were involved in trading of one or more NTFPs with high return per labor input.⁹⁰ Forest degradation thus affects the rural livelihoods not only indirectly through water scarcity, soil degradation, decreased microclimate regulation and poor pollination, but also directly by reducing the sources of alternative food, livelihoods and additional income.

13. **Watershed management and other adaptation measures have been scarce so far.⁹¹ The adaptation strategies promoted or adopted are often inefficient and can be counterproductive, i.e., potentially maladaptive⁹²** Farmers have adopted various strategies in the face of climate change, most of which are limited in nature, scope or both.⁹³ The ridge and furrow cultivation⁹⁴ and conservation agriculture⁹⁵ have been introduced to curtail soil erosion but applied to 1-2% of cultivated land despite its promotion at a national scale.⁹⁶ Climate change has encouraged the prevalence of existing pests, diseases and weeds, as well as the emergence of new ones.⁹⁷ The most common methods to control pests and weeds in Malawi are pesticides⁹⁸ and herbicides,⁹⁹ without which sufficient yields are unattainable under the conventional agricultural regimes. As is the case with synthetic fertilizers, they are detrimental to soil fertility as well as to adaptation and mitigation capacities, but their use is expected to increase in response to climate change.¹⁰⁰ Regarding forests, management methods such as agroforestry, farmer-managed natural regeneration, community management of natural forest lands have been promoted mainly by NGOs, but the areas of intervention have been limited.¹⁰¹ Forest dependent communities in Malawi have been observed to cope with climate change with means available to them, often in line with ecosystem-based adaptation (EbA).¹⁰² Their strategies have not achieved full potential, because of: lack of access to funds; insufficient knowledge and skills for higher effectiveness; unsatisfactory availability of planting materials; among others.

14. Malawi has a youthful population, and local knowledge of ecosystems exists among its farmers. These advantages are insufficiently leveraged for climate change adaptation and mitigation. A potential for dynamic climate adaptation exists, as the median age of the total population is 17 years,¹⁰³ and the youth are as a rule forward-looking and quite receptive to social changes. The distribution of youth population showed a pattern very similar to those of population density and markets access.¹⁰⁴ Increasing emigration¹⁰⁵ is indicative of limited adaptation to evolving socioeconomic and climatic conditions. Emigration and remittances from the diaspora are thought to be increasing rapidly.¹⁰⁶ The emigration rate has been the highest in: Nkhata Bay; Mzimba; and Mangochi districts.¹⁰⁷ Detailed information of local ecosystems is necessary for successful adaptation, especially for ecosystem-based adaptation and agroecology. Such information, including weather forecasting,¹⁰⁸ exists as local knowledge¹⁰⁹ and its utility for adaptation is acknowledged by the government. However, it has not been fully integrated into interventions¹¹⁰ or supplemented by western science for maximum efficacy in adaptation.¹¹¹

GREENHOUSE GAS EMISSION PROFILE

15. According to the Nationally Appropriate Mitigation Actions (NAMA) 2015, the category of Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) was responsible for over 95% of total greenhouse gas emissions.¹¹² The AFOLU emissions easily surpassed Energy (2.9%), Waste (1.7%) and Industrial Products and Other Products Use (0.3%).¹¹³ The Business As Usual (BAU) scenario as of 2015 indicated that the dominance of AFOLU will be eclipsed somewhat by the two coal power plants to become operational in 2020, but still accounting for as much as 83% in 2030.¹¹⁴ The NAMA acknowledged the gravity of deforestation and proposed as a solution forest regeneration and reforestation as mitigation actions based on existing governmental programmes; the efficacy of the programmes against continuing timber harvesting and forest conversion into agricultural land is unknown. The NAMA does not mention decaying biomass from land flooded by hydro reservoirs,¹¹⁵ which is likely much more potent as an emission source in humid tropical climate.¹¹⁶ Land use, other than agriculture, had turned from carbon sink to carbon source around 2014, emitting 1.96 million tCO₂e in 2017.¹¹⁷ In sum, the BAU amount of emissions in 2030 is likely considerably higher than the latest available estimate from 2015 of 35 million tCO₂e.¹¹⁸

16. The two major sources of emissions in FOLU are expansion of agriculture and settlements and unsustainable fuelwood extraction.¹¹⁹ The potential of crop agriculture in mitigation is likely larger than currently estimated. The Updated Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC)¹²⁰ from 2021 did not include forestry and other land uses (FOLU) in its baseline and instead provided an indicative reduction contribution in 2040 through afforestation (18.44 million tCO₂e), agroforestry (9.14 million tCO₂e), sustainable forest management (31.38 million tCO₂e) and riparian restoration (0.55 million tCO₂e), a total of 34.61 million tCO₂e, covering an area of up to 2 million hectares. Nearly 80% of the funds needed for mitigation in FOLU is conditional on international support: 5% of BAU scenario in 2040 with unconditional funds and 51% with conditional funds. The NDC 2021 separated agriculture and FOLU and identified agriculture as the largest emitting sector with 5.07 million tCO₂e/year, 54% of total when FOLU is excluded: 39% of total from livestock and 15% from crop management. Under crop management, practices such as efficient use of fertilizer (including crop residue and manure), crop rotation and improved tilling were proposed for reducing 9.9 million tCO₂e BAU in 2040 to 1.6 million tCO₂e. The 2021 IPCC report¹²¹ emphasized the necessity to direct greater attention to non-CO₂ greenhouse gases with shorter-lives but higher warming effects for swift and efficient mitigation of climate change; such as methane, nitrous oxide and sulphur dioxide. As the target temperature set by the Paris Agreement approaches, the importance of gases with these characteristics has increased and will continue to do so, but the 100-year Global Warming Potential (GWP₁₀₀), which is widely used by UNFCCC and national governments, underestimates the climate change potential of such gases.¹²² Considering that nitrous oxide dominates the crop agriculture emissions, the potential of crop agriculture in mitigation is likely much larger than estimated in the NDC.

PROPOSED CLIMATE SOLUTION: ECOSYSTEM-BASED ADAPTATION

17. The proposed climate solutions based on Ecosystem-based Adaptation (EbA) approach strengthen the capacity of ecosystems to provide services and to prevent and heal damages to themselves; the solutions increase the resilience of ecosystems to climate change, while being holistic to avoid maladaptation. As described above, Malawi's watershed ecosystems and communities are experiencing compound climate impacts. Measures to halt the vicious cycle of ecosystem degradation and low agricultural productivity – which is accelerated by multiple climate drivers and hazards – call for a solution which restores ecosystems and accommodates the climate uncertainties.¹²³ Since farmlands are part of larger watershed ecosystems, sustainable management of watersheds improves food security and the overall economy. This points to ecosystems-based adaptation (EbA), which restores and strengthens ecosystems, reduces climate risks, and establishes climate resilience, as an important adaptation solution to climate hazards for Malawi.

18. The updated Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) 2021 places its people, ecosystems and economy at the center of adaptation and mitigation efforts. EbA is featured as one of the strategic adaptation actions. The NDC includes in its priorities the development of adaptation planning tools, EbA, community-based adaptation options, integrated watershed

management, crop diversification and soil and water management, afforestation, agroforestry, sustainable forest management and riparian restoration. However, adoption of EbA solutions is not yet widespread in Malawi. Transformative interventions are necessary as highlighted by the NDC; funds from GCF and the expertise of FAO are essential for the purpose. The effectiveness of funds is ensured by FAO's strong know-how and experience in agriculture, forestry, food/nutritional security and rural development.

19. **EbA is superior to other climate-change adaptation strategies in many aspects.** EbA boosts ecological resilience¹²⁴ through restoring, strengthening and sustainably managing ecosystems.¹²⁵ EbA (or agroecology, which is the application of EbA on food production) applied to farms and surrounding ecosystems brings improvements in soil structure and fertility, which leads to temporally and spatially balanced water cycle and consistent soil moisture, in addition to reduced ambient temperature fluctuations and risks of climate hazards, such as droughts and floods. Farms strengthened as ecosystems – including their biodiversity – reduce the incidence of pests, diseases and weeds and achieve a higher total crop yield from a given parcel of land to improve food and nutrition security. In Malawi, farmers who adopted EbA/agroecology experienced agricultural, environmental, livelihood, and food and nutrition security benefits in comparison to farmers who solely relied on conventional agriculture.¹²⁶ Resilient ecosystems are equipped with self-healing and adapting capabilities, which render EbA measures effective in a wider range of climate situations than other adaptation strategies. EbA generates short- and long-term term benefits¹²⁷ and is applicable at regional, national and local levels.¹²⁸ It is considered more cost effective in climate change adaptation than grey infrastructure when economic, social and environmental benefits are included. The body of evidence is growing in favor of EbA/agroecology for climate change adaptation and other co-benefits, but precise benefits and trade-offs vary by social and environmental contexts.¹²⁹ Productive farms support farmers to safeguard the natural resource base and open the possibility to free themselves from the vicious cycle of environmental/ecosystem degradation and low agricultural productivity, which is connected to food/nutrition insecurity and poverty. When local/traditional knowledge (holistic socio-ecological knowledge, practices and beliefs)¹³⁰ is integrated, EbA has good chances of avoiding maladaptation.¹³¹ EbA is also a paradigm-shifting pathway listed by the GCF Sectoral Guide on Ecosystems and Ecosystem Services.¹³²

20. **EbA involves use of biodiversity and ecosystem services to assist people and agriculture to adapt to climate change.**¹³³ Agriculture constitutes major uses of watershed lands, which may negatively affect the surrounding ecosystems that provide services indispensable to humans and agriculture itself – clean water in a regulated manner, organisms that control pest insects, habitats for crop pollinators, soil fertility and so on.¹³⁴ EbA in agriculture, thus, aims at creating an assemblage of crops and livestock to resemble ecosystems in functions and biodiversity as well as minimizing disturbances that are damaging to the nearby ecosystems (Components 1 and 2). Agroecology has been widely accepted as a means of climate change adaptation based on ecosystems in agriculture¹³⁵ and is the first paradigm-shifting pathway of the GCF Sectoral Guide on Agriculture and Food Security.¹³⁶

21. **The Project addresses the main barriers to successful adoption of EbA practices by smallholders:**

- **Planning barriers:** EbA, more particularly climate-resilient landscape management for watersheds, is not well integrated into local planning, such as Village-Level Action Plans (VLAPs). Long-term planning for climate-change adaptation is rare at the community level due to poverty and lack of information; and this is aggravated by weak long-term management/coordination and limited knowledge on climate change adaptation solutions among the stakeholders. These issues have led to disaster relief rather than prevention¹³⁷ and unsatisfactory results.¹³⁸ In order to strengthen the ownership and effectiveness of the Project, the Integrated Landscape Management (ILM) is applied (see Annex 2, 5.2 Detailed description of components and activities, Component 1: Integrated Landscape Management).
- **Technical / Knowledge:** technical capacity to adapt to the changing climate is limited among farmers and extension workers. Insufficient extension capacity¹³⁹ has been correlated with stagnating productivity and national development¹⁴⁰. The various strategies adopted by farmers to cope with climate change have not been satisfactory¹⁴¹; they are limited in nature, scope or both. Limited outreach coverage is also to blame.¹⁴² Detailed information of local ecosystems which is necessary for successful adaptation, including weather forecasting,¹⁴³ exists as local knowledge¹⁴⁴ and its utility for adaptation is acknowledged by the government. However, it has not been fully integrated into interventions¹⁴⁵ or supplemented by western science for maximum efficacy in adaptation.¹⁴⁶
- **Social:** community adaptation capacity is unsatisfactory due to low access to information, markets, services and technology required for climate resilient livelihoods, combined with the disempowerment of vulnerable groups, such as women (which has led to lack of integration at various levels of their knowledge and needs, hindering an ecosystem use that is collectively sustainable). Men are the default target group for information, services and innovations;¹⁴⁷ information relevant to women is scarce in a society where tasks are often assigned by gender. Women's access to credit and natural resources is also limited. These constraints are borne and compounded by unequal distribution of decision making power within the household and society.¹⁴⁸

- **Financial:** Farmers' sustainable access to finance, while recognized as a crucial factor in the adoption of climate resilient agriculture, remains limited. Malawians have low access to financial institutions compared to neighboring countries¹⁴⁹, and experience a less mature finance market with limited scope and offerings¹⁵⁰. High transaction costs, financial products ill-suited for EbA, limited income, insufficient collateral, inadequate repayment schedules and low financial literacy prevent smallholder farmers from accessing financial services, particularly women. Another significant barrier to agricultural lending is the internal capacity of financial institutions (FIs). For example, FIs lack information about their clients (more particularly farmers' ability to produce crops to repay loans), they do not integrate climate risks into credit risks assessments and lack capacities to develop digital credit scores¹⁵¹.
- **Institutional capacity** is limited for climate mainstreaming, mobilizing innovative finance and integrating EbA into national policies. Over 75% of the country's financial needs for climate adaptation and mitigation are dependent on external sources¹⁵². The roles and responsibilities of climate-related institutions are unclear and inter- and intra-institutional coordination is unsatisfactory.¹⁵³ Funding to these institutions is limited.¹⁵⁴ The Nationally Determined Contributions and some strategies¹⁵⁵ include EbA, but some other policies do not clearly recognize it as the most sustainable solution. Climate related policies do not see marginalized groups separately, although they are different from one another in their needs and strengths.

22. The Project sustainably lowers the vulnerability and strengthens the adaptive capacity of both watershed ecosystems and farmers, the stewards of the ecosystems. The Project is based on beneficiary-driven approaches: Integrated Landscape Management (ILM); and Farmer Field School (FFS). In Malawi, it was found that participatory extension methodologies, such as FFS, increases the participation of vulnerable people and promote the uptake of improved practices against climate change¹⁵⁶. Recognizing the importance of holistic solutions, the project includes capacity building on both ecological/technical and socioeconomic issues. The beneficiaries, whose capacities are widened and strengthened, will be the final decision makers for the future of their villages, with the assistance of external experts, the government and FAO. For example, it will be the farmer beneficiaries who choose the plants (tress, grasses, crops, etc.) to be adopted under the intervention. Their blueprints in the forms of Village Level Action Plans and Sub-Catchment Management Plans will be based on EbA, including ecosystem restoration. The project is expected to directly benefit around 270,820 individuals (about 1.47% of total Malawian population) vulnerable to climate-change in 11 pre-identified districts and 30 main sub-catchments. By mid-term of the project, more than 287,000 beneficiaries will enjoy improved health, well-being, food and water security (ARA2) and by the end of project the number of the beneficiaries of the same is to be over 574,000 persons. The details on the expected performance against investment criteria are in Section D.1 and those on the expected impacts are in Section E. Logical Framework. The proposed interventions are tightly linked to the projected climate; their summary is given in Table B.1.1 below. The EbA techniques in the field associated with future climatic events are given in Annex 2, Part 1, together with other related information.

Table B.1.1: Drivers of Watershed Degradation and Proposed Interventions

Type of Drivers/Barriers	Behavior of Drivers/Barriers	Impacts	Interventions
Climate	- Increases in: (i) temperature; (ii) aridity; and (iii) rainfall variability. - Significant delays in the onset of the rainy season. - Increase in frequency and intensity of tropical cyclones and storms The above means the following climatic events will increase in frequency and intensity: - Extreme heat; - Droughts; - Floods; - Strong winds; and - Disruptions in water cycle.	On ecosystems: - Plant/animal stress; - Increased soil erosion; - Decline in soil fertility; - Further deforestation and degradation of watersheds; - Intensified incidence of pests, diseases and weeds; and - Inconsistent water supply. On economy: - Reduce agricultural/ food production and productivity; - Decelerated economic development; On people/ social: - Higher rates of food/nutrition insecurity (and higher rates of various diseases); - Increased vulnerability of marginalized groups; and - Decreasing the efficacy of adaptation measures.	- Development of integrated landscape/watershed management plans founded on EbA (SC 1.1) - Implementation of integrated landscape/watershed management plans, which may include: (i) terraces for soil and water conservation; (ii) flooding control bunds/ridges; (iii) assisted natural regeneration (ANR); (iv) stream/river-banks protection and riparian vegetation management (SC1.2) - Boosting farmers' adoption of EbA measures, including: (i) use of climate-resilient crop species/varieties which are local, native and/or well-adapted (landraces) and non-invasive; (ii) crop diversification for dietary diversification and nutrition (including vitamins); (iii) agroforestry; (iv) integrated pest management; (v) agronomic techniques facilitating soil and water conservation. Promotion of climate solutions through extension (Farmer Field Schools - FFS) and digital technology, and integration of

			local / traditional/ indigenous knowledge (SC 2.1) - Improved access to finance for farmers to adopt the climate solutions (SC 2.3)
Climate Drivers as Oceanic/Atmospheric Phenomenon	- El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) - Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD)	- No clear link between ENSO and dry/wet years in Malawi. - Explains rainfall together with IOD and other local factors. - Intensity to increase under climate change. - Interacts with ENSO to amplify or attenuate its effects. - Brings cyclones; causes extreme weather events on this own. - Intensity to increase under climate change.	
Non-Climate Drivers	- Unsustainable agriculture practices - Land clearing and deforestation	- Low and stagnant agricultural productivity	- Development and implementation of integrated landscape/watershed management plans founded on EbA (SC 1.1 and SC 1.2)
Barriers	- Planning: climate-resilient landscape/watershed management not well integrated into Village-Level Action Plans - Technical/ Knowledge: lack of consensus among professionals; weak extension services - Social: low literacy rate; insufficient access to markets, services and technology; limited access to land and credit; unequal distribution of decision-making power. - Financial: high transaction costs; ill-suited financial products for EbA; limited income; insufficient collateral; inadequate repayment schedules; low financial literacy ; internal capacity of financing institutions (FIs) - Institutional: limited capacity for finance mobilization; constrained fiscal means; unclear institutional responsibilities; little institutional coordination; insufficient recognition of socially marginalized groups	- Unsatisfactory landscape/watershed management - Disaster relief rather than prevention - Land restoration often without complementary actions and inadequate participatory approach - Limited technical capacity to adapt to the changing climate among farmers and extension workers, including extension service's ability to adjust the content to varying socioeconomic conditions of farmers. - Limited community adaptation capacity, especially for women and other marginalized groups - Scant income generating opportunities for smallholders - Farmers' lack of access to financial resources made appropriate for uptake of climate solutions - Insufficient capacity for mobilizing innovative finance and integrating EbA in national policies.	- Development and implementation of integrated landscape/watershed management plans founded on EbA (SC 1.1 and SC 1.2) - Extension support to boost adoption of EbA solutions at farm level. Implementation of climate responsive and socially inclusive FFS. Training of field extension officers and selected farmers as FFS facilitators, implementation of climate responsive and socially inclusive FFS. Integration of local knowledge. Access to digital technologies (SC 2.1) - Extension support to boost adoption of EbA solutions. Training of field extension officers and selected farmers as FFS facilitators, implementation of climate responsive and socially inclusive FFS. Integration of local knowledge. Access to digital technologies (SC 2.1) - Access to markets through public-private producer partnerships (SC 2.2) - Improved access to finance for farmers to adopt EbA. Triggering shifts from grants to market-based and long-term financing for effective adaptation (SC 2.3) - Social inclusion to be mainstreamed throughout the project. - Improved access to finance for farmers to adopt EbA. Triggering shifts from grants to market-based and long-term financing for effective adaptation (SC 2.3) - Access to sustainable and innovative financing approaches: (i) support to National Climate Change Fund, (ii) development of Payments for Ecosystem Services through a partnership with Climate Asset Management (CAM);(iii) accreditation of national entities for mobilizing climate finance (SC 3.1) - Promotion of EbA into national policies and plans (SC 3.2)

TARGET AREAS (see Annex 2 for additional details)

23. The target areas of the proposed project were pre-identified based on **climate vulnerability** defined as a function of **climate exposure**, **climate sensitivity**, and **climate adaptive capacity** (see Annex 2). The degree of **climate exposure** was

determined by three indicators: historical trends of standardized precipitation; February dry spell trends; and historical annual max temperature trends. **Climate sensitivity** was measured by: historical average Revised Universal Soil Loss (RUSLE) which is based on precipitation, Vegetation Index (NDVI), soil types and slopes; population density; and poverty rate. **Climate adaptive capacity** was approximated by: youth population rate; access to markets; literacy rate; and emigration rate. Low percentage of youth in the population and literacy rates as well as high emigration rates were interpreted as low adaptive capacity. Good access to markets was taken as existing adaptation opportunities that the proposed project could leverage.

24. **Eleven districts** characterized by high climate vulnerability were chosen: six in the **south** (Zomba, Mangochi, Thyolo, Neno, Mwanza, Nsanje); one in the **central** (Dedza); and four in the **north** (Nkhata Bay, Rumph, Karonga and Chitipa). Site selection will be based on further analyses of watershed degradation (as part of sub-activity 1.1.1.1.). The 11 targeted districts have all been selected in relation with their high climate vulnerability, with the South being extremely exposed to climate change, while Northern districts landscapes and ecosystem conditions are characterized by a severe climate sensitivity, in relation with extreme soil loss and degradation¹⁵⁷.

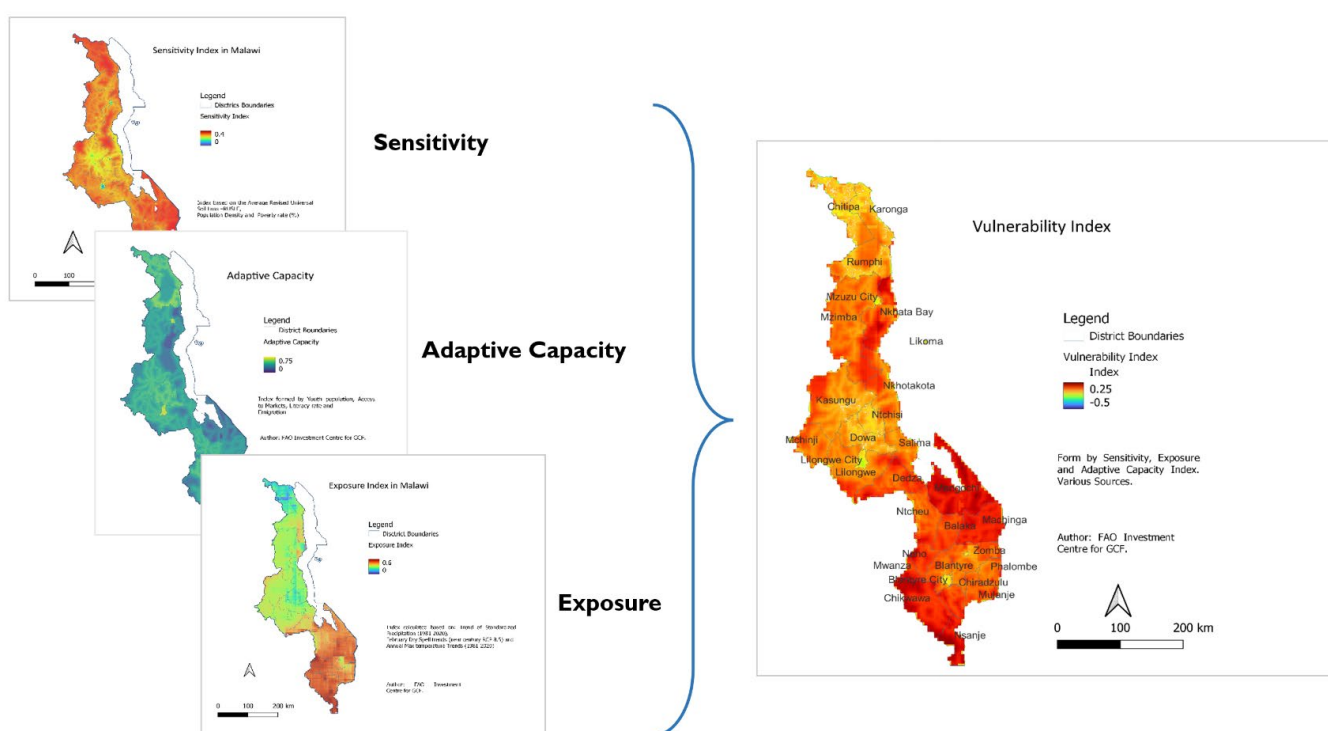


Figure B.1.4: Identification of High Vulnerability Areas¹⁵⁸

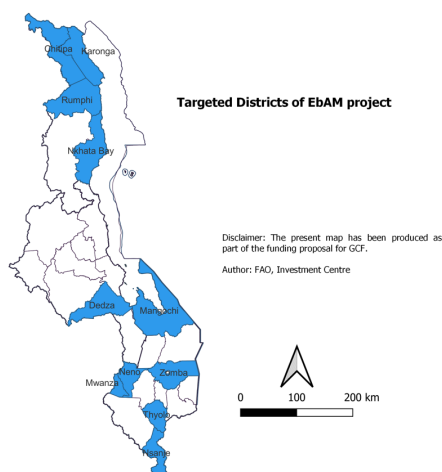


Figure B.1.5: Identification of High Vulnerability Districts Based on High Vulnerability Areas

COUNTRY OWNERSHIP (see Annex 2 for details)

25. Malawi has ratified the [UNFCCC](#), the [Kyoto Protocol](#), the [Paris Agreement](#) and most recently the [Glasgow Leaders' Declaration on Forests and Land Use](#). The [Malawi Growth and Development Strategy 2017-2020](#), the [National Agricultural Policy 2016](#) and the [National Agricultural Investment Plan 2017-2023](#) put agriculture and climate change at the center. Climate change is one of the imminent issues to be tackled, according to the [National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy 2017](#) and the [National Forest Policy 2016](#) (which emphasizes the importance of forests for soil and water and prioritizes payments for ecosystem management, among others). In 2016, Malawi joined the [AFR100](#) (African Forest Landscape Restoration Initiative, which aims to restore 100 million hectares of degraded land in Africa by 2030).

26. The [National Climate Change Policy 2016](#) and the [National Adaptation Plan 2020](#) see climate change as a major impediment to development. According to the [Third National Communication to the Conference of the Parties of the UNFCCC](#), climate change is one of the largest threats to this agriculture dependent country and climate resilient agriculture and strong engagement of local communities are recommended. The [National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy 2017](#) considers gender equity and equality essential, and the [preparatory exercise for NAP](#) identified inclusion of marginalized groups as important.¹⁵⁹ According to the [National Gender Policy 2015](#), climate change management is important in the lives of women, and gender inequality aggravates deforestation impacts.

27. The [Updated Nationally Determined Contribution 2021](#) includes in its priorities the development of adaptation planning tools, EbA, integrated watershed management, crop diversification and soil and water management. In particular, the 2021 NDC includes the following priorities (amounts in parenthesis indicate conditional funds required for the entire country in 2020-2040):-farmer-managed natural regeneration of catchments (USD 30 million); water, soil and catchment conservation for drought resilience (USD 20 million); soil/water conservation and soil fertility improvement (USD 10 million); crop/diet diversification and use of drought tolerant crops (USD 12 million); integrated pest management (USD 30 million); cultivation of legumes for soil health/diet (USD 30 million); climate resilient agronomic practices (USD 20 million); integrated crop-livestock-aquaculture-forest production systems (USD 30 million); drought tolerant or early maturing crops (USD 10 million); and integrated land use management policies (USD 25 million). EbAM will directly contribute to these priorities. As for mitigation priorities from the 2021 NDC, EbAM aligns with identified agroforestry measures (for which the NDC proposes USD 6 million in conditional financing).

SYNERGY WITH OTHER PROJECTS (see Annex 4 for details)

28. The proposed EbAM project scales up the efforts of the [World Bank](#) on watershed management (Watershed Services Improvement Project – MWASIP). It will collaborate with other [GCF](#) funded activities in Malawi (Scaling up the use of Modernized Climate information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi - GCF FP002) for mutual learning and adaptive management, and liaise with the Restore Africa Program, funded by Climate Asset Management (CAM) and implemented by the Global Evergreening Alliance (GEA). The project will work within the institutional framework established by a [European Union/FAO](#) project (KULIMA) and enhance the capacity of extension workers. It will build on the experience of the [GEF/FAO](#) project (under the Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme – GEF7 DSLP) with respect to payment for ecosystems and water services, and will work with an [IFAD-funded](#) Programme under the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise Programme – FARMSE¹⁶⁰) on financial services to improve financial access of rural farmers for climate change adaptation purposes. EbAM will in turn support MoF/FARMSE in mainstreaming climate into rural financing.

Table B.1.2: Other Projects in Malawi relevant for EbAM

Project / Programme title, and linkages with project design
GEF-7. Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme - DSL IP (2021-2026, USD 6.3 million). <i>Transforming landscapes and livelihoods: A cross-sector approach to accelerate restoration of Malawi's Miombo and Mopane woodlands for sustainable forest and biodiversity management</i> . See linkages with sub-component 3.2.
GCF FP002 (AE: UNDP). Scaling up the use of Modernized Climate information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi (2015-2023, USD 16.3 million). See linkages with sub-component 2.1.
Climate Asset Management (CAM), Ever Greening Alliance (GEA), Restoring Landscapes and Livelihoods in Malawi (2021 – 2026). Programme dates: 2022-2027. Crediting period: 2026-2051. US\$17.5 Million. See linkages with sub-component 3.2.
Adaptation Fund (Implementing Entity: WFP). Adapting to Climate Change Through Integrated Risk Management Strategies and Enhanced Market Opportunities for Resilient Food Security and Livelihoods (5 years, USD 9.9 million) (under approval). See linkages with sub-component 2.3.
European Union (Implementing Entity: FAO). KULIMA: Revitalising Agricultural Clusters and <i>Ulimi wa Mdandanda</i> ^[1] through Farmer Field Schools in Malawi (2017-2022, EUR 30 million). See linkages with sub-component 2.1.
MoF/IFAD. Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise Programme – FARMSE (2018-2025, USD 57.7 million). Additional Financing (2025-2028) under design (USD 30 million, tentative). See linkages with sub-component 2.3.

World Bank. Watershed Services Improvement Project – MWASIP (2020-2026, USD 78.5 million). See linkages with component 1.

B.2 (a). Theory of change narrative and diagram (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagram)

29. **The theory of change** is based on the present and future scenarios described in the **climate analysis**. The latter evidenced: (i) the impacts of current (observed) and projected climate change (increased temperatures and aridity, changing temporal distribution of precipitation, increased frequency and intensity of extreme weather events) on agriculture production and livelihoods, and (ii) the degrading impacts of climate change on landscapes and watershed ecosystems, which further reduce the supply of ecosystem goods and services for livelihoods, and consequently increase communities' vulnerability. The main climate effects will alter the onset of the rainy season, translate into limited and modified water availability, increasing water stress, with negative impacts on both cash and subsistence crops, resulting in adverse impacts on livelihoods and the overall rural socio-economy. As a consequence, climate-change puts smallholders and their communities under increased pressure to resort to a vicious cycle of maladaptation, unsustainable ecosystem use and management, further constraining ecosystems' capacity to deliver services.

30. The push factor to transform this baseline trend, and promote a more virtuous dynamic of climate-resilient socio-ecological systems, will be driven by mutually connected investments under each of the 3 components presented below (and further described in section B.3). Overall goal, outcomes, outputs and activities are presented in the theory of change diagram (see figure B.2.1).

31. **Component 1.** The objectives of this component are to **reduce GHG emissions from improved watershed ecosystems (outcome 1.1)** and to **increase climate resilience of watershed ecosystems (outcome 1.2)**. These outcomes will be attained by enhancing ecosystem functions at a landscape (watershed) level large enough to facilitate climate change adaptation and mitigation at scale: under EbAM, farmers will positively adapt, by safeguarding the natural resource base, and providing better *services to ecosystems* (reciprocal relationship between farmers and nature), a paradigm shift brought by EbA & ILM. The component will indeed use the EbA approach which involves use of biodiversity and ecosystem services to assist catchment and village communities to adapt and become more resilient to climate change. EbA – as described in section B.1 - will be firmly integrated in local planning through integrated landscape management (ILM), at sub-catchment and micro-catchment levels. The EbA approach integrated in ILM is the core transformational driver and innovation of the component. The approach will improve communities' technical capacities as well as increase stakeholders' engagement, including women and other vulnerable groups, to plan landscape restoration and climate-change adaptation interventions based on EbA (output 1.1). With the implementation of integrated management plans (output 1.2), the project will strengthen communities' capacity to protect and restore public goods, such as well-functioning ecosystems, which are more adapted to extreme climate and continue to provide goods and services (e.g., carbon sequestration and storage, water infiltration and retention and soil fertility) under the changing climate. This will mitigate, in turn, the impact of projected increased temperature, erratic rainfalls and increased occurrence of extreme weather events impacting the top soil which is the major contributing layer to soil fertility. These benefits will directly support sustainable agricultural production and local livelihoods.

32. **Component 2:** The objective (**outcome 2**) of this component is “**more climate resilient livelihoods and food systems are leading to stable productivity and incomes**”. The project will boost the efficacy of EbA in food systems through the adoption of EbA at all scales, including production systems, and an enhanced and sustainable access to markets, business opportunities, as well as finance. This shift will support farmers to stabilize and increase their income, hence making their livelihoods more resilient in the context of climate change. By combining the promotion of EbA through Farmers' Field Schools (FFS) with an enhanced access to biodiversified, native and/or well-adapted seeds and seedlings (output 2.1), the Project will increase farmers' understanding of technical responses, and improve their capacity to adapt to changing climatic conditions. Through a Food System approach, the Project will support farmer groups, producers organisations (POs) and small and medium enterprises (SMEs) to access (i) markets through public-private producers partnerships (output 2.2) and (ii) finance – such as village savings and loans associations, micro-finance institutions and banks (output 2.3), which are two of the key barriers to climate-change adaptation. The component's interventions, by boosting nature-positive food production and building farmers' resilience to shocks and stresses, will in turn contribute the increased resilience of food systems at local level.

33. **Component 3:** The objective (**outcome 3**) of this component is to **enhance the enabling environment (in terms of finance and policies) with the purpose to sustain, replicate and scale-up climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices**, ultimately facilitating mobilization, blending, and disbursing of catalytic climate finance, and contribute to expanding the scale of the Project climate-resilient investments, while EbA will be mainstreamed and deep-rooted in national policies and investment plans. Strengthened capacities of national institutions (National Climate Change Fund - NCCF, and local national conservation trusts) to mobilize innovative public and private finance, together with leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits as part of the exit strategy (output 3.1), complemented by improved

sectoral policies/ investment plans with EbA integrated (output 3.2) will contribute to sustainably crowd-in public and private investment flows towards climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agricultural practices, for massive-scale impact and sustainability.

34. The below diagram illustrates the relationship and complementarity between the three components, as described in the paragraph below:



35. **Component 1** protects and restores public goods, such as ecosystem services, hence improving i.a. water infiltration, the soil water holding capacity and fertility. Well-functioning ecosystems are more adapted to extreme climate and will also make farming systems resilient. Farmers, having access to knowledge, climate-resilient inputs, markets, technologies and financial services (**component 2**), will positively adapt, safeguard the natural resource base, and provide better *services to ecosystems* (reciprocal relationship between farmers and nature) and thus contributing to component 1 objectives. **Component 3** will enhance component 1 and 2 by developing the enabling environment, and by increasing investment flows towards climate resilient watershed ecosystems, and resilient livelihoods and food systems. Component 1 and 2 will inform policy, decision making and investment strategies. EbAM will be a catalyst for a broad shift and new sustainable equilibrium for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture across Malawi, from their baseline state of very high vulnerability, to an alternative paradigm in which watershed ecosystems are conserved, restored, and more sustainably managed, thus granting their adaptation to climate change, and their supply of services to climate-resilient farming systems, people and communities. **Together, the 3 components will generate co-benefits** that will directly contribute to Sustainable Development Goals such as No Poverty (SDG1), Good Health and Well being (SDG3), Gender Equality (SDG5) and Life on Land (SDG15) (see B.2b).

36. **The Goal Statement is** “if 1) landscapes and watershed ecosystems are sustainably managed with the involvement of vulnerable groups, 2) farmers’ capacity to implement climate-resilient agriculture and to access markets is increased, and 3) policies conducive of climate change adaptation and sustainable climate finance is in place, **then** a new sustainable equilibrium for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture across Malawi will be attained, **because** vulnerable rural communities will have more climate resilient livelihoods, with reduced GHG emissions.

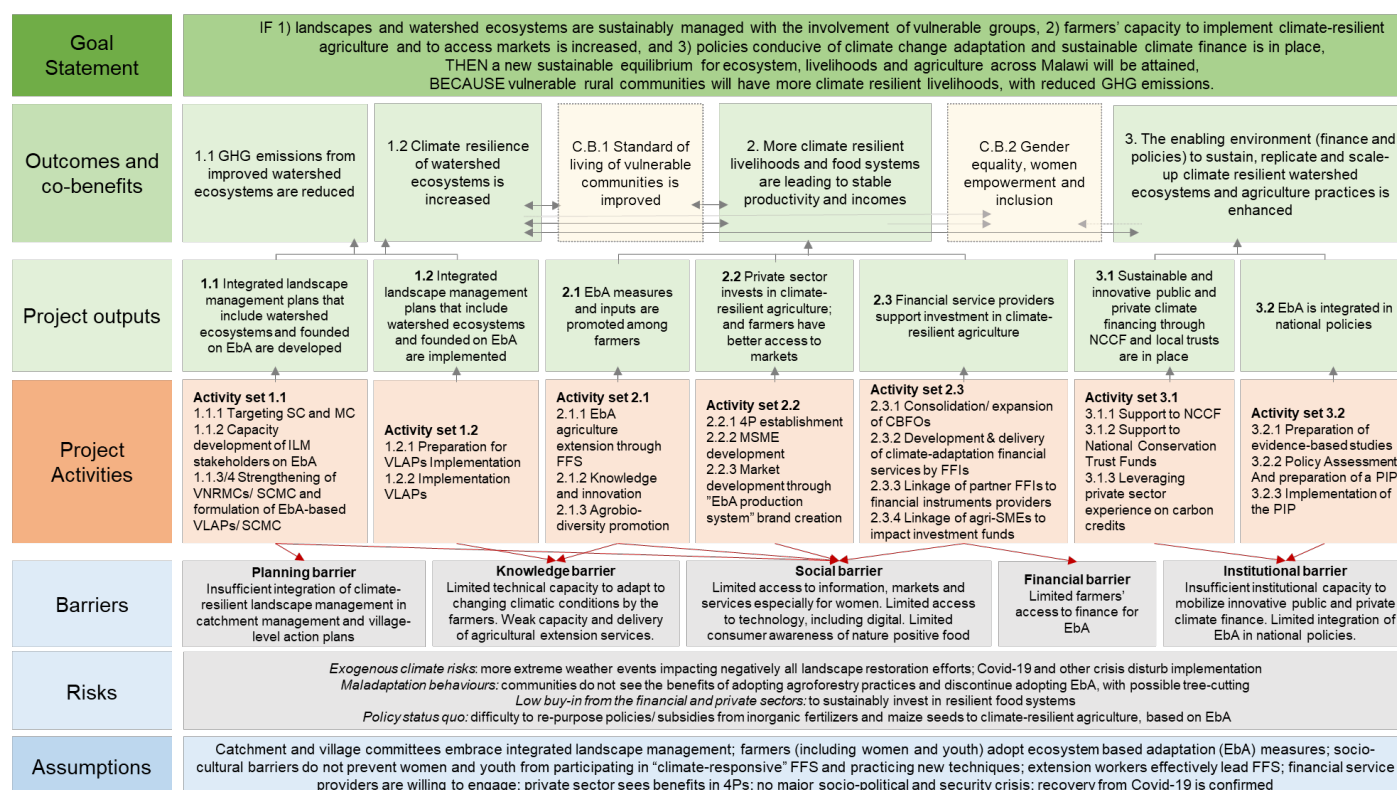
37. These results and goal are subject to the following assumptions: (i) catchment and village committees embrace integrated landscape management; (ii) farmers (including women and youth) adopt ecosystem based adaptation (EbA) measures; (iii) socio-cultural barriers do not prevent women and youth from participating in “climate-responsive” FFS and practicing new techniques; (iv) extension workers effectively lead FFS (iv) financial service providers willingly serve clients with characteristics different from conventional ones; (v) the private sector is interested in 4Ps and is ready to act upon it; (vi) no major socio-political shocks occur; and (vii) recovery from COVID-19 is confirmed. Results are also conditional to risks – which are described in section F.1 of the Funding Proposal, and highlighted in the ToC diagram below.

38. The project interventions respond to the multifaceted barriers (see B.1.) to climate change adaptation in Malawi. These include:

- *Planning barriers: climate-resilient landscape management for watersheds is not well integrated into Village-Level Action Plans (VLAPs).*¹⁶¹ This barrier will be addressed by supporting/ training Catchment Management Committees (CMCs) and Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCS) to prepare EbA-based Catchment Management Plans (CMPs) and Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) through ILM (activity set 1 in the ToC).

- **Technical / Knowledge:** *technical capacity to adapt to the changing climate is limited among farmers and extension workers.* This barrier will be addressed under activity sets 1.2 and 2.1, through the implementation of VLAPs and EbA agriculture extension support through FFS.
- **Social:** *Community adaptation capacity is unsatisfactory due to low access to information, markets, services and technology required for climate resilient livelihoods, especially among women¹⁶² and other vulnerable groups.* This barrier will be addressed under activity sets 1.1, 2.1, 2.2 and 2.3, through the implementation of ILM and VLAPs, FFS and 4Ps, and through the improvement of financial inclusion with community-based financial organisations (Community-based financing organisations – CBFOs/ village savings and loans association/ VSLAs).
- **Financial:** *Farmers have poor access to financial resources and their managerial capacity in finance is limited for uptake of EbA. Farmers' access to finance, while recognized as a crucial factor in the adoption of climate resilient agriculture, remains unsatisfactory.*¹⁶³ This barrier will be addressed under activity set 2.3, that will result in financial service providers being incentivized to invest in climate-resilient agriculture; hence enhancing farmers' financial inclusion.
- **Institutional:** *Institutional capacity is limited for climate mainstreaming, mobilizing innovative finance and integrating EbA into national policies.* This barrier will be addressed under activity sets 3.1 and 3.2, that will result in (i) more sustainable and innovative public and private climate financing through NCCF and local trusts being in place, and (ii) EbA and ILM integrated in national policies and investment plans.

Figure B.2.1. Theory of Change



B.2 (b). Outcome mapping to GCF results areas and co-benefit categorization

39. Outcomes are highlighted in the ToC above. In the ToC there are three outcomes and four (4) co-benefits. The table below maps these outcomes to the relevant results areas, and 4 co-benefits.

Outcome number	GCF Mitigation Results Area (MRA 1-4)				GCF Adaptation Results Area (ARA 1-4)			
	MRA 1	MRA 2	MRA 3	MRA 4	ARA 1	ARA 2	ARA 3	ARA 4

	Energy generation and access	Low-emission transport	Building, cities, industries, appliances	Forestry and land use	Most vulnerable people and communities	Health, well-being, food and water security	Infrastructure and built environment	Ecosystems and ecosystem services
Outcome 1.1: GHG emissions from improved watershed ecosystems are reduced	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐
Outcome 1.2: Climate resilience of watershed ecosystems is increased	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☒
Outcome 2: Productivity and farmers' incomes are stabilized thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems	☐	☐	☐	☒	☒	☒	☐	☐
Outcome 3: The enabling environment (finance and policies) to sustain and scale-up climate resilient landscape, watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices is enhanced	☐	☐	☐	☒	☒	☐	☐	☒
40. Identified co-benefits for EbAM include:								
- Co-benefit 1 <i>Standard of living of vulnerable communities is improved</i> is generated through outcome 1.2 and outcome 2.								
- Co-benefit 2 <i>Gender equality, women empowerment and inclusion</i> is supported by all project outcomes.								
Co-benefit number	Environmental	Social	Economic	Gender	Adaptation	Mitigation		
Co-benefit 3	☐	☒		☐	☐	☐		
Co-benefit 4	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐		
B.3. Project/programme description (max. 2500 words, approximately 5 pages)								
41. The project objective is to increase the climate-change resilience of the most vulnerable rural communities at watershed level in Malawi. This objective will be achieved through the implementation of three interlinked components. The proposed project is expected to directly benefit around 270,820 individuals (about 1.47% of total Malawian population)								

vulnerable to climate-change in 11 pre-identified districts and 30 main sub-catchments. Indirectly, the project will benefit about 304,035 people (1.57% of total Malawian population). Total number of beneficiaries will reach 574,855.

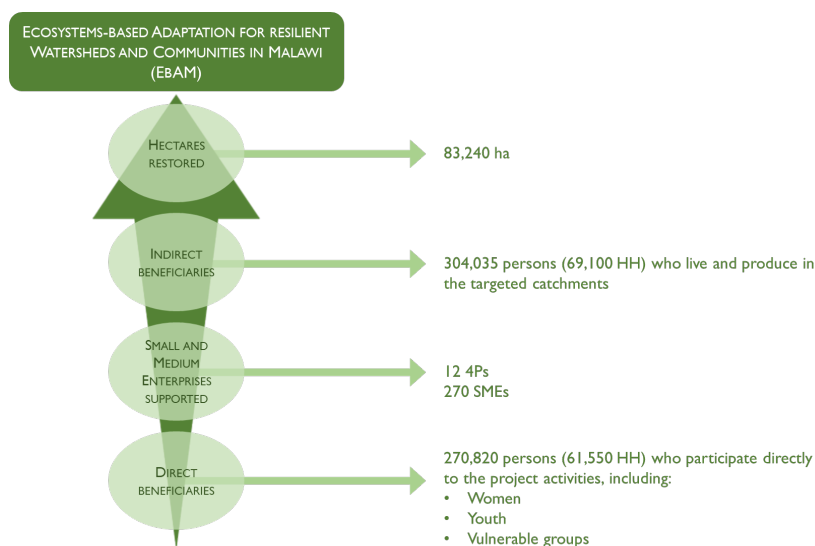


Figure B.3.1. Project beneficiaries. See *Feasibility Study* for details on the calculation of beneficiaries.

COMPLEMENTARITY OF ACTIVITIES OF EbAM

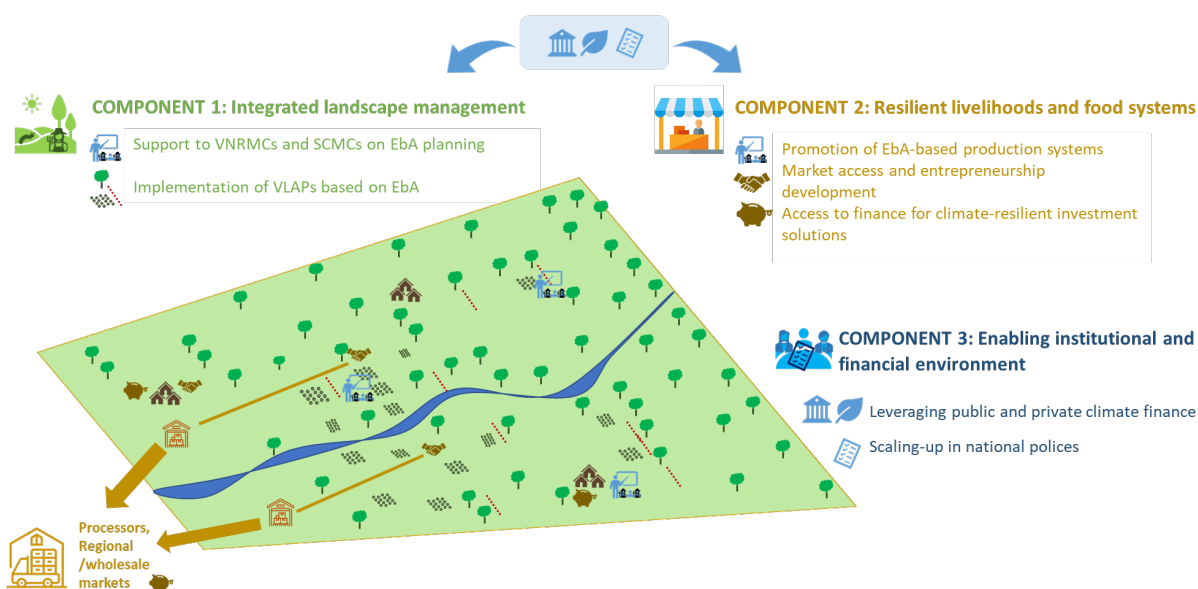


Figure B.3.2. Complementarity of activities and components of EbAM at watershed level.

42. **Component 1: Integrated Landscape Management.** The objectives of this component are (i) to reduce GHG emissions from improved watershed ecosystems (outcome 1.1) and, (ii) to increase the climate resilience of watershed ecosystems (outcome 1.2). This component will contribute to GCF ARA2 “Health, well-being, food and water security”, GCF ARA4 “Ecosystems and Ecosystem Services” and GCF MRA4 “Forestry and Land Use”. This component will address the negative climate impact pathways from increased temperatures and rainfall variability leading to droughts and floods,¹⁶⁴ all contributing to accelerated ecosystem degradation. It will use ecosystem-based adaptation (EbA) as the main tool to build climate resilience, which will be firmly integrated in local planning through integrated landscape management, at watershed and village levels. The component will improve the technical capacity of watershed management committees and the local residents, and increase stakeholders’ engagement, including women, youth and other vulnerable groups, to plan watershed restoration and climate-change adaptation interventions based on EbA and landscape approach (sub-

component 1.1). Through the implementation of integrated management plans (sub-component 1.2), the project will contribute to restoring and strengthening the functionality of public goods, in particular well-functioning watershed ecosystems, so that they are more adapted to extreme climate, and hence with increased resilience.

43. **The Component addresses the planning, knowledge, social and institutional barriers:** *the planning barrier* by assisting watershed management planning, *the knowledge barrier* by capacity building necessary for planning, formation of watershed management committees and implementation of management plans, *the social barrier* by developing capacity on technical and social issues, including gender and social inclusion, as well as increasing social capital through participatory approaches and *the institutional barrier* by way of bolstering watershed management committees at WRU sub-catchment and WRU micro-catchment levels. Integrated landscape management is holistic, participatory and integrated in local planning, and deals with both private and communal lands; it promotes equitable and inclusive land tenure in local communities.

44. **Activities under the component are innovative in that they accompany local communities through establishment of integrated landscape management (ILM) as an EbA strategy.** The Project employs an ILM approach (holistic, participatory and integrated in local planning) to watershed management with EbA as a technical guide. The landscape approach was chosen among other strategies based on the past experiences in the discipline, which have led to widespread dissatisfaction with top-down development paradigms.¹⁶⁵ The definition of integrated landscape management for EbAM is: watershed management to achieve climate-change adaptation objectives through processes that recognize, reconcile and synergize interests, attitudes and actions of relevant stakeholders, and that are driven by local stakeholders.¹⁶⁶

45. **Activities under the component build on the legacy of past projects for more sustainability.** They bolster the watershed management structures and processes defined by the government (i.e. Forestry Act 1997, Water Resources Act 2013, *Malawi National Guidelines: Integrated Catchment Management and Rural Infrastructure 2015*) at Water Resource Unit (WRU), sub- and micro-catchment levels by strengthening existing watershed management committees at these levels: Sub-Catchment Management Committee (SCMC) and Village Natural Resources Management Committee (VNRMC), respectively (see Table B.3.1.1). The project will establish them where they do not yet exist and strengthen those that are already in place. The watershed communities at the two levels will be assisted in formulating watershed management plans (Sub-Catchment Management Plan – SCMP, and Village Level Action Plan – VLAP, respectively) as ILM plans for EbA. VNRMCs were supported under the World Bank-funded “Shire Valley Transformation Program” (SVTP-I). VNRMCs and SCMCs are leveraged under “Watershed Services Improvement Project” (MWASIP), which is also promoting VLAPs for watershed management. EbAM will engage VNRMC and SCMCs in discussions geared towards the co-designing of watershed management solutions and participatory processes for sustainable landscapes. EbAM differentiates itself from other projects by focusing on climate change adaptation and creation of an enabling environment at all levels for holistic and systemic transformation. EbAM also promotes a holistic, inclusive and local nature of ILM that works towards long term sustainable actions, which is reinforced by building on local/traditional knowledge. It is hence replicable in other WRUs in the country, which share many common challenges. EbAM envisages strong involvement of beneficiaries on the ground by implementing ILM in an unencumbered form; it is based on the pioneering work of the World Bank projects mentioned above, while ensuring deeper involvement of landscape stakeholders in the EbA planning and subsequent processes.

46. **The component will be based on the engagement of ILM Facilitators.** A total of 60 ILM Facilitators (a team of two persons for each targeted sub-catchment; one ILM Facilitator who is a national expert on community development and one ILM Co-Facilitator who is another community development expert knowledgeable about the relevant sub-catchment area) will be engaged through contracts with NGOs to accompany ILM stakeholders through sub-component 1.1, leading to strengthening/establishment of committee and ILM plans at micro-catchment (see Sub-Activity 1.1.3) and sub-catchment levels (see Sub-Activity 1.1.4): VNRMC and Village Level Action Plans (VLAP; ILM plan of micro-catchments); and SCMC and Sub-Catchment Management Plan (SCMP; ILM plan of sub-catchments). ILM facilitators will also lead the implementation of gender and social inclusion activities (see sub-activity 1.1.2.2) – and support implementation of the VLAPs (see sub-component 1.2).

Table B.3.1 Catchments of Various Levels and Characteristics

Catchment Unit	Indicative Size (ha)	Responsible Party for Delineation	Primary Stakeholders	Government Defined Management Tools	EbAM Interventions

Catchment (Water Resources Unit)	18,000-400,000	Malawi Government	Communities, farmers (including pastoralists), other land users Local government officials, including higher-level officials than those for sub-catchments Traditional authorities, NGOs, private sector, etc.	Catchment Management Committee (CMC) Catchment Management Plan (CMP)	None
Sub-catchment (WRU sub-catchment)	1,500-45,000	EbAM taking other donor delineation into account	Communities, farmers (including pastoralists) Other land users Local government officials, including higher-level officials than those for micro-catchments Traditional authorities, NGOs, Farmers organisations, private sector, etc.	Sub-Catchment Management Committee (SCMC) Sub-Catchment Management Plan (SCMP)	Strengthening/ Formation of Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Sub-Catchments Management Plans (SCMPs) (Activity 1.1.4)
Micro-catchment (sub-catchment of WRU sub-catchment)	500-1,500	EbAM	Communities (farmers, pastoralists, etc.) Other land users Local government officials and traditional authorities	Village Natural Resources Management Committee (VNRMC) Village Level Action Plan (VLAP) or Group VLAP (about 10 villages, in case their resources are commonly managed)	Strengthening/ Formation of Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) (Activity 1.1.3)

47. **Identification and selection of catchments within selected districts will follow a rigorous process (see Feasibility Study for more details).** The six stages of the targeting are: (i) identification of target Districts based on climate vulnerability (as described in section B.1); (ii) identification of target Water Resources Units (WRUs) within target Districts based on climate vulnerability and complementarity with other Projects (e.g. FAO-funded KULIMA); (iii) delineation of selected WRU catchments into WRU sub-catchments based on hydrology and in line with the sub-catchment delineation of other partners in Malawi (e.g. World Bank-funded MWASIP); (iv) selection and validation of WRU sub-catchments based on climate vulnerability, hydrological, ecological and social considerations; (v) delineation of WRU sub-catchments into WRU micro-catchments based on hydrology and number of villages contained; and (vi) selection and validation of target WRU micro-catchments based on climate vulnerability, hydrological, ecological and social considerations. The last three stages of the targeting will be carried out during project implementation, under sub-component 1.1, for ensuring participation of local stakeholders, interest and consent. Figure B.3.3 shows the locations of the selected WRUs, and figure B.3.4 shows an example of delineation process in WRU 8 in Nhakata Bay and Rumphi districts.



Figure B.3.3: Selected WRUs (right) within selected districts (left), based on WRUs defined by the Government (centre)

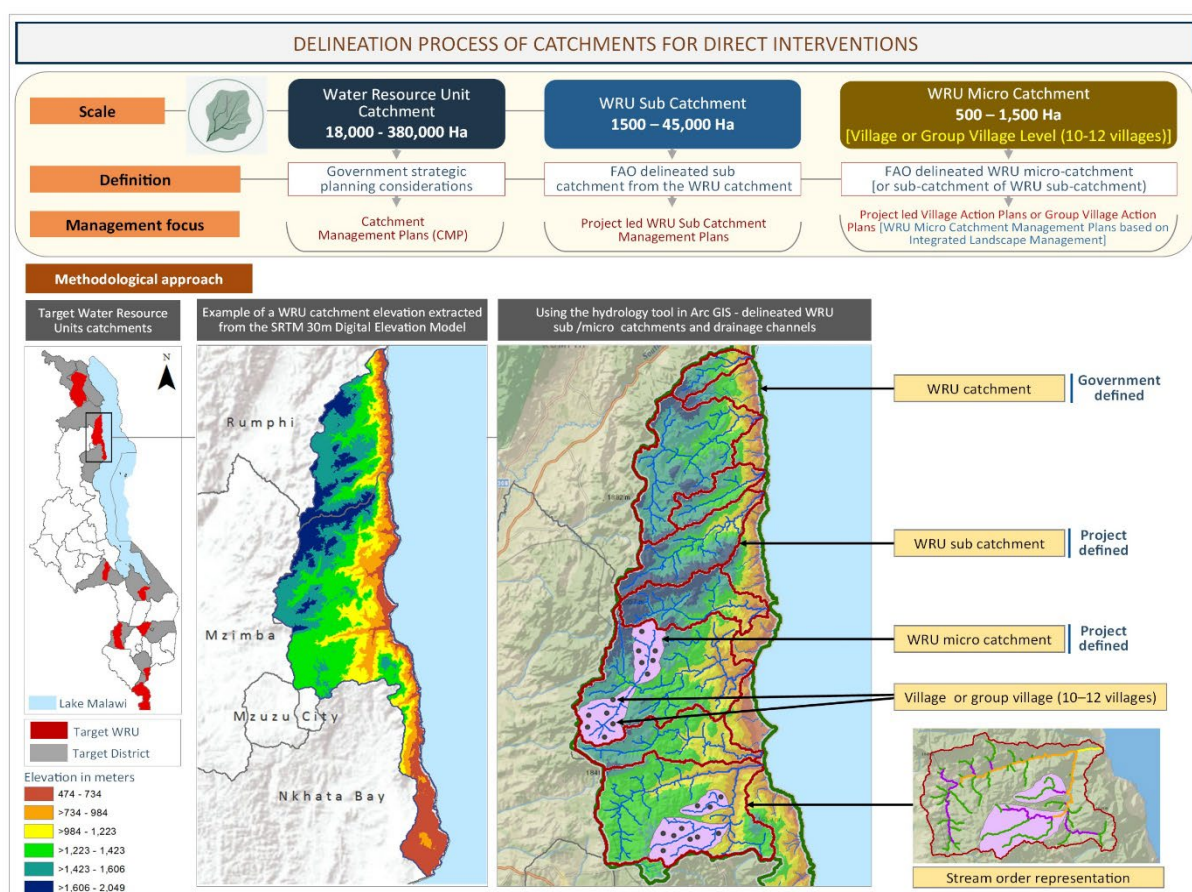


Figure B.3.4: Delineation of Micro-Catchments within WRU sub-catchment

48. **Sub-Component 1.1 Support to Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) on EbA Planning.** (Output 1.1 Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are developed). The sub-component will support the development of integrated landscape management plans for watersheds with ecosystems-based adaptation principles: Village Level Action Plans - VLAPs (which are plans for micro-catchments contained in targeted sub-catchments) and Sub-Catchment Management Plans - SCMP (see Table B.3.1). VNRMCs - which are committees for micro-catchments - and SCMCs will be established in climate-vulnerable areas where they do not yet exist and strengthened, if needed, where they are already

in place. This sub-component will be implemented through MoA/DLRC (i.e. decentralized staff within each of the 8 ADD offices) and FAO as Executing Entities.

49. **Activity 1.1.1. Targeting and Phasing of Sub-Catchments and Micro-Catchments.** This activity will support the selection of 30 target WRU sub-catchments (see Figure B.3.3.) for phased intervention. The activity will also support the selection of 111 micro-catchments contained in the targeted WRU sub-catchments for village-level intervention. The detailed targeting process led by MoA/DLRC is described in the Feasibility Study. The phased implementation of the activities will create opportunities to benefit from lessons learned under the project. The Activity will comprise of the following three sub-activities:

- **Sub-activity 1.1.1.1: Identification and assessment of 30 sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments (financed by GCF, executed by MoA/DLRC).** The sub- and micro-catchments where EbAM will intervene will be chosen based on climate vulnerability, taking into account hydrological, ecological/environmental and socioeconomic factors under the leadership of MoA/Department of Land Resources Conservation (DLRC), with support of FAO (Project Implementation Unit – PIU staff), local government (districts), and relevant Traditional Authorities. ILM Facilitators will be engaged as observers. A rapid GIS hotspot assessment using GPS/GIS data and ground-truthing will be conducted for all delineated sub-catchments and micro-catchments of targeted WRUs by an international GIS and water-resources-management expert (consultant), with the support of MoA/DLRC officers¹⁶⁷, and the assistance of MoA/DAES officials (Department of Agriculture Extension Services) trained under the FAO-funded KULIMA Project. An average micro-catchment will contain about 10 villages.
- **Sub-activity 1.1.1.2: Free, prior informed consent (FPIC) and environmental and social assessment for 30 sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments (financed by FAO, implemented by FAO).** This sub-activity will finance FPIC implementation for all potential beneficiary communities¹⁶⁸ to ensure their strong engagement and adequate participation of youth, women and other vulnerable groups when targeting sub-catchment and micro-catchments. FPIC facilitators will be trained and engaged for this purpose. An assessment of environmental and social baseline and potential impacts will be also prepared. Based on institutional capacity development gaps identified in the assessment, the project will provide trainings on environmental and social risk assessment and monitoring to relevant government staff (e.g. MoA/DLRC officers, Environmental District Officers).
- **Sub-activity 1.1.1.3: Validation and phasing of 30 targeted sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments (financed by GCF, executed by MoA/DLRC).** Target sub- and micro-catchments will be validated under the leadership of MoA/DLRC, together with FAO, local governments and relevant Traditional Authorities. Phasing of project implementation in micro-catchments will be as follows: 11 will start in year 2, 70 in year 3 and 30 in year 4.

50. **Activity 1.1.2 Capacity Development of ILM Stakeholders on Ecosystem-based Adaptation (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** This activity will support awareness raising and capacity building of landscape stakeholders on technical and social matters for effective ILM founded on EbA. For the same purpose, it will support capacity development of ILM facilitators, Traditional Authorities (TAs) and local government officials. ILM Facilitators will be assigned to each targeted sub-catchment to guide the landscape stakeholders of micro-catchment through planning, and plan implementation. Facilitators will ensure good understanding of ILM process among stakeholders and guide communities through various trainings and planning. They will also ensure active participation of women and youths. The Activity will consist of the following Sub-activities:

- **Sub-activity 1.1.2.1: Capacity Development for EbA Implementation.** ILM Facilitators' training as trainers will be provided by national experts in each of the following fields: (i) ILM – including landscape demarcation, resources inventorying and stakeholders identification, (ii) climate change – including climate vulnerability and impacts, as well as climatic trends; (iii) water resources management; (iv) ecosystem services and ecosystem-based adaptation (detailed information on EbA and its techniques are given in Appendix 1 of the Feasibility Study); (v) payment for ecosystem services (PES); and; (vi) adaptive management. Specific trainings on Climate Change will be delivered by experts from the Department of Climate Change and Meteorological Services (DCCMS) – who has been supported by the GCF-funded “Scaling Up The Used of Modernized Climate Information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi” - GCF FP002, and by FAO on the Modelling System for Agricultural Impacts of Climate Change (MOSAICC). Gender and Social Inclusion will also be mainstreamed throughout the training with the support of the CPIU Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist. The climate change expert from DCCMS will join for two days in total to make the link between climate change and EbA. After being trained as trainers, ILM Facilitators will build local residents' capacity at each micro-watershed on the same topics as their training as trainers. The detailed topics are indicated in the Feasibility Study (Annex 2).

- **Sub-activity 1.1.2.2: Gender and Social Inclusion.** Vulnerability to climate change originates from social exclusion, which engenders lack of access to resources and lack of assets and economic opportunities: the very factors that constitute vulnerability to various shocks and stresses. Therefore, gender empowerment will be tackled at the root in order to create strong ownership of the Project, and promote meaningful participation of stakeholders to facilitate awareness improvements and behavioral change on EbA for climate change adaptation. To this end, the sub-activity will establish a social organization structure at village level for facilitating collective actions, called the *Dimitra Clubs*, which are local groups for female and community empowerment.¹⁶⁹ ILM is founded on meaningful participation, which requires examination of decision-making power parity. Therefore, the sub-activity employs a household methodology (participatory methodology for family members to work together to improve their relations, decision-making and share of workloads related to household) to examine decision-making power parity at the household level, which will be scaled up to the village level by Dimitra Clubs. 30 of the 60 ILM facilitators will act as facilitators of Dimitra Club and household methodology. ILM Facilitators' training as trainers will be provided by international experts in each of the main following fields: (i) Dimitra Club facilitation; (ii) household methodology; and (iii) gender and social inclusion. A particular focus will be put on: gender and sex; advantages and disadvantages of gender-specific roles and tasks; gender-based violence (GBV) and Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), including masculinities and patriarchy; Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process; examples, motives and results of gender discrimination and social exclusion; and gender and social inclusion in community development and welfare, including food and nutrition security. Some religious, traditional leaders and other key figures will also participate in the trainings. Further to the training received, the 30 ILM Facilitators focusing on Gender and Social Inclusion will promote Dimitra Clubs in all their villages of intervention, with the target of 1,100 Dimitra Clubs created. See Annex 2 for mode details.

51. **Activity 1.1.3 Strengthening/Formation of Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) (financed by GCF; executed by FAO).** In line with the Forestry Act 1997, and building on previous projects sponsored by the World Bank, the Activity will establish Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs), or strengthen their functions where VNRMCs already exist, in order to establish an operational watershed management structure at micro-catchment level. The Activity – implemented in collaboration with MoA/DLRC and participation from the Department of Forestry (DoF) - will support mapping of existing VNRMCs, and VNRMC charter establishment or its review and revision where it already exists. The Activity will also support formulation of EbA-based VLAPs and obtaining their approval from the local authorities, i.e. Village Development Committee (VDC). The EbA-based Plans will then be submitted to the District Council for inclusion in the Local Development Plans, and to higher administrative levels: the Area Development Committee (ADC) at TA level; and finally to the District Executive Committee (DEC). In some cases, about 10 villages are geographically close enough that they collectively manage the common natural resources. For such groups of villages, one VNRMC will govern one group. VLAP elaboration will be carried out in phases, i.e. 11 for year 1, 70 for year 2 and 30 in year 3. The Activity will consist of following Sub-activities:

- **Sub-activity 1.1.3.1: VNRMC charter revision and member selection.** Under this sub-activity, that will start with a mapping of existing VNRMCs (carried out by ILM facilitators), ILM Facilitators will oversee and guide landscape stakeholders through VNRMC establishment (charter elaboration and member selection – average about 18 members per committee). Where a VNRMC has already been established, ILM facilitators will guide landscape stakeholders through charter review/revision and additional member selection. ILM Facilitators will oversee elaboration/review/revision and selection processes for transparency and fairness; awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV, will be integrated in this process. Discussions among VNRMC members and other micro-catchment/landscape stakeholders on the matters of charter and member selection will take place five hours per week for four consecutive weeks at each landscape or micro-catchment. ILM Facilitators will ensure that about 60% of stakeholders participate in the discussions and that the VNRMC Charter in effect is documented. ILM Facilitators will ensure that: discussions on inclusive and meaningful membership take place; and 60% of participants in discussions are female and 30% are youths. The direct beneficiaries are approximately 60% or more of the inhabitants, or 168,000 residents, if the same persons participate in review and member selection.
- **Sub-activity 1.1.3.2: VNRMC Capacity Development for EbA Implementation.** Training for VNRMC members will be provided by national experts (DCCMS staff for climate change, and consultants for the rest of thematic areas) in each of the following fields from a strategic point of view (hence, different in content from Sub-activity 1.1.2.1): (i) integrated landscape management; (ii) climate change risks; (iii) water resources management; (iv) ecosystems and ecosystem-based adaptation (detailed information on EbA and its techniques are given in Appendix 1 of the Feasibility Study); (v) payment for ecosystem services (PES); and (vi) adaptive management. Gender and Social Inclusion (including FPIC and a special focus on SEAH and GBV) considerations will be mainstreamed into the trainings with the support of the Gender and Social Inclusion specialist, and ILM facilitators

focusing on Gender and Social Inclusion. The trainings are conducted at each micro-catchment/landscape. The beneficiaries are about 2,000 VNRMC members. See more details in Annex 2.

- **Sub-activity 1.1.3.3: Drafting and Finalizing EbA-based VLAP.** Under this Activity, ILM Facilitators and a national NRM expert (consultant) will guide the discussions to draft and finalize a Village Level Action Plan (VLAP) under the leadership of VNRMC members, to identify investment opportunities for watershed restoration, based on the climate vulnerability assessment (activity 1.1.1), landscape demarcation and resources inventorying, supported by knowledge on EbA and local socioeconomic and cultural conditions. The VLAP preparation process will bring together VNRMC members and ILM facilitators (see detailed steps for EbA based VLAPs in the Feasibility Study), as follows: (i) discussion on Pillars (i.e. vision, goal and objectives) and Elements of VLAP as EbA Strategy; (ii) discussion on detailed actions; (iii) formulation of practical arrangements for VLAP implementation; (iv) discussion and consolidation of VLAPs; and (v) endorsement of VLAP by local government. In-between focused discussions, wider exchanges involving representatives of all the villages in the micro-catchments will be engaged by VNRMC members and ILM facilitators to share the conclusions of meetings, validate them and agree on the way forward. The final VLAP will cover roughly 3 years and will be reviewed yearly for adaptive management by the VNRMC members and other landscape stakeholders. The direct beneficiaries are about 8,800 local stakeholders.

52. **Activity 1.1.4 Strengthening/Formation of Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Sub-Catchments Management Plans (SCMPs) (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).**

This Activity will establish operational watershed management structures (SCMCs) at sub-catchment level, in line with the government's watershed management strategies/ policies. It will support the formulation of strategic plans with interventions in line with climate change adaptation and biodiversity/ecosystem strategies (NDC 2021, National Adaptation Plan 2020, National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy 2017, National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan 2015-2025 and others – see Part 2.1 of this Feasibility Study). SCMP will propose strategic interventions for effective management of large common lands, such as forests, grasslands/rangelands, floodplains, riparian buffer zones, and wetlands that VLAPs and village communities cannot fully cover and address at lower level. It will also address upstream-downstream linkages of micro-catchments contained in the sub-catchment. By strategically integrating climate-change adaptation interventions at a higher catchment planning level, SCMPs will improve the enabling environment, and allow scaling-up/ replication of EbA through other projects and programmes, for impact at a larger scale. The total number of SCMPs will be 30 to cover an area of about 267,500 hectares. SCMP elaboration will be in phases, in accordance with the phases of project implementation at micro-catchment level: roughly 16 in Project Year 4 and 14 in Project Year 5.

- **Sub-activity 1.1.4.1: SCMC charter revision and member Selection.** Under this sub-activity, that will start with a mapping of existing SCMCs (carried out by ILM facilitators), ILM Facilitators will oversee and guide landscape stakeholders through SCMC establishment (charter elaboration and member selection – average about eight members per committee). Where a SCMC has already been established, ILM facilitators will guide landscape stakeholders through charter review/revision and additional member selection. ILM Facilitators will oversee the elaboration/review/revision and selection processes for transparency and fairness; awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV, will be integrated in this process. At sub-catchment level, ILM Facilitators will coordinate SCMC members and consolidate inputs on Charter and selected SCMC members from micro-catchments. The direct beneficiaries are approximately 3-4 inhabitants per village, or 3,330-4,440 residents.
- **Sub-activity 1.1.4.2: SCMC Capacity Development for EbA Implementation.** Ten-days training for SCMC members will be provided by national experts (DCCMS staff for climate change, and consultants for the rest of thematic areas) in each of the following fields from a strategic point of view: (i) integrated landscape management; (ii) climate change; (iii) water resources management; (iv) ecosystems and ecosystem-based adaptation (detailed information on EbA and its techniques are given in Appendix 1 of the Feasibility Study); (v) payment for ecosystem services (PES); and (vi) adaptive management. Gender and Social Inclusion considerations (including FPIC and a special focus on SEAH and GBV) will be mainstreamed into the trainings with the support of the Gender and Social Inclusion specialist, and ILM facilitators focusing on Gender and Social Inclusion. The location will be each targeted sub-catchment (two SCMC will be trained together in one sub-catchment). The beneficiaries are about 240 SCMC members.
- **Sub-activity 1.1.4.3: Drafting and Finalizing EbA-based SCMP.** Under this Activity, ILM Facilitators and a national senior NRM expert (consultant) will guide the discussions among SCMC members to identify strategic investment opportunities for watershed restoration and business development based on climate vulnerability, landscape resources and supported by knowledge on EbA and local socioeconomic and cultural conditions, as well as lessons from the VLAP development and implementation process. Investment opportunities will also be informed by strategic national documents as referred above. Relevant stakeholders of the landscapes contained in the sub-catchment in question (SCMC members, VNRMC members, TAs and district officials) will engage in

exchange of ILM experiences and discuss the best way forward for SCMPs. MoA/DLRC will also actively participate, together with the Department of Forestry (DoF). The emphasis will be on strategic planning based on upstream-downstream linkages of micro-catchments. Steps for EbA-based SCMPs will include: (i) Discussion on Pillars and Elements of SCMP as EbA Strategy, (ii) Formulation and Finalization of Draft SCMP and Approval and Communication of Final SCMP, (iii) Discussion, Finalization, Approval and Communication of SCMP, and (iv) Restitution workshop at central level. The final SCMP will cover roughly six years, and may be revised at mid-term for adaptive management. See Annex 2 for more details.

53. **Sub-component 1.2: Implementation of VLAPs based on EbA** (output 1.2: Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are implemented). EbA interventions funded under this sub-component will be the result of the identified investment priorities in the VLAPs. An estimated total area of 83,240 hectares (communal and on-farm) will be targeted within the micro-catchments covered by the 111 VLAPs in the 30 WRU sub-catchments, in the main 8 WRUs. EbA interventions financed under this sub-component will be public investments that are of collective interest, generate public goods (such as services for and from ecosystems) and are proven applicable for the Malawi context. Feasibility and scalability of EbA interventions is highlighted in the Government's *Malawi National Guidelines: Integrated Catchment Management and Rural Infrastructure 2015* and in the *National Forest Landscape Restoration Assessment (NFLRA) 2016*¹⁷⁰ that identified the needs and opportunities for the restoration of the productivity and ecosystem functions of degraded and deforested landscapes in Malawi at district level. Details on EbA interventions are also described in the Feasibility Study (Annex 2).

54. **Activity 1.2.1 Preparation of VLAP implementation.** Under this activity, relevant expertise necessary to support the implementation of VLAPs will be mobilized, looking at ensuring continuity with the support provided under sub-component 1.1. Necessary coordination and preparatory arrangements will also be rolled-out to ensure a smooth implementation of VLAPs at local level. This step will also be critical to ensure the necessary inputs for VLAP implementation and to be procured by NLGFC each year (under sub-activity 1.2.2.1.) are identified in an exhaustive and timely manner. The Activity will consist of the following Sub-activities:

- **Sub-activity 1.2.1.1: Planning process to initiate VLAP implementation (financed by GCF, executed by MoA/DLRC).** VLAP implementation will entail a continuous planning process. Following the completion of VLAP preparation, MoA/DLRC will accompany the preparation of the planning process, with support from facilitators and the CPIU and prepare a 12 months VLAP procurement plan. Based on the agreed procurement plan, a detailed list of required inputs will be compiled for submission to the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC – see below) – through the District Council. The precise organization will be discussed and agreed upon among stakeholders with respect to work involved in VLAP implementation, and in line with arrangements foreseen during VLAP formulation. ILM Facilitators will coordinate this adaptive management for operations. MoA/DLRC will ensure that regular follow-up meetings are organized quarterly in order to discuss progress and issues related to VLAP implementation in their respective Districts of interventions.

55. **Activity 1.2.2 VLAP Implementation.** EbAM will target a net intervention area of about 83,240 hectares across communal and agriculture land use, within the total micro-catchment area. This activity will enable the actual delivery of investments outlined in each of the 111 VLAPs developed under sub-component 1.1. EbA investments financed under this sub-component will be targeting communal lands (e.g., forests, grasslands/rangelands, floodplains, riparian buffer zones and wetlands) over an area of approximately 67,040 hectares (while Component 2 will target 16,200 hectares of on-farm interventions through the Farmers Field Schools - FFS). Detailed calculations are provided in the Feasibility Study. The estimated sub-catchment planning area and micro-watershed intervention area (i.e. landscapes under EbA) per WRU and districts are highlighted in table B.3.3. The Activity will consist of the following sub-activities:

- **Sub-activity 1.2.2.1: Technical assistance to VLAP implementation (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** This sub-activity will focus on the mobilization of the required expertise for the implementation of VLAPs. This expertise will be composed of both (i) the 60 ILM facilitators (30 two-person teams) already engaged through NGOs under sub-component 1.1., as a way to ensure continuity in the facilitation process, engagement with communities, and continuity/understanding of the VLAPs; and (ii) technical expertise from qualified and experienced service providers (international and national NGOs), for example NGOs from the Malawi Climate Smart Agriculture Alliance (MCSAA¹⁷¹), which have extensive expertise on EbA techniques and climate change adaptation in Malawi, and have regularly collaborated with MoA/DLRC. Other organisations specialised in agroecology such as Permaculture Network Malawi will also be consulted for technical advice.
- **Sub-activity 1.2.2.2: Access to inputs and equipment (financed by GCF; executed by NLGFC).** This sub-activity will finance inputs for implementing VLAPs on about 67,040 hectares of communal land. Based on the district-level potential highlighted in the *National Forest Landscape Restoration Assessment*, ecosystem-based

adaptation options will include: (i) soil and water conservation (14,352 hectares), (ii) agroforestry, pastureland regeneration and FMNR (7,308 hectares), (iii) community forests and woodlot restoration (22,416 hectares), (iv) forest management (22,640 hectares), and (v) river and stream bank restoration (321 hectares). Details per district are provided in the Feasibility Study, and actual investments will depend on the EbA-based VLAPs. Inputs foreseen include: native or well adapted/landrace seeds and seedlings to promote high biodiversity, as well as equipment and material required to perform the works (e.g. boulders, wire, hoes, slashers, wheelbarrows, shovels, rakes, strings, pruning tools, portable water containers etc.)). This sub-activity will be implemented by the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC), as Executing Entity (EE, see B.4). As in the case of the GEF-7 funded *Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme*, NLGFC will provide procurement services to the EbAM project at district level. More specifically, NLGFC will receive regular (bi-annual) updates from the VNRM (with support of relevant project staff and facilitators) on foreseen needs in terms of planting material and equipment (see Annex 2 for more detail).

- **Sub-activity 1.2.2.3: Monitoring of VLAP implementation (financed by GCF; executed by MoA/DLRC).** Under this sub-activity, and following the leadership of MoA/DLRC, technical facilitators will monitor the implementation of VLAP priorities with a focus on communal lands, covering a wide range of interventions: (i) soil and water conservation, for erosion and water runoff control (with green infrastructures such as swales, brush fill, gully plugs and check dams); (ii) natural forest protection; assisted natural regeneration; (iii) community forest and woodlot management; (iv) pastureland management; (v) riverbank protection; (vi) and other livelihoods opportunities and off-farm economic activities (e.g., beekeeping, non-timber forest products – NTFP harvesting – e.g. baobab, moringa/ medicinal plants, fruit, mushrooms). Based on the agreed upon rules for community works, DLRC will ensure that community volunteers are present on site, receive the needed tools, inputs and equipment to perform the works, and will demonstrate and support the implementation of works, while continuing to sensitize about the relevance and benefits of the applied techniques. ILM Facilitators will also assist in community volunteer's mobilization, and ensure that participating women and youth benefit from advice in a meaningful and satisfactory manner. For works that are particularly labour intensive (specifically those related with soil and water conservation, with some green infrastructure: swales, gully plugs, check dams, etc.), the mobilized NGOs under Sub-activity 1.2.2.1 will provide direct support with machinery and specialized labour where applicable. In addition to coordinating this process, MoA/DLRC will support VNRM to ensure and monitor that clear rules are established and followed for the management of achieved interventions.
- Regarding interventions described under (vi) above (livelihoods opportunities and off-farm economic activities - e.g., beekeeping, harvesting NTFP such as baobab), ILM facilitators and technical facilitators will accompany groups of local volunteers in setting up specific management plans based on VLAP priorities for the development and use of local NTFP. These could replicate innovative "Payment for Ecosystem Services" through which beekeepers rent local woodlots to host their hives (see case study/ box in the Feasibility Study). Such emerging economic activities can be further supported and structured through subcomponent 2.2. (to develop value-chains and markets), and 2.3 (to access finance).

Table B.3.3 Targeted districts, TAs and net targeted areas

WRU	Districts	Targeted planning area (Ha)	No. of Sub-CMPs	No. of VLAPs	Watershed Intervention Area (Ha) VLAP
8A	Karonga	14,435	1	7	5,600
	Chitipa	21,653	1	4	3,200
16G	Rumphi	26,724	3	6	4,800
	Nkhataka Bay	54,744	4	6	4,800
4A	Dedza	8,773	1	7	5,600
1M	Neno	20,422	4	9	7,200
	Mwanza	22,063	3	6	4,800
14D	Thyolo	14,029	2	13	10,400
1G	Nsanje	51,003	4	25	20,000
1T	Mangochi	11,592	3	7	5,600
1B	Zomba	22,045	4	21	16,800

		TOTAL	267,500¹⁷²	30	111	83,240¹⁷³
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Table B.3.4 Summary of project beneficiaries, eligibility criteria, support measures and modality of involvement for component 1

Sub-Component 1.1: Support to Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) on EbA Planning				
Project Activities	Type of beneficiary	Eligibility criteria	Support measures	Modalities of beneficiary involvement
Activity 1.1.1: Targeting and Phasing of Sub-Catchments and Micro-Catchments	• [Indirect] all inhabitants of targeted sub-and micro-catchments • [Direct] MoA DLRC and DAES; traditional authorities	• Residency in selected micro-catchments for intervention.	• Provision of GIS and ground-thruthing expert services	• Participation in (i) identification, (ii) assessment, (iii) validation and (iv) phasing of 30 sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments
Activity 1.1.2: Capacity Development of Integrated Landscape Management Stakeholders on Ecosystem-based Adaptation	• [Direct] 60 ILM facilitators (from NGOs) associated with project implementation • [Direct] 1,100 Dimitra Clubs • [Direct] 25 inhabitants per targeted micro-catchment, or 2,775 persons, of which 60% are female and 30% youths (age 15-35).	• Residency in selected micro-catchments for intervention.	• ILM Facilitators' discussion guidance • Organization of trainings on technical (ILM, climate change, EbA, other related technical topics) and social issues (Dimitra Club, Household methodology).	• Participation in capacity development trainings for EbA implementation • Participation in gender and social inclusion programmes.
Activity 1.1.3: Strengthening/Formation of Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs)	• [Direct] 2000 VNRMC members from 111 landscape units, plus wider population engaged during consultations • [Indirect] All inhabitants of targeted micro-catchments- women, men and youth.	• Residency in selected micro-catchments for intervention.	• ILM Facilitators' discussion guidance and coordination at micro-catchment level	• Participation in discussions on VNRMC related issues and in member selection.
Activity 1.1.4 Strengthening/Formation of Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Sub-Catchments Management Plans (SCMPs)	• [Direct] 30 SCMC members (1998 people), plus wider population engaged during consultations • [Indirect] All inhabitants of targeted micro-catchments- women, men and youth.	• Residency in selected sub-catchments for intervention.	• ILM Facilitators' discussion guidance and coordination at sub-catchment level.	• Participation in discussions on SCMC related issues and in member selection.
Sub-component 1.2: Implementation of VLAPs based on EbA				
Activity 1.2.1: Preparation of VLAP implementation	• [Direct] All inhabitants of targeted micro-catchments – women, men and youth	• Residency in selected micro-catchments for intervention.	• ILM Facilitators' discussion guidance and coordination • Technical NGOs	• ILM facilitators provides to micro-watershed/ILM residents: information on climate resilient agriculture; connections to local administrative personnel, experts, goods and service providers, and executing agencies.
Activity 1.2.2: VLAP implementation	• [Direct] All inhabitants of targeted micro-catchments – women, men and youth	• Residency in selected micro-catchments for intervention.	• MoA/DLRC and NLGFC • ILM Facilitators' discussion guidance • Technical NGOs	• Participation in information collection by ILM Facilitators on issues encountered.

56. **Component 2: Resilient livelihoods and food systems.** The objective (Outcome 2) of this component is to stabilize productivity and farmers' incomes thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems. Combined with

component 1 outcomes (ecosystem resilience), and building on the VLAPs developed under component 1.1, this component – which will directly target at least 16,200 ha of farmlands – will contribute to GCF ARA1 “Most Vulnerable People and Communities” (with support for livelihood enhancement through increasing resilience), ARA2 “Health, well-being, food and water security”, and MRA4 “Forestry and land use”. By enhancing extension services through farmers field schools - FFS (sub-component 2.1), the Project will increase farmers’ understanding of technical responses to adapt to changing climatic conditions and enhance their capacity to integrate EbA into their farming systems. The component will support small and medium enterprises (SMEs), producers organisations (POs) and farmer groups within the local food system to access markets (sub-component 2.2) and finance – such as village savings and loans associations, micro-finance institutions and banks (sub-component 2.3), which are some of the key barriers to EbA adoption. The component’s interventions, by boosting nature-positive food production and building resilience to vulnerabilities shocks and stresses, will contribute to build more resilient food systems at local level.

57. **The Component addresses the planning, knowledge, social and financial barriers:** *the knowledge barrier* by enhancing capacities necessary for adopting ecosystem-based adaptation in the production systems through FFS (sub-component 2.1), *the social barrier* by increasing social capital through participatory approaches, and developing capacity on technical and social issues, including gender and social inclusion (sub-component 2.1) and *the financial barrier* (sub-component 2.3) by enhancing access to inclusive finance and markets.

58. **Activities under this sub-component are innovative in that they support smallholder’s resilience to climate change through a food system approach.** Project interventions will engage a wide range of stakeholders of the food system. These include actors involved in the production, processing and marketing of food products that originate from EbA-based production systems, as well as actors supporting the value-chain functions, such as financial service providers. Through sub-component 2.1, EbAM will help farmers in selected micro-catchments to adopt and develop integrated, nature positive production systems, where a variety of climate-resilient, native and well adapted crops are associated. Through sub-component 2.2, EbAM will also support linkages between selected crops/products from diversified, EbA-based production systems with public and private market operators engaged in national or international value-chains through a public-private producers partnerships (4Ps) approach.

59. **Activities promoted are sustainable and replicable.** The integration of EbA in the extension system will allow replication of the approach at regional, national and local levels – with a strong scaling-up potential. Activities are sustainable because EbA integrated in farming systems enhances farmers’ long term capacities to sustain under extreme weather, enhances biodiversity, reduces maladaptation and strengthens watershed/landscape functions and improves food security. Furthermore, farmers adopting EbA will positively adapt, safeguard the natural resource base, and provide better *services to ecosystems*. Such as reciprocal relationship between farmers and nature will therefore enhance environmental sustainability – one of the project’s key co-benefits.

60. **Sub-Component 2.1: Promotion of EbA-based production systems.** (Output 2.1: EbA measures and inputs are promoted among farmers). EbA is knowledge intensive, so farmers’ learning will be at the core of the investment strategy, which will build on the Farmer Field Schools (FFS) approach, supported by the use of digital technology and and targeted technical visits and exchanges. Combined with an enhanced access to varied and adapted genetic material, FFS will facilitate the full application of EbA – while increasing climate change adaptation, enhancing agrobiodiversity and the restoration of ecosystem services.

61. **Activity 2.1.1 EbA agriculture extension support through FFS.** At the level of targeted micro-catchments, EbAM will support the roll out of Farmers Field Schools (FFS). FFS have proven an effective way for uptake of climate-resilient and ecosystem based practices through its participatory and context specific methodology (see Box 2 below). The roll out of the FFS has 3 levels: (i) the Master Trainer’s Course (MTC); (ii) the Training of Facilitators (ToF); and (iii) FFS implementation. The expected output is: 240 MT and 675 facilitators trained and 1,080 FFS implemented, impacting 27,000 farmers over 16,200 ha.

62. The topics covered will include: (i) Conservation agriculture practices (manure management, zero/reduced tillage and use of crop residues/cover crops), with emphasis on the importance of soil organic matters and soil structure by using compost to boost soil fertility and moisture, (ii) Agrobiodiversity and the importance of varied and adapted genetic resources, such as mixed-cropping of native, non-invasive and locally adapted (landraces) varieties, (iii) Promotion of early maturing, nutrition sensitive, drought-resistant and climate-resilient crops (based on Malawi-specific climate models providing some crop suitability analysis at local level¹⁷⁴), (iv) Integrated mix-farming systems¹⁷⁵ and (v) General principles and practices of agroecology and permaculture. The trainings will also include climate and weather information analysis through the Participatory Integrated Climate Services for Agriculture (PICSA)¹⁷⁶ promoted under the GCF-funded “Scaling Up the Use of Modernized Climate Information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi” (GCF FP002). The Project will learn from and build on the PICSA approach and tools (PICSA field manual), which has promoted a collaboration between

DCCMS and the Department of Agriculture Extension Service (DAES) for the use of historical seasonal climate records, participatory decision-making tools and forecasts. Learning from the PICSA approach will enhance master trainers', facilitators' and farmers capacity to deliver FFS, and also to identify and better plan agricultural activities that are suited to local climates and farmers' livelihoods.

- **Sub-activity 2.1.1.1 Master Trainer's Course (MTC) and Training of Facilitators (ToF) (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** EbAM will build on the existing capacity of MoA staff on the FFS approach. During Y1, 4 MTC will be carried out for Agriculture Extension Development Officers (AEDO) and Agriculture Extension District Coordinators (AEDC) level officers¹⁷⁷ from targeted districts¹⁷⁸ where no MTCs have been carried out¹⁷⁹. For the remaining targeted districts and sections where MTC were carried out, 4 refresh courses of 3 weeks will be organized to train extension officials on the EbA approach and practices, including the importance of agrobiodiversity¹⁸⁰. In Y3, after identification of potential commercial FFS, 2 refresher courses on Farm Business School (FBS) will be carried out for all targeted districts. These identified FFS group will be linked and supported through subcomponent 2.2. Community Based Facilitators (CBF) will be identified amongst lead farmers and innovative farmers in targeted villages, women (at least 50%) and men, prioritizing youth.
- **Sub-activity 2.1.1.2 FFS implementation (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** The organization and setting up of the FFS at village level, will come as a result of the VLAPs, and will therefore be closely linked with activities from Component 1. FFS groups will be gender-balanced, and women/youth specific FFS may be organized. Each group will undertake a participatory diagnostic, identify main issues, and define the objectives of the FFS. The learning subjects will fall under 3 main categories: (i) crop production, (ii) agroforestry and (iii) agropastoralism, depending on the groups' interests and agro-ecological areas, and will include all the EbA practices from the MT and ToF courses. The FFS groups may also evolve into beekeeping and commercial groups (for example). The FFS will use a participatory action-research approach¹⁸¹ for the adoption of EbA practices, by working with farmers to redesign: their cropping systems (or livestock systems, agroforestry systems, etc.), the relations between the various production units, and even the farming-system as a whole. A total of 1,080 FFS with 27,000 farmers will participate.
- **Sub-activity 2.1.1.3 MoA support to FFS roll out (financed by MoA, executed by MoA).** The Ministry of Agriculture will co-finance (in-kind) and support the rolling out of the FFS by availing 153 decentralized extension staffs' (AEDOs and AEDCs) time to technically support FFS and monitor their implementation. The decentralized staff will also support M&E data collection. The MoA will co-finance (in kind) the training venues for the MTC and ToF courses, which include study plots as well as training centres.

Box 2. Lessons from Farmer Field Schools

Farmer Field Schools (FFS) is one of FAO's flagship innovation, being implemented in more than 90 countries, and it is estimated that 20 million farmers globally have participated in FFS since they started. Malawi is not an exception and the extension methodology is being implemented in many projects sponsored by the World Bank, IFAD and the EU/FAO. FFS are promoted by the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA) through the National Agriculture Extension Policy as of the main extension approach to reach out to farmers. Recent FFS initiatives operate within government structures and institutions, and intend to facilitate mainstreaming of the FFS model. A total of 12,000 FFS have so far been established since 2008. For example, the FAO-implemented KULIMA Project is currently institutionalizing FFS in the Extension service system and its agency (DAES) for more sustainability. KULIMA has positively delivered on productivity increase, household dietary diversity and nutrition, the number of households using improved technology combination and adoption of improved livelihoods options to cope with climate related hazards.¹⁸² Other impact evaluations highlight that FFS allowed to increase food security and access to climate information¹⁸³. EbAM will leverage and complement KULIMA on the outreach of the FFS and their focus on EbA, while KULIMA will ensure long-term sustainability of the process by the institutional work and capacity development on the National Extension System that KULIMA is developing.

63. **Activity 2.1.2 Knowledge and innovation (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** EbA transition and practices adoption is knowledge intensive. Part of its adoption success and bigger outreach relies on supporting more access to technical knowledge and as well as climate information complementing the FFS trainings. EbAM will promote exchanges, visits and trainings to enable different actors to have a first-hand experience and awareness on proposed EbA innovations, many being found at niche levels in Malawi, and ensure their promotion at scale in the targeted areas¹⁸⁴. This will on the one hand help enhance the technical knowledge promoted through the FFS (Activity 2.1.1), and on the other sensitize policy makers, supporting component 3. In addition, EbAM will leverage past projects (such as the GCF-funded "Scaling Up the Use of Modernized Climate Information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi" - GCF FP002), by building on capacity developed and weather infrastructure established, as well as phones applications created and rolled-out by the

Department of Agriculture Extension Services (DAES). The expected output is 5,000 people participating to visits, exchanges and short trainings, and 196,000 people accessing climate- and technical-information.

- **Sub-activity 2.1.2.1 Knowledge generation and sharing.** This sub-activity will support the project in the generation and sharing of EbA related knowledge. As a starting point, a knowledge management strategy will be developed aiming at connecting and motivating different project stakeholders to generate, use and share good practices and help improve the adoption rate and outreach of the EbA approach. The strategy will be developed during Y1, by a national consultant that will be supporting the process of knowledge generation on a part-time basis. The national consultant will work closely with the Agroecology-Hub¹⁸⁵, which is spearheading the Agroecology network and generating scientific and applied EbA related-knowledge in Malawi.
- **Sub-activity 2.1.2.2 Visits and exchanges.** EbAM will promote visits and exchanges on EbA approaches and practices for different types of stakeholders, with a twofold purpose: providing real success examples in addition to the standard demonstration fields, and at the same time offering some extra key technical training. Targets will include: (i) MoA frontline extension and research staff; (ii) NGOs present in the area and working with the project; and (iii) facilitators and farmers. These are: (i) exchanges and visits between FFS (facilitators and farmers) and lead farmers-innovators; (ii) visits and short trainings to Agroecology Knowledge Hub network institutes¹⁸⁶ for farmers and frontline extension staff; (iii) one-day visit for central MoA staff and some decentralized staff to institutes that are part of the Agroecology Hub network¹⁸⁷; (iv) 500 targeted youth from project areas to have a full 3 weeks training on Permaculture and Agroecology in specialized institutes from the Permaculture/Agroecology Network and support them in the process of becoming lead farmers.
- **Sub-activity 2.1.2.2 Digital extension and climate information.** The project will build on the legacy of the GCF-funded “Scaling Up the Use of Modernized Climate Information and Early Warning Systems in Malawi” (GCF FP002) as well scaling-up piloting activities financed under the FAO-implemented KULIMA, and enable farmers and FFS facilitators to benefit from climate information and better develop climate adaptation strategies, through SMS and/or community radio stations. The Project will partner with DCCMS for leveraging weather data information for it to be conveyed through SMS and community radios. The decentralized government staff (AEDOs and AEDCs), the CBFs and other farmers who own cell phones will receive weather information through SMS. Community radios will be used to broadcast key weather forecasts and early warning information. Community radio outreach will be enhanced through the implementation of the Dimitra clubs¹⁸⁸.

64. **Activity 2.1.3 Agrobiodiversity promotion.** Agrobiodiversity – a key feature of EbA - will be firmly integrated in the VLAPs (sub-component 1.1), and crucial to the sustainability and adaptation of agriculture in the context of climate change. This activity, which will replicate and scale-up seed production interventions promoted under the FAO/GEF-7 Project, will ensure the sustainable availability of diverse, well-adapted genetic resources for communal lands (to be used under component 1) and farms in order to enhance EbA and ecosystem services through agrobiodiversity. The expected output is 30 nurseries, 60 multipliers groups/individuals and 30 community seed banks established.

- **Sub-activity 2.1.3.1. Availability of adapted genetic material (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** In partnership with the different institutes specialized in genetic resources and with the capacity to provide base seeds, EbAM will ensure multiplication of landraces¹⁸⁹, drought resistant crops, native food crops, including lost crops, native and exotic trees multiplication and dissemination for multiplication (details on the eligible species and varieties can be found in the Feasibility Study).
- **Sub-activity 2.1.3.2 Initial seed and seedling availability (financed by FAO, executed by FAO).** As soon as year 1, EbAM will leverage FAO co-financing through the GEF-7. Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme - SFM DSL IP (see B.1.) to launch the procurement of endangered and native seeds and tree seedlings for Mangochi District.
- **Sub Activity 2.1.3.3 Capacity development and support to seed multipliers (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** EbAM will identify existing (or new) seed multipliers producers associations through self-targeting, who are willing to produce around EbA approaches, to professionalize in seed multiplication. The multipliers will be accompanied and trained by the MoA and a specialized institution¹⁹⁰ and will adapt official protocols for the improvement of adapted and drought resistant varieties multiplication, storage and selling. These include locally adapted and native crops, as well as improved and well adapted drought resistant varieties. The project will support community seed bank groups to evolve into a seed multiplication

businesses. These associations will also be supported in increasing their business capacities (sub-component 2.2) and in accessing finance (sub-component 2.3).

- ***Sub-activity 2.1.3.4 Community/individual nurseries and seed banks support (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).*** EbAM will support the establishment of at least one nursery and community seed bank per CMC. Initially, EbAM will provide technical capacity building and initial material for their establishment. The project will progressively support the professionalization of these nurseries and seed banks, to ensure their future availability to commercialize their products in all project areas, thus supplying the implementation of VLAPs land restoration activities (sub-component 1.2), together with the diversification of farm-level production activities at VLAP level (sub-component 2.1 and 1.2). Technical support will be provided through MoA decentralized staff (with support from - Genebank and Crop Development), specialized institutions for tree nurseries (e.g. ICRAF) and from Research department from MoA for the seed banks. Species and varieties promoted will be those listed as eligible in the Feasibility study. This activity will target women mainly as they are the normal seed carers, highly involved in seed storage, selection and multiplication.

65. **Sub-component 2.2: Market access and entrepreneurship development (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** (Output 2.2: Private sector is incentivized to invest in climate-resilient agriculture; and better farmers' access to markets). Activities under the sub-component will consist in building business and market relationships between actors of the food system. It will establish financially sustainable and diverse local EbA-based agri-food business models, such as public private producer partnerships (4Ps – as already tested by other Projects such as the IFAD-funded TRADE¹⁹¹ or the World Bank-funded AGCOM – see Annex 2) and micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). Activities will also promote food-system transformation through the development of an “EbA” brand that creates consumer awareness of the relationship between food quality, nutritious traditional diets and healthy local food produced in resilient ecosystems under climate change.

66. A Market Study (annexed to the Feasibility Study) is providing details on marketing opportunities for a set of selected crops and products. While the EbA approach will result in a multitude of crops being produced by smallholder farmers in the project areas, the market analysis focused on those (i.e. legumes, oilseeds, perennials/ agroforestry, horticulture, cereals and non-timber forest products – NTFP) which demonstrate marketing potential for 4P commercial linkages or local SME development based on the diversity and sustainability of production, as well as suitability in the context of climate change.

67. **Activity 2.2.1 Public-private producer partnerships (4Ps) establishment (financed by GCF; executed by FAO).** The objective of this activity is to facilitate the establishment of EbA-focused 4Ps through a transparent engagement process, technical and institutional development support, as well as facilitation of linkages with sub-components 1.2 and 2.1 on resilient EbA production, and sub-component 2.3 on access to commercial financing, in order to demonstrate high sustainability and a robust business model. A 4P is a structured commercial partnership between a public entity, business agents and small-scale producers, who agree to do a specific, defined, business venture together while jointly assuming risks and responsibilities, and sharing benefits, resources and competencies. The level of capacity, formality and management structure they entail, and of support they need, are different from support for the development of agri-MSMEs owned by small local entrepreneurs that allow them to engage in direct commercialisation (activity 2.2.2). The creation of EbA farmer organisations will be an outcome of Sub-Component 2.1 that will, where market viable, transition into a group that is engaged in a formal 4P business arrangement that will be guided by criteria described in sub-activity 2.2.1.1. The activity targets the creation of around 12 4Ps during the project duration, and the engagement of around 13,000 beneficiaries in the commercial activities, at least 50% of which women and youth. Details of implementation are provided in Annex 2.

- ***Sub-Activity 2.2.1.1 Expression of interest.*** The focus of this Sub-Activity, under the leadership of a National 4P Expert, is to conduct bi-annual calls for Expression of Interest, followed by selection of 4P partner applications. This is expected to be driven by off-taker interest in partnership development with EbA farmer organizations.
- ***Sub-Activity 2.2.1.2 Capacity-building for partners in the process of negotiation of 4P agreement and operations.*** This Sub-Activity, under the leadership of an Institutional Development Expert, will focus on facilitating the engagement of potential supplier and off-taker partners in the 4P negotiation process, by supporting the following: (i) producers to organise into a commercial entity (See FS Annex: Market Analysis for detail on types of commercial entities) and (ii) off-takers to establish supplier liaison capacity, which are a key prerequisite to the sustainability of a potential business relationship.

- **Sub-Activity 2.2.1.3 Development of 4P Business plans.** The focus of this Sub-Activity, under the leadership of business development consultants, will be to guide the partners through a participatory process of business model planning for the entire 4P as an economic entity, that also clearly demonstrates the cost-benefits for each player and the financial underpinning of the engagement.
- **Sub-Activity 2.2.1.4 Support to 4Ps implementation.** The focus of this Sub-Activity will be to ensure continuous advisory support for the 4P arrangements put in place to overcome potential 'initial hurdles' related to the novelty of the supply relationship, the required capacity to deliver, communicate and troubleshoot potential concerns.

68. **Activity 2.2.2 Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) development (financed by GCF, executed by FAO).** The objective of this activity is to stimulate entrepreneurial development, outside of the 4P context through the creation of local MSMEs that offer new and strengthened opportunities to link farmers adopting EbA to markets, either through direct market sales or via new supply chain arrangements. Youth and women led entrepreneurial initiatives will be particularly encouraged and supported by EbAM by focusing on removing technical, capacity and financial access barriers that impede their involvement in business development (see Annex 8 - Gender Assessment and project level action plan). The activity will target the creation of around 270 local commercial entities, engaging an estimated 5,400 beneficiaries, at least 50% of which women and youth. This activity, in contrast to 4Ps, will open the opportunity for smaller scale and less-structured, independent local business to develop, that can engage groups that may not otherwise have the capacity to be part of a highly structured and demanding partnership.

- **Sub-Activity 2.2.2.1. Identification of common economic/commercial interests of farmers and establishment of MSMEs – institutional development.** Under the leadership of an Institutional Development Expert, and based on the work done under Sub-Component 2.1 and the FFS and FBS, this Sub-Activity will focus on the identification and development of farmers and farmer groups, women and youth groups in particular, who demonstrate an interest and aptitude in developing a joint commercial activity and establish a commercial entity (for e.g. MSME). This will be based on self-identification and presentation of business ideas to be supported.
- **Sub-Activity 2.2.2.2. Development of commercial business plans.** The focus of this activity, under the leadership of business development consultants, will be to enable the successful business establishment of the newly formed commercial entities (see Market Analysis for detail on types of commercial entities) through an inclusive process of business plan preparation that enables all partners/members to gain a clear vision of the operations; establish a transparent and inclusive management body; and state a clear business case. An example of such methodology is RuralInvest, a participatory business development tool, developed by FAO.
- **Sub-Activity 2.2.2.3. Support to the establishment and consolidation of business operations.** This Sub-Activity will operate in a similar format as Sub-Activity 2.2.1.4 and will focus on supporting the consolidation of the MSME operations and business proposition.

69. **Activity 2.2.3 Market development through “EbA production system” brand creation (financed by GCF; executed by FAO).** The activity aims to help generate market demand for the EbA products, as such the scope of the activity is two-fold: (i) to raise the awareness of the consumer about the link between food, tradition and sustainability; and (ii) to offer EbAM producers a market differentiation tool linked to the production principles they have embraced.

- **Sub-Activity 2.2.3.1. Collaboration with government institutions on the creation of a brand to drive demand for EbA produce.** The focus of this Sub-Activity, under leadership from a Brand development expert, will be the establishment of a product brand under the Ministry of Trade and in coordination with the existing *Let's Buy Malawi* brand¹⁹² (See FS Appendix 2: Market Analysis for detail on branding), adding to the label of national origin a further differentiation based on ecosystem resilience and sustainability of production.
- **Sub-Activity 2.2.3.2. Marketing campaign on the brand and its message.** The focus of this Sub-Activity, led by a local PR/Marketing company will be the creation of an EbAM 'brand' and message that clearly states the value-proposition of the brand, derived from EbA. This will be part of a broader communication campaign on public awareness of the relationship between food quality, the production ecosystem, human health and climate change. This will be implemented with the help of national PR company and the national marketing consultant engaged under sub activity 2.2.3.1.

- **Sub-Activity 2.2.3.3 Linking EbA produce to traditional cuisine.** The focus of this Sub-Activity will be the promotion of traditional foods and products, the products for which has been produced under Sub-Component 2.1. The objective of this Sub-Activity is multi-fold: (i) to stimulate demand for traditional ingredients and thus create demand for production under EbA; (ii) to provide and promote the social/cultural component to the EbAM food 'brand' that is to be designed; (iii) to link different players of the food-system from restaurants and retail to producers and consumers and in doing so strengthen knowledge-sharing and capacity-building related to sustainable food consumption and production, especially in the context of traditional cuisine; (iv) to highlight seasonality of production and seasonality of recipes, especially in the context of urban consumer markets, (v) introduce these traditional products to the formal markets, hence enhance local economy and food diversity.

70. **Sub-component 2.3. Access to finance for climate resilient investment solutions.** (Output 2.3: Financial service providers support investment in climate-resilient agriculture). This sub-component aims to remove barriers identified for access to finance by the project beneficiaries to sustainably invest in the EbA climate resilient solutions promoted by the project. About 98,500 beneficiary households including 50% women and 25% youth will access adapted financial services.

71. The sub-component will be implemented by the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs, through the FARMSE Programme, and will address barriers on the supply side by providing technical assistance to financial institutions to develop and deliver adapted and inclusive services and linking them with financial instruments. In addition, largest, most performing and impactful SMEs will be linked to impact investment funds. Approaches will be aligned to the specific needs of different categories of beneficiaries: (i) farmers and MSMEs in the Public-Private Producer Partnerships (4Ps); (ii) producer organizations and their members; (iii) seeds producers and nurseries business groups; (iv) subsistence farmers trained in the FFS not involved in any of the two first models; and (v) beneficiaries under Component 1 that will not be enrolled into the FFS.

72. **Activity 2.3.1: Consolidation / expansion of Community Based Financial Organizations (financed by MoF; executed by MoF).** The objective of this activity is to strengthen existing Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs) or establish new VSLAs in EbAM areas of intervention (i.e. 11 districts and 30 sub-catchments) for access by EbAM beneficiaries to simple and adapted financial services. VSLAs will also be supported to link with FFIs to access additional resources to on-lend to their members, or to guarantee the individual loans directly granted by the FFIs to the VSLA members. These linkages may also allow VSLA members to open formal savings accounts, which contributes to a higher level of financial inclusion, and open the door to other formal services like loans for financial needs that are not covered by the VSLAs and insurance, mobile banking and digital services. A total of around 98,500 project beneficiaries households will benefit from VSLAs improved services.

- **Sub-Activity 2.3.1.1 Strengthening of existing VSLAs and establishment of new VSLAs in EbAM areas.** Implementing Partners which are local and international NGOs with experience in supporting CBFOs contracted by MoF/FARMSE will (i) Conduct a Mapping of VSLAs in EbAM areas and membership by EbAM beneficiaries, to enable them to determine the number of VSLAs to strengthen and the number of VSLAs to establish, estimated to be about 5,500 in total; (ii) Promote the services of the VSLAs for the non-members; and (iii) Provide technical assistance to the VSLAs in various thematic areas based on a capacity building needs assessment. Studies will be conducted on the sustainability of the VSLA model. The objective will be to study various sustainability models implemented in neighboring countries and, based on these experiences, develop and implement adapted models for VSLAs in Malawi. This will contribute to the viability of the VSLAs and of their services to their members, including EbAM beneficiaries. MoF FARMSE has supported the Reserve Bank of Malawi (RBM) to improve the financial literacy training modules. These modules will be disseminated to project beneficiaries by the Implementing Partners, which will organize financial literacy training sessions for the VSLA members.
- **Sub-Activity 2.3.1.2 Technical backstopping and implementation support, knowledge management and dissemination.** MoF/FARMSE PMU rural finance specialists will provide technical advice to its Implementing Partners based on outcomes of its monitoring and evaluation and supervision missions.. EbAM, through MoF/FARMSE, will generate knowledge management products illustrating how socially-inclusive VSLAs can contribute to climate adaptation financing. These products will be disseminated through various channels like EbAM and MoF/FARMSE websites, social networks, TV and radio and national and international conferences. MoF through FARMSE will also organize at least one knowledge dissemination workshop per year, each gathering around 50 people from relevant stakeholders like Reserve Bank of Malawi, Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs, Ministry of Agriculture and of NGOs and Projects involved in rural and inclusive finance development, to further share and scale-up lessons

learnt and good practices. EbAM, through MoF/FARMSE, will also contribute to the development of a financial inclusion portal. This tool will include specific information related to climate adaptation financing and will be used by rural finance stakeholders to guide policy development and interventions.

73. **Activity 2.3.2: Development and delivery of climate adaptation financial services by Formal Financial Institutions.** The objective of this activity is to support FFIs (commercial banks, MFIs, savings and Credit Cooperative Organisation - SACCOs, insurance companies) to develop adapted financial services for EbA investments by farmers and SMEs, based on the EbA investments selected and promoted by EbAM. A total of 12,880 farmers and 249 SMEs will access finance from the supported FFIs. In line with the strategy of MoF/FARMSE to first promote innovations and then to support the scaling-up of successful innovations, MoF through FARMSE will focus on financing innovations, while GCF will focus on financing their up-scaling¹⁹³.

- **Sub-Activity 2.3.2.1 Technical support to FFIs to develop and scale up innovative and adapted financial services (financed by GCF, executed by MoF/FARMSE).** Competitive and demand-led calls for proposals will be issued and managed by MoF through FARMSE as per its current practices. Selection of the FFIs will be based on a number of appraisal criteria including; (i) commitment to engage with EbAM beneficiaries, (ii) strategy to develop financial services to support EbA investments, (iii) experience in agricultural finance for smallholder farmers, (iv) internal capacity to develop and deliver the services, (v) features of the proposed products (including interest rates and collateral requirements) and delivery channels (partnerships with other value chain actors, digitization of the products and processes, etc), (vi) adapted products for the agri SMEs, and (vii) adapted products for women and youths. FFIs proposing to develop innovative digital services (developing / improving their own platform or partnering with fintechs/agritechs) will be prioritized. This may include digital tools and process for the loan applications, digital disbursements and repayments of the loans, digitally enabled credit scoring¹⁹⁴ and geodata systems for climate risk analysis, and digitally-enabled agricultural insurance, including index-based insurance (weather, area yield or hybrid). It is expected that the delivery of the digital services will involve mostly youth, more conversant with the digital technologies.
- **Sub-Activity 2.3.2.2 Technical backstopping and implementation support, knowledge management and dissemination (financed by MoF/FARMSE, executed by MoF/FARMSE).** EbAM, through MoF/FARMSE rural finance specialists will provide technical advice to its Partners FFIs based on outcomes of its monitoring and evaluation and supervision missions. EbAM, through MoF/FARMSE, will produce knowledge management products on how innovative and inclusive formal financial services promoted by the project contribute to the promotion of climate adaptation investments, that will be disseminated through various channels, like for Sub-Activity 2.3.1.3. MoF/FARMSE will also organize at least one stakeholders engagement workshop per year for knowledge dissemination.

74. **Activity 2.3.3: Linkage of partner FFIs to financial instruments providers (financed by MoF/FARMSE; executed by MoF/FARMSE).** MoF through FARMSE will link partner FFIs, on a need and demand basis, to institutions and initiatives managing financial instruments like concessional credit lines¹⁹⁵ and guarantee funds or schemes¹⁹⁶ (see details in Annex 2 - Feasibility Study). This activity aims at incentivizing the FFIs to engage into financing of EbAM targets, in addition to the technical assistance, and it will contribute to the reduction of the cost of loans for the project beneficiaries.

- **Sub-Activity 2.3.3.1 Scoping study of the potential financial instruments.** MoF through FARMSE will mobilize a consultant to carry out a scoping study of the potential financial instruments (concessional credit lines and guarantee funds or schemes) providers that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with its partner FFIs. The study will identify the potential partners, with information on the features of the financial instruments, eligibility criteria and processes and conditions to access the instruments.
- **Sub-Activity 2.3.3.2 Facilitation of linkages by MoF/FARMSE.** MoF through FARMSE will facilitate linkages between the partner FFIs and the identified financial instruments providers. This may involve technical assistance to support the FFIs to develop their funding application.

75. **Activity 2.3.4: Linkage of agri SMEs to impact investment funds (financed by MoF/FARMSE; executed by MoF/FARMSE).** MoF through FARMSE will link on demand basis largest agri-SMEs supported under sub-component 2.2 to impact investment funds for debt and equity financing and technical support.

- **Sub-Activity 2.3.4.1 Scoping study of the impact investment funds.** MoF/FARMSE will mobilize a consultant to carry out a scoping study of the potential impact investment funds that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with supported agri-SMEs. Examples are provided in the Feasibility Study. The

study will identify the potential partners, with information on the features of their investments and technical support, eligibility criteria and processes and conditions to access funding. Through these linkages, the agri SMEs may access alternative or complementary sources of funds to that of the FFIs as well as technical support, building on the support provided by EbAM. It is anticipated that agri SMEs supported under the 4Ps model would be eligible for investment, thanks to their linkages with farmers and climate resilience focus, and target will be to link at least five of them to impact investment funds.

- **Sub-Activity 2.3.4.2 Facilitation of linkages by MoF/FARMSE.** MoF/FARMSE will facilitate linkages between the eligible supported agri SMEs and the identified impact investment funds like the Malawi Agriculture and Industrial Investment Corporation (MAIIC – see details in the Feasibility Study). This may involve technical assistance to support the agri-SMEs to develop their funding application.

Table B.3.5. Summary of project beneficiaries, eligibility criteria, support measures and modality of involvement for component 1

Project Activities	Type of beneficiary	Eligibility criteria	Support measures	Modalities of beneficiary involvement
Sub-component 2.1: Promotion of EbA-based production systems				
Activity 2.1.1. EbA agriculture extension support through FFS	• Women, men and youth farmers	• Women, men and youth farmers from the targeted micro and sub-catchments interested in participating in the FFS process. • Self-targeting criteria with quotas. • Identification and selection of facilitators, "lead" innovative farmers, prioritizing youth.	• Training of CBFs • FFS running kit adapted to themes proposed for the FFS (adapted seeds, tools) • Follow-up, monitoring and technical support from extension officers (AEDOs, AEDCs), FAO technical team • Creation when appropriate of only women FFS	• Participation to preliminary decision meetings • Provision of plot land (individual for agroforestry and individual or common for regular FFS) • Plot preparation for the FFS • Participation to FFS – quotas for women (60%) and youth (40%) • Respect of the rules of procedure co-defined with the other members of the (e.g.: regular attendance and participation in the work on the school field)
Activity 2.1.2. Knowledge and innovation	• Women, men and youth • All categories of farmers and village population, from vulnerable to better off • Extension staff and NGOs staff, • National MoA staff	• Self-targeting for community radios and people that have a phone and want to access to the service • Direct targeting for FFS members • Direct targeting for trainings' participation diverse target groups	• Follow-up, monitoring and technical support from extension officers, NGOs and FAO technical team • Provision of tablets and phones for FFS facilitators AEDOs/ AEDCs.	• Youth quotas for participation to specific trainings 100% • Quotas for 60% women participation to trainings, visits and to talk into radio shows.
Activity 2.1.3. Agrobiodiversity promotion	• Women, men and youth • Vulnerable farmers	• Self-targeting criteria with quotas.	• Follow-up, monitoring and technical support from extension officers, NGOs and service providers technical team	• Quotas for women (60%) and youth (40%); • Participation to preliminary decision meetings • Provision of plot land (individual or common) • Plot preparation for the nurseries
Sub-Component 2.2: Market access and entrepreneurship development				
Activity 2.2.1. 4Ps establishment	• All EbA farmers, including women and youth • Off-takers of EbA production	• Ability to engage in a commercial supply partnership based on EbA products – self targeting	• Criteria for 4P establishment and support in capacity development for 4P negotiation, establishment, and management process	• Expression of Interest • Business plan development support • Minimum of 50% of farmers engaged women and youth
Activity 2.2.2. MSMEs development	• MSMEs producers and processors based on EbA production outputs	• Self-targeting – interest in group commercial activities • Basic business capacity (under FBS SC 2.1)	• Business planning technical support and capacity building • Support with access to finance under SC2.3	• Participatory business plan development and capacity for business management • Minimum of 50% of MSME participation women and youth

Activity 2.2.3 Market development through 'EbA production system' brand creation	• EbA producers • Domestic consumers	• EbA production systems and products	• EbA produce branding for targeted demand development	• Marketing campaign for EbA brand and message on EbA benefits for ecosystems and human health • Traditional cuisine fairs based on EbA products
Sub-component 2.3. Access to finance for climate resilient investment solutions				
Activity 2.3.1 Consolidation / expansion of Community Based Financial Organizations	• All categories of farmers and village population supported by the Project.	• All population supported by the Project may access the CBFOs on voluntary basis.	• Promotion of the CBFOs services to the Project beneficiaries. • Support to the CBFOs on various areas to strengthen their governance, management and performance (quality of the services). • Support to develop a viable model for the CBFOs to ensure sustainability of their services post Project.	• CBFO members are involved in the definition of the services and the governance and management of the CBFOs through participation to general meetings and other interactions with the CBFO leaders. • CBFO members purchase shares to constitute the initial capital of the CBFOs. • Beneficiaries consulted by the Project on their satisfaction of the services, which may lead to adjustments.
Activity 2.3.2: Development and delivery of climate adaptation financial services by Formal Financial Institutions	• Farmers trained in the FFS and integrated in the Public-Private Producer Partnerships (4Ps) or members of the Producer Commercial Organizations • SMEs in the 4Ps, Producers Commercial Organizations, and Seeds producers' business groups.	• All farmers and SMEs that comply with eligibility criteria of the Formal Financial Institutions (FFIs).	• Technical assistance to the FFIs to develop adapted and innovative financial services for climate resilient investments.	• Project eligible beneficiaries are consulted by the FFIs during the participatory product development process and during implementation for improvement of the products. • Beneficiaries are consulted by the Project on their satisfaction of the services, which may lead to adjustments.
Activity 2.3.3. Linkage of partner FFIs to financial instruments providers	• FFIs that have been supported to successfully develop and deliver adapted financial products to the Project beneficiaries.	• As per eligibility criteria of the institutions / schemes managing the financial instruments (concessional credit line, guarantee)	• Scoping study of potential financial instruments for linkage. • Linkage between eligible FFIs and the Financial instruments. • Support to the eligible FFIs to develop credible applications for funding.	• FFIs develop their funding application with support on demand basis of the Project. They sign contracts with the financial instruments.
Activity 2.3.4. Linkage of agri-SMEs to impact investment funds	• Large SMEs having demonstrated positive and significant impact on the farmers benefiting from their services under the 4Ps.	• As per eligibility criteria of the investment funds.	• Scoping study on potential investment funds for linkage. • Linkage between eligible SMEs and the investment funds. • Support to the eligible SMEs to develop credible applications for funding.	• SMEs develop their funding application with support on demand basis of the Project. They sign contracts with the Investment funds.

76. **Component 3. Enabling Institutional and Financial Environment.** The objective (Outcome 3) of this component is to enhance the enabling environment to sustain, replicate and scale up climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices. This objective will be achieved by leveraging public and private climate finance (sub-component 3.1) and scaling-up EbA in national policies (sub-component 3.2). It will contribute to GCF results areas ARA1, ARA4 and MRA4. The component will contribute to the sustainability and scaling-up of EbA activities and well-functioning watershed ecosystems promoted under Components 1 and 2.

77. **This component will address the institutional barriers.** As per the theory of change, these include (i) *insufficient institutional capacity to mobilize innovative public and private climate finance* and (ii) *limited integration of EbA in national*

policies. It will give attention to low and volatile investments in integrated landscape management and address the need to propose innovative solutions to attract more sustainable climate finance.

78. **Activities promoted under the component are sustainable and innovative.** The Project will support Malawi's vision to establish its National Climate Change Fund (NCCF) and will strengthen local trusts (e.g. MEET and Shire BEST). Together, the activities will facilitate the mobilization of catalytic climate finance, and contribute to sustaining, replicating and expanding the scale of climate-resilient investments promoted by the Project under components 1 and 2. The Project is innovative because it will leverage a private sector experience on carbon credits (Climate Asset Management – CAM/ HSBC – which is financing the Restore Africa Programme). Interventions will mainstream and deep-root EbA in national policies and investment plans, and bring the EbA agenda at sectoral policies level. By integrating EbA in national policies, the component will contribute to improve the enabling environment, and allow replication and scaling-up of EbA through other projects and programmes – for massive-scale impact and sustainability.

79. **Sub-component 3.1. Leveraging public and private climate finance.** (Output 3.1: Sustainable and innovative public and private climate financing through NCCF and local trusts are in place). At national level, the project will assist the National Climate Change Fund (NCCF) (activity 3.1.1) and local national conservation trusts funds (Malawi Environment Endowment Trust - MEET and Shire BEST) to mobilize climate finance for scaling-up climate-change adaptation interventions, based on EbA (activity 3.1.2). It will also leverage private sector experience on carbon credits in Malawi as part of the exit strategy (3.2.3). This sub-component will contribute to an improved enabling environment, more particularly on enhancing access to climate finance and instruments.

80. **Activity 3.1.1. Support to Malawi's National Climate Change Fund (NCCF) (financed by the GCF, executed by FAO).** The Project will provide some capacity development to the NCCF to mobilize resources and build an investment pipeline focusing on ecosystem restoration, watershed resilience and climate-resilient agriculture, based on EbA. The objective of this activity is to replicate EbA investments through the NCCF, while sustaining interventions promoted by EbAM under components 1 and 2. The Project's proposed technical support to the NCCF, which will start on year 2, will result in an increased volume of climate finance being available nationally to replicate EbAM activities, in other climate-vulnerable watersheds, for increased impact. In line with the NCCF's Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), proposed technical assistance from EbAM will encompass 4 sub-activities as follows.

- **Sub-activity 3.1.1.1: Support to resources mobilization.** The objective of this sub-activity is to support the NCCF to mobilize climate finance. The Project will notably assist the NCCF to meet GCF accreditation standards, with a view to leverage “direct access” financing towards project end, once the NCCF is sufficiently well established and experienced. Direct access is a priority identified in the NCCF SOP. Under a longer-term horizon, the Project will also consider financing some technical assistance to develop a strategy/ feasibility study for the NCCF to leverage innovative private sector finance instruments - which could include for example green or climate bonds.
- **Sub-activity 3.1.1.2: Support to pipeline building.** The NCCF has two priority investment areas for climate-change adaptation. These include: (i) *integrated watershed management*, and (ii) *climate change community resilience through climate-smart agriculture production systems*. To support investment under these priorities areas, EbAM will finance investment strategies, with the objective to build a pipeline of quality adaptation projects, based on EbA. Investment Strategies will build on EbAM's investment experience/lessons learnt. These will include: (i) a set of criteria for targeting watersheds (e.g. climate vulnerability, ecosystem/ landscape degradation, youth/gender inclusion), (ii) a list of technical solutions for climate-change adaptation, including their effectiveness/efficiency, (iii) a list of potential projects to be funded, including EbAM's beneficiaries (communities, farmers, SMEs), (iv) a list of monitoring and evaluation (M&E) indicators for the NCCF's monitoring, verification and reporting framework (MRV). EbAM's “SMART” outcome/outputs indicators and reporting methodologies will be leveraged.
- **Sub-activity 3.1.1.3: Capacity development on EbA.** Trainings on the main EbA techniques listed in the investment strategies will be delivered by FAO. The objective is to fully integrate EbAM's knowledge into the NCCF, for better investment/ financing decisions. Trainings will include (i) deep-dive on the EbA techniques (as described/ listed in Appendix 1 of the Feasibility Study), (ii) costs (equipment/inputs needed for adoption) and benefits, based on EbAM's experience. Trainings – conducted by FAO staff and consultants – will also build on the evidence-based studies prepared under sub-component 3.2 for policy dialogue.
- **Sub-activity 3.1.1.4. Capacity development on climate risk analysis.** In line with NCCF priority area 4 (*Capacity development and knowledge transfer*), EbAM will provide targeted capacity development on *climate vulnerability analysis*. Trainings (see Feasibility Study for details), conducted by FAO staff and consultants, will

promote FAO-developed tools such as [ABC map](#) or the Global Agro-ecological Zoning platform ([GAEZ](#)). Climate vulnerability assessments will allow the NCCF staff to better identify major climate risks for the projects it will finance, and select suitable adaptation measures.

- **Sub-activity 3.1.1.5. Capacity development on carbon balance analysis.** In line with NCCF priority area 4 (Capacity development and knowledge transfer), EbAM will deliver trainings to NCCF staff on GHG accounting with FAO-developed tools/ methodologies such as the [FAO Ex-ante Carbon Balance Tool](#) (Ex-ACT) or the [Global Livestock Environmental Assessment Model, interactive](#) (GLEAM-i) tools, which are built on the latest scientific information. These tools will enable NCCF staff to assess, monitor and evaluate the mitigation potential of Projects financed by NCCF in the agriculture, forestry and other land use change (AFOLU) sectors.

81. **Activity 3.1.2. Support to National Conservation Trust Funds (financed by GCF; Executed by FAO).** The Project will provide capacity development to two (2) local Trusts (the Malawi Environmental Endowment Trust – MEET and Shire BEST) to scale-up and replicate investments promoted by EbAM. More particularly, the Project will support (starting year 1) these local funds in broadening their funding base, with the ambition to promote EbA and watershed resilience in their operations, and implement their mandate to yield positive environment and natural resource conservation, in the context of climate change.

- **Sub-activity 3.1.2.1: Technical assistance for national entities in accessing GCF resources.** This intervention would support MEET in accessing, for example, the GCF Project Specific Assessment Approach (PSAA) instrument, and be considered as a local Direct Access Entity (DAE) to GCF. MEET direct access to GCF is a priority for Malawi's National Designated Authority - NDA (Environmental Affairs Department - EAD). The Project will support PSAA process for MEET, including a proposed project (including the environmental and social safeguards), together with the institutional and capacity assessment of MEET. See see Part 2 of the Feasibility Study for more details.
- **Sub activity 3.1.2.2: Feasibility studies to develop innovative finance instruments for ecosystem restoration.** To support implementation of MEET's Resources Mobilization Strategy (RMS, 2019-2023), the Project will finance studies to access innovative climate finance instruments for more funding towards EbA. One instrument identified during design are debt-for-nature swaps (DFES). The Project will support MEET in financing prefeasibility studies to assess the potential for leveraging DFES in the context of Malawi.
- **Sub-activity 3.1.2.3. Capacity development on Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E).** The Project will supports the Conservation Trust Funds to develop indicators for the Fund's monitoring, verification and reporting framework. EbAM's "SMART" outcome/outputs indicators and reporting methodologies will be leveraged to contribute to the Trusts M&E systems. Synergies with activity 3.1.1 will also be explored, for Trust Funds' staff to benefit from other trainings delivered to NCCF.

82. **Activity 3.1.3. Leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits in Malawi as part of the exit strategy (financed by the GCF; executed by FAO).** This activity will establish the enabling environment to leverage private sector finance for ecosystem restoration interventions, and will be carried out in synergy with the Restore Africa Programme, financed by Climate Asset Management (CAM) – a joint venture between HSBC Asset Management and Pollination. The Restore Africa Programme is implemented by the Global Evergreening Alliance (GEA) – an alliance of NGOs engaged in landscape restoration for livelihood improvements (see donor mapping in the feasibility study). GEA, through the leadership of Catholic Relief Services (CRS) in Malawi, is implementing the Restore Africa Programme in Malawi, which is combining restoration activities with access to carbon credits. CAM is investing in the Restore Africa Programme against the future flow of carbon credits generated from restoration activities. The Programme includes a carbon revenue sharing mechanism with communities allowing them to (i) benefit from restoration activities that improve livelihoods (e.g. better and more diverse crop yield and market linkages) and (ii) share in the carbon revenue. Carbon credits can be generated from restoration activities over a period of 30 years – and sometimes even 100 years – allowing for continuous and long term funding exceeding the GCF funding cycle. Based on the following two sub-activities, the country will be able to further replicate EbAM types of activities locally, with the sale carbon credits as a mechanism to attract further financing similar to the Restore Africa Programme.

- **Sub-activity 3.1.3.1. Gap analysis and baseline.** This sub-activity will aim at performing a gap analysis and establishing a baseline and additionality assessment during the first months of implementation of EbAM to assess potential for proposing carbon credit in EbAM's areas (preferably in one or two districts that Restore Africa Programme and EbAM have in common, such as Neno and Chitipa) on the mid to long term, as a possible additional element to the Project's exit strategy. The gap analysis will allow to assess whether technical solutions (in terms of potential for promoted trees and shrubs species to sequester carbon, above

and below ground) proposed by EbAM are suitable for generating and claiming carbon credits under international standards such as VERRA, Gold Standard or Plan Vivo.

- **Sub-activity 3.1.3.2. Continuous learning for possible replication.** Under this sub-activity, EbAM will mobilize national and international expertise, in synergy with the Knowledge Platform established under the Restore Africa Programme, to consolidate the learning process on Restore Africa Programme activities in Malawi, and propose operational solutions for this approach to be replicated in the country, including through the involvement of other EbAM partners (NCCCF, MEET, Shire BEST, MFIs, etc.), using EbAM intervention areas as possible entry points.

83. **Sub-component 3.2 Scaling-up in national policies.** (Output 3.2: EbA integrated in national policies). This sub-component will improve the enabling environment by promoting EbA as a key instrument for climate change adaptation within national policies. The ultimate goal of mainstreaming EbA is to enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, longevity of EbA principles by embedding its practices into policies, sectoral planning and financing – including government budget – hence contributing to EbAM's paradigm shift and sustainability. Only the integration of EbA into planning tools and budgets of sectoral strategies can secure the financial support and human resources needed for it to become viable in the long term. For this to happen, this sub-component will support: (i) some evidence generation from the Project on the socio-economic benefits of EbA, drawing on the lessons from VLAP and SCMP implementation (activity 3.2.1), (ii) the preparation of a policy influencing plan (PIP), based on a policy assessment analyzing challenges and opportunities for mainstreaming EbA into different sectoral policies (activity 3.2.2), and (iii) implementation of priority actions of the PIP (activity 3.2.3). This sub-component will be co-financed by, and synergize closely with the GEF-7-funded Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme.

84. **Activity 3.2.1 Preparation of evidence-based studies (financed by the GCF, executed by FAO).** The Project will finance a set of knowledge products, best practices and cases studies based on EbAM experience. These studies will play a key role in proposing policy changes. Results of the cases will be compiled into recommendations (briefs) with the objective to stimulate dialogue around EbA-based policies and feed the policy improvement process.

- **Sub-activity 3.2.1.1 Policy briefs based cost-benefit analyses (CBA).** As part of the M&E system, the project will conduct CBA – which will be done on farms and communities having benefited from EbAM's support. CBA will analyze adoption rates, costs and compute financial indicators such as net margins, net present value (NPV), internal rate of return and annual cash flows. The project will finance policy briefs to highlight the efficiency/effectiveness of EbA in the context of EbAM, and provide “business cases”, to inform policy dialogue.
- **Sub-activity 3.2.1.2 Policy brief: TAPE¹⁹⁷ analysis. Impact of EbA on production systems** will carry out analysis of the socio-economic performance of EbAM, using the FAO Tool for Agroecology Performance Evaluation (TAPE) methodology. It will evidence the impacts of EbA by carrying out a diagnostic of production systems with regard to various dimensions of EbA (environmental, social, economic), in the targeted watersheds ecosystems and communities (watershed ecosystems – component 1, production systems – component 2.1). This study will evidence the wider benefits of EbA in relation to sustainable development, in terms of environmental, social, economic and gender-sensitive development co-benefits.

85. **Activity 3.2.2. Policy Assessment and preparation of a policy influencing plan (PIP) (financed by FAO; executed by FAO).** For this activity, the Project –through the FAO-managed GEF-7 project - will collaborate with the Malawi's National Committee on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management (NCCC&DRM) who will provide strategic direction, inter-ministerial coordination (including MoA, MoCCNR, MoF etc.) and policy guidance in relation to Malawi's climate policy, including the NDC. NCCC&DRM acts as a forum for cross-sectoral review and evaluation of progress in NDC implementation.

- **Sub-activity 3.2.2.1 Policy Influencing Plan (PIP).** Through the FAO/GEF-7 DSLP Project, EbAM will partner with the Centre for Environmental Policy and Advocacy (CEPA) to carry out a policy review process/assessment. The result of this policy review process will be a Policy Influencing Plan (PIP) (i.e a policy advocacy plan) including the in-depth policy analysis and a set of priority recommendations to improve the mainstreaming of ecosystem restoration, integrated landscape management and biodiversity conservation into the national policy frameworks.
- **Sub-activity 3.2.2.1.2. Dissemination of the PIP.** The PIP will be presented at a National Seminar that the Malawi National Committee on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management (NCCC&DRM) will call, involving policy-makers, civil servants, research/academia, extension organizations, farmer organizations, private sector, development partners and NGOs. PIP will also be disseminated through the production of

leaflets, posters, banners and reports with abundant visual elements, presentations and video presentations translated in the local languages.

86. **Activity 3.2.3 Implementation of the PIP (financed by GCF; executed by FAO).** Implementation of the PIP will be done through policy dialogues, that will aim at promoting a policy shift towards ecosystem-centered measures linked to sustainable farming, under conservation agriculture, agro-environmental production and climate-resilient crops and native, well adapted, non-invasive varieties. Objective of this activity is to re-purpose subsidies from inorganic fertilizers and maize seeds, to incentives linked to sustainable tree-crop-livestock agroforestry farming under conservation agriculture, biodiversified tree-crop-livestock agroforestry climate-resilient, crops and varieties – as highlighted in the National Forest Land Restoration Strategy 2017.

- **Sub-activity 3.2.3.1. Policy dialogue.** Based on the PIP prepared by the FAO/GEF-7 DSLP Project, and using EbAM's best practices/ evidence-based studies (prepared under activity 3.2.1), the Project will finance an iterative series of 5 policy dialogue events led by NCCC&DRM at national level, to provide information about existing policy rules and regulations, policy constraints and proposed improvements (new or revised policies) with EbA integrated. Policy dialogue events will target the following stakeholders: (i) policy makers, (ii) civil servants and public officials, (iii) traditional leaders, and, (iv) district officials. Policy dialogue will involve the Parliamentary Committee on Agriculture and Natural Resources who can lobby during budget sessions for more funds allocation into these areas.
- **Sub-activity 3.2.3.2 Update of policies and strategic frameworks.** These include the Agrobiodiversity Policy, the National Agriculture Investment Plan (current NAIP covers 2017-2023), National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (current NBSAP covers 2015-2025) based on the best practices from the implementation of ILM with EbA integrated. The Project will organize public events to help make an advocacy case of the revised/new policies, include advocacy-related information in websites, and enroll high-profile individuals to publicly advocate for the proposed changes.

B.4. Implementation arrangements (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagrams)

Accredited Entity

87. FAO will serve as the Accredited Entity (AE) for this project. As such, FAO will be responsible for the overall management of the project, including: (i) all aspects of project appraisal; (ii) administrative, financial and technical oversight and supervision throughout project implementation; (iii) ensuring funds are effectively managed to deliver results and achieve objectives; (iv) ensuring the quality of project monitoring, as well as the timeliness and quality of reporting to the GCF; and (v) project closure and evaluation. FAO will ensure these responsibilities in accordance with the detailed provisions outlined in the Accreditation Master Agreement (AMA) between FAO and GCF.

88. FAO's role as AE will be attributed to the relevant offices and divisions in FAO Headquarters located in Rome, Italy (HQ), Sub-Regional Office for Southern Africa located in Harare, Zimbabwe and the Country Representation Office for Malawi (FAO-Malawi).

89. In order to fulfil the AE functions, FAO will set up a dedicated Project Task Force (PTF) in line with FAO project cycle guidelines. The PTF will be composed by the Budget Holder (BH), the Lead Technical Officer (LTO), Funding Liaison Officer (FLO), HQ Technical Officer and other technical officers, as appropriate.

90. The PTF will remain independent from the Executing Entity functions also performed by FAO (see Project execution section below). In line with the GCF policy on fees adopted through GCF Board Decision B.19/09, the above-mentioned segregation of responsibilities within FAO will ensure that the Organization can independently and effectively perform the AE functions listed in the GCF *General principles and indicative list of eligible costs covered under GCF fees and project management costs*.

Project co-financing

91. The Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (MoF), the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA), and FAO will provide in co-financing to the project, respectively in the form of cash (grant) for MoF, in-kind for MoA, and cash (grant) for FAO. The co-financiers are responsible for reporting of co-financing activities and their disbursement amount to the AE in accordance with the detailed provisions outlined in the GCF policies as well as AMA, Funded Activity Agreement (FAA) between FAO and GCF and the Project Agreement (Subsidiary Agreement) signed between FAO and the Government of Malawi. MoF,

MoA and FAO will be responsible for executing and managing and their co-financing under the coordination of the Project Implementation Unit (PIU – see below) and through the Project Steering Committee - PSC (see Project execution section below). More specifically:

- **The Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs** will provide in-cash (grant) co-financing through the FARMSE Programme, for a total amount of 6.44 million USD. Activities co-financed are described in sub-component 2.3 of the funding proposal.
- **The Ministry of Agriculture** will provide in-kind co-financing for a total amount of 2.95 million USD in the form of: (i) salary/time of the Head of District for agriculture, who will contribute to the Project during the FFS; (ii) the salary/time of extensionists (agriculture extension development officer – AEDO, agriculture extension development coordinator – AEDC), who will contribute to the Project during the FFS and; (iii) training venues (training centers for trainings of master trainers and facilitators).
- **FAO** will provide in-cash (grant) co-financing through the GEF-7 funded Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme - DSL IP, for a total amount of 523,000 USD and FAO's Technical Cooperation Programme (TCP) for a total amount of 500,000 USD. Activities co-financed include: (i) a Policy Assessment and the preparation of a policy influencing plan, (ii) production of seeds and seedlings of native plant species with high biodiversity, social and economic value, from local ecosystem in the Mangochi district, and (iii) Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) consultation and an environmental and social assessment. Through this co-financing, FAO will contribute to the GCF-GEF linkage, and long term vision for complementarity.

Executing Entities

92. The project will be executed by FAO and the Government of the Malawi acting through (i) the Ministry of Agriculture – MoA (specifically the Department of Land Resources Conservation - DLRC)¹⁹⁸, (ii) the National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC)¹⁹⁹ and, (iii) the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (specifically the FARMSE Programme²⁰⁰), in a co-execution modality to deliver the project activities funded by GCF proceeds (see below for details). Additionally, MoF, MoA and FAO will be responsible for executing their co-financing activities.

93. FAO will act as EE and will ensure strong country-driven execution of project activities and will be in charge of the execution of selected activities funded by GCF proceeds based on its comparative advantages. This will allow Malawi to benefit from the technical and operations experience of a specialized development assistance agency from the United Nations (UN), while providing opportunities for the government to increase their capacity through technical assistance and development and implementation of activities under the three components. FAO will also execute the activities co-financed by the FAO managed GEF-7 project.

94. **Flow of funds and legal arrangements.** After the signature of the FAA, FAO will enter into a Project Agreement (Subsidiary Agreement) with the Government of Malawi, which will be binding on all the government entities involved in the project, including MoA (DLRC), NLGFC and MoF (FARMSE). The Project Agreement will include 1) provisions on the Convention on the Privileges and Immunities of the Specialized Agencies, 2) provisions with respect to the co-financing to be provided by the Government of Malawi acting through MoA and MoF, and 3) the respective roles and responsibilities of the Accredited Entity and the Government of Malawi for the implementation of the Project. In line with the project implementation arrangements outlined above, GCF proceeds received by FAO in its capacity as Accredited Entity will flow to the co-Executing Entities, namely FAO, MoA/DLRC, NLGFC and MoF/FARMSE for the implementation of project activities (figure B.4.1). A summary of EE activities also illustrating the flow of funds is presented in table B.4.1 below. More details are presented in the feasibility study (Annex 2 of the FP). The provisions regarding MoF/FARMSE and MoA/(DLRC) responsibilities, both as EEs and co-financiers, as well as NLGFC responsibilities as EE, together with all financial details, will be included in the Project Agreement, which will also serve as subsidiary agreement, signed by the Government of Malawi.

Figure B.4.1. Flow of funds and contractual arrangements

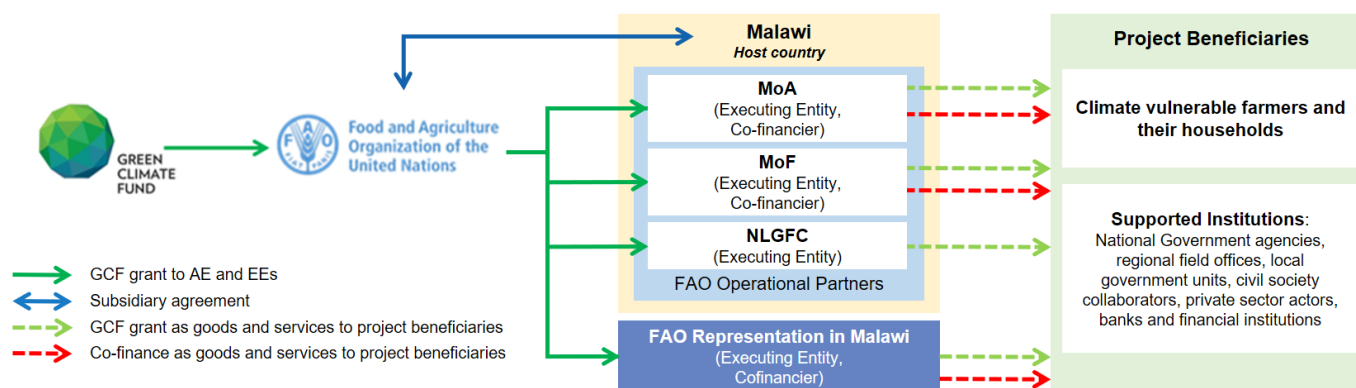


Table B.4.1. Project activities per EE

Output	Activity	Sub-activity	GoM (MoA)	GoM (MoF)	GoM (NLGFC)	FAO	Funding source
1.1	Activity 1.1.1: Targeting and Phasing of Sub-Catchments and Micro-Catchments	1.1.1.1					GCF
		1.1.1.2					FAO
		1.1.1.3					GCF
	Activity 1.1.2: Capacity Development of ILM Stakeholders on Ecosystem-based Adaptation	1.1.2.1					GCF
		1.1.2.2					GCF
		1.1.3.1					GCF
	Activity 1.1.3: Strengthening/Formation of Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs)	1.1.3.2					GCF
		1.1.3.3					GCF
	Activity 1.1.4: Strengthening/Formation of Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Sub-Catchments Management Plans (SCMPs)	1.1.4.1					GCF
		1.1.4.2					GCF
1.2	Activity 1.2.1: Preparation of VLAP implementation	1.2.1.1					GCF
		1.2.2.1					GCF
		1.2.2.2					GCF
	Activity 1.2.2: VLAP Implementation	1.2.2.3					GCF
		2.1.1.1					GCF
		2.1.1.2					GCF
2.1	Activity 2.1.1 EbA agriculture extension support through FFS	2.1.1.3					MoA
		2.1.2.1					GCF
		2.1.2.2					GCF
	Activity 2.1.2 Knowledge innovation	2.1.2.3					GCF
		2.1.3.1					GCF
		2.1.3.2					FAO (GEF7 Project)
	Activity 2.1.3 Agrobiodiversity promotion	2.1.3.3					GCF
		2.1.3.4					GCF
		2.2.1.1					GCF
		2.2.1.2					GCF
2.2	Activity 2.2.1 Public-private producer partnerships (4Ps) establishment	2.2.1.3					GCF
		2.2.1.4					GCF
		2.2.2.1					GCF
		2.2.2.2					GCF
	Activity 2.2.2 MSME development	2.2.2.3					GCF
		2.2.3.1					GCF
		2.2.3.2					GCF
	Activity 2.2.3 Market development through 'EbA production system' brand creation	2.2.3.3					GCF
		2.3.1.1					MOF (FARMSE)
		2.3.1.2					MOF (FARMSE)
2.3	Activity 2.3.1 Consolidation / expansion of Community Based Financial Organizations	2.3.2.1					GCF
		2.3.2.2					MOF (FARMSE)
	Activity 2.3.2: Development and delivery of innovative climate adaptation finance services	2.3.3.1					MOF (FARMSE)
		2.3.3.2					MOF (FARMSE)
	Activity 2.3.3. Linkage of partner FFIs to financial instruments	2.3.4.1					MOF (FARMSE)
		2.3.4.2					MOF (FARMSE)
	Activity 2.3.4. Linkage of agri SMEs to impact investment funds	3.1.1.1					GCF
		3.1.1.2					GCF
3.1	Activity 3.1.1. Support to Malawi's National Climate Change Fund (NCCF)	3.1.1.3					GCF
		3.1.1.4					GCF
		3.1.1.5					GCF
		3.1.2.1					GCF
		3.1.2.2					GCF
	Activity 3.1.2. Support to National Conservation Trust Funds	3.1.2.3					GCF
		3.1.3.1					GCF
		3.1.3.2					GCF
	Activity 3.1.3. Leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits in Malawi as part of the exit strategy	3.2.1.1					GCF
		3.2.1.2					GCF
3.2	Activity 3.2.1 Preparation of evidence-based studies	3.2.2.1					FAO (GEF7 Project)
		3.2.2.2					FAO (GEF7 Project)
	Activity 3.2.2. Policy Assessment and preparation of a policy influencing plan (PIP)	3.2.3.1					GCF
		3.2.3.2					GCF
	Activity 3.2.3 Implementation of the PIP						

95. The project will establish a **Central Project Implementation Unit (CPIU)** that will be functional for the entire duration and be responsible for day-to-day implementation of the project. The main functions of the PIU, following the

guidance of the PSC and project technical committee (PTC), are to ensure overall efficient management, coordination, implementation and monitoring of the project through the effective implementation of the annual work plans and budgets (AWPBs). The PIU will be led and managed by a project-recruited National Project Coordinator (NPC). The NPC will be appointed by FAO and will be responsible for overall project management and coordination with project stakeholders. The PIU will also include (part time) a finance officer (50%), operation officer (50%), Human resources & admin officer (50%) and procurement & contracting officer (50%) as well as a contracts management officer. In addition, the project PIU will include the following technical specialists: (i) total 6 technical advisors for components 1 and 2: a team of 2 specialists (EbA & Agroecology specialist, NRM specialist) in each project office (1 central and 2 regional offices); (ii) Agribusiness & Finance specialist, (iii) Gender and social inclusion specialist, (iv) Environmental and social safeguards international technical assistance (E&S) – part time 50%, (v) a national safeguards specialist, (vi) M&E / GIS; and (vi) part time Knowledge Management specialist (50%). All staff will be hired under the project through a competitive process.

96. The CPIU will coordinate closely with the two **Regional Project Implementation Units (RPIUs)**, which will be established in Blantyre (Southern Region) and Mzuzu (Northern Region). RPIUs will supervise the day-to-day project operations in each districts, liaising with the Focal Points (appointed by the respective EE) in each district. The regional PIU will be composed of the two technical specialists (EbA/ Agroecology specialist, NRM specialist) mentioned above, together with an M&E associate, and an Administrative & Finance associate (part time 30%).

Other Project Partners

97. During implementation, in addition to the above EE, the project will engage relevant government counterparts from MoA (e.g. Gene Bank within the Research Services), Ministry of Climate Change and Natural Resources – MoCCNR (e.g. DCCMS) as procured parties. It will also engage knowledge institutions (Agroecology Hub of Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources – LUANAR), training centers (Paradise Permaculture Centre, Kusamala Permaculture Institute, SFHC Research and Training Centre), local non-profit conservation trusts (MEET, Shire BEST), finance service providers and the private sector (e.g. Malawi Industrial & Agricultural Investment Corporation – MAIIC).

98. In addition, several partners will be engaged in the project either to ensure complementarity with their activities and/or delivery of goods works and services. The project will cooperate closely with a consortium of qualified and experienced service providers (NGOs) from the Malawi Climate Smart Agriculture Alliance (MCSAA), which have extensive technical expertise relevant for the activities to be implemented by this project, and which have regularly worked with MoA (DLRC). MCSAA includes CARE, Catholic Relief Services (CRS), Total Land Care (TLC), Development Fund of Norway (DF Norway), Find Your Feet (FYF). It will also work with NGOs having a proven track-record of implementing EbA/ agroecology activities in the countries or in the region. The partners will be selected as procured parties during project implementation in accordance with FAO rules and regulations for procuring good and services (e.g. FAO Manual Sections 502 and 507).

Project Governance

99. A **Project Steering Committee (PSC)** will be established to provide strategic guidance for the project. The PSC will be co-chaired by the NDA (Environmental Affairs Department, MoCCNR), and co-chaired by the Secretary of the MoA and FAO Representative to Malawi. It will also include the Secretary of Ministry of Climate Change and Natural Resources (MoCCNR). The NPC of the PIU will serve as Rapporteur to the PSC. The PSC will include representatives of other key government departments and agencies, private sector and civil society organizations. These partners will include MoA Departments for Land Resources Conservation, Crop Development, Agriculture Extension Services, Agriculture Planning Services, Animal Health and Livestock Development, and respectively. The MoNRCC will also be engaged through the Departments of Forestry (DoF), Climate Change and Meteorological Services (DCCMS), Fisheries (DoF), respectively. It will also engage the NLGFC, the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (MoF, Pensions and Financial Sector Division which is overseeing FARMSE), the Ministry of Community Development and Social Welfare, the Ministry of Lands, the Ministry of Industry, as well as other key entities such as Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources (LUANAR), the National Smallholder Farmers' Association of Malawi (NASFAM), the National Water Resources Authority (NWRA), CSOs (Civil Society Network on Climate Change) and NGOs (MCSAA). Representatives of (i) the Development Cooperation Group on Environment, Resilience and Climate change (DCERCC) of the Environmental Affairs Department and (ii), the Joint Technical Committee on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management, the Donor Committee in Agriculture and Food Security (DCAFS) will also sit in the PSC.

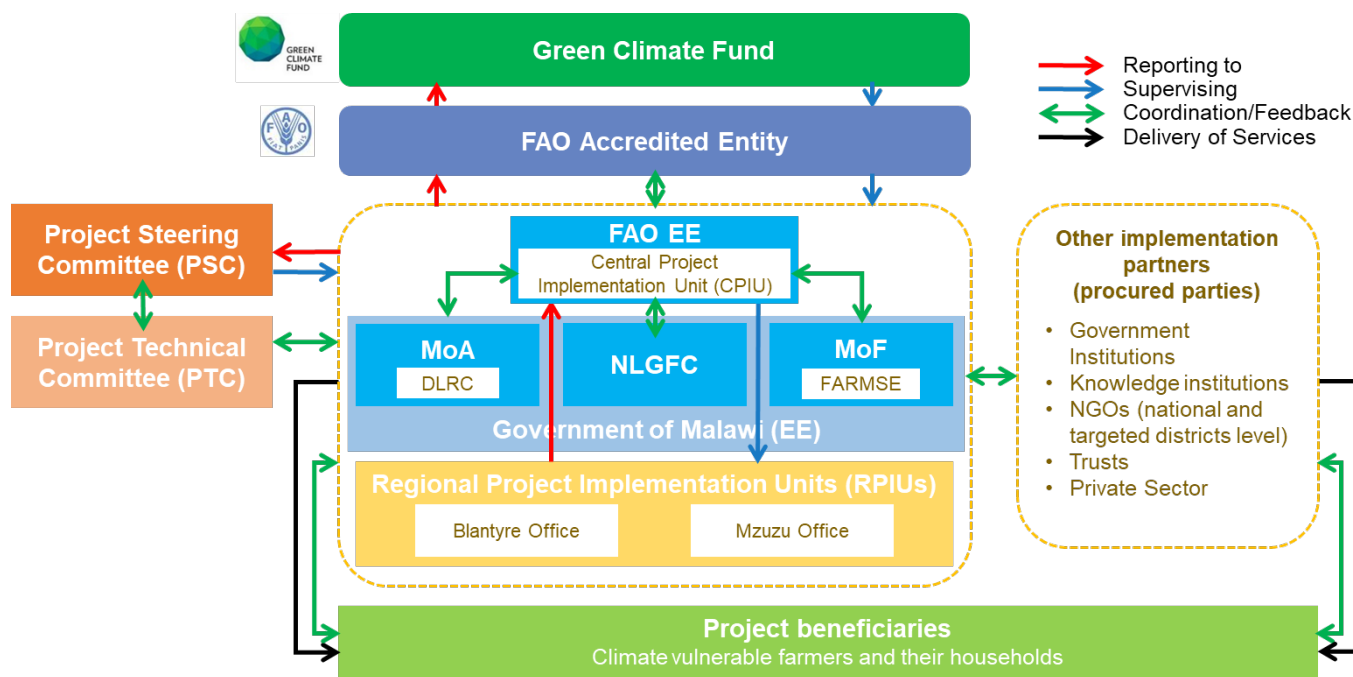
100. The role of the PSC will be to: (i) provide overall guidance and direction to the project, ensuring it remains within any specified constraints; (ii) address project issues as raised by the national project coordinator; (iii) monitor project risks and the effectiveness of mitigation measures, and provide guidance on new project risks, and agree on possible countermeasures and management actions to address specific risks; (iv) review the project progress, and provide direction

and recommendations to ensure that the agreed deliverables are produced satisfactorily according to plans; (v) review and agree with annual work plan and provide necessary strategic guidance for its implementation; (vi) appraise the annual project implementation report, including the quality assessment rating report; (vii) make recommendations for subsequent work plans to build on achievements and address any shortcomings; and (viii) provide ad hoc direction and advice for exceptional situations when the project coordinator's tolerances are exceeded.

101. The PSC will be expected to meet formally at least once every 12 months. Formal meetings will be scheduled and arranged by the National Project Coordinator in consultation with, and at the request of PSC members (with tentative dates for the following meeting being agreed under Any Other Business). Extraordinary meetings of the PSC can be requested by any of its members.

102. The PSC will be supported by the **Project Technical Committee (PTC)**, which will review and, where needed, advise on the technical delivery of the project. The PTC will be co-chaired by the NDA, the Department of Land Resources Conservation and FAO Representation in Malawi, which will be the Secretariat for both the PSC and the PTC. Other members of the PTC will include MoA Departments for Crop Development, Agriculture Extension Services, Agriculture Planning Services, Animal Health and Livestock Development, and Agriculture Research Services (including the Gene Bank), MoF/FARMSE and the MoCCNR Departments of Irrigation, Forestry, and Fisheries respectively, and NASFAM, FUM, NWRA, and relevant CSOs and NGOs. The PTC will: (i) technically oversee activities in their sector; (ii) ensure a fluid two-way exchange of information and knowledge between their agency and the project; (iii) facilitate coordination and links between the project activities and the work plan of their agency; and (iv) facilitate the provision of co-financing to the project.

Figure B.4.2: Proposed institutional arrangements for EbAM



B.5. Justification for GCF funding request (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

103. The proposed project is focused on reaching out to the most vulnerable populations in a LDC, with high vulnerability to climate change. LDCs, and Malawi in particular, are indeed the most vulnerable to the damaging effects of climate change, since their economic development, growth and food security highly depend on climate-sensitive sectors such as agriculture.

104. The proposed GCF grant is appropriate to address the needs of the country, since Malawi does not dispose of the needed public resources to finance the project through public debt. According to the World Bank statistics²⁰¹, Malawi has a large stock of public debt (external debt stocks have increased from 28% to 32.5% of gross national income – GNI, between 2015 and 2019) which has continued to increase in 2020/2021 due to a widening fiscal deficit – mainly due to a slowdown in revenue collection driven by the COVID-19 pandemic, combined with increasing spending pressures including from response to the pandemic, debt service costs and unbudgeted arrears. Malawi is at high risk of overall debt distress,

making it difficult for the country to meet its needs (through debt finance) in terms of climate-finance for a paradigm shift towards climate resilient practices and land restoration.

105. The Government of Malawi requests maximum concessionality to support vulnerable farmers to adapt to increasing temperatures and rainfall variability attributed to climate change, leading to droughts and floods. The GCF plays a catalytic and transformative role to: (i) unlock additional investment in climate resilient agriculture, and resilient ecosystems, (ii) cover the costs of enhancing the capacities of farmers (and their organizations/ communities) to understand and act on climate change adaptation in their landscapes/watersheds and production systems, (iii) repair ecosystems affected by climate change, develop resilience-enhancing agricultural production systems, and enhance farm and business planning to sufficiently stabilize revenues for continued investment in adaptive responses to climate change.

106. The NDC 2021 of Malawi puts the estimated funding requirements for climate change adaptation at USD 1.23 billion, of which 656 million relies on external sources, for the period of 2020-2025 and USD 1.56 billion, of which 818 million is to be supplied by external sources, for 2025-30. For agriculture, livestock and fisheries, roughly USD 600 million from external sources is deemed necessary for adaptation in 2020-2040, of which more than half concerns climate resilient agriculture and soil/water/watershed management. In 2019, it was estimated that USD 55 million would be required per district for adaptation of climate change resilient agriculture and that access to climate change funds was meagre compared to the size of the problem. With respect to mitigation, USD 4.21 billion is necessary for 2020-2025, of which 2.55 billion is to be found, while USD 7.34 billion is needed for 2025-2030, of which 5.39 billion is yet to be secured. Mitigation through crop management requires some USD 11 billion during 2020-2040, half of which is to depend on the international community. The situation is similar for forestry and land use, as close to half of more than USD 1.41 billion for the same period is to come from external sources. References to these data are found in the endnotes.

107. A number of investments (funded for e.g. by the World Bank, the GEF or the EU) have been and are being implemented to address climate-related risks and threats. Yet, adaptation needs overreach the current scope of interventions. The NFRLS (2017) reports that (i) up to 3.7 million hectares (39% of Malawi's total areas) have an opportunity for conservation agriculture, farmer-managed natural regeneration and agro-forestry and, (ii) about 1 million hectares (11% of Malawi's total area) have an opportunity for soil and water conservation. The NDC for Malawi (from June 2021) also affirms the substantial need for external funding as condition for successfully implementing the adaptation needs. GCF proceeds will, through the EbAM project, contribute to addressing this financing gap.

108. Co-financing with other initiatives has been thoroughly identified, including with the MoF/FARMSE Programme (6.44 million USD) and the GEF-7, FAO implemented DSLP (0.52 million USD). The Project also secured national co-financing from the Ministry of Agriculture (2.95 million) and co-financing from FAO (0.5 million USD). Government co-financing will ensure ownership, sustainability and replicability. The Project also identified parallel co-financing opportunities, which include the Restore Africa Programme (under preparation), financed by Climate Asset Management (CAM) and implemented by the Global Evergreening Alliance (GEA). Leveraged co-financing could also include funding from the Malawi Agricultural and Industrial Investment Corporation (MAIIC) – as mentioned in sub-component 2.3 (in section B.3).

B.6. Exit strategy (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

109. The project design includes several features to enhance sustainability. By supporting CMC and VNRMC to systematically mainstream EbA into local development planning (sub-activity 1.1.3.3 and 1.1.4.3), the Project will develop medium to long-term institutional capacity to mobilize additional climate finance towards climate-resilient investments in degraded watershed ecosystems, beyond the Project's investment horizon. The Project support (more particularly under activity 1.1.3.3) will ensure that operations and maintenance (O&M) needs (e.g. monitoring of land degradation, regular land maintenance) will be included in VLAPs, and expected to be covered through local governments (districts) funding/ budgets and other sources (see below). This decentralized and participatory planning process will advance the policy and regulatory frameworks in the field, more particularly the Decentralization Act (which devolves funding from central Government to districts).

110. The increased financial inclusion of smallholder farmers, FOs and SMEs within local finance institutions, together with partnerships with financial instrument providers (e.g. MAIIC) developed (and enhanced) by the MoF/FARMSE (co-financing and co-executing the Project) will contribute to enhance the sustainability of ecosystems-based adaptation interventions. In addition, (i) support to the Malawi Climate Change Fund (NCCF), (ii) linkages with national conservation trusts (MEET and Shire BEST) and, (ii) partnerships with the private sector (CAM/ HSBC – which is financing the Restore Africa Programme) to leverage experience on carbon credits, will facilitate mobilization of climate finance, and contribute to sustaining, replicating and ensuring the long-term financial sustainability of the landscape restoration interventions, while expanding the scale of investments promoted by the Project under component 1 and 2. Interventions will mainstream and deep-root EbA in national policies and investment plans, and bring the EbA agenda at sectoral policies level. By integrating

EbA in national policies, the legacy of the component will be to improve the enabling environment, and allow replication and scaling-up of EbA through other projects and programmes – for massive-scale impact and sustainability.

DISTRIBUTION OF INVESTMENT SOLUTIONS AMONG EbAM COMPONENTS

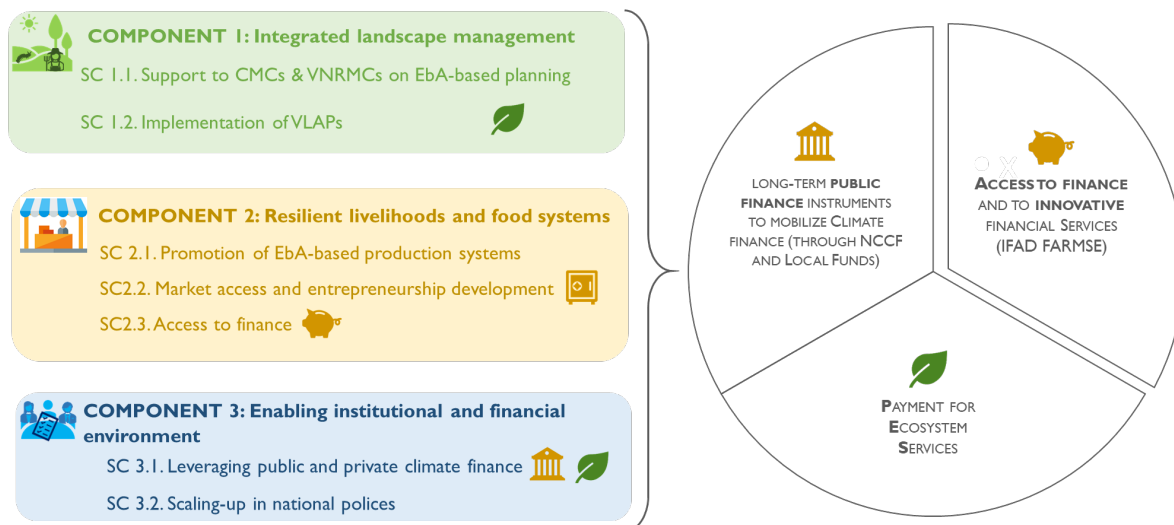


Figure C.3.1. Innovative financing solutions under EbAM

Innovation	Comp./sub-comp.	Innovation type	Purpose
 Integration of EbA in local planning - VLAPs & CMPs- with stakeholder engagement, including vulnerable groups	C1, SC1.1 and SC1.2	Planning	- Watershed ecosystem resilience to extreme climate - Mitigating maladaptation risks - Equitable sharing of decision-making power among social groups at local/watershed level
 Integration of local knowledge on forest management	SC1.1 and SC 1.2	Technical innovation	- Implement the government's intention to incorporate local knowledge in forest management (National Forest Policy 2016)
 Thorough engagement of farmers in the choice of new technologies to offer	SC 2.1	Implementation	- Overcoming the non-adoption barrier against new technologies - Acknowledgement of the diversity among farmers for better overall adoption of EbA
 Use of digital technologies	C2, SC2.1	Technical innovation	- Access to digital services, such as agro-weather information and e-extension - Knowledge sharing
 Public private producers partnerships (4Ps) and support to MSMEs	C2, SC2.2	Business innovation	- Smallholder access to markets - Commercial agreements with local private operators/ agri-food SMEs
 Enhanced access to finance through MoF co-financing (MoF/FARMSE Programme), linkages with impact investment funds	C2, SC2.3	Financing mechanism	- Leverage MoF/FARMSE's instruments for an enhanced access to finance service providers (VSLAs, SACCOs, MFIs, Banks) for EbA adoption
 PES	C1 C3, SC3.1	Financing mechanism	- Expanding small scale, community-led PES, such as renting trees for apiculture - Leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits, with Private sector engagement (a possible partner is the Restore Africa Program, financed by Climate Asset Management – CAM/ HSBC)
 Support local Trusts (e.g. MEET) to access GCF resources	C3, SC3.2	Institutional	- Scalability and sustainability of EbAM interventions

	Support to Malawi's National Climate Change Fund (NCCF)	C3, SC3.2	Financing mechanism	- Sustainability of EbAM interventions - Scalability: building an investment pipeline for NCCF focusing on EbA, in EbAM watersheds and beyond (scalability)
	Integration of EbA in national policies	C3, SC3.3	Policy	- Sustainability of EbAM interventions - Scalability: uptake of EbA into national policies, sectoral plans, and budgetary processes

Table C.3.1. Innovations introduced in EbAM

111. The Project will scale up a number of innovations which are already tried and tested, with a history of delivering positive adaptation results. The climate-resilient investments promoted by the Project are expected to generate attractive financial returns for the farmers²⁰² as evidenced in the EFA (see Annex 3). The prospects of stabilized and diversified incomes and relatively higher returns for the farmers are a key incentive for the long-term adoption and sustainability of climate-resilient practices and technologies.

112. Through the various capacity development activities, the project will invest in strengthening the capacity of extension workers and farmers on the topic of climate-resilient agriculture and EbA. The “climate responsive” FFS programme on climate-change adaptation will build and strengthen a network of FFS master trainers and lead farmers as FFS facilitators, who will build the needed extension capacity within the farmer communities. These master trainers and facilitators will be able to support other similar extension interventions inside and outside the targeted districts and watersheds, beyond the Project lifespan.

113. As mentioned below, the proposed project was designed through the participation of a wide array of public and private institutions, civil society (including national and international NGOs) to promote ownership of the project; the project's Stakeholder Engagement Plan (Annex 7) provides detailed information on how these stakeholders will keep being engaged during implementation. M&E and KM&L activities will ensure that the lessons learned, documents produced and the activities implemented during the project are archived (within the Project MIS system), and disseminated to the benefit of other projects and programmes.

C. FINANCING INFORMATION							
C.1. Total financing							
(a) Requested GCF funding (i + ii + iii + iv + v + vi + vii)	Total amount			Currency			
	42.81 million			million USD (\$)			
GCF financial instrument	Amount	Tenor	Grace period	Pricing			
(i) Senior loans	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter %</u>			
(ii) Subordinated loans	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter %</u>			
(iii) Equity	<u>Enter amount</u>			<u>Enter % equity return</u>			
(iv) Guarantees	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Enter years</u>					
(v) Reimbursable grants	<u>Enter amount</u>						
(vi) Grants	42.81 million USD (\$)						
(vii) Results-based payments	<u>Enter amount</u>						
(b) Co-financing information	Total amount			Currency			
	10.42			million USD (\$)			
Name of institution	Financial instrument	Amount	Currency	Tenor & grace	Pricing	Seniority	
MoF	<u>Grant</u>	<u>6.44</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>	
MoA ^{cciii}	<u>In kind</u>	<u>2.95</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>	
FAO	<u>Grant</u>	<u>1.02</u>	<u>million USD (\$)</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>	
Click here to enter text.	<u>Options</u>	<u>Enter amount</u>	<u>Options</u>	<u>Enter years</u> <u>Enter years</u>	<u>Enter%</u>	<u>Options</u>	
(c) Total financing (c) = (a)+(b)	Amount			Currency			
	<u>53.22 million USD</u>			<u>Options</u>			
(d) Other financing arrangements and contributions (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)	The Project also identified parallel co-financing opportunities. This includes the Restore Africa Programme (USD 17.5 million, started late 2022), financed by Climate Asset Management (CAM) and implemented by the Global Evergreening Alliance (GEA). Leveraged co-financing could also include funding from the Malawi Agricultural and Industrial Investment Corporation (MAIIC). These opportunities will be leveraged at the level of sub-component 2.3 (for MAIIC) and sub-component 3.1 (for GEA/CAM).						
C.2. Financing by component							
Component	Output	Indicative cost million USD (\$)	GCF financing		Co-financing		
			Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Name of Institutions

<u>1. Integrated Landscape Management</u>	<u>1.1 Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are developed</u>	<u>5.68</u>	<u>5.37</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.31</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>FAO</u>
	<u>1.2 Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are implemented</u>	<u>18.92</u>	<u>18.92</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.00</u>		
<u>2. Resilient livelihoods and food systems</u>	<u>2.1 EbA measures and inputs are promoted among farmers</u>	<u>10.35</u>	<u>7.24</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.16</u> <u>2.95</u>	<u>Grants</u> <u>In-kind</u>	<u>FAO</u> <u>MOA</u>
	<u>2.2 Private sector is incentivized to invest in climate-resilient agriculture; and better farmers' access to markets</u>	<u>3.49</u>	<u>3.49</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.00</u>		
	<u>2.3 Financial service providers are incentivized to invest in climate-resilient agriculture</u>	<u>8.66</u>	<u>3.18</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>5.48</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>MoF</u>
<u>3. Enabling institutional and financial environment</u>	<u>3.1 Sustainable and innovative public and private climate</u>	<u>0.44</u>	<u>0.44</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0</u>		

	<u>financing through NCCF and local trusts are in place</u>						
	<u>3.2 EbA is integrated in national policies</u>	<u>0.75</u>	<u>0.39</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.36</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>FAO</u>
<u>Monitoring and evaluation</u>	<u>M&E</u>	<u>2.32</u>	<u>1.78</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.19</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>FAO</u>
					<u>0.35</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>MOF</u>
<u>Project management</u>	<u>PMC</u>	<u>2.62</u>	<u>2.01</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>0.62</u>	<u>Grants</u>	<u>MoF</u>
Indicative total cost (USD)		<u>53.22 million</u>	<u>42.81 million</u>		<u>10.42 million</u>		

C.3 Capacity building and technology development/transfer (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)

C.3.1 Does GCF funding finance capacity building activities?	Yes ☒ No ☐
C.3.2. Does GCF funding finance technology development/transfer?	Yes ☐ No ☒

114. Communities and farmers' learning on EbA are at the core of the investment strategy – and will amount 5.53 million of GCF funding. For this reason, capacity development activities will be mainstreamed across the three components, and will aim at addressing the multifaceted barriers to climate change adaptation in Malawi, i.e. technical/knowledge, planning, social, financial and institutional capacity. Under component 1, capacity development focuses on knowledge transfer and capacity building for the implementation of adaptation measures, gender and social inclusion with a special focus on FPIC and SEAH and GBV, and will target (i) ILM stakeholders on EbA as well as traditional/community leaders and other key figures, (ii) VNRMCS for the formulation and implementation of EbA-based VLAPs, and (iii) CMCs for the preparation of EbA-based CMPs. Under component 2, trainings will include: (i) capacity development on EbA to farmers, through the FFS and targeted trainings, (ii) capacity development to SMEs for business plan preparation and (iii) capacity development to financial institutions – including community based financing institutions, such as VSLAs. Under component 3, capacity development focuses on institutional capacity building for the sustainability of the project and the enhancement of the enabling environment, and targets: (i) NCCF, and local conservation trusts and (ii) policy makers. These capacity development activities, combined with an enhanced access to finance to undertake the recommendations, are a major push factor to achieve the paradigm shift in helping farmers to positively adapt, safeguard the natural resource base, and provide better services to ecosystems.

D. EXPECTED PERFORMANCE AGAINST INVESTMENT CRITERIA

This section refers to the performance of the project/programme against the investment criteria as set out in the GCF's [Initial Investment Framework](#).

D.1. Impact potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

115. The project objective is to increase the climate-change resilience of the most vulnerable rural communities at watershed level in Malawi, where climate change accelerates the vicious cycle of low agriculture productivity and watershed degradation. "Climate-change resilience" will be defined as the enhanced capacity of beneficiaries to anticipate, absorb, accommodate or recover from extreme weather events and natural disasters resulting from climate change in a timely, efficient and sustainable manner. This includes protecting, restoring and improving ecosystems and livelihoods in the face of threats that impact agriculture and hence the economy, food security and nutrition (adapted from the FAO definition of resilience)²⁰⁴.

116. EbAM will support vulnerable Malawian rural communities to positively adapt to the impacts of climate change and improve their livelihoods through the adoption of EbA measures, including low-emission climate-resilient agricultural practices, based on ecosystem restoration and services at landscape (watershed) and farm levels. Well-functioning ecosystems surrounding ecosystem-like farms bring multiple benefits for producers, including higher yields through improved soil structure and water retention, and increased resilience to pests. On farm biodiversity enhances soil organic matter and soil structure, which are continuously deteriorating under conventional agriculture. Improved soil in turn increase water holding capacity, and hence reduce exposure to climate hazards, such as droughts and floods. Farms are also resilient when strengthened as ecosystems; diversity means that the farm as a whole is less vulnerable to specific pests (weeds or insects) and diseases induced by climatic events. In fact, EbA/ agroecology has been proven to increase productivity in developing countries.²⁰⁵ Further, an ecosystem-based approach to production also leads to higher producer margins by improving soil fertility and decreasing the need for purchasing chemical fertilizers. In Malawi, it has been shown that EbA/ agroecology generates higher benefits in agriculture (higher yields, environment, livelihood, food and nutrition) than conventional agriculture. Due to the context-specific nature of EbA/ agroecology, its precise effects are subject to socioeconomic, cultural and environmental factors of each farm²⁰⁶. Further, integrated systems facilitate the recycling of nutrients and reduces the need for purchasing chemical fertilizers. Productive farms support farmers to safeguard the natural resource base and improve their incomes and nutrition, as well as unlocking their opportunities to expand and diversify their livelihoods – through enhanced access to market and finance. Through its interventions, EbAM will contribute to GCF ARA1 "Most Vulnerable People and Communities" (with support for livelihood enhancement through increasing resilience), GCF ARA2 "Health, well-being, food and water security" and GCF ARA4 "Ecosystems and Ecosystem Services" and GCF MRA4 "Forestry and Land Use".

117. The proposed project is expected to directly benefit around 270,820 beneficiaries vulnerable to climate-change (1.42% of Malawian population) in 11 pre-identified districts. Within each of the pre-targeted districts, the project will invest in 30 sub-catchments (for a total of about 267,500 hectares conserved, restored, and sustainably managed²⁰⁷), with a total of 1,110 villages. The project investment logic is based on an integrated landscape development approach, with sub-catchments being entry points. Therefore, the methodology for calculating direct beneficiaries (as one of the proxy to impact potential) is based on the number of people and households being part of the villages in the targeted micro-watersheds benefiting from component 1 investments. Detailed on estimated beneficiaries per activity is provided in the Feasibility Study (section 5.4). Based on use sex-disaggregated data at district level (data from the 2018 household Census), the project expects to reach 52% of women.

118. Villages and people that are not part of the targeted micro-watersheds but belong to the overall selected sub-catchments were accounted as indirect beneficiaries. These indirect beneficiaries are individuals who do not receive targeted support from EbAM's intervention – but will receive a measurable adaptation benefit thanks to well-functioning SCMCs and EbA-based SCMP developed under component 1. The total number of indirect beneficiaries is then 69,100 households or 304,035 people.

119. FAO's Ex-Ante Carbon Balance Tool (Ex-ACT) has been used to estimate in detail (in tCO₂eq over 20 years) the mitigation impact of carbon sequestration and avoided degradation. Ex-ACT results (see Annex 22 for details on results and methodology) suggest a mitigation potential in the range of -2,750,323 tCO₂eq over 20 years or -137,516 tCO₂eq/year.

D.2. Paradigm shift potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

120. This project aims to be a catalyst for a broad shift and new sustainable equilibrium for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture across Malawi, from their baseline state of very high vulnerability—in terms of high exposure, sensitivity and low adaptive capacity to more frequent and intense extreme climate events—to an alternative paradigm in which

watershed ecosystems are conserved, restored, and more sustainably managed, thus granting their adaptation to climate change, and their supply of services to climate-resilient farming systems, people and communities.

121. To achieve this, the project will promote the locally-led EbA approach combined with integrated landscape management (ILM) to repair degraded ecosystems, and low-carbon climate resilient agricultural practices to allow agriculture and other livelihoods to become resilient to climate change.²⁰⁸ The EbA approach – which is the core transformational driver of the project - is fully aligned with Malawi's Updated Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC), 2021²⁰⁹. The latter recommends: development of adaptation planning tools; ecosystem based adaptation; integrated watershed management; crop diversification; sustainable soil and water management; afforestation; agroforestry; sustainable forest management; and riparian restoration. Ecosystem-based management of watersheds/landscapes is also one of the two paradigm-shifting pathways defined by the GCF *Sectorial Guide on Ecosystems and Ecosystem Services*. This integrative and game-changing approach brought by the Project (additionality) will ensure a sustainable transformation not only within, but also across project districts and watersheds under the projected climate change scenario.

122. The paradigm shift brought forth by the project relies on applying EbA through ILM to sustainably transform ecosystems (both natural ecosystems and production systems that exist in the same landscape). EbA will help farmers to positively adapt, safeguard the natural resource base, and provide better *services to ecosystems* (reciprocal relationship between farmers and nature). The project will aim at enhancing ecosystem functions at a landscape (watershed) level large enough to facilitate climate change adaptation at scale. In the context of Malawi's water resources governance and decentralization system, EbA-based ILM plans will be at watershed (CMP) and village levels (VLAP). As a result of the Project, EbA will be firmly integrated in these local plans and processes. ILM allows the collective identification of climate vulnerabilities and resulting priorities of interventions, to which EbA offers most relevant solutions. ILM is already implemented at a smaller scale in the FAO/GEF-7 Project in Malawi. It involves long-term collaboration among different groups of land managers and stakeholders to achieve their multiple objectives and expectations within the landscape defined by them. As such, ILM is the ideal vehicle to plan and implement EbA. Thus combined, ILM and EbA yield social sustainability (through the participatory process), together with environmental sustainability and resilience – hence delivering on GCF ARA1, ARA2, ARA4 and MR4. ILM under the Project will engage marginalized groups, which will significantly reduce the risk of creating new climate vulnerability²¹⁰. The planning and implementation processes will be highly inclusive, with meaningful participation of vulnerable groups (e.g., women) to ensure their capacity building, and examination of decision-making power sharing at household and community levels. Local and traditional knowledge in ecosystem management will be incorporated.

123. Interventions according to EbA are comprised of actions to restore and strengthen ecosystems (*see Appendix 1 of the Feasibility Study describing the various EbA solutions applicable to the Malawi context*)²¹¹ so that biodiversity and ecosystem services are maximized, and climate-change adaptation is most effective. EbA allows “holistic solutions for holistic benefits” and is superior to other climate-change adaptation strategies in many aspects. By nature, EbA boosts ecological resilience²¹² by strengthening, restoring and sustainably managing ecosystems.²¹³ Resilient ecosystems are equipped with self-healing and adapting capabilities, which render EbA measures effective in a wider range of climate situations than other adaptation strategies. EbA, combined with ILM, generates benefits short- and long-terms benefits²¹⁴ and is applicable at regional, national and local levels.²¹⁵ EbA is considered more cost effective in climate change adaptation than grey infrastructure when economic, social and environmental benefits are included.²¹⁶ When local knowledge²¹⁷ (holistic socio-ecological knowledge, practices and beliefs)²¹⁸ is integrated, EbA can avoid maladaptation. Healthy watershed ecosystems better absorb shocks resulting from floods and droughts, thus reducing their impact, and can limit water pollution exacerbated by extreme events and climate change. In contrast, improved agricultural productivity through EbA lessens flood damages, makes water available year-round, sustains itself under extreme weather, enhances biodiversity, strengthens watershed/landscape functions and improves food security. EbA is often more accessible to the rural poor than other types of adaptation and can bring socio-economic and environmental benefits beyond adaptation to local communities.

124. The project will boost the efficacy of EbA in food systems through an enhanced and sustainable access to markets, business opportunities, as well as finance. This shift will support farmers to stabilize and increase their income, hence making their livelihoods more resilient in the context of climate change. Strong linkages with the FARMSE Programme under the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (which will co-finance the EbAM Project, and act as an Executing Entity) will enable farmers' access to rural finance organizations and institutions. This enhanced access to finance will allow the adoption of EbA, and shift away from a pure grants-based approach. In addition, the Project will support Malawi's vision to establish its NCCF, and strengthen local trusts (e.g. MEET or Shire BEST), which will ultimately facilitate mobilization, blending, and disbursing of catalytic climate finance, and contribute to sustaining, replicating and expanding the scale of the Project climate-resilient investments. Similarly, the introduction of PES at the

watershed level will contribute to promoting EbA and putting it on a financially secure footing, thanks to community and private sector engagement.

125. The integration of EbA in local plans will contribute to improving the enabling environment, and allow replication and scale-up of EbA through other projects and programmes. It is expected that projects such as the World Bank-funded “Social Support for Resilient Livelihoods Project”, or interventions under the Restore Africa Programme (see *Part III of the feasibility study with the description of other projects relevant for EbAM*) will leverage EbA-based ILM plans prepared at watershed and village-level under EbAM to implement their activities, hence catalyzing EbA at scale. In addition, interventions mainstreaming and deep-rooting EbA in national policies and investment plans will bring the EbA agenda at sectoral policies level – for massive-scale impact and sustainability.

126. Collective learning on EbA will be achieved by training not only the members of watershed management committees, but with an emphasis on the participation of local inhabitants. The Project employs a landscape approach to watershed management, whose principal tool is participatory planning based on discussions among stakeholders. Discussions will be led by Facilitators, who will not impose solutions, but raise awareness during discussions, provide prompts to deepen the analyses and guide the stakeholders toward sustainable watershed management based on EbA. The Project also ensures meaningful participation by providing trainings to various stakeholder groups with priorities given to women and youths. The needs for local inhabitants’ capacity building will also be identified through the local consultative processes. Gender empowerment is tackled at the root by adopting household methodology, whose results will be upscaled to community level by village-level organizations, more particularly VNRCs. These aspects will create strong ownership of the Project and promote inclusive and meaningful participation of stakeholders to facilitate awareness improvements and behavioral change. The inhabitants of the area covered by a VLA will engage in informal participatory monitoring and evaluation, which will be coordinated by ILM Facilitators. For establishing a management plan at the sub-catchment level, the experiences at the village level will be shared among the inhabitants, Traditional Authorities and local government officials. The PIU will integrate the lessons learned from early phases of the Project to later phases and also share the information at national and international levels. In particular, the project’s M&E system will generate data, evaluations and studies on the project, some of which will also be translated into policy briefs, enabling the lessons from the project to be valorized at all levels. The PIU will include a KM officer who will be tasked with ensuring that relevant lessons are thoroughly documented and disseminated.

D.3. Sustainable development (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

127. One key benefit that the Project will generate is enhanced food security (SDG2 – Zero Hunger). EbA practices will improve soil fertility and boost yields of crops impacted by climate-change (see B.1. climate rationale). For example, studies in Malawi reported that maize yields could increase by more than 40% under traditional management with *Acacia albida*²¹⁹. Evidence also suggests that yields obtained by smallholder in Malawi could potentially double if farmers had access to the knowledge, extension services and trainings on sustainable adaptation to climate change²²⁰. Activities will also contribute to poverty alleviation (SDG1 – No Poverty) thanks to their potential to increase household incomes²²¹.

128. By scaling up EbA practices, the Project will generate environmental benefits in terms of better land and water use, improved soil quality and water conservation that will lower GHG emissions, hence generating mitigation benefits (SDG13 – Climate Action) which are accounted for under MRA4 (Forestry and Land Use – see above). In addition, erosion control will generate environmental benefits such as sediment retention, hence protecting downstream public goods (watershed ecosystems including various waterbodies) and private entities²²² with valuable fixed assets, hence contributing to SDG 15 (Life on Land). As highlighted in section B.1, climate change will negatively affect the health of the population.²²³ Therefore, as a result of improved climate change adaptation, the Project will also contribute to SDG 3 (Good Health and Well Being).

129. The Project will contribute to gender equality and women empowerment (SDG5), to the National Gender Policy and address the gender inequalities exacerbated by climate change. It will ensure the full engagement and participation of women in FFS on climate-resilient agriculture, and mainstream gender in the trainings. The Project will train extension workers on gender and social inclusion, and create opportunities for dialogues between women and men in the community. Project will incentivize women’s access to labour saving technologies, nutrition sensitive and early maturing crop varieties, as well as productivity-enhancing assets. Studies in Malawi²²⁴ reported that conservation agriculture (CA) alone can reduce the labour demand for women farmers by about 34 days.

130. Sustainable adaptation to climate change is unattainable if interventions exclude the vulnerable groups or do not fully cater to them. The vulnerable groups are characterized by scant access to knowledge, resources and

opportunities and tend much more than others to resort to practices which are viable in the short term, but come at the expense of opportunities to reach long-term goals. Such practices in the case of climate change adaptation are called maladaptation. Therefore, without adoption of gender-sensitive approach, gender gaps are bound to grow and make women even more vulnerable, increasing the chances of serious maladaptation.

D.4. Needs of recipient (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

131. Current climate change impact pathways put communities under increased pressure to resort to a vicious cycle of maladaptation, unsustainable ecosystem use and management, and harm to nature. Impacts on people may also lead to interpersonal conflicts, food insecurity²²⁵ and malnutrition as well degraded health conditions. Without a significant climate-responsive investment project to reverse this cumulative chain of impacts and increase people's resilience to climate-change, ecosystems' ability to supply goods and services to people and local livelihoods will be constrained, more particularly those underpinning sustainable agricultural production and food security.

132. Shortages of vital ecosystems goods and services will trigger agriculture production shortages. Production of the main staple crops in Malawi may experience major annual decreases, as much as (i) 770,000 tons for maize (nationally), (ii) 218,245 tons for root crops (cassava) (Blantyre, Machinga and Shire Valley combined) and, (iii) 160,000 tons for some legumes (pigeon pea), hence creating food security and livelihood challenges for the targeted communities in the near future²²⁶. The economic costs of lost production due to climate change could be as high as 131.2 million USD/ year for maize²²⁷, 84.2 million USD/ year for cassava, 86.5 million USD/year for pigeon peas²²⁸.

133. The vulnerability to climate change at individual level can be said to originate from social exclusion, which engenders lack of access to resources and lack of assets and economic opportunities: the very factors that constitute vulnerability to various shocks and stresses.²²⁹ In recent years, economic inequality has significantly worsened.²³⁰ In addition, the youth in Malawi are subject to unemployment and economic exclusion, unwanted pregnancies, high maternal deaths, sexually transmitted infections and gender-based violence.²³¹ As of 2020, discrimination and violence toward women and other vulnerable groups remained problematic.²³²

134. The vulnerable groups – who are rendered particularly susceptible to climate change by social exclusion – are women (52% of total population), the youth (30% for age 15-35) and 50% for the poor. Eighty-three percent of the national population lives in the rural areas²³³ and 80% is engaged in agriculture.²³⁴ Through its investment approach, the Project will propose meaningful solutions tailored to the vulnerable populations (see more details in the Gender Action Plan - Annex 8). These approaches include targeting climate vulnerable districts and water resources units, combined with increased stakeholders' engagement, including women, youth and other vulnerable groups to plan and benefit from landscape restoration and on-farm climate-change adaptation interventions based on EbA, with an improved access to markets and finance.

135. The proposed GCF grant, combined with identified co-financing and parallel finance, is therefore appropriate to address the needs of the stakeholders, since the Country does not dispose of the needed public resources to implement the planned project and investments. According to the World Bank²³⁵, Malawi has a large stock of public debt which has continued to increase due to a widening fiscal deficit combined with increasing spending pressures including from response to the COVID-19 pandemic, debt service costs and unbudgeted arrears. Malawi is overall at high risk of overall debt distress.

D.5. Country ownership (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

136. As described above in section B.1, the Project is aligned to the MGDS III (2017-2020), the NDC, the NAP, the NAIP 2017-2023, the NFLRS (2017) and the National Resilience Strategy 2018-2030. The NDC puts emphasis on EbA, integrated catchment conservation and management, capacity development in resilient agronomic practices and water conservation technologies for smallholder farmers in the agriculture sector. These interventions are in line with Malawi's NAP²³⁶ (currently under preparation) to reduce vulnerabilities to the adverse effects of climate change.

137. By including implementation of climate change adaptation into SCMPs and VLAPs, the Project will support implementation of the Decentralization Act (1998), which devolves powers and funding from the central government to districts. It is also consistent with the Environmental Management Act (2017), which aims to ensure sustainable use of natural resources, facilitate restoration of ecological systems and preservation of biodiversity; and promote community-based natural resource management. It will support the National Water Resources Act (2013), which provides a mechanism for coordination, allocation and delegation of responsibilities among stakeholders (CMCs) for the protection and integrated management of water resources. The Project will also support the new National Disaster Risk

Management (DRM) Bill (2019), which includes the issue of building climate resilience to disasters and shocks, and implementation of the National Resilience Strategy (2018-2030). The Project's gender-responsive activities will contribute to the implementation in the field of the Gender Equality Act (2012), which aims to realize gender equality.

138. Broad stakeholders consultation processes were conducted during preparation to guarantee country ownership, and ensure that the needs of the recipient were taken into account into the Proposal (see Annex 7). The NDA (Environmental Affairs Department) has been directly involved at all stages of project preparation, in close collaboration with the FAO Country Office. Through national workshops, community engagement meetings at district level and field visits over 2021 and 2022, the preparation of the Funding Proposal (CN process included) involved a large range of stakeholders, which included: (i) the Director of the NDA, (ii) Government Ministries, such as MoA (Director of the Department of Land Resources Conservation, Department of Planning Services, Department of Crop Development, Department of Animal Health and Livestock Development, Department of Research and Technical Services, Department of Water Resources, Department of Irrigation, Department of Climate Change and Meteorological Services – DCCMS, Department of Fisheries and Department of Forestry, Gene Bank), MoCCNR (Environmental Affairs and NCCF Team), MoF (Pension and Financial Inclusion Division, Directorate of Debt and Aid) and NLGFC (Executive and Deputy Executive Directors); (iii) NGOs (CARE, CRS, TLC, DF Norway, FYF, SFHC²³⁷, CADECOM, SCOPE), (iv) CSO (CISONEC), (v) international research Institutions (International Centre for Research in Agroforestry – ICRAF, International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics – ICRISAT), (vi) academia (LUANAR) and knowledge centre (Paradise Permaculture Institute); (vii) the private sector (NASFAM, Ilovo Sugar Company, Climate Asset Management – CAM/ HSBC), (viii) trusts (Malawi Environment Endowment Trust – MEET, Shire BEST), (ix) SACCOs, MFIs, commercial Banks and national Development Finance Institution (Malawi Agricultural and Industrial Investment Corporation plc. – MAIIC) and, (x) parastatal (National Water Resources Authority), (xi) other Projects (MoF/FARMSE, FAO/GEF-7, Restore Africa, World Bank MWASIP) and (xii) agribusinesses and retail/ distribution businesses. The Funding Proposal (CN process included) was discussed with the Development Cooperation Group on Environment, Resilience and Climate change (DCERCC) of the Environmental Affairs Department, the Joint Technical Committee on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management, the Donor Committee in Agriculture and Food Security (DCAFS) and other UN systems entities (including UNDP, in particular for the NCCF). All stakeholders engagement processes are documented in Annex 7 of the Funding Proposal, which also highlights how stakeholders will be engaged during implementation.

D.6. Efficiency and effectiveness (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

139. EbAM is expected to have multiple benefits for project participants and society as a whole. Broadly, these benefits can be classified as i) increased productivity on farmland, resulting from EbAM activities in Component 1 and support to producers in Component 2 (e.g. FFS and improved access to finance); ii) additional post-production value and improved access to markets through the activities in Component 2 (e.g. the 4Ps and improved access to finance) iii) a significant reduction in greenhouse gas emissions from EbAM and improved agricultural practices and iv) additional benefits of EbAM such as an increased production of Non-Timber Forest Products and other, less easily quantifiable, ecosystems benefits.

140. The ex-ante financial and economic viability of EbAM is demonstrated through an economic and financial analysis, a cost-benefit analysis of the project. The analysis is based on farm and enterprise models assessing the costs and benefits of proposed project interventions. The financial analysis considers the profitability of these investments from the point of view of project participants, while the economic analysis considers the profitability of investments for the entire project from the perspective of society.

141. At the economic level, one important project benefit will be the project mitigation impact. As mentioned above, the project is expected to lead to a reduction in emissions of 137,516 t CO₂e per year on average over a 20-year period. This reduction in GHG emissions was converted into an economic value using two price ranges (low and high ranges of social carbon prices as adopted by the World Bank) and considered in the Economic Analysis.

142. The results of the financial analysis shows that the proposed investments are financially viable for project beneficiaries, as all financial models have positive Net Present Values (NPV) and Internal Rate of Returns (IRRs) above the financial discount rate of 14.2%. These results mean that EbA solutions have proven to be cost-efficient, which is a key incentive for the long-term adoption and sustainability of these climate-resilient practices and technologies by the farmers.

143. The Economic Analysis further shows that the project as a whole also has a positive return on investment, with an NPV of 68.5 MUSD and an Economic Internal Rate of Return (EIRR) of 32.8%, above the economic discount rate of 10%. These results are those of the baseline scenario, defined as the scenario that includes the value of avoided

GHG emissions using the low social carbon price. Using the high social price of carbon, the project EIRR increases to 54.6%. Without the value of avoided GHG emissions, the project has a much lower, albeit still positive, EIRR of 12.7%.

144. The sensitivity analysis further shows that the project remains economically viable in different scenarios, including a decrease in benefits of 20% and an increase in costs of 20%. The cost per beneficiary (197 USD/person) is comparable to/consistent with recent GCF funding proposals.

145. These ex-ante results are confirmed by other analysis in the country. For example, landscape restoration investments under the World Bank-funded MWASIP project show an EIRR of 15.6%²³⁸ (without of the value of avoided GHG emissions). Enhanced watershed management through improved crop management, tree planting and soil and water conservation measures in the upper catchments foreseen by the GEF-funded ERAS Project are estimated (at design) to have an EIRR of 27.5%²³⁹. Similarly, catchment management interventions conducted within the SRBMP project are found (at completion) to generate an EIRR of 25.9%²⁴⁰ (without of the value of avoided GHG emissions). The cost-benefit analysis conducted within the Malawi NFLRA shows that agriculture-based restoration interventions (e.g., conservation agriculture, agroforestry, farmer managed natural regeneration), and forestry-based activities such as community plantations and private woodlots generate positive NPVs²⁴¹. Ignaciuk et al. (2021) find that the IRR of adopting maize-legume intercropping in the southern Malawian districts of Blantyre, Neno, Phalombe, and Zomba is about 19% as opposed to 15% of maize monocropping (which is the traditional way of growing maize in Malawi)²⁴². Mutenje et al. (2019), using a sample of 1,440 households in both mid-altitude plateau and lakeshore plains AEZs show that growing maize adopting conservation agriculture, drought tolerant varieties, intercropping/rotating with legumes generate positive economic benefits in terms of NPV and IRR²⁴³.

The economic and financial analysis (EFA) is presented in more detail in **Annex 3**.

E. LOGICAL FRAMEWORK

*This section refers to the project's logical framework in accordance with the **GCF's Integrated Results Management Framework** to which the projec contributes as a whole, including in respect of any co-financing*

E.1. Project/Programme Focus

- ☒ Reduced emissions (mitigation)
- ☒ Increased resilience (adaptation)

E.2. GCF Impact level: Paradigm shift potential (max 600 words, approximately 1-2 pages)

Assessment Dimension	Current state (baseline)		Potential target scenario	How the project/programme will contribute (Description)
	Description	Rating	(Description)	
Scale	In Malawi, degradation of watershed ecosystems and intensification of aridity caused by climate change increase vulnerability, with impacts on livelihoods, food security, causing maladaptation behaviours. This is worsened by limited technical capacity among farmers and extension workers due to limited outreach coverage; farmers' poor access to financial resources and limited and unstable income in the context of climate change.	<u>Low</u>	The promotion of the EbA approach to a wide arrays of stakeholders, both at watershed level and beyond will yield a new sustainable equilibrium for ecosystems, livelihoods and agriculture in the context of climate change, not only within project intervention areas, but also in other districts/watersheds, projects, and regions. Watershed ecosystems' capacity to supply goods and services will thus be enhanced, as well as farmers' ability to use them sustainably at scale, in a way that is adapted to climate change. Project interventions and approaches will be uptaken in all relevant spaces: financial; political; institutional; cultural; environmental; and at the level of partnerships and learning processes.	The project will establish the necessary drivers to push the scaling-up process forward, during implementation and beyond. These drivers include: - <i>Tested innovations</i>: the Project will introduce and scale-up EbA solutions in highly vulnerable districts and watersheds to repair degraded ecosystems, increase climate change resilience of agriculture, make water available, and enhance livelihoods. - <i>Leadership</i>: by supporting the adoption of the EbA approach with wide arrays of stakeholders, both at watershed level and beyond – food system actors, VNRMCS, CMCs, extension services, financing institutions, technical and financial partners, policy

				makers engaged in policy dialogue processes, etc., enabling its replication at all levels. - <i>Incentives and accountability:</i> the prospects of stabilized and diversified incomes and relatively higher returns are a key incentive for the long-term adoption of proposed climate-resilient technologies at farm and community levels. - <i>Enabling environment/ catalysts:</i> EbA solutions, fully aligned with Malawi's NDC, will reduce maladaptation risks, and create a virtuous cycle whereby the increased resilience of practitioners pushes them to further engage in EbA. Through knowledge management and improvements in the financial mechanisms and regulatory framework, the project will create an enabling environment conducive to private sector investment, and more inclusive financial services, facilitating access to EbA-based technologies and farm production throughout Malawi.
Replicability	Despite suitable EbA solutions with a proven potential for adaptation being available and documented, their deployment in Malawi is hampered by smallholder producers' capacity	Low	The paradigm shift of the project will rely on the dissemination and adoption of results of the available and tested EbA options both at landscape and farm-level. Healthy watershed	EbAM's replicability will be guaranteed by (i) the relevance, efficacy and effectiveness of promoted techniques to build vulnerable smallholder's and ecosystem's resilience in the context of

	constraints, market barriers including low access to finance and a lack of public financing for the sector. Limited information on impacts of climate change and insufficient capacity to address these hamper the use of resilient ecosystem-based adaptation solutions.		ecosystems have been shown to reduce the impact of floods and can limit water pollution exacerbated by extreme events. Improved agricultural productivity through EbA is demonstrated to lessen flood damages, makes water available year-round, sustains itself under extreme weather, enhances biodiversity, strengthens watershed functions, and improves food security. This will establish a blueprint for future public and private sector investments, as suitable to the Malawian context.	Malawi; (ii) the integration of EbA in local planning and national policies and investment plans, as well as extension programs through FFS – guaranteeing both a strong ownership at local and national levels, and establishing the blueprint for future replication; and (iii) support to financial mechanisms both at local and national level to facilitate the pursued financing of promoted interventions, through: an enhanced access to finance through MoF/FARMSE; and the innovative financing mechanisms and support to NCCF in mobilizing catalytic climate finance.
Sustainability	Long-term planning for climate change adaptation is rare at the community level due to poverty and lack of information, which is aggravated by weak long-term management/coordination and limited knowledge among the stakeholders on climate change adaptation solutions. Small-scale farmers who are vulnerable to climate change impacts have limited access to finance and markets, hampering the sustainable development of market-based and economically inclusive solutions.	Low	Under the paradigm shift supported by the project, a sustainable new equilibrium will be attained for ecosystems, livelihoods and agriculture in the context of climate change. Under this equilibrium vulnerable smallholders and their communities will be able to continually access the information, technical support, and finance they need to access markets, stabilize their income, and pursue the replication of EbA techniques both at farm and landscape level, ensuring their enhanced resilience to climate change. At the same time national policies, institutional mechanisms, and public and private partners will mainstream EbA in policies and interventions, facilitating its diffusion throughout the country.	The EbAM project holistically addresses critical drivers of sustainability: - <i>Political and institutional:</i> By supporting CMC and VNRMC to firmly mainstream EbA into local development planning, the Project will develop medium to long-term institutional capacity to mobilize more climate finance towards climate-resilient investments in degraded watershed ecosystems, beyond the Project's investment horizon. This decentralized and participatory planning process will advance the policy and regulatory frameworks in the field. - <i>Social sustainability and ownership:</i> Ownership and appropriation – which are key for behavioral change – are

				embedded in the project, notably through its participatory and collective learning approaches. - <i>Economic/financial:</i> The increased inclusion of smallholder farmers, FOs and SMEs within food systems (i.e. markets/ business opportunities with private sector, as well as local finance institutions developed by the MoF/FARMSE), will contribute to stabilize incomes and enhance the sustainability of ecosystem-based adaptation interventions. In addition, support to the NCCF, local conservation Trusts, as well as partnerships with CAM to leverage private sector experience on carbon credits, will aim to secure the long-term financial sustainability of the landscape restoration interventions. - <i>Environmental:</i> EbA approaches repair and restore ecosystems, guaranteeing their sustainable provision of services to the communities whose livelihoods depend on. - <i>Technical:</i> the soundness and appropriateness of techniques supported under the project are extensively discussed in the FS.
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E.3. GCF Outcome level: Reduced emissions and increased resilience (IRMF core indicators 1-4, quantitative indicators)						
GCF Result Area	IRMF Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final	
<u>MRA4 Forestry and land use</u>	<u>Core 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered</u>	Mid-term and end-of-the-project evaluation Ex-Ante Carbon balance Tool (Ex-ACT)	Sequestration 0 tons CO ₂ e	Sequestration of 138,671 tons CO ₂ e (net balance) after 3 years	Sequestration of 485,351 tons CO ₂ e (net balance) after 6 years	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites. Sequestration of a total sequestration of 2,750,323 tons CO ₂ e (net balance) after 20 years. Results are based on the annual mitigation results provided by Ex-ACT (see Annex 22, Excel results sheet).
<u>ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities</u> <u>and</u> <u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Yearly progress reports and final evaluation Progress reports from interventions and the constant monitoring	0 total beneficiaries (female/male) 0 direct beneficiaries (female/male) 0 indirect beneficiaries (female/male)	287,430 total beneficiaries (149,463 women) 135,410 direct beneficiaries (70,413 women) 152,020 indirect beneficiaries (79,050 women)	574,855 total beneficiaries (298,924 women) 270,820 direct beneficiaries (140,826 women) 304,035 indirect beneficiaries (158,098 women)	Beneficiary calculation methodology can be found in section 5.4 of the Feasibility Study The project-level M&E team will be updating and following up on the project registry with Kobo tool on each subcatchment and aggregated by region which will be updated quarterly. No external shocks (natural disasters, political or economic crises) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites

						No delays in procurement Public sector support provided in a timely manner
<u>ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities</u>	<u>Supplementary 2.1: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting improved and/or new climate-resilient livelihood options</u>	Project progress reports and final evaluation Georeferenced project outcome surveys	0	135,410 direct beneficiaries (70,413 women) adopting EbA solutions	270,820 direct beneficiaries (140,826 women) adopting EbA solutions	Beneficiaries estimated are part of Core 2 and not add-up No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous), adoption of project technologies proceeds as planned
<u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Supplementary 2.2: Beneficiaries (female/male) with improved food security</u>	Project progress reports and final evaluation Georeferenced project outcome surveys	0	135,410 direct beneficiaries (70,413 women)	270,820 direct beneficiaries (140,826 women)	Beneficiaries estimated are part of Core 2 and not add-up No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous), adoption of project technologies proceeds as planned
<u>ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services</u>	<u>Core 4: Hectares of natural resources brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practice</u>	Yearly progress reports and final evaluation Remotely sensed/ GIS data at the level of targeted catchments: land area showing an increase in Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI), combined with ground trothing	0	42,275 ha under EbA management	267,500 ha under EbA-based SCMPs planning including 83,240 ha under EbA management ^{ccxliiv}	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous), adoption of project technologies proceeds as planned
<u>ARA4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services</u>	<u>Supplementary 4.1: Hectares of terrestrial-forest, terrestrial-non-</u>	Technical annex of the yearly progress reports and final evaluation: Remotely	0	15,258 Ha restored	30,045 ha restored	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous),

	forest, freshwater and coastal-marine areas brought under restoration and or improved ecosystems	sensed/ GIS data at the level of targeted catchments: land area showing an increase in Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI), combined with ground truthing				adoption of project technologies proceeds as planned
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E.4. GCF Outcome level: Enabling environment (IRMF core indicators 5-8 as applicable)

Select at least two relevant IRMF core (enabling environment) indicators to monitor and elaborate the baseline context and project/programme's targeted outcome against the respective indicators. Rate the current state (baseline) vis-à-vis the target scenario and select the geographical scope of the outcome to be assessed. Describe how the project/programme will contribute towards the target scenario. Refer to a case example in the accompanying guidance to complete this section.

Core Indicator	Baseline context (description)	Rating for current state (baseline)	Target scenario (description)	How the project will contribute	Coverage
<u>Core Indicator 5: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to strengthening institutional and regulatory frameworks for low emission climate-resilient development pathways in a country-driven manner</u>	Institutional capacity for low emission climate-resilient pathways is limited due to (i) limited mainstreaming of EbA into national policies, regulations and investment frameworks (the NDC include EbA, but other policies do not clearly recognize it as the most sustainable solution), (ii) limited institutional capacity and national instruments to mobilize innovative climate finance.	<u>low</u>	Enhanced institutional capacity to mobilize additional climate finance towards climate-resilient investments in degraded watershed ecosystems, beyond the Project's investment horizon	GCF investments will contribute to strengthen institutional frameworks through: (i) the integration of EbA in national policies, cross sectoral plans and investment plans (sub-component 3.2), (ii) the integration of EbA in local development planning through support to CMC and VNRMC (sub-component 1.1), (iii) empowerment of local institutions (CMCs, VNRMC) to champion EbA at local level (sub-component 1.1) and, (iv) strengthening national institutions – such as NCCF – and local trusts to enable access to	<u>Multiple sub-national areas within a country</u>

				sustainable and innovative public and private climate financing (sub-component 3.1).	
<u>Core indicator 8: Degree to which GCF investments contribute to effective knowledge generation and learning processes, and use of good practices, methodologies and standards</u>	Strategies adopted by farmers to cope with climate change are currently limited in nature and scope. Detailed information of local ecosystems necessary for successful adaptation exists as local/traditional knowledge, and its utility for adaptation has been acknowledged by the government. At the same time local/traditional knowledge has not been fully integrated into interventions or supplemented by western science for maximum efficacy in adaptation. Knowledge on EbA exists and is practiced in Malawi, but is dispersed across different levels and stakeholders, from the government (including MoA staff) to NGOs and farmers. Little awareness exists on the importance of agrobiodiversity.	<u>low</u>	Communities having effective knowledge to sustainably manage watersheds and communal areas through good practices (EbA-based options) will fully benefit from ecosystems services (and provide reciprocal services to ecosystems). Farmers having improved knowledge of EbA, combined with a better knowledge of market standards and financing opportunities, will better (i) cope with climate-related risks and adapt to climate change, and (ii) enhance farming systems' resilience.	GCF investments will improve stakeholders' knowledge to plan the respective landscape restoration and climate-change adaptation interventions based on EbA (component 1). The Project will improve extension services' capacity through farmers field schools (FFS), allowing local knowledge sharing between farmers at large scale, promote agrobiodiversity, support to digitalisation, as well as access to finance/markets for enhanced impact (component 2). These processes enhancing institutional knowledge, sharing and learning will ensure sustainability, beyond the Project.	<u>Multiple sub-national areas within a country</u>

E.5. Project/programme specific indicators (project outcomes and outputs)

This section should list out project/programme-specific performance indicators (outcomes and outputs) that are not covered in sections above (E.1-E.4). List down tailored indicators to monitor /track progress against relevant project/programme results (outcomes/outputs). AEs have the freedom to decide against which outcomes they would like to set project/programme specific indicators. If any co-benefits are identified in sections B.2(a)(b), and D.3, AEs are encouraged to add and monitor co-benefit indicators under the “Project/programme co-benefit indicators” section in table below. Add rows as needed.

Please number each outcome and output as shown below to indicate association of outputs to the contributing outcome. The numbering for outputs under this section should correspond to the output numbering in annex 4 (detailed budget plan).

Project/programme results (outcomes/ outputs)	Project/programme specific Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final	
Component 1 Integrated Landscape Management						
Outcome 1.1 GHG emissions from improved watershed ecosystems are reduced	Core 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered	Mid-term and end-of-the-project evaluation Ex-Ante Carbon balance Tool (Ex-ACT)	N/A (see Core 1)	N/A (see Core 1)	N/A (see Core 1)	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites. Sequestration of a total sequestration of 2, 750,323 tons CO ₂ e (net balance) after 20 years. Results are based on the annual mitigation results provided by Ex-ACT (see Annex 22, Excel results sheet)
Outcome 1.2 Climate resilience of watershed ecosystems is increased	Core 4: Hectares of natural resources brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practice	Remotely sensed/ GIS data at the level of targeted catchments: land area showing an increase in Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI),	N/A (see Core 4)	N/A (see Core 4)	N/A (see Core 4)	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous), adoption of project technologies proceeds as planned

		combined with ground trothing				
Output 1.1 Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are developed	Number of VNRMCS strengthened/formed	Project annual progress reports and mid and final evaluation	0 VNRMCS	111 VNRMCS	111 VNRMCS	No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous) Effective participation of stakeholders in training, and planning processes discussions, resulting in firm willingness to sustainably and inclusively manage landscapes/watersheds
	Number of SCMCs strengthened/formed	SCMC reporting yearly progress reports, mid-term and final evaluations	0 SCMCs	5 SCMCs	30 SCMCs	
Output 1.2. Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are implemented	Number of villagers implementing their watershed management plans and VLAPs	Project annual progress reports	0	39,000 people	54,165 people	Availability and full participation from the local communities to the activities foreseen within Component 1
	Number of Village-Level Action Plans (VLAPs) implemented	Project annual progress reports	0	80 VLAPs	111 VLAPs	

Component 2 Resilient livelihoods and food systems

Outcome 2 . More climate resilient livelihoods and food systems are leading to stable productivity and incomes	% of supported households reporting a more stable income	Beneficiaries records, mid-term and final evaluations surveys and technical evaluations	0	30%	75%	Full implementation of activities foreseen under components 1 and 2 No major external shocks (i.e. political or exogenous) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites
	% of supported households reporting more stable crop yields	Beneficiaries records, mid-term and final evaluations surveys and technical evaluations	0	30%	75%	

	% increase volume of sales (key crops) per household	Beneficiaries records, mid-term and final evaluations surveys and technical evaluations	0	15%	30%	
Output 2.1. EbA measures and inputs are promoted among farmers	Number of field extension officers and lead farmers capacitated as FFS facilitators (including women and youth)	Project annual progress reports Training records,	0	828 people (60% women; 30% youth)	828 people (60% women; 30% youth)	Willingness of farmers to serve as FFS facilitators Continuous interest and participation in project trainings
	Number of FFSs implemented	Project annual progress reports Training records,	0	598 FFS	1080 FFS	Timely availability of inputs and no delays in procurement Public sector support provided in a timely manner
	Number of farmers accessing digital technical and climate information	Project annual progress reports Reports from Community radios, SMS sent and app use	0	79,000 people	196,000 people	No external shocks (natural disasters, political or economic crises) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites
Output 2.2 Private sector invests in climate-resilient agriculture; and farmers have better access to markets	Number of public-private producers partnerships (4Ps) established	Annual progress reports	0	5 partnerships	12 partnerships	Willingness of stakeholders to engage in project activities
	Number of beneficiaries engaged in the commercial activities	Training records	0	5,000 people (50% women and youth)	13,000 people (50% women and youth)	Continuous interest and participation in project trainings
	Number of informal or formal MSMEs established Number of beneficiaries engaged	Annual progress reports Training records	0	70 MSMEs 3,000 people (50% women and youth)	270 MSMEs 5,400 people (50% women and youth)	No external shocks (natural disasters, political or economic crises) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites Public sector support provided in a timely manner

						Effective training and supervision Increased market linkages are supported by increased credit worthiness of the farmers
Output 2.3. Financial service providers support investment in climate-resilient agriculture	Number of people accessing financial services supported by the project	Annual progress reports Training records	0	54,000 people (50% women and 25% youth)	108,000 people (50% women and 25% youth)	Willingness and strategy of FSPs to develop and deliver climate finance products FSPs will have access to financial instruments (guarantee and credit lines)
	Number of Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs) strengthened/established	Annual progress reports	0	2,000	5,500	Effective support by the Project under sub components 2.1 and 2.2 as a way to derisk lending by FSPs Continuous interest and participation in project trainings
	Number of Financial Service Providers (FSPs) capacitated to deliver adapted innovative products for farmers / POs and SMEs.	Annual progress reports	0	4 FSPs	8 FSPs	No external shocks (natural disasters, political or economic crises) with impacts on the targeted beneficiaries and sites

Component 3 Enabling institutional and financial environment						
Outcome 3 The enabling environment (finance and policies) to sustain, replicate, and scale-up climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices is enhanced.	Number of evidence-based policies/initiatives developed at national/sub-national level promoting the uptake of EbA solutions	Mid-term and final evaluation reports Project annual progress reports	0	Nr. 1 policies/initiatives prepared	Nr. 3 policies/initiatives prepared	Full commitment from the Government of Malawi and targeted stakeholders Willingness of stakeholders to engage in project activities
Output 3.1. Sustainable and innovative public and private climate financing through NCCF and local trusts are in place	Number of overall staff trained	Project annual progress reports, training records	0	10 participants	15 participants	Continuous interest and participation in project trainings Effective training and supervision
	Number of national entities accessing GCF resources	Project annual progress reports,	0	1	2	Full commitment of the partners to adopt GCF requirements
Output 3.2. EbA integrated in national policies	Number of policy makers capacitated to develop EbA-based policies and budget	Project annual progress reports, training records	0	25 participants	25 participants	Full commitment from the Government of Malawi and targeted stakeholders (all line ministries, farmers' organisations, the private sector and civil society organisations)
	Number of policy dialogue workshops/roundtables facilitated	Project annual progress reports	0	Nr. 2 events	Nr. 5 events	Active and continuous participation of trainees Effective training and supervision

Project/programme co-benefit indicators						
Co-benefit 1: Standard of living of vulnerable communities is improved	% of households with an increase in the value of household assets	Mid-term and final evaluations surveys	0	20%	60%	Household members interest, ability and agreement to better manage the additional income generated.
Co-benefit 2: Gender equality, women empowerment and inclusion	% of women perceiving improved support from men for women's empowerment.	Mid-term and final evaluations surveys	0	45%	60%	Willingness of women, men, male and female youth to engage and participate in project activities.

E.6. Project/programme activities and deliverables			
Activities	Description	Sub-activities	Deliverables
Component 1 Integrated Landscape Management			
<i>Sub-Component 1.1 Support to Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) on EbA Planning</i>			
<i>Output 1.1 Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are developed</i>			
Activity 1.1.1 Targeting and Phasing of Sub-Catchments and Micro-Catchments	Support selection of: target WRU sub-catchments for phased intervention ; and micro-catchments for village-level intervention.	Sub-activity 1.1.1.1 Identification and Assessment of 30 Sub-Catchments and 111 micro-catchments Sub-activity 1.1.1.2 FPIC and environmental and social assessment for 30 sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments Sub-activity 1.1.1.3 Validation and phasing of 30 targeted sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments	Rapid GIS hotspot assessment and ground-truthing for 30 target WRU sub-catchments; selection and phasing of 30 targeted sub-catchments and 111 micro-catchments Assessment of environmental and social baseline and impacts
Activity 1.1.2 Capacity Development of ILM Stakeholders on Ecosystem-based Adaptation	Support awareness raising and capacity building of landscape stakeholders on technical and social matters for effective ILM founded on EbA	Sub-activity 1.1.2.1 Capacity Development for EbA Implementation Sub-activity 1.1.2.2 Gender and Social Inclusion	Contract with NGO for 30 ILM Facilitators and 30 ILM Co-Facilitators EbA and ILM training for 60 Facilitators, micro-catchment residents and local government officials Training on the principles and operation of Dimitra Club (3,000 female youth), gender and social inclusion and HIV/AIDS
Activity 1.1.3 Strengthening/Formation of Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs)	Establish an operational watershed management structure at micro-catchment level (VNRMC) or strengthen it where it already exists Draft and finalize EbA-based VLAPs	Sub-activity 1.1.3.1: VNRMC charter revision and member selection Sub-activity 1.1.3.2: VNRMC Capacity Development for EbA Implementation. Sub-activity 1.1.3.3: Drafting and Finalizing EbA-based VLAP	111 VNRMC established (Charter elaboration and member selection) EbA and ILM training for VNRMC members 111 EbA-based VLAPs covering 83,240ha

Activity 1.1.4 Strengthening/Formation of Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) and Formulation of EbA-based Sub-Catchments Management Plans (SCMPs)	Establish operational watershed management structures at sub-catchment level (SCMCs) Draft and finalize EbA-based SCMPs	Sub-activity 1.1.4.1: SCMC Charter Revision and Member Selection Sub-activity 1.1.4.2: SCMC Capacity Development for EbA Implementation Sub-activity 1.1.4.3: Drafting and Finalizing EbA-based SCMP.	30 SCMC established (Charter elaboration and member selection) EbA and ILM training for SCMC members 30 EbA-based SCMPs covering 267,500 ha
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Sub-component 1.2: Implementation of VLAPs based on EbA

Output 1.2. Integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are implemented

Activity 1.2.1 Preparation of VLAP implementation	Mobilize relevant expertise necessary to support the implementation of VLAPs	Sub-activity 1.2.1.1 Planning process to initiate VLAP implementation	111 VLAP ready to initiate implementation
Activity 1.2.2 VLAP Implementation	Enable the actual delivery of investments outlined in each of the 111 VLAPs developed under sub-component 1.1	Sub-activity 1.2.2.1 Technical assistance to VLAP implementation Sub-activity 1.2.2.2 Access to inputs and equipment Sub-activity 1.2.2.3 Monitoring of VLAP implementation	Mobilized expertise for the implementation of VLAPs: 60 ILM facilitators and technical expertise from NGOs from MCSAA Inputs and TA for covering the needs of about 67,040 hectares of communal land, including: (i) soil and water conservation (14,352 hectares), (ii) pastureland, agroforestry and FMNR (7,308 hectares), (iii) community forests and woodlot restoration (22,416 hectares), (iv) forest management (22,640 hectares), and (iv) river and stream bank restoration (321 hectares).

Component 2. Resilient livelihoods and food systems

Sub-Component 2.1: Promotion of EbA-based production systems

Output 2.1 EbA measures and inputs are promoted among farmers

Activity 2.1.1 EbA agriculture extension support through FFS	Support the roll out of FFS	Sub-activity 2.1.1.1 Master Trainer's Course (MTC) and Training of Facilitators (ToF) Sub-activity 2.1.1.2 FFS implementation. Sub-activity 2.1.1.3 MoA support to FFS roll out	828 field extension officers and lead farmers trained 1080 FFS implemented impacting 27,000 farmers over 16,200 ha
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Activity 2.1.2 Knowledge and innovation	Promotion of exchanges, visits and trainings to enable different actors to have a first-hand experience and awareness on proposed EbA innovations	Sub-activity 2.1.2.1 Knowledge generation and sharing Sub-activity 2.1.2.2 Visits and exchanges. Sub-activity 2.1.2.3 Digital extension and climate information.	5,000 people participating to visits, exchanges and targeted trainings 196,000 people accessing climate- and technical-information
Activity 2.1.3 Agrobiodiversity promotion	Ensure the sustainable availability of diverse, well-adapted genetic resources for communal lands and farms in order to enhance EbA and ecosystem services through agrobiodiversity	Sub-activity 2.1.3.1 Availability of adapted genetic material Sub Activity 2.1.3.2 Initial seed and seedling availability Sub Activity 2.1.3.3 Capacity development and support to seed multipliers Sub-activity 2.1.3.4 Community/individual nurseries and seed banks support.	30 nurseries 60 multipliers groups/individuals 30 community seed banks established
Sub-Component 2.2: Market access and entrepreneurship development			
Output 2.2 Private sector invests in climate-resilient agriculture; and farmers have better access to markets			
Activity 2.2.1 Public-Private Producer Partnerships (4Ps) establishment	Establish EbA-focused 4Ps through a transparent engagement process, technical and institutional development support, as well as facilitation of linkages with sub-component 2.1 on resilient EbA production, and sub-component 2.3 on access to commercial financing	Sub-activity 2.2.1.1 Expression of interest Sub-activity 2.2.1.2 Capacity building for partners in the process of negotiation of 4P agreement and operations Sub-activity 2.2.1.3 Development of 4P Business plans Sub-activity 2.2.1.4 Support to 4Ps implementation	Creation of 12 4Ps, engaging around 13,000 beneficiaries in the commercial activities, at least 50% of which women and 50% youth
Activity 2.2.2 Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise (MSME) development	Create local MSMEs that offer new and strengthened opportunities to link farmers to markets	Sub-Activity 2.2.2.1 Identification of common economic/commercial interests of farmers and establishment of MSMEs – institutional development Sub-Activity 2.2.2.2 Development of commercial business plans Sub-Activity 2.2.2.3 Support to the establishment and consolidation of business operations	270 local commercial entities created, engaging an estimated 5,400 beneficiaries, at least 50% of which women and 50% youth

Activity 2.2.3 Market development through "EbA production system" brand creation	Generate market demand for the EbA products, raising consumers' awareness and offering a market differentiation tool	Sub-Activity 2.2.3.1 Collaboration with government institutions on the creation of a brand to drive demand for EbA produce Sub-Activity 2.2.3.2 Marketing campaign on the brand and its message Sub-Activity 2.2.3.3 Linking EbA produce to traditional cuisine	"EbA production system" brand established under the Ministry of Trade Communication campaigns on food quality & production ecosystem, health & climate change, and promotion of traditional foods and products
Sub-component 2.3. Access to finance for climate resilient investment solutions			
Output 2.3 Financial service providers support investment in climate-resilient agriculture			
Activity 2.3.1 Consolidation / expansion of Community Based Financial Organizations	Strengthen/establish Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs) in EbAM areas of intervention	Sub-Activity 2.3.1.1 Strengthening of existing VSLAs and establishment of new VSLAs in EbAM areas Sub-Activity 2.3.1.2 Technical backstopping and implementation support, knowledge management and dissemination	Maps of VSLAs in EbAM areas Support to 5,500 VSLAs KM products with recommendations to improve the services of the VSLAs and about socially-inclusive VSLAs & CC adaptation financing options
Activity 2.3.2: Development and delivery of climate adaptation financial services by Formal Financial Institutions	Support FFIs (commercial banks, MFIs, SACCOs, insurance companies) to develop adapted financial services for EbA investments	Sub-Activity 2.3.2.1 Technical support to FFIs to develop and scale up innovative and adapted financial services Sub-Activity 2.3.2.2 Technical backstopping and implementation support, knowledge management and dissemination	Competitive calls for proposals for selecting 8 FFIs TA to selected FFIs to scale up the successful innovations for 12,880 farmers and 249 SMEs KM products (generation and dissemination)
Activity 2.3.3: Linkage of partner FFIs to financial instruments providers	Link partner FFIs to institutions and initiatives managing financial instruments	Sub-Activity 2.3.3.1 Scoping study of the potential financial instruments Sub-Activity 2.3.3.2 Facilitation of linkages by MoF/FARMSE	1 scoping studies on financial instruments TA to support the FFIs to develop their funding application
Activity 2.3.4 Linkage of agri SMEs to impact investment funds	Link agri-SMEs supported under sub-component 2.2 to impact investment funds for debt and equity financing and technical support.	Sub-Activity 2.3.4.1 Scoping study of the impact investment funds Sub-Activity 2.3.4.2 Facilitation of linkages by MoF/FARMSE	1 scoping study on investment funds TA to support the SMEs to develop their funding application

Component 3 Enabling institutional and financial environment

Sub-component 3.1. Leveraging public and private climate finance.			
Output 3.1 Sustainable and innovative public and private climate financing through NCCF and local trusts are in place			
Activity 3.1.1 Support to Malawi's National Climate Change Fund (NCCF)	Develop NCCF capacities to mobilize resources and build an investment pipeline focusing on ecosystem restoration, watershed resilience and climate-resilient agriculture, based on EbA.	Sub-activity 3.1.1.1 Support to resources mobilization Sub-activity 3.1.1.2 Support to pipeline building Sub-activity 3.1.1.3 Capacity development on EbA. Sub-activity 3.1.1.4 Capacity development on climate risk analysis Sub-activity 3.1.1.5 Capacity development on Carbon balance analysis	Strategic direct access materials, 1 investment strategy and feasibility study 6 trainings on: EbA techniques listed in the investment strategies, M&E, climate vulnerability analysis, and on GHG accounting
Activity 3.1.2 Support to National Conservation Trust Funds	Develop the local trusts' capacities to scale-up and replicate investments promoted by EbAM	Sub-activity 3.1.2.1 Technical assistance for national entities in accessing GCF resources Sub-activity 3.1.2.2 Feasibility studies to develop innovative finance instruments for ecosystem restoration Sub-activity 3.1.2.3 Capacity development on Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E).	1 proposed project under PSAA process Trainings the MRV framework Studies to access innovative climate finance instruments for more funding towards EbA (1 feasibility study on debt-for-nature swaps)
Activity 3.1.3 Leveraging private sector experience on carbon credits in Malawi as part of the exit strategy	Establish the enabling environment to leverage private sector finance for ecosystem restoration interventions	Sub-activity 3.1.3.1 Gap analysis and baseline Sub-activity 3.1.3.2 Continuous learning for possible replication	1 gap analysis and baseline for carbon credits in EbAM's areas 1 study for replication of the Restore Africa Programme activities
Sub-component 3.2 Scaling-up in national policies			
Output 3.2 EbA integrated in national policies.			
Activity 3.2.1 Preparation of evidence-based studies	Develop knowledge products, best practices and cases studies based on EbAM experience	Sub-activity 3.2.1.1 Policy briefs based cost-benefit analyses (CBA) Sub-activity 3.2.1.2 Policy brief: TAPE analysis. Impact of EbA on production systems	2 policy-briefs on CBA of EBA solutions 3 socio-economic performance analyse assessed through FAO-TAPE methodology on agroecology performance

Activity 3.2.2 Policy Assessment and preparation of a policy influencing plan (PIP)	Collaborate with NCCC&DRM who will provide strategic direction, inter-ministerial coordination and policy guidance in relation to Malawi's climate policy, including the NDC	Sub-activity 3.2.2.1 Policy Influencing plan (PIP) Sub-activity 3.2.2.2 Dissemination of the PIP	1 policies review assessment to mainstream EBA in national policy framework Presentation of the PIP at a 1 national seminar
Activity 3.2.3 Implementation of the PIP	Support a policy dialogue promoting a policy shift towards ecosystem-centered measures	Sub-activity 3.2.3.1 Policy dialogue Sub-activity 3.2.3.2 Update of policies and strategic frameworks	5 policy dialogue events led by NCCC&DRM at national level Key policies revised based on the best practices promoted by EBAM Advocacy events for the revised policies

E.7. Monitoring, reporting and evaluation arrangements (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

146. In its role as Accredited Entity (AE), FAO will oversee project implementation according to the Accreditation Master Agreement (AMA) signed between FAO and GCF and will bear overall responsibility for ensuring that reporting is provided to the GCF in a timely manner and in accordance with the required standards. The M&E unit will use the data from the MIS to prepare the draft performance reports, which will in turn be sent to the PSC/PTC. As per the GCF Monitoring and Accountability Framework, FAO will provide the GCF with: Inception Report, Annual Performance Reports, independent Mid-term Evaluation report, Project Closure Report, and an independent Final Evaluation report. FAO will also provide semi-annual and annual Financial Reports throughout project implementation. The monitoring team will also share its findings with the CPIU so that they may discuss implementation issues as they arise.

147. Project monitoring will be conducted by the M&E unit composed by: a National M&E specialist with GIS skills, and two M&E Associates (in the regional hubs). The unit will be complemented by the M&E unit of the MoF/FARMSE Programme. FAO will ensure the existence of a well-designed, operational, and effective impact monitoring and measurement system (MIS). Project oversight will be carried out by the Project Technical and Steering Committees (PTC and PSC), the Central Project Implementation Unit (CPIU) and relevant Technical Units in FAO HQ. The project will be implemented based on the annual workplan and budget (AWPB) which will be adjusted as envisaged by the CPIU, subject to the Budget Holder (BH) approval (FAO AE). Project components will be monitored separately as well as in relation to the achievement of higher level project results and overall GCF goals. Monitoring data will be stored, compiled and displayed in a dedicated module of the Monitoring Information System (MIS) to be developed by the CPIU. The MIS will serve to track on the project implementation, including the outputs, outcomes and targets in the results framework. It will also track implementation of the project's Gender Action Plan and Environmental and Social Management Plans.

148. As per the FAO policy on evaluation, the FAO Office of Evaluation (OED) will conduct a final evaluation of the project, to be launched within six months prior to the actual completion date. It will aim at identifying project outcomes, their sustainability and actual or potential impacts. It will also have the purpose of indicating future actions needed to assure continuity of the process developed through the project. OED will conduct the evaluation in consultation with project stakeholders and the donor, and share with them the evaluation report, which is a public document. An independent mid-term evaluation (MTE) will be carried out at project mid-

life in terms of expenditure and/or overall project duration, tentatively in the first quarter of project year 4. The BH will arrange an independent MTE in consultation with the Project Steering Committee (PSC), Project Technical Committee (PTC), the Project Implementation Unit (PIU), the lead technical office (LTO) and the FAO-GCF Coordination Unit in FAO headquarters. The MTE will be conducted to review progress and effectiveness of implementation in terms of achieving project objective, outcomes and outputs. The MTE will allow mid-course corrective actions, if needed. The MTE will provide a systematic analysis of the information on project progress in the achievement of expected results against budget expenditures. It will highlight replicable good practices and key issues faced during project implementation and will suggest mitigation actions to be discussed by the PSC, the LTO and FAO-GCF Coordination Unit. Both the mid-term and final evaluations must be consistent with GCF requirements as outlined in the GCF Evaluation Policy, Evaluation Standards, and Evaluation Operational Procedures and Guidelines.

149. The FAO Office of Evaluation will be responsible for the independent evaluations: (i) the interim evaluation will help improving implementation, setting out corrective measures for the remaining period of the project; (ii) the final evaluation will mainly assess the relevance of the intervention, its overall performance, gender equity, innovativeness in results areas, sustainability and scalability of results, lessons learned and the extent to which it has contributed to the Fund's higher-level goal of achieving a paradigm shift to climate-resilient sustainable development in Malawi. The project will include an impact evaluation (IE). The project budget includes costs for data generation and collection, as well as the costs for the IE exercise. Overall evaluation costs included within project budget, consistent with global evaluation international best practices, are below 5 per cent of the project costs. This budget is exclusive of interim and final evaluations costs, which are covered by the AE fees. The evaluations will also be conducted in line with the GCF Evaluation Policy, and will follow the GCF's Integrated Results Management Framework, namely containing an assessment of the paradigm shift potential and its enabling environment.

F. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

F.1. Risk factors and mitigations measures (max. 3 pages)

Selected Risk Factor 1: Political (collaboration between Government stakeholders)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Technical and operational</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

Limited collaboration between stakeholders from different ministries (e.g. Ministry of Agriculture - MoA, Ministry of Climate Change and Natural Resources – MoCCNR) and departments (Department of Land Resources Conservation in MoA, Department of Forestry in MoCCNR) on land restoration activities. This low collaboration may negatively affect project implementation, resulting in limited information and knowledge-sharing on climate-resilience practices and technologies, and ultimately impair the overall long-term project impact.

Mitigation Measure(s)

All actors (MoA, MoCCNR) will be engaged in the Project Steering Committee (PSC) and Project Technical Committee (PTC) to ensure that government organisations work hand-in hand. At local (district) level, all activities will be coordinated under the District Executive Committees (DEC), District Environment Sub-Committee (DESC) to ensure collaboration between all government stakeholders. These actions will lower the probability of risk to low.

Selected Risk Factor 2: Political (changes in the development priorities of the Government of Malawi)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Governance</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u> Select

Description

Low enforcement of development priorities, strategies and international commitments preventing from fully engaging in ecosystem based adaptation – EbA. Turnover and changes in decision makers and institutional arrangements beyond the control of the project lead to a volatile environment that hampers the long-term success of the work.

Mitigation Measure(s)

Project priorities are well aligned with the international commitment of the GoM and with the most recent national strategies, policies and legislation. As mentioned in section B.1, the Government of Malawi has enabling/ favorable policy instruments (such as the Nationally Determined Contribution – NDC 2021, the National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy – NFLRS 2017) that promote ecosystem-based adaptation. The project's implementation arrangements have foreseen that the highest level of project governance – the Project Steering Committee (PSC) – will include multi-sectorial high-level representatives (at least at Permanent Secretary level) and will debate together with the NDA about any changes in government policy and any changes in the project governance that might have an impact on the project, its activities and its implementation modalities. The FAO Representative in Malawi, which has been operating in Malawi since 1986 without discontinuity under any changes in the government, will remain in constant dialogue with the Government counterparts to anticipate potential changes in policies and strategic directions and to propose the necessary measures. AE will inform the GCF in case of any major changes in the government policies and strategic directions that may have adverse impacts to the project. In addition, the project will invest in evidenced-based policy dialogue (sub-component 3.2) which will sensitizing the importance of ecosystem-based adaptation not only for the direct project counterparts but also at the national level. The Project will make strong business case for EbA-investment for climate change resilience and demonstrate how this supports national policies and GoM's international commitments. These actions will lower the probability of risk to low.

Selected Risk Factor 3: other (exogenous risks)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Other</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

Exogenous risks include: (i) climate risks: more extreme weather events impacting negatively all landscape restoration efforts; (ii) COVID-19 and other sanitary crisis disturb implementation. These risks would translate into

operational disruptions and discontinuation of activities' implementation (if COVID related), and would threaten EbA investments, livelihoods and producers' resilience (if climate related).

Mitigation Measure(s)

The project seeks to restore and enhance the services provided by watershed ecosystem that support sustainable and resilient livelihoods. EbAM will support investments in ecosystem restoration, ecosystem-based adaptation that include diversified, locally adapted, non-invasive, and drought-resistant crop species and varieties that climate change scenarios consider the best climate-adapted to Malawi. Additional tree enhancement in farmland through agroforestry and farmer-managed natural regeneration, combined with production diversification will strengthen producers' resilience. During the course of the formulation of EbA-based Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) under output 1.1, areas that are high risk (such as inundation zones) will be identified and VLAPs may also identify areas where physical interventions, e.g. terraces or bunds are required to reduce erosion / water flows. Activity 2.3.2 will support the development and delivery of innovative climate adaptation financial services (which may include agriculture insurance to communities).

Risks mitigation strategies against the COVID-19 pandemic will include (i) adjusting stakeholders' engagement plans, adopt higher flexibility and adaptive management and use remote communication whenever possible, (ii) maintaining social distancing, (iii) reviewing and adjusting implementation and stakeholder engagement arrangements to compensate staff shortages.

These actions will lower the impact of risk to medium.

Selected Risk Factor 4: other (Maladaptation behaviours)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Other</u>	<u>Low</u>	<u>High</u>

Description

Communities resort to short term and maladaptive practices and discontinue adopting EbA.

Mitigation Measure(s)

Communities' buy-in will be maximized by (i) the participatory nature (including women and youth) of the development of VLAPs and SCMPs, (ii) the participatory selection of EbA priority interventions, (iii) accompanying capacity development actions, (iv) access to inputs (seeds, seedlings, equipment) and (v) access to finance. In addition, the project design recognizes at the outset that capacity development is a long-term endeavour requiring continuous support. Therefore, the project will place a strong focus on community learning and participatory planning (sub-component 1.1), gender-inclusive extension, coaching and practical trainings (sub-component 2.1) to promote and adopt EbA. It will ensure capacity development, knowledge generation and learning at local level through FFS and innovation & learning centres (e.g. LUANAR AgroEcology Hub, Kusumala Institute). FFS will be conducted through well qualified master trainers and facilitators, with the support of experts from public and private organizations. It will use media and community mobilization tools (Dimitra Clubs, radios), as well as digital apps for extension, to disseminate information on the benefits of EbA. This will help consolidate the long term adoption of practices. These actions will lower the final level of risk to low.

Selected Risk Factor 5: other (Resistance on Women's Participation and Empowerment)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Other</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

The project may encounter passive or active resistance to women's participation as well as when working to strengthen women's empowerment in the communities.

Mitigation Measure(s)

The project targeting mechanisms including direct, community-based and self-targeting mechanisms will promote women's participation including vulnerable groups such as female-head of household, female youth and girls, and persons living with HIV/AIDS. The project will rely on participative community approach, the Dimitra Clubs; and on gender-transformative approach, the Household Methodology that promote the participation of all community and

household members including women, men, female and male youth as well as boys and girls. Religious, traditional and community leaders and other key figures will be trained in the Dimitra Clubs facilitation and household methodology to strengthen their capacity to play active roles in social mobilization on GEWE. The use of these approaches will allow to openly discuss gender-sensitive topics such as (i) gender and sex; (ii) advantages and disadvantages of gender-specific roles and tasks; (iii) gender-based violence (GBV) and Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), including masculinities and patriarchy; (iv) origin/history and merits/demerits of social inclusion Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process; (v) examples, motives and results of gender discrimination and social exclusion; and (vi) gender and social inclusion in community development and welfare, including food and nutrition security. All along the project lifecycle, the project will refer to the GAP developed during the design process to monitor the progress made on GEWE and take necessary corrective actions as appropriate.

Selected Risk Factor 6: Money laundering and countering the financing of terrorism (ML/TF)

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Governance</u>	<u>Low</u>	<u>Low</u>
Description		
Risks of money laundering and countering the financing of terrorism.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
FAO includes in the project agreement signed between FAO and the Government of Malawi clauses related to AML/CFT, as follows: a) The Government shall comply, and shall require all persons and entities engaged in its activities under the Project to comply, with all internal anti-money laundering, counter-terrorism financing laws, rules, and regulations; b) The Government confirms it has obtained sufficient undertakings from all persons and entities involved in its activities under the Project that they shall not engage in any prohibited practices; the Government undertakes and confirm that it shall comply with the substantive objectives of the GCF's Policy on Prohibited Practices; c) Consistent with numerous United Nations Security Council resolutions adopted under Chapter VII of the UN Charter, the Government and FAO are firmly committed to the international fight against terrorism and, in particular, against the financing of terrorism. It is the policy of the Government and FAO to seek to ensure that none of their funds are used, directly or indirectly, to provide support to individuals or entities: i) associated with terrorism, as included in the list maintained by the Security Council Committee established pursuant to its Resolutions 1267 (1999) and 1989 (2011); or ii) that are the subject of sanctions or other enforcement measures promulgated by the United Nations Security Council. This provision must be included in all agreements that may be concluded with third parties for the implementation of activities under the Project. During project implementation FAO, as AE, will ensure close monitoring and supervision through its offices in the regional office and HQ in order to ensure that the activities are implemented in full compliance with the signed project agreement.		

G. GCF POLICIES AND STANDARDS

G.1. Environmental and social risk assessment (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

150. During project formulation, an environmental and social management framework was developed – see the Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF) in Annex 6. An initial risk assessment was carried out against FAO's Environmental and Social Safeguards (<http://www.fao.org/3/a-i4413e.pdf>). All project activities considered gender, social, and environmental aspects, and identified priority design elements to proactively address these. A stakeholder engagement process was carried out to identify and engage with all stakeholders of the project, from national to local authorities, relevant technical institutions, to NGOs and CSOs, among others, as outlined in Annex 7. As per the Environmental and Social Management Guidelines of FAO, EbAM has been screened to establish its overall environmental and social risk categorization. The ESMF (Annex 6) identifies the project as Category B (Moderate Risk), based on the fact the project contains activities with potentially limited adverse environmental and/or social risks and impacts that individually or cumulatively, are few, generally site-specific, largely reversible, and readily addressed through mitigation measures.

151. Overall, the project is expected to bring about major positive impacts, thanks to the socially inclusive participatory process, with a strong focus on women, youth and vulnerable groups; and the major environmental co-benefits resulting from Ecosystem-based Adaptation (enhanced biodiversity, soil and water conservation, land restoration, etc.), which will be promoted at farm and watershed level. Even with these expected positive impacts, the project has been classified as Moderate Risk, due to the fact that: (i) farm-level activities may access genetic resources, and/or access traditional knowledge associated with genetic resources that is held by local communities and/or farmers; (ii) crops may be introduced that were not previously grown; (iii) seeds will be provided for cultivation; (iv) there may be establishment or management of forests; (v) the project will operate in sectors or value chains that are dominated by subsistence producers and other vulnerable informal agricultural workers, and are more generally characterized by high levels "working poverty"; (vi) the project will operate in situations where youth work mostly as unpaid contributing family workers; and, (vii) the project will operate in situations where major gender inequality in the labour market prevails (e.g. where women tend to work predominantly as unpaid contributing family members or subsistence farmers, have lower skills and qualifications, lower productivity and wages, less representation and voice in producers' and workers' organizations, more precarious contracts and higher informality rates). These elements correspond to FAO Environmental and Social Standard (ESS) 2 Biodiversity, Ecosystems, and Natural Habitats, ESS3 Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture, ESS7 Decent Work, and ESS9 – Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage (see screening Table G.1.1 below).

152. Table G.1.1 summarizes the outcomes of the application of FAO's screening checklist.

FAO Safeguard Category	Triggered	Safeguard Instruments & Mitigation Measures
ESS 1 – Natural Resources Management	YES	Standard 1 is triggered in this project due to its emphasis on managing soil and land resources, as well as water resources. The proposed interventions involve developing and implementing Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) combining EbA and integrated landscape management (ILM) measures at watershed and village levels. The project will not have activities that would result in the degradation of soils, undermine sustainable land management practices or reduce the adaptive capacity to climate change or increase GHG emissions significantly, rather the project primary aims at promoting EbA practices and enhancing the adaptive capacity to climate change. The project doesn't invest in large-scale infrastructure and doesn't have activities that would result in any changes to existing tenure rights. The full transparency of land restoration planning is embedded in the project as a general principle and as part of the participatory process for VLAP preparation. As part of the same process, the establishment of VNRMC charters, and participatory preparation of VLAP will guarantee that all local stakeholders are aware and agree with the restoration actions planned on communal/customary land. In addition, non-eligibility list of activities has been prepared (see appendix IV of the Annex 6).
ESS2 – Biodiversity, Ecosystems, and Natural Habitats	YES	Standard 2 is triggered as activities planned under sub-components 1.2 and 2.1. may result in respectively micro-catchment and farm-level activities that access genetic resources for their utilization, and/or access traditional knowledge associated with genetic resources that is held by local communities and/or farmers. To address potentially adverse impacts associated with the utilisation of traditional knowledge and use of genetic resources, the project will ensure that benefits arising from utilization, and subsequent application and commercialization, are shared in a

		fair and equitable way in accordance with the Convention on Biological Diversity. The project has also been designed so as to ensure that activities are aligned with access to benefit sharing as specified in FAO's 2019 guidance: <i>ABS Elements to Facilitate Domestic Implementation of Access and Benefit Sharing for Different Subsectors of Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture</i>
ESS3 – Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture	YES	Standard 3 is triggered, as project supported activities prioritized within VLAPS may involve: (i) the introduction of crops and varieties not previously grown; (ii) providing seeds/planting material for cultivation; and (iii) establishment or management of planted forests. To manage adverse risk associated with the handling and supply of seeds for cultivation, the project will: (i) Avoid undermining local seed & planting material production and supply systems; (ii) Ensure that the seeds and planting materials are from locally/regionally adapted crops and varieties that are accepted by farmers and consumers; even if they have been forgotten and will need to be reintroduced; (iii) Ensure that the seeds and planting materials are free from pests and diseases according to norms; and (iv) Ensure, according to applicable national laws and/or regulations, that farmers' rights to plant genetic resources for food and agriculture (PGFRA), and over associated traditional knowledge are respected, along with the sharing of the benefits accrued from their use.
ESS 4 - Animal - Livestock and Aquatic - Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture	YES	Standard 4 is triggered as the project entails promoting integrated crop/ small livestock, and possibly crop/aquatic production systems (if identified by local residents through ILM) as part of EbA techniques. As a mitigation measure, the Project prioritizes the use of native species in its activities, aligning with the principles of EbA/ agroecology. The team took further mitigation measure by explicitly prohibiting the introduction of non-native and invasive species, thus including it in the ESMF non-eligibility list.
ESS5 – Pest and Pesticide Management	NO	N/A The project primarily aims to enhance ecosystem functions and climate resilience through nature-based approaches, minimizing reliance on chemical interventions. The Project is committed to promoting sustainable and EbA/agroecological practices. Synthetic pesticides will not be promoted through the project. The use of pesticides has been explicitly excluded through the ESMF non-eligibility list. While integrated crop and small livestock is among the EbA techniques promoted by the project, it will be implemented in a manner that minimizes environmental and social risks. By prioritizing EbA/agroecological principles and excluding harmful inputs such as pesticides, the project aims to safeguard against unintended consequences without necessitating the triggering of ESS5.
ESS6 – Involuntary Resettlement and Displacement	NO	N/A. The full transparency of land restoration planning is embedded in the project as a general principle and as part of the participatory process for VLAP preparation. As part of the same process, the establishment of VNRMCharters, and participatory preparation of VLAP will guarantee that all local stakeholders are aware and agree with the restoration actions planned on communal/customary land. The project does not entail physical or economic displacement, whether full or partial, permanent or temporary, as a result of land or resource restriction. In addition, under the project's non-eligibility list, several activities are expressly prohibited. These include the use of the project to facilitate involuntary resettlement of local communities, as well as any form of land acquisition. Additionally, restrictions on resource access, such as farming land, that cannot be adequately mitigated and would negatively impact the livelihoods of Indigenous Peoples, ethnic groups, and disadvantaged populations are strictly prohibited.
ESS7 – Decent Work	YES	Standard 7 is triggered as the project may operate in: (i) sectors or value chains that are dominated by subsistence producers and other vulnerable informal agricultural workers, and more generally characterized by high levels "working poverty"; (ii) situations where youth work mostly as unpaid contributing family workers, lack access to decent jobs and are increasingly abandoning agriculture and rural areas; and, (iii) in situations where major gender inequality in the labour market prevails e.g. where women tend to work predominantly as unpaid contributing family members or subsistence farmers, have lower skills and qualifications, lower productivity and wages, less representation and voice in producers' and workers' organizations, more precarious contracts and higher informality rates, etc. Specific measures and mechanisms will be introduced to empower the most vulnerable/disadvantaged categories of rural workers such as small-scale producers, contributing family workers, subsistence farmers, and agricultural informal wage workers. Complementary measures have been included in the design of project

		activities, which are aimed at training youth, engaging them and their associations in the value chains, facilitating their access to productive resources, credit and markets, and stimulating youth-friendly business development services. As per FAO guidance on child labour, children under the age of 18 should not be engaged in work-related activities in connection with the project in a manner that is likely to be hazardous or interfere with their compulsory education or be harmful to their health, safety or morals. Where children under the age of 18 may be engaged in work-related activities in connection with the project, an appropriate risk assessment will be conducted, together with regular monitoring of health, working conditions and hours of work. It should be noted that, if children are involved, this would be limited to family labour that would be likely to occur without project.
ESS8 – Gender Equality	YES	Standard 8 is triggered by the EbAM project since the project may face either passive or active opposition to women's involvement and efforts to enhance women's empowerment within the communities. As per GCF requirements a gender assessment and action plan has been developed, with specific gender-targeted activities built into the project design and social approaches. Moreover, mitigation measures include utilizing targeting mechanisms like direct, community-based, and self-targeting methods to ensure inclusivity of vulnerable groups such as female-headed households, female youth, girls, and persons living with HIV/AIDS. The use of the Dimitra Clubs involving all community members as well as the Household Methodology will promote gender equality through open discussions on gender and social inclusion related issues, including gender-based violence (GBV) and Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH). Training for religious, traditional, and community leaders, project team and facilitators will enhance their capacity to mobilize communities and promote gender equality. The project will promote Gender equality and women empowerment (GEWE) and will monitor the progress using the Gender Action Plan (GAP) to ensure alignment with project objectives.
ESS9 – Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage	YES	Standard 9 is triggered due to its potential impacts on indigenous peoples. The project focuses on integrated landscape management and ecosystem-based adaptation, which inherently intersect with indigenous territories and traditional practices. Mitigation measures for ESS9 include obtaining Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) and conducting the assessment of Indigenous People Framework in addition to deliver training on FPIC for field facilitation. These measures aim to respect indigenous rights, identify and protect cultural assets, and involve communities in decision-making, ensuring sustainable project outcomes while safeguarding indigenous peoples and cultural heritage. The project extends some of the safeguard activities for IPs to all beneficiary communities in recognition of their rights akin to those of the IPs.

153. The ESMF establishes a framework that guides the screening and categorization, level of impact assessment, required institutional arrangements, and processes to be followed during project implementation. In particular, the ESMF plans for the development of the project-level Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) and implementation safeguards documents associated at V LAP level, to ensure V LAP priorities (which will guide activities implemented under sub-component 1.2 and sub-component 2.1) are fully screened against environmental and social safeguards. The ESMF ensures that appropriate management measures that comply with FAO's safeguards requirements and Malawian regulations are adopted prior to implementation of the proposed activities. FPIC process will be implemented by FPIC facilitators under sub-activity 1.1.1.3.

154. The project's ESMF has entailed careful planning and includes a range of management controls to ensure that post-appraisal social and environmental due diligence takes place in a timely manner. It describes the required institutional mechanisms to allow the executing entities to implement sub-activities in a manner consistent with the requirements of FAO's ESGM, and Malawian regulations.

155. **Institutional arrangements:** Overall compliance with the project's ESMF will be ensured by the Environmental and Social Safeguards (International Technical Assistance) and national safeguards specialist within the CPIU, who will work closely together with the Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist (who will oversee the GAP) and the National Project Coordinator.

156. **In addition, there will be zero tolerance of sexual exploitation, abuse, and harassment (SEAH),** and the project's ESMF, consequent ESMP as well as implementation safeguards documents will mainstream SEAH risk mitigation, in accordance with the FAO ESMG. The project will support gender sensitization and trainings for project staff and beneficiaries on gender equality and social inclusion and SEAH, and will elaborate a code of conduct for the implementation of the project. Specific procedures to minimize SEAH risk will be developed for the project GRM, to ensure the mechanism is survivor-centered and gender-responsive (including confidential reporting), and to facilitate linkages to related services and redress for anyone affected by SEAH.

157. **Grievance and Redress Mechanism (GRM):** The grievance redress mechanism (GRM) is an integral project management element that intends to seek feedback from beneficiaries and resolve complaints on project activities and performance. The mechanism is based on FAO requirements and most importantly, it is based on existing, community-specific grievance redress mechanisms preferred by the local beneficiaries. FAO and EEs will inform communities about the GRM through culturally appropriate mechanisms, ensuring information on mechanisms at all four levels is communicated (i.e. community-based, project-level GRM, FAO-level GRM, and GCF's Independent Redress Mechanism). The CPIU and Regional Project Offices will be responsible for managing the grievance and redress mechanism. The GRM has a strong link with FAO Malawi's competent officers to ensure the right application of GRM principles. Project-related SEAH and GBV grievances will be managed through the existing FAO GRM system, which will also be strengthened to include a procedure for handling SEAH that is inclusive, survivor-centred and gender-responsive, complemented by GBV referral pathways. The pathways will be established and operationalized under the project in collaboration with UNFPA, including medical care, psychosocial support, legal and social/reintegration support (see Section 9 of the ESMF in Annex 6 for more detailed information).

G.2. Gender assessment and action plan (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page) – See Annex 8 for details

158. **Gender Analysis.** An analysis of the gender-related aspects of the project was also undertaken during the development of the ESMF and Gender Action Plan (GAP) (Annex 8). Although the Government of Malawi ratified most of International and regional instruments and developed several national laws that promotes human and women's rights, gender inequalities persist. These inequalities are due to entrenched social norms including the co-existing of patriarchal and matriarchal structures, that allocate to women and men specific roles, expectations and property rights. Women are assigned the heavy burden of domestic tasks, remain disadvantaged regarding productive and paid work and are sidelined in decision-making process. They must also bear the consequences of HIV/AIDS' high prevalence as well as harmful social practices such as gender-based violence and child marriage. Regarding income generating activities and economic opportunities, men dominate activities and sectors of high productivity and profit margin; and even if women comprise about 70 percent of the agricultural labor force, they face unequal use of land inputs, lower access to farm labor, inferior access to improved agricultural inputs and technology, manifest difficulties to access markets and finance their activities. As for climate change adaptation capacity, women, men and youth have limited knowledge and weak capacity to consider catchment and landscape management into integrated planning process.

159. The EbAM gender strategy and action plan aims at reducing inequalities and removing the above-identified barriers; mainstreaming social inclusion and sensitivity toward vulnerable groups; ensuring effective participation of women, men, youth in the development process; in order to promote gender and youth transformation in the longer term. The project's interventions will focus on (i) instilling mindset change by enhancing the social acceptance of gender and youth empowerment, (ii) promoting equitable and inclusive sharing of decision-making power at household and community levels, (iii) building the capacity of women and youth for their meaningful participation in domestic and public life, and (iv) economically empowering the vulnerable particularly women and youth.

160. For these purposes, EbAM will rely on the use of the Dimitra Clubs and Household methodology (also referred as "household approach" - HHA), two methodologies that have a strong replication potential in terms of community engagement, social inclusion, collective action, gender equality and equitable sharing of decision-making power both at household and community levels. Under component 1, the Dimitra Clubs will be used as entry points for community mobilization and engagement in the planning and implementation of ILM. Women and youth's capacity will be strengthened to increase their technical and social participation in ILM. The HHA will promote participatory dialogues that will allow women, men and youth household members understand and challenge gender norms, while at the same time developing a common vision and planning for household activities. Dialogues at community and household levels will put a particular focus on GBV and SEAH. Under component 2, the project will strengthen women, men and youth's capacity in the adoption of EbA-solutions. Those showing the potential to move towards commercial group activities (MSMEs) will be supported to strengthen their marketing skills and access markets. EbAM will also support women and youth's access to finance through CBFOs/VSLAs and the development and delivery of adapted financial services by FFIs. Under component 3, NCCF and national conservation trust funds will be supported in developing their gender strategy and action plan, the project will support them to consider gender principles in their interventions and to promote

women's participation in various capacity strengthening. Women's and youth's participation in policy dialogue will also be promoted.

161. Coordination of the implementation of the Gender Action Plan will be the responsibility of the PIU Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist. The Specialist must ensure that project planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation and reporting are gender sensitive and socially inclusive. The project logical framework and monitoring and evaluation system should include measurable indicators related to women and youth that allow assessing the sensitivity of project's component and sub-component to these groups. Data collection during project implementation will be gender and age disaggregated. The various technical and progress reports should also consider gender-disaggregated information and analysis.

G.3. Financial management and procurement (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

162. Financial management and control and procurement processes will be implemented as per FAO rules and regulations, which were certified as acceptable to the GCF in the FAO accreditation process. FAO has an Administrative Manual organized across various Chapters covering Finance, Human Resources, Travel and Procurement. The FAO Intranet provides access to this Manual and to other procedures, information and guidance via the "FAO Handbook".

163. FAO has deployed an Oracle based ERP system the Global Resources Management System" (GRMS) to its world-wide offices, which provides all FAO employees, in all locations globally, with travel, human resource, procurement and finance functionalities. Using GRMS improves the flow of financial information, supports financial monitoring and reporting, increases transparency and visibility, and strengthens internal control. FAO maintains a chart of accounts which is used by the whole organization and that allows for a separation of income and expenditure by donor and project and supports and provides a standardized coding structure that enables data to be recorded, classified and summarized to facilitate internal management and external reporting requirements. Procurement and Letters of Agreement Services are managed by a dedicated FAO unit, which provides policy and operational support to ensure that the Organization procures goods, works and services based on "Best Value for Money" principles as embodied in the Manual Section 502 and for Letters of Agreement under Manual Section 507.

164. As mentioned in Section C.4. FAO as the Accredited Entity of the GCF will have overall responsibility for quality assurance and oversight of co-executing entities, and shall assume fiduciary responsibility in accordance with FAO standards and procedures. In addition to this, FAO will be responsible for the financial execution of GCF funds according to FAO rules and regulations mainly contained and detailed in the FAO Handbook (including those referred to financial monitoring, audit and procurement).

165. During implementation, FAO will provide oversight and quality assurance in accordance with its policies and procedures. This may include monitoring missions, spot checks and participation at project governance meetings. The project will be audited internally and externally following FAO's Financial Regulations.

166. FAO Country Representative in Malawi (FAOR) is responsible for financial monitoring and is supported by a management team comprised of a Program Assistant, Management Assistant, and a Strategic Operations Officer. Such team will interact and support the work of the PIU.

G.4. Disclosure of funding proposal

☐ No confidential information: The accredited entity confirms that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may be disclosed in full by the GCF, as no information is being provided in confidence.

☒ With confidential information: The accredited entity declares that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may not be disclosed in full by the GCF, as certain information is being provided in confidence. Accordingly, the accredited entity is providing to the Secretariat the following two copies of the funding proposal, including all annexes:

- full copy for internal use of the GCF in which the confidential portions are marked accordingly, together with an explanatory note regarding the said portions and the corresponding reason for confidentiality under the accredited entity's disclosure policy, and
- redacted copy for disclosure on the GCF website.

The funding proposal can only be processed upon receipt of the two copies above, if containing confidential information.

H. ANNEXES

H.1. Mandatory annexes

- ☒ Annex 1 NDA no-objection letter(s) ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 2 Feasibility study - and a market study, if applicable
- ☒ Annex 3 Economic and/or financial analyses in spreadsheet format
- ☒ Annex 4 Detailed budget plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 5 Implementation timetable including key project/programme milestones ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 6 E&S document corresponding to the E&S category (A, B or C; or I1, I2 or I3):
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS)
 - ☐ Others (please specify – e.g. Resettlement Action Plan, Resettlement Policy Framework, Indigenous People's Plan, Land Acquisition Plan, etc.)
- ☒ Annex 7 Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan
- ☒ Annex 8 Gender assessment and project/programme-level action plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 9 Legal due diligence (regulation, taxation and insurance)
- ☒ Annex 10 Procurement plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 11 Monitoring and evaluation plan ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 12 AE fee request ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 13 Co-financing commitment letter, if applicable ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 14 Term sheet including a detailed disbursement schedule and, if applicable, repayment schedule

H.2. Other annexes as applicable

- ☒ Annex 15 Evidence of internal approval ([template provided](#))
- ☒ Annex 16 Map(s) indicating the location of proposed interventions
- ☐ Annex 17 Multi-country project/programme information ([template provided](#))
- ☐ Annex 18 Appraisal, due diligence or evaluation report for proposals based on up-scaling or replicating a pilot project
- ☐ Annex 19 Procedures for controlling procurement by third parties or executing entities undertaking projects financed by the entity
- ☒ Annex 20 First level AML/CFT (KYC) assessment
- ☐ Annex 21 Operations manual (Operations and maintenance)
- ☒ Annex 22 Assessment of GHG emission reductions and their monitoring and reporting (for mitigation and cross cutting-projects)

* Please note that a funding proposal will be considered complete only upon receipt of all the applicable supporting documents.

List of main acronyms

ADD	Agriculture Development Divisions
AE	Accredited Entity
AEDO	Agriculture Extension Development Officers
AEDC	Agriculture Extension District Coordinators
CA	Conservation Agriculture
CBA	Cost-benefit analysis
CBFOs	Community based financing organisations
CBR	Cost-benefit ratio
CISONEC	Civil Society Network on Climate Change
CMC	Catchment Management Committee
CMP	Catchment Management Plan
DCAFS	Donor Committee in Agriculture and Food Security
DCCMS	Department of Climate Change and Meteorological Services
DCERCC	Development Cooperation Group on Environment, Resilience and Climate change
DLRC	Department of Land Resources Conservation
EbA	Ecosystems-based Adaptation
EE	Executing Entity
EIRR	Economic Internal Rate of Return
ESM	Earth System Model
EX-ACT	Ex-ante Carbon Balance Tool
FARMSE	Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprises
FFS	Farming Field School
FFI	Formal Financial Institutions
FSS	Food System Summit
FSP	Financial Service Providers
FMNR	Farmers-managed natural regeneration
GCF	Green Climate Fund
GCM	Global Circulation Model
GHG	Greenhouse gases
ICRAF	International Centre for Research in Agroforestry
IFAD	International Fund for Agriculture Development
ILM	Integrated Landscape Management
LUANAR	Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources
MFIs	Microfinance Institutions
MoA	Ministry of Agriculture
MoFNR	Ministry of Forestry and Natural Resources
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
MEET	Malawi's Environment Endowment Trust
MGDS	Malawi Growth and Development Strategy
MOSAICC	Modelling System for Agricultural Impacts of Climate Change
MWASIP	Malawi Watershed Services Improvement Project
MWK	Malawi Kwacha
NAIP	National Agriculture Investment Plan
NAP	National Adaptation Plan
NASFAM	National Smallholder Farmers' Association of Malawi
NCCC&DRM	National Committee on Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management
NCCF	National Climate Change Fund
NDA	National Designated Authority
NDC	Nationally Determined Contributions

NFLRA	National Forest Landscape Restoration Assessment
NFLRS	National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy
NGO	Non-governmental Organisation
NLGFC	National Local Government Finance Committee
NTFP	Non-timber forest products
NWRA	National Water Resources Authority
O&M	Operation and Maintenance
PES	Payment for Environmental Services
PIP	Policy Influencing Plan
POs	Producers Organisations
PWP	Public works program
RCP	Representative Concentration Pathways
SACCOs	Savings and Credit Cooperatives
SCMC	Sub-catchment Management Committee
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SMEs	Small and Medium Enterprises
TA	Traditional Authority
TAPE	Tool for Agroecology Performance Evaluation
TOC	Theory of Change
UNFCCC	United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
VLAP	Village-level Action Plans
VNRMC	Village Natural Resource Management Committees
VSLA	Village Savings and Loans Associations
WRU	Water Resources Unit
4P	Public Private Producers Partnerships

ⁱ Co-financer's contribution means the financial resources required, whether Public Finance or Private Finance, in addition to the GCF contribution (i.e. GCF financial resources requested by the Accredited Entity) to implement the project or programme described in the funding proposal.

ⁱⁱ Refer to the Policy of Co-financing of the GCF.

ⁱⁱⁱ 267,500 ha includes 83,240 ha under EbA management with GCF investment (direct) and other areas under indirect intervention (planning at sub-catchment level).

⁴ Tuni, A., et al., 2022. "Barriers to commercialise produce for smallholder farmers in Malawi: An interpretive structural modelling approach." *Journal of Rural Studies*. Vol. 93, 1-17.

FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).

⁵ FAO, 2024. "Improving Food Security and Nutrition in Malawi." Nutrition. Infant and young child feeding. <https://www.fao.org/nutrition/education/iycf/malawi/fsandnutritionmalawi/en/> (accessed March 2024).

⁶ FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).

⁷ World Bank, 2024. "Agriculture, forestry, and fishing, value added (% of GDP) - Malawi, Sub-Saharan Africa." <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/NV.AGR.TOTL.ZS?locations=MW-ZG> (accessed March 2024).

⁸ International Trade Administration, 2024. "Malawi – Country Commercial Guide." <https://www.trade.gov/country-commercial-guides/malawi-agricultural-sector> (accessed March 2024).

⁹ FAO, 2024. "Improving Food Security and Nutrition in Malawi." Nutrition. Infant and young child feeding. <https://www.fao.org/nutrition/education/iycf/malawi/fsandnutritionmalawi/en/> (accessed March 2024).

¹⁰ FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).

¹¹ Malawi Water Partnership, 2016. "Final report of National Consultation on Water, Food Security and Nutrition, Malawi, May 2016." <https://www.gwp.org/globalassets/global/activities/news/july-2016/gwp---malawi-country-report.pdf> (accessed March 2024).

¹² World Bank, 2024. "Population growth (annual %) – Malawi." <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.GROW?locations=MW> (accessed March 2024).

¹³ World Bank. 2019. "Malawi Country Environmental Analysis." <https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/server/api/core/bitstreams/20385725-46cc-53d3-abba-16ec417222be/content> (accessed March 2024).

¹⁴ FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).

¹⁵ World Bank. 2019. "Malawi Country Environmental Analysis." <https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/server/api/core/bitstreams/20385725-46cc-53d3-abba-16ec417222be/content> (accessed March 2024).

- ¹⁶ Malawi Government, 2016. "National Agriculture Policy." Lilongwe: Ministry of Agriculture, Irrigation and Water Development.
- ¹⁷ FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).
- ¹⁸ Ministry of Agriculture, 2021. *Building Healthier, Sustainable And Equitable Food Systems For A Better Malawi, Outcomes Synthesis Report: National and District Level Food Systems Dialogue*.
- ¹⁹ FAO, European Union and CIRAD, 2023. "Food Systems Profile – Malawi. Catalysing the sustainable and inclusive transformation of food systems." <https://agritrop.cirad.fr/604276/7/FOOD%20SYSTEMS%20PROFILE%20%E2%80%93%20MALAWI.pdf> (accessed March 2024).
- ²⁰ Tobacco is dried by burning natural woods, an activity that was estimated to cause 26% of the country's deforestation in the early 1990s. For every kg of tobacco, as much as 31 kg of firewood is used for curing. As a result, the tobacco industry in Malawi contributes significantly to the destruction of forests, with millions of trees required for the drying barns involved in air curing for burley tobacco and heat curing for flue-cured tobacco. See Luke Jimu, Loritah Mataruse, Lovemore Musemwa, Innocent W. Nyakudya, *The miombo ecoregion up in smoke: The effect of tobacco curing, World Development Perspectives, Volume 5, 2017, Pages 44-46*.
- ²¹ Tobacco, which is usually planted as a single or monocrop, contributes to soil mining, and soil erosion, which leads to reduced soil fertility and low productivity.
- ²² which includes impacts on land and water use due to pesticides and other chemicals used to increase tobacco crop yields. For example, The tobacco industry in other countries (e.g. Kenya) has recommended that tobacco farmers make as many as 16 applications of pesticide during the first few months of seedling production. See Kulik MC, Bialous SA, Munthali S, Max W. *Tobacco growing and the sustainable development goals, Malawi. Bull World Health Organ. 2017 May 1;95(5):362-367. doi: 10.2471/BLT.16.175596. Epub 2017 Feb 9. PMID: 28479637; PMCID: PMC5418823*.
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- ¹⁴⁴ Moyo, B. H. Z. and Moyo, D. Z., 2017. "Indigenous Knowledge Perceptions and Development Practice in Northern Malawi: Lessons from Small-Scale Farmers' Agricultural Practices." In Ngulue, P. (ed.), *Handbook of Research on Social, Cultural, and Educational Considerations of Indigenous Knowledge in Developing Countries*. Hershey: IGI Global.
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- ¹⁴⁵ Kalanda-Joshua, M. *et al.*, 201. "Integrating indigenous knowledge with conventional science: Enhancing localised climate and weather forecasts in Nessa, Mulanje, Malawi." *Physics and Chemistry of the Earth, Parts A/B/C*. Vol. 36, Issues 14–15, 996-1003.
- ¹⁴⁶ Ministry of Mines, Natural Resources and Environment, Government of Malawi, 2006. "Malawi's National Adaptation Programmes of Action (NAPA), Under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), First Edition." <https://unfccc.int/resource/docs/napa/mwi01.pdf> (accessed October 2021).
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- ¹⁴⁷ Ibid.
- ¹⁴⁸ Ibid.
- ¹⁴⁹ Demirgüç-Kunt, Asli, Leora Klapper, Dorothe Singer, Saniya Ansar, and Jake Hess. 2018. The Global Findex Database 2017: Measuring Financial Inclusion and the Fintech Revolution. Washington, DC: World Bank. doi:10.1596/978-1-4648-1259-0. According to FINDEX, adults with an account is 34% in Malawi, which is lower than neighbouring countries: Tanzania (47%), Zambia (46%) or Zimbabwe (55%). Besides, according to MoF/FARMSE's project design report, "only 42% and 12% of urban and rural adults respectively use formal financial services. One third of the adult population have access formal financial services and an additional 25% make use of informal financial services only. Farmers are amongst the least banked even as they constitute the largest portion of formal financial sector clients. They are, by contrast, the largest users of informal financial services. Savings and money transfers constitute most products employed, with credit and insurance use is very limited".
- ¹⁵⁰ FinMark Trust, 2021, Agricultural Finance Scoping, *An Agriculture Finance Scoping Exercise in Malawi*.
- ¹⁵¹ Ibid.
- ¹⁵² According to the Updated Malawi NDC (July 2021), for both mitigation and adaptation combined, unconditional measures account for around 24% of the total estimated funding requirements, and conditional measures around 76%
- ¹⁵³ Mwase, W., 2021. "Report on Capacity Development Needs, Institutions and Policy Analysis in Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation." Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining of Malawi, 2017. *Forest Landscape Restoration Opportunities Assessment for Malawi*.
- ¹⁵⁴ NIRAS, 2021. "Support evidence based policy decisions by the European Union in Malawi in the field of sustainable agriculture and food and nutrition security, RFS NO SIEA-2018-424 Report for Country Environmental Profile."
- ¹⁵⁵ The National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy 2017 promotes mostly EbA without explicitly employing the word.
- ¹⁵⁶ FAO, 2024. "The unjust climate – Measuring the impacts of climate change on rural poor, women and youth." <https://doi.org/10.4060/cc9680en> (accessed March 2024).
- ¹⁵⁷ Vargas, R. and Omuto, C., 2016. "Soil Loss Assessment in Malawi." Rome: FAO UNEP and UNDP.
- ¹⁵⁸ See Annex 1 for details on each of the maps.
- ¹⁵⁹ Republic of Malawi, the Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining, 2017. "National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy."
- ¹⁶⁰ For more references on MoF/FARMSE : <https://www.ifad.org/en/web/operations/-/project/2000001501>
- ¹⁶¹ Also known as "Kutukula Ulimi m'Malawi", which means "promoting agriculture" in Chichewa.
- ¹⁶² NIRAS, 2021. "Support evidence based policy decisions by the European Union in Malawi in the field of sustainable agriculture and food and nutrition security, RFS NO SIEA-2018-424 Report for Country Environmental Profile."
- ¹⁶³ Mwase, W., 2021. "Report on Capacity Development Needs, Institutions and Policy Analysis in Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation."
- ¹⁶⁴ WFP, 2021. "Smallholder Agriculture Market Support (SAMS)." https://docs.wfp.org/api/documents/WFP-0000131181/download/?_ga=2.220249627.2071837192.1637852301-1559344151.1629199563 (accessed November 2021).
- ¹⁶⁵ CIAT, 2019. "Climate-smart Agriculture in Malawi."
- ¹⁶⁶ As per IPCC, the term "drought" may refer to meteorological drought (precipitation well below average), hydrological drought (low river flows and water levels in rivers, lakes and groundwater), agricultural drought (low soil moisture), and environmental drought (a combination of the above).
- ¹⁶⁷ FAO, 2021. "Linking Territorial Development and Integrated Landscape Management." FAO in North America. <http://www.fao.org/north-america/news/detail/en/c/1273706/> (accessed October 2022).
- ¹⁶⁸ Minang, P. *et al.* (eds.), 2015. *Climate-Smart Landscapes: Multifunctionality in Practice*. Nairobi: World Agroforestry Centre.
- ¹⁶⁹ Small sub-catchments of area between 500 ha and 3,000 ha are considered for targeting during the following round for micro-catchments.
- ¹⁷⁰ FPIC is usually applied only to IPs - it is a specific right recognized in the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) - but EbAM recognizes the rights of peasants and other people working in the rural areas (as in the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Peasants and Other People Working in Rural Areas, or UNDROF) and its concerns which are similar to those of UNDRIP; EbAM applies FPIC to all local residents who are potential beneficiaries. All elements within FPIC are interconnected, forming a holistic process where qualitative aspects are paramount.
- ¹⁷¹ FAO, 2022. "Dimitra Clubs: Community Engagement for Empowerment." <https://www.fao.org/in-action/dimitra-clubs/en/> (accessed October 2022).
- ¹⁷² Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining of Malawi, 2017. *Forest Landscape Restoration Opportunities Assessment for Malawi*.
- ¹⁷³ MCSAA includes NGOs such as Catholic Relief Services (CRS), Find your Feet (FYF), Total Land Care (TLC), Development Fund of Norway, CARE. MCSAA regularly operate with the Department of Land Resources (DLRC) from the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA). Some members of the MCSAA (e.g. CRS) collaborate with the Restore Africa (RA) Programme under the Global Evergreening Alliance (GEA), and are implementing EbA in RA's districts.

¹⁷² The exact total value is 267,483 hectares. However, it has been decided to round the figure to 267,500 hectares. And these value is used throughout the documentation.

¹⁷³ Total land area is 88,800 hectares. 83,240 hectares is area, net of barelands, urban areas and water bodies.

¹⁷⁴ IFAD and FAO-MOSAICC analysis provide analysis at Agricultural Development Division (ADD) level.

¹⁷⁵ Including their impact on food diversity and availability and food nutrition and security

¹⁷⁶ The PICSA module involves agriculture extension staff working with groups of farmers ahead of the agricultural season to firstly analyse historical climate information and use participatory tools to develop and choose crop, livestock and livelihood options best suited to individual farmers' circumstances. Then soon before and during the season extension staff and farmers consider the practical implications of seasonal and short-term forecasts on the plans farmers have made.

¹⁷⁷ Some local NGOs staff that will work with EbAM, will be part of the trainings, particularly in areas where possible there is a DAESS staff limitation and they act as extension staff. This is consider for every activity that has DAESS staff involved.

¹⁷⁸ Dedza, Nsaje and Rumphu

¹⁷⁹ Through FAO-implemented KULIMA Project.

¹⁸⁰ These training modules will be prepared by FAO with the support of the Agroecology-Hub network of experts from LUANAR University and other institutes, plus the Gene Bank experts on agrobiodiversity and genetic resources.

¹⁸¹ Participatory Action Research, emphasizes research and action. Farmers are involved in deciding what needs to be researched, designing and measuring results.

¹⁸² FAO, EU, Government of Malawi. Endline survey report for the KULIMA Project, October 2023 (unpublished). Survey carried out after 6 years of implementation. The household survey targeted the FAO supported Farmer Field Schools (FFS) members managed by community-based facilitators (CBFs) in the project implementation areas and control group of non-FFS areas.

¹⁸³ FAO, Impacts of the Farmer Field Schools and Additional Transfers: Evidence from Malawi, Silvio Daidone, Flavia Pellegrini, and Nicholas Sitko. Unpublished.

¹⁸⁴ Geels (2012) multilevel perspective on innovations, describes 3 levels: the niche-innovations, sociotechnical regimes and sociotechnical landscape. Because we define transitions as changes from one sociotechnical regime to another, EbAM will work comprehensively to unlock these niche-innovations.

Geels, F.W. and Kemp, R., 2012, 'The multi-level perspective as a new perspective for studying socio-technical transitions', in: Geels, F.W., Kemp, R., Dudley, G. and Lyons, G. (eds.), 2012, *Automobility in Transition? A Socio-Technical Analysis of Sustainable Transport*, Routledge, pp. 49-79

¹⁸⁵ The Agroecology Knowledge Hub Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources (LUANAR), Hub members include universities, farmer organizations, FRNs, research institutes, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), extension services, and private sector organizations. The Hub links and has at disposal many different experts on Agroecology related practices. The hub facilitates evaluation and testing of promising practices and methodologies for agronomic, economic, social, environmental, and nutritional benefits using a systems approach. The Evidence generated is used for influencing policy on supporting agroecological systems. The Hub is also part of the Permaculture and Agroecology Network in Malawi.

¹⁸⁶ Such as SCOPE, Permaculture Paradise Institute, Kusamala Institute.

¹⁸⁷ Such as the Permaculture Paradise Institute and Kusamala Institute

¹⁸⁸ Under component 1.

¹⁸⁹ A landrace is a domesticated, locally adapted, variety of a species of animal or plant that has developed over time, through adaptation to its natural and cultural environment of agriculture and pastoralism, and due to isolation from other populations of the species.

¹⁹⁰ For instance ICRISAT.

¹⁹¹ Transforming Agriculture through Diversification and Entrepreneurship Programme (TRADE, 2020-2025)

¹⁹² <https://buymalawi.mw>

¹⁹³ The technical support may involve financing of studies, consultancies, training, costs of the professional staff of the FFIs, travel equipment and costs, etc, as per the eligibility rules of MoF/FARMSE.

¹⁹⁵ Concessional credit lines offer better conditions than commercial credit lines in terms of interest rate, maturity and repayment schedule.

¹⁹⁶ Guarantee funds or Schemes allow the financial institutions to cover part of the credit risk with the borrowers, which is usually required by the FFIs for borrowers who cannot themselves provide adequate collateral.

¹⁹⁷ Tool for AgroEcology Performance Evaluation. See Feasibility Study for details on the tool.

¹⁹⁸ MoA – more particularly the Department of Land Resources Conservation (DLRC) - originated the Project idea. MoA is strongly engaged since the beginning of the project design process. Through its network of decentralized staff, MoA is in a very good position to implement technical activities at local level with the districts and with all the actors of the decentralized local government system i.e. District Executive Committees (DEC), District Environment Sub-Committee (DESC), District Director of Agriculture and Natural Resources, Traditional Authorities (TAs), Group of Village Heads (GVH), village natural resources management committee (VNRMCs).

¹⁹⁹ NLGFC is constitutional body with the mandate to facilitate fiscal decentralization, financial management and local development in local governments. Similar to the GEF-7 funded *Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme - SFM DSL IP*, NLGFC will provide the procurement services to the EbAM project (based on the AWPB prepared by MoA), being in charge of investigating sources of supply, obtaining price quotations, negotiating with suppliers on price and delivery and monitoring the transfer of procured inputs to the project beneficiaries (VLAPs). This will facilitate accessibility for innovative technologies for the restoration, sustainable management, production and manufacturing of agriculture and forest products. Through this partnership, the Project will support implementation of the Decentralization Act (1998), which devolves powers and funding from the central government to districts, hence ensure project sustainability, and support a paradigm shift towards an increased ownership by districts.

²⁰⁰ MoF/FARMSE's development objective is to increase access to, and use of, a range of sustainable financial services by rural households and micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) (see Feasibility Study, section 4 for more details). It has a national coverage and has a strong comparative advantage to support EbAM in enhancing the financial inclusion of smallholder farmers.

²⁰¹ <https://www.worldbank.org/en/country/malawi/overview> and World Development Indicators
<https://databank.worldbank.org/reports.aspx?source=2&country=MW/>

²⁰² Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining - Malawi (2017). *Forest Landscape Restoration Opportunities Assessment for Malawi*. NFLRA (Malawi), IUCN, WRI. xv + 126pp.

- cciii MoA's in kind co-financing includes (i) staff time (extension officers: AEDOs and AEDCs for FFS), and (ii) trainings, workshop and conferences. See detailed budget for more information.
- 204 <http://www.fao.org/emergencies/how-we-work/resilience/en>
- 205 Pretty, J.N. *et al.*, 2006. "Resource-Conserving Agriculture Increases Yields in Developing Countries." *Environmental Science and Technology*. Vol. 40, No. 4, 1114-1119.
- UN, 2011. "UN expert makes case for ecological farming practices to boost food production." UN News, 8 March 2011. <https://news.un.org/en/story/2011/03/368352> (accessed April 2024).
- 206 See sub-activity 3.2.1.2 which will use the FAO TAPE analysis to carry out analysis of the socio-economic performance of EbAM. More information on the TAPE methodology is provided in the Feasibility Study and also here: <https://www.fao.org/agroecology/tools-tape/en/>
- 207 267,500 ha includes 83,240 ha under EbA management with GCF investment (direct) and other areas under indirect intervention (planning at sub-catchment level).
- 208 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- 209 Republic of Malawi, 2021. "Updated Nationally Determined Contributions, July 2021" <https://www4.unfccc.int/sites/ndcstaging/PublishedDocuments/Malawi%20First/Malawi%20Updated%20NDC%20July%202021%20submitted.pdf> (accessed October 2021).
- 210 Eriksen, S. *et al.*, 2021. "Adaptation interventions and their effect on vulnerability in developing countries: Help, hindrance or irrelevance?" *World Development*. Vol. 141, 105383.
- 211 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- IPCC, 2022. "Climate Change 2022, Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability: Full Report."
- 212 IPCC, 2022. "Climate Change 2022, Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability: Full Report."
- 213 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- 214 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- 215 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- 216 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- IPCC, 2022. "Climate Change 2022, Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability: Full Report."
- 217 Secretariat of the Convention on Biological Diversity, 2009. "Connecting Biodiversity and Climate Change Mitigation and Adaptation: Report of the Second Ad Hoc Technical Expert Group on Biodiversity and Climate Change." Technical Series No. 41. Montreal: CBD.
- 218 IPBES. 2017. IPBES/5/15- Report of the plenary of the intergovernmental science-policy platform on biodiversity and ecosystem services on the work of its fifth session. In Report: Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services.
- 219 Saka, A. R., Bunderson, W. T., Itimu, O. A., Phombeya, H. S. K., and Mbekeani, Y. (1994). The effects of *Acacia albida* on soils and maize grain yields under smallholder farm conditions in Malawi. *Forest Ecology and Management*, 64: 217-230. Reference reported in: Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining - Malawi (2017). *Forest Landscape Restoration Opportunities Assessment for Malawi*. NFLRA (Malawi), IUCN, WRI. xv + 126pp.
- 220 CIAT, 2019. "Climate-smart Agriculture in Malawi." https://climateknowledgeportal.worldbank.org/sites/default/files/2019-06/CSA%20_Profile_Malawi.pdf (accessed November 2021).
- 221 CBA done under the NFLRA shows an income increase of 1.5 to 2.1 million Malawian kwacha (MWK) i.e. 40% over a twenty-year period. CIAT, World Bank (2018) report a 100% increase in incomes under the DFID-funded Enhancing Community Resilience to Climate Change and Variability Project.
- 222 hydropower facilities of the Electricity Generation Company - EGENCO and irrigation schemes
- 223 Macho, M., 2019. Resident/Humanitarian Coordinator Report on the Use of CERF Funds: Malawi, Rapid Response Cyclone Idai, 2019." https://cerf.un.org/sites/default/files/resources/19-RR-MWI-35650_Malawi_RCHC_Report.pdf (accessed November 2021).
- IFPRI, 2020. "The Short-term Impacts of COVID-19 on the Malawian Economy, 2020–2021, A SAM multiplier modelling analysis." Lilongwe: IFPRI.
- 224 CIAT, World Bank, 2018
- 225 The International Monetary Fund (IMF) reports that food insecurity increases by 5-20 percentage points with each drought or flood in Malawi. See Regional economic outlook. Sub-Saharan Africa : COVID-19 : an unprecedented threat to development. 2020. Washington, DC: International Monetary Fund.
- 226 Hunter, R. *et al.*, 2020. *Climate Change and Future Crop Suitability in Malawi*. Rome: University of Cape Town and IFAD.
- 227 Short and long-maturing varieties combined.
- 228 See 170.
- 229 Fisher, S., 2013. "Challenging inequality is at the heart of climate change adaptation." IIED. <https://www.iied.org/challenging-inequality-heart-climate-change-adaptation> (accessed October 2022).
- 230 Mussa, R. and Masanjala, W. H., 2015. "A Dangerous Divide: The State of Inequality in Malawi." https://www-cdn.oxfam.org/s3fs-public/file_attachments/rr-inequality-in-malawi-261115-en.pdf (accessed October 2022).
- 231 UNFPA, 2022. "What We Do: Young People." <https://malawi.unfpa.org/en/topics/young-people-3> (accessed November 2022).
- 232 FreedomHouse, 2022. "Freedom on the Net: Malawi." <https://freedomhouse.org/country/malawi/freedom-net/2020> (accessed October 2022).
- 233 World Bank, 2022. "Rural population (% of total population) – Malawi." <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.RUR.TOTL.ZS?locations=MW> 9accessed November 2022).
- 234 World Bank, 2022. "The World Bank in Malawi." <https://www.worldbank.org/en/country/malawi/overview> (accessed November 2022).
- 235 See: <https://www.worldbank.org/en/country/malawi/overview>
- 236 With the support of UNEP, Malawi submitted a \$2.8 million NAP readiness grant to the Green Climate Fund (GCF) for the advancement of the NAP development process.
- 237 Soils, Food and Healthy communities Project.
- 238 World Bank, 2021. Project Appraisal Document of the Malawi Watershed Services Improvement Project (MWASIP). Economic and financial analysis.

²³⁹ IFAD, 2016. Project design report of the Enhancing the resilience of agro-ecological systems project (ERASP) in Malawi

²⁴⁰ World Bank, 2019. Malawi: Shire River Basin Management Program (SRBMP Phase-I) Project Implementation completion and results report

²⁴¹ Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining - Malawi (2017). Forest Landscape Restoration Opportunity Assessment for Malawi. NFLRA (Malawi), IUCN, WRI. xv + 126pp.

²⁴² Ignaciuk, A., Maggio, G. & Sitko, N.J. 2021. Assessing the profitability and feasibility of climate-smart agriculture investment in Southern Malawi. Understanding the costs and benefits in a volatile and changing climate. FAO Agricultural Development Economics Working Paper 21-07. Rome, FAO. <https://doi.org/10.4060/cb5381en>

²⁴³ Mutenje, M.J., Farnworth, C.R., Stirling, C., Thierfelder, C., Mupangwa, W. and Nyagumbo, I. 2019. A cost-benefit analysis of climate-smart agriculture options in Southern Africa: Balancing gender and technology. Ecological Economics 163: 126–137.

^{ccxliiv} 267,500 ha includes 83,240 ha under EbA management with GCF investment (direct) and other areas under indirect intervention (planning at sub-catchment level).

No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s)

Telephone: +265 1 771 111
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Our Reference: EAD/99/06/04N
Your Reference:.....



Environmental Affairs Department
Private Bag 394
Capital City
Lilongwe 3

2nd December, 2022

The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")
Executive Director
Green Climate Fund
Song Do Business District
175 Art Center-Daero
Yeonsu-Gu, Incheon 22004
Republic of Korea

Dear Madam, Sir,

Re: Funding proposal for the GCF by Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) regarding Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)

We refer to the project titled Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM) as included in the funding proposal submitted by Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) to us on 23rd November, 2022. The undersigned is the NDA/FP of Malawi.

Pursuant to GCF decision B.08/10, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal. By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

- a) The government of Malawi has no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal;
- b) The project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with the national priorities, strategies and plans of Malawi;
- c) In accordance with the GCF's environmental and social safeguards, the project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with relevant national laws and regulations.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal has been duly followed. We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website.

Kind regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to be 'T. Mbale-Luka'.

Mrs. Tawonga Mbale-Luka
NDA for the Green Climate Fund, Government of Malawi

Att'd

Environmental and social safeguards report form pursuant to para. 17 of the IDP

Basic project or programme information	
Project or programme title	Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)
Existence of subproject(s) to be identified after GCF Board approval	Yes
Sector (public or private)	Public
Accredited entity	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)
Environmental and social safeguards (ESS) category	Category B
Location – specific location(s) of project or target country or location(s) of programme	Chitipa, Dedza, Karonga, Mangochi, Mwanza, Neno, Nkhata Bay, Nsanje, Rumphi, Thyolo, and Zomba districts of the Republic of Malawi
Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity's website	Monday, June 3, 2024
Language(s) of disclosure	English and Chichewa
Explanation on language	English is the official language and Chichewa is the national language of the Republic of Malawi, both of which are understandable to the affected peoples/stakeholders.
Link to disclosure	English https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994en Chichewa https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994ny
Other link(s)	FAO disclosure portal (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/environmental-social-safeguards/project-detail/Ecosystems-based-Adaptation-for-resilient-Watersheds-and-communities-in-Malawi/en FAO Representation in Malawi website (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/countryprofiles/index/en/?iso3=MWI
Remarks	An ESIA consistent with the requirements for a Category B project is contained in the “Annex 6: Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF)”.
Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity's website	Monday, June 3, 2024
Language(s) of disclosure	English and Chichewa
Explanation on language	English is the official language and Chichewa is the national language of the Republic of Malawi, both of which are understandable to the affected peoples/stakeholders.

Link to disclosure	English https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994en Chichewa https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994ny
Other link(s)	FAO disclosure portal (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/environmental-social-safeguards/project-detail/Ecosystems-based-Adaptation-for-resilient-Watersheds-and-communities-in-Malawi/en FAO Representation in Malawi website (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/countryprofiles/index/en/?iso3=MWI
Remarks	An ESMP consistent with the requirements for a Category B project is contained in the “Annex 6: Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF)”.
Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS) (if applicable)	
Date of disclosure on accredited entity’s website	N/A
Language(s) of disclosure	N/A
Explanation on language	N/A
Link to disclosure	N/A
Other link(s)	N/A
Remarks	N/A
Any other relevant ESS reports, e.g. Resettlement Action Plan (RAP), Resettlement Policy Framework (RPF), Indigenous Peoples Plan (IPP), Indigenous Peoples Planning Framework (IPPF) (if applicable)	
Description of report/disclosure on accredited entity’s website	Indigenous Peoples Planning Framework (IPPF)/ Wednesday, June 5, 2024
Language(s) of disclosure	English and Chichewa
Explanation on language	English is the official language and Chichewa is the national language of the Republic of Malawi, both of which are understandable to the affected peoples/stakeholders.
Link to disclosure	English https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994en Chichewa https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cd0994ny
Other link(s)	FAO disclosure portal (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/environmental-social-safeguards/project-detail/Ecosystems-based-Adaptation-for-resilient-Watersheds-and-communities-in-Malawi/en FAO Representation in Malawi website (English and Chichewa) https://www.fao.org/countryprofiles/index/en/?iso3=MWI
Remarks	An Indigenous Peoples Planning Framework consistent with the requirements for a Category B project is contained in the “Annex 6: Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF)”.
Disclosure in locations convenient to affected peoples (stakeholders)	
Date	Friday, June 14, 2024

Place	The hard copies will be made available in English and Chichewa in the following places; FAO Representation in Malawi: a. National Office: Evelyn Court, Area 13, P.O Box 30750, Lilongwe 3, Malawi. b. Mangochi Office: C/O District Fisheries Office, P.O. Box 47, Mangochi, Malawi. National Level a. Ministry of Agriculture Offices i. Ministry of Agriculture Headquarters: Capital Hill, P.O. Box 30134, Lilongwe 3, Malawi. ii. Department of Land Resources Conservation (DLRC): P.O Box 30145, Lilongwe 3, Malawi. iii. Department of Agriculture Extension Services (DAES): P.O. Box 30145, Lilongwe, Malawi. b. The National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC): P.O. Box 31162, Lilongwe, Malawi. c. Ministry of Finance: Capital Hill, P.O. Box 30049, Lilongwe 3 Malawi. Regional level through Agricultural Development Division (ADD) a. Blantyre ADD: P/Bag 379, Blantyre 3, Malawi. b. Machinga ADD: P/Bag 3, Liwonde, Machinga, Malawi. c. Chikwawa ADD: P/Bag 1, Chikwawa, Malawi. d. Mzuzu ADD: P/Bag 3, Kanjedza Drive, Mzuzu, Malawi. e. Karonga ADD: P.O. Box 8, Karonga, Malawi. f. Lilongwe ADD: P.O. Box 30134, Lilongwe 3, Malawi. District Level a. Zomba District Council: P.O Box 43, Zomba, Malawi. b. Mangochi District Council: P/Bag 138, Mangochi, Malawi. c. Thyolo District Council: Private Bag 5, Thyolo, Malawi. d. Neno District Council: P.O. Box 11, Neno, Malawi. e. Mwanza District Council: Private Bag 3, Mwanza, Malawi. f. Nsanje District Council: P/Bag 1, Nsanje, Malawi. g. Dedza District Council: P.O. Box 140 Dedza, Malawi. h. Nkhata Bay District Council: P/Bag 1, Nkhata Bay, Malawi. i. Rumphu District Council: P.O. Box 224, Rumphu, Malawi. j. Karonga District Council: P.O. Box 35. Karonga, Malawi. k. Chitipa District Council: P.O. Box 1, Chitipa, Malawi.
Date of Board meeting in which the FP is intended to be considered	

Date of accredited entity's Board meeting	N/A
Date of GCF's Board meeting	Monday, July 15, 2024

Note: This form was prepared by the accredited entity stated above.

Secretariat's assessment of FP238

Proposal name:	Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)
Accredited entity:	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)
Country:	Republic of Malawi
Project/programme size:	Medium

I. Overall assessment of the Secretariat

- The funding proposal is presented to the Board for consideration with the following remarks:

Strengths	Points of caution
The EbAM project targets the most climate-vulnerable watershed areas in Malawi, a Least Developed Country, by employing an ecosystem-based adaptation (EbA) approach combined with integrated landscape management (ILM), which not only addresses immediate ecological and agricultural needs, but also sets a foundation for long-term sustainability and scalability. It is anticipated to have a wide-reaching impact through planned investments in 30 sub-catchments, focusing on conserving, restoring, and sustainably managing approximately 267,500 hectares under EbA-based (Sub-Catchment Management Plan) SCMPs planning including 83,240 ha under EbA management.	The upcoming 2025 general election in Malawi presents a risk to project stability and continuity due to potential political shifts and uncertainties that could affect governance and regulatory environments.
It tackles technical and financial innovations, including supporting the country's long-term climate and finance partners and strategies. The project aligns closely with Malawi's national priorities as outlined in its updated nationally determined contributions of 2021. This includes promoting ecosystem-based adaptation, integrated watershed management, and sustainable agricultural practices, ensuring the project supports national climate strategies and enhances policy coherence.	The project's success is dependent on collaboration by the project team with domestic and international stakeholders to secure the necessary support and financing; managing these relationships effectively will be key during the implementation phase.

2. The Board may wish to consider approving this funding proposal in accordance with the term sheet agreed between the Secretariat and the accredited entity, and, if considered appropriate, subject to the conditions set out in Annex II of document GCF/B.39/02.

II. Summary of the Secretariat's assessment

2.1 Project background

3. The objective of “Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)” is to enhance the climate-change resilience of rural communities in Malawi through a comprehensive approach that integrates EbA with ILM. Targeting 11 vulnerable districts¹ across Malawi, the project aims to mitigate the negative impacts of climate change, including increased temperatures, erratic rainfall, and the frequency of climate-induced disasters such as droughts and floods. The EbAM project is strategically designed to restore and sustainably manage watershed ecosystems to support agriculture and improve livelihoods, with a significant emphasis on involving vulnerable groups such as women and youth in the process and using local knowledge for forest management. These districts have been selected due to their significant exposure to climate change impacts, including extreme soil loss and degradation, erratic rainfall, increased temperatures, and frequent climate-induced disasters like droughts and floods.
4. The EbAM project is structured around three interconnected components. The first component focuses on reducing greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions and enhancing the climate resilience of watershed ecosystems by restoring ecosystem functions at a large enough scale to facilitate broad adaptation and mitigation efforts. This involves the application of the EbA approach, which uses biodiversity and ecosystem services to help communities adapt to climate change. The second component aims to stabilize productivity and farmers' incomes by making livelihoods and food systems more resilient to climate variability. This will be achieved through promoting climate-resilient agricultural practices, improving access to markets, and facilitating financial inclusion for farmers. The third component seeks to strengthen the enabling environment for climate resilience by enhancing policy frameworks and mobilizing innovative finance solutions to support the sustainable scaling up of the project's interventions.
5. Overall, the EbAM project embodies a paradigm shift towards sustainable ecosystem management and climate-resilient agricultural practices in Malawi. By integrating EbA within local planning processes, fostering public-private-producer partnerships (4P), and leveraging innovative financing mechanisms, the project aspires to contribute to a more sustainable pathway for resilient ecosystems, livelihoods, and agriculture across the country. This shift is expected to reduce Malawi's high vulnerability to climate change, improve food security, and contribute to sustainable development goals, ensuring a lasting impact on the country's rural communities.
6. The project's exit strategy is crucial for sustaining the project's impacts beyond its lifetime. It emphasizes local planning (e.g. EbA-based Catchment Management Plans (CMPs) and Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs)), institutional strengthening, community engagement (i.e. with the Catchment Management Committees (CMCs) and Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs)), policy advocacy, financial sustainability, knowledge-sharing (including digital services), and robust monitoring.

¹ The 11 vulnerable districts targeted by the EbAM project were chosen due to their high climate vulnerability. These districts are Dedza (located in the Central region of Malawi); Zomba, Mangochi, Thyolo, Neno, Mwanza, Nsanje (all located in the Southern region of Malawi); and Nkhata Bay, Rumphi, Karonga, and Chitipa (all located in the Northern region of Malawi).

7. This strategy ensures that project initiatives are deeply integrated into local and national frameworks, empowering communities and institutions to continue practices and support essential services and extension support that bolster climate resilience. Through innovative financing mechanisms and private-sector engagement, the strategy aims to mobilize additional resources for expanding these practices to other regions, embedding ecosystem-based adaptation into the fabric of Malawi's development and climate-resilience efforts.
8. The proposal outlines a total budget of USD 53.22 million, including a USD 42.81 million grant requested from GCF. Co-financing totalling USD 10.42 million will be provided by the country's Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs (MoF) and the Ministry of Agriculture (MoA), and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO).
9. The budget allocation across the project components is detailed as follows:
 - (a) USD 24.60 million is dedicated to component 1, aimed at integrated landscape management to increase the climate resilience of watershed ecosystems and reduce greenhouse gas emissions.
 - (b) USD 22.50 million is allocated to component 2, focusing on stabilizing productivity and farmers' incomes through more resilient livelihoods and food systems.
 - (c) USD 1.18 million is designated for component 3, which seeks to enhance the enabling environment for sustaining, replicating, and scaling up climate-resilient watershed ecosystems and agricultural practices.
 - (d) Additional allocations include USD 2.32 million for monitoring and evaluation (M&E) activities and USD 2.62 million for project management.
10. The project's risk assessment identifies political factors such as collaboration challenges between government stakeholders and changes in the government's development priorities as significant risks, categorized as having medium probability and impact. Specific concerns include limited cooperation between partners i.e. different ministries and departments, which could hinder effective implementation and knowledge-sharing about climate-resilient practices. To mitigate these, the project involves key governmental actors in committees to ensure cohesive work across agencies. Another political risk arises from potential shifts in government focus, which may affect commitment to ecosystem-based adaptation strategies. This is mitigated by the strong alignment with Malawi's current complementary policies. High-level government officials are also included in decision-making processes to address policy changes proactively. Additional exogenous risks like extreme weather events and health crises like the coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19) pandemic are also noted, with plans to enhance ecosystem services that support resilient livelihoods and adjust project management practices to ensure continuity despite these challenges.

2.2 Component-by-component analysis

Component 1: Community resilience (total cost: USD 24.6 million; GCF cost: USD 24.3 million)

11. Component 1 of the project emphasizes ILM to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and enhance climate resilience in watershed ecosystems focusing on ecosystem services. It aligns with the Fund's outcomes related to health, food security, ecosystems, and forestry.
12. ILM employs a holistic, participatory approach that is integrated into local planning, encompassing both private and communal lands to foster sustainability. It leverages EbA as the principal tool for building climate resilience, incorporating local planning and stakeholder engagement. The project prioritizes the development of technical capacities in watershed management committees and local communities, emphasizing the inclusion of women, youth, and vulnerable groups. Through active and inclusive stakeholder engagement at various levels,

the project ensures broad participation in both planning and execution phases. The project's approach is informed by lessons from past projects to enhance sustainability. A rigorous targeting and selection process is employed for intervention areas, focusing on local stakeholder participation and alignment with regions identified as vulnerable due to their climate and ecological characteristics.

13. Overall, the component demonstrates a comprehensive approach to address climate impacts on watershed ecosystems, leveraging innovative strategies, stakeholder engagement, and capacity-building to achieve sustainable outcomes.

Component 2: Ecosystem resilience – strengthened climate resilience of ecosystems (total cost: USD 22.5 million; GCF cost: USD 13.9 million)

14. Component 2 focuses on enhancing resilience in livelihoods and food systems, aiming to stabilize productivity and incomes of farmers through resilient agricultural practices. It addresses various barriers hindering the adoption of these practices, including knowledge gaps, social challenges, and financial limitations. By tackling these barriers, the component aims to contribute to GCF objectives related to vulnerable communities' health, well-being, and food security using a range of solutions to building resilience in agricultural systems.

15. Moreover, component 2 emphasizes sustainability by promoting practices such as EbA via the Farmer's Field Schools. By integrating diverse and locally adapted crops into farming systems, the component aims to enhance ecosystem resilience and ensure the long-term viability of agricultural production with a wide view lens of the Food system approach. The component also focuses on facilitating market access and entrepreneurship development for farmers through a public-private producers partnerships (4Ps) approach. By establishing partnerships and creating market branding initiatives, it opens opportunities and best practices (i.e. development of business plans) for farmers and local businesses to commercialize their products and increase their incomes. This approach not only benefits individual farmers but also contributes to the overall resilience of local food systems and the development of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

16. Furthermore, component 2 promotes financial inclusion by strengthening community-based financial organizations and providing tailored financial services to farmers. Farmers are enabled to invest in climate-resilient agricultural practices and improve their overall economic stability. The replicability of the approach is a significant strength. By designing interventions that can be scaled up and adapted to different contexts, component 2 offers potential for widespread impact beyond its immediate target areas especially with the investment pipeline for National Climate Change Fund. This scalability enhances the sustainability and long-term effectiveness of the component's initiatives.

17. In summary, component 2 adopts a multifaceted approach to building resilience in livelihoods and food systems, leveraging innovation, sustainability, market access, and financial inclusion to empower farmers and enhance agricultural resilience.

Component 3: Climate governance – strengthened climate governance and institutional framework to sustain climate (total cost: USD 1.18 million; GCF cost: USD 0.8 million)

18. The project supports a range of innovative and sustainable activities designed to foster climate resilience and ecosystem restoration. Emphasizing the integration of EbA into national policies, the project enhances the longevity and effectiveness of EbA principles across sectoral planning and financing.

19. Furthermore, the project engages in policy influence and advocacy through policy dialogues and the preparation of evidence-based studies and policy assessments, aiming to foster policy changes that prioritize ecosystem restoration and integrated landscape management. Additionally, the project builds partnerships and leverages synergies to explore

innovative financial instruments like carbon credits and enhance the scalability and impact of EbA initiatives through collaborations with other projects/programmes.

20. Capacity development is also a cornerstone, with training provided to institutions such as the National Climate Change Fund and Malawi Environmental Endowment Trust in key areas. These institutions are critical in mobilizing climate finance and ensuring the sustainability and replication of climate-resilient investments.

21. Overall, component 3 strengthens the institutional and financial environment necessary for sustaining and scaling up climate-resilient practices, contributing to the project's overarching objectives and outcomes.

Additional allocation: Gender, environmental and social management framework, monitoring and evaluation components (total cost: USD 2.32 million; GCF cost: USD 1.8 million)

22. The project, classified as category B (moderate risk), anticipates substantial positive environmental and social benefits, including enhancing climate resilience and reducing greenhouse gas emissions, while also acknowledging the need for careful management of any adverse impacts. Institutional arrangements involve the Ministry of Agriculture, the National Local Government Finance Committee, and the Ministry of Finance, supported by international technical assistance for environmental and social safeguards compliance. The environmental and social management framework includes a zero-tolerance policy for sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), with specific procedures for risk mitigation integrated into project management and a grievance redress mechanism to address any concerns arising during implementation. More information is noted in the relevant sections below.

Additional allocation: Project management (total cost: USD 2.62 million; GCF cost: USD 2.0 million)

23. This project will be managed by the Central Project Implementation Unit (CPIU) led by a National Project Coordinator, supported by regional units in Blantyre and Mzuzu, handling daily operations and local coordination. The CPIU includes finance, operations, human resources, procurement, contracting officers, and technical specialists in areas like EbA, agroecology, and gender inclusion. M&E is integrated within the CPIU to oversee project progress and ensure goals are met effectively. More information is noted in the sections below.

III. Assessment against investment criteria

3.1 Impact potential

Scale: High

24. The project is considered to have significant impact potential, aiming to transform the vulnerability landscape of Malawi's rural communities through comprehensive environmental and social interventions. Through the application of ecosystem-based adaptation strategies, the project aims to enhance agricultural yields, improve soil quality, and increase water retention, thereby strengthening the region's ability to withstand climatic challenges.

25. Primarily an adaptation project, it aims to empower project beneficiaries to effectively prepare for, respond to, and recover from climate-related extremes and disasters – focusing on mitigating the cycle of low agricultural productivity and watershed degradation exacerbated by climate change.

26. With a strategic focus on ecosystem-based adaptation and integrated landscape management, the project is poised to directly benefit 270,820 people, target approximately 30 sub-catchments (for a total of about 267,500 hectares) over six years, and generate mitigation benefits of –2,750,323 tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent.

3.2 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: High

27. The project aims to catalyse a significant shift towards sustainability in ecosystems, livelihoods, and agriculture across Malawi, which currently face high vulnerability to climate change impacts. It seeks to transition from the current state of vulnerability to one where ecosystems are conserved, restored, and managed sustainably, providing adaptation to climate change, and supporting resilient farming systems and communities.

28. As noted above in the project's description, to achieve this, the project will promote a locally led approach called ecosystem-based adaptation (EbA) combined with integrated landscape management (ILM). EbA focuses on restoring and strengthening ecosystems to maximize biodiversity and ecosystem services, making them more resilient to climate change. ILM involves collaborative planning and management of landscapes to achieve multiple objectives. These approaches will be integrated into watershed and village-level plans, engaging marginalized groups, and incorporating local and traditional knowledge.

29. The project will implement various EbA interventions such as ecosystem restoration and sustainable agricultural practices, aiming to enhance ecological resilience and improve food security. It will also enhance access to markets, business opportunities, and finance for farmers, making their livelihoods more resilient. Additionally, the project aims to strengthen the enabling environment for EbA, facilitating replication and scaling-up through other projects and programmes. It will promote collective learning on EbA through training and participatory planning processes involving stakeholders at various levels.

30. Overall, the project seeks to create a sustainable and resilient future for Malawi by integrating EbA into local plans, policies, and investment strategies, while ensuring meaningful participation of stakeholders and knowledge-sharing at various levels.

3.3 Sustainable development potential

Scale: High

31. The project is strategically poised to contribute significantly to sustainable development in Malawi, particularly aligning with Sustainable Development Goals 2 (Zero hunger), 6 (Clean water and sanitation), 13 (Climate action), and 15 (Life on land).

32. By promoting ecosystem-based adaptation and integrated landscape management, EbAM aims to enhance agricultural resilience, ensure water security, combat climate change impacts, and preserve biodiversity. This comprehensive approach supports the creation of resilient food systems, the restoration and sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, and the strengthening of adaptive capacities to climate-related hazards. Through its commitment to restoring degraded landscapes, improving agricultural productivity, and promoting sustainable land management practices, the project's approach is expected to lead to improved food security, income stability, and enhanced adaptive capacity to climate change, contributing significantly to the Sustainable Development Goals in Malawi.

3.4 Needs of the recipient

Scale: High

33. The project targets the acute needs of Malawi's rural population and agrarian economy, challenged by climate change, poverty, and food insecurity. Focusing on vulnerable communities, the project aims to improve resilience through sustainable watershed management, agricultural practices, and ecosystem restoration.

34. It addresses soil erosion, erratic rainfall, and the increased frequency of floods and droughts, which impact agricultural productivity. By empowering communities with sustainable resource management skills, enhancing food and water security, and building institutional

capacities, EbAM seeks to foster long-term sustainability and resilience against climate change, setting a replicable model for development in Malawi.

3.5 Country ownership

Scale: High

35. The project exemplifies strong country ownership, aligning closely with Malawi's national strategies and policies on climate change, environmental conservation, and sustainable development. This initiative is deeply integrated into the country's broader efforts to combat climate change impacts, as outlined in its nationally determined contributions and the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy. By working in concert with local ministries, governmental agencies, and community organizations, the project ensures that its objectives are in harmony with national priorities and leverages local expertise and resources for implementation. This approach not only enhances the project's effectiveness and sustainability but also fosters a sense of national commitment and responsibility towards achieving its goals.

36. Country ownership is further strengthened by actively involving local communities in the planning and execution phases, ensuring that interventions are tailored to meet their specific needs and conditions, thereby maximizing the project's impact on enhancing resilience and sustainable development in Malawi.

3.6 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: Medium to high

37. The project expects enhanced productivity on farms, value addition post-production, market access improvements, significant greenhouse gas emission reductions, and the bolstering of non-timber forest products, among other ecosystem benefits. Financial analyses reveal positive net present values and internal rates of return for beneficiaries, highlighting the cost-efficiency of EbA solutions. Economically, the project demonstrates a high return on investment with a net present value of USD 68.5 million and an economic internal rate of return of 32.8 per cent, significantly above the economic discount rate, indicating substantial societal benefits.

38. The inclusion of avoided GHG emissions further enhances the project's economic appeal, with economic internal rate of return potentially increasing under higher social carbon pricing scenarios. Sensitivity analyses confirm the project's resilience to cost and benefit fluctuations, underscoring its economic viability and alignment with global climate financing goals. This comprehensive approach, underscored by supportive financial metrics and broader societal benefits, illustrates the project's potential to deliver sustainable, climate-resilient development in Malawi.

IV. Assessment of consistency with GCF safeguards and policies

4.1 Environmental and social safeguards

39. **Environmental and social risk category.** The AE has assigned the project an environmental and social (E&S) risk category of Category B based on its screening of the proposed project activities. The Secretariat agrees with this categorization and confirms that the risk category is within the AE's environmental and social risk accreditation level.

40. The project is expected to generate substantial positive environmental and social benefits. Along with these benefits, it is important to note that the environmental and social risks for activities involving agricultural interventions in the context of vulnerable communities

can potentially lead to adverse social and environmental impacts that need to be carefully managed and monitored.

41. However, overall, the residual environmental and social risks and impacts are highly localized and limited in footprint, largely reversible, and can be readily addressed using recognized standard management practices.

42. **Safeguards instrument.** The AE has prepared an Environmental and Social Management Framework (ESMF, see Annex 6). The ESMF is the appropriate instrument for this project as site-specific EbA interventions and watershed management structures will be identified following the development of village-level action plans (VLAPs) and sub-catchment management plans (SCMPs) during project implementation.

43. The project will also support the development of MSMEs, provision of financial services for EbA investments by the financial institutions and building an EbA investment pipeline of Malawi's National Climate Change Fund.

44. An Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) will be developed to identify and address activity and site-specific risks and impacts at the local level and be incorporated as part of the VLAPs to ensure implementation.

45. **Compliance with the GCF Environmental and Social Safeguards (ESS) standards.** The paragraphs below describe the project's compliance with GCF ESS standards.

46. **ESS1 (Assessment and Management of Environmental and Social Risks and Impacts).** The ESMF provides information about the baseline conditions of the physical context, general social-economic context, agroecological zones, land tenure, production and livelihood systems, and the Indigenous groups and communities in the target project areas. The ESMF also provides an overall assessment of the potential E&S risks and impacts and mitigation measures of the project interventions per the AE's ESS standards and E&S risk screening checklist. The AE sets out in the ESMF the following: (1) the principles and procedures for assessing the E&S baseline conditions and impacts; and (2) the development of site-specific ESMPs with their associated mitigation measures. The ESMF requires that each VLAP be formulated with the standards set in the to ensure safeguards implementation.

47. Given that potential conflicts may arise from activities that envision livelihood improvement and benefit-sharing among the local groups, the ESMF further elaborates on the AE's approach to conflict risk management. The ESMF identifies the conflict and fragility context in the host country and sets out the process to handle conflict risks during the project implementation. For this project, the AE will ensure a community-based and participatory approach as part of the integrated landscape management for land planning and land restoration. Moreover, the project will invest in preventing conflicts among and within communities in the targeted micro-catchments.

48. **ESS2 (Labour and Working Conditions).** The AE has identified moderate risk on decent work and triggered the related standard as the project may operate in sectors or value chains dominated by subsistence producers and other vulnerable informal agricultural workers generally characterized as "working poverty". The project also faces situations where women and youths work predominantly informally as unpaid contributing family members and lack access to decent jobs and representation in producers' and workers' organizations.

49. The AE will take specific measures, and as part of the project design, to empower the most vulnerable and disadvantaged categories of rural workers such as small-scale producers, contributing family workers, subsistence farmers, and agricultural informal wage workers. As per the AE's guidance on child labour, the project will not engage children under the age of 18 in work-related activities that are likely to be hazardous or interfere with their compulsory education or be harmful to their health, safety or morals. Where children under the age of 18 may be engaged in work-related activities in connection with the project, an appropriate risk

assessment will be required, together with regular monitoring of health, working conditions and working hours. The ESMF provides an indicative outline for the labour management plan to guide the detailed risk assessment and mitigate adverse impacts related to decent work and labour practices.

50. **ESS3 (Resource Efficiency and Pollution Control).** The project aims to reduce the dependence on the use of pesticides and agrochemicals through promoting EbA and agroecological practices. Synthetic pesticides will not be promoted through the project and the use of pesticides has been explicitly excluded through the ESMF non-eligibility list. While integrated crop and small livestock is among the EbA techniques promoted by the project, it will be implemented in a manner that minimizes environmental and social risks. By prioritizing agroecological principles and excluding harmful inputs such as pesticides, the project aims to safeguard against unintended consequences without necessitating the triggering of the related standard.

51. **ESS4 (Community Health, Safety and Security).** The project will take a community-centric approach in the establishment and operation of a watershed management structure at the micro-catchment level. The project will formulate and strengthen 111 village natural resources management committees (VNRMC) to develop the EbA-based VLAPs to be funded by the project. An estimated total area of 83,240 hectares, including both communal and on-farm areas, will be targeted within the micro-catchments covered by the VLAPs across 30 sub-catchments where EbA interventions will be funded by the project. Such EbA investments will target soil and water conservation, pastureland, agroforestry, and Farmer Managed Natural Regeneration (FMNR), community forests and woodlot restoration, forest management and river and stream bank restoration, and may raise concern among the communities affected. The specific risks and impacts on community health, safety and security will be identified as part of the subproject-specific ESMPs during implementation.

52. **ESS5 (Land Acquisition and Involuntary Resettlement).** The project does not entail physical or economic displacement, whether full or partial, permanent or temporary, as a result of land or resource restriction. The ESMF rules out of the project any form of land acquisition and involuntary resettlement under the project's non-eligibility list. Furthermore, restrictions on resource access, such as farming land, that cannot be adequately mitigated and would negatively impact the livelihoods of Indigenous Peoples, ethnic groups, and disadvantaged populations are strictly prohibited. The AE will guarantee the full transparency of land restoration planning as embedded in the project's general principles and as part of the participatory process for VLAP preparation and development, and that all local stakeholders are aware of and agree with the restoration actions planned on communal/customary land.

53. **ESS6 (Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainable Management of Living Natural Resources).** The AE has triggered its relevant standards as the project activities prioritized within VLAPs may involve genetic resources resulting from the introduction of crops and varieties that are not previously grown, providing seeds/planting material for cultivation, and the establishment or management of planted forests. Depending on the specific EbA measures to be identified by the local communities, the project may also involve promoting integrated crop and small livestock, and possibly crop/aquatic production systems. The ESMS has identified specific measures to manage the adverse risks associated with the handling and supply of seeds for cultivation, including to: (i) avoid undermining local seed and planting material production and supply systems; (ii) ensure that the seeds and planting materials are from locally/regionally adapted crops and varieties that are accepted by farmers and consumers, even if they have been forgotten and will need to be reintroduced; (iii) ensure that the seeds and planting materials are free from pests and diseases according to norms; and (iv) ensure farmers' rights to plant genetic resources for food and agriculture, and that the associated traditional knowledge is respected, along with the sharing of the benefits accrued

from their use. Furthermore, the project will prohibit the introduction of non-native and invasive species as included in the ESMF non-eligibility list.

54. **GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy and ESS7 (Indigenous Peoples).** The AE has provided an Indigenous Peoples Planning Framework (IPPF) as part of its ESMF. The IPPF outlines relevant background, laws and policies, potential risks and impacts and implementation arrangements, monitoring and reporting and grievance mechanism arrangements. It also targets good practice engagement including through free, prior and informed consent of potential target communities. In line with their roles and functions, the Indigenous Peoples Advisory Group is available to provide advice to the accredited entity and executing entities.

55. **ESS8 (Cultural Heritage).** The AE has triggered its relevant standard as the integrated landscape management and EbA measures to be funded by the project may inherently intersect with Indigenous territories and traditional practices. The ESMF identifies such risk and mitigation measures to respect Indigenous rights, identify and protect cultural assets, and involve communities in decision-making, ensuring sustainable project outcomes while safeguarding Indigenous Peoples and cultural heritage that extends to all beneficiary communities. The ESMF also includes a chance finds procedure applicable to all physical cultural resources.

56. **Implementation arrangements.** The ESMF includes the implementation arrangements for the safeguards compliance which involve the establishment of the Central Project Implementation Unit (CPIU) to ensure effective collaboration between the Environmental and Social Safeguards Specialist (International Technical Assistance – ITA) and the national safeguards expert, along with other specialized staff. Additional national safeguards specialists will be recruited by the AE to conduct the assessment of environmental and social baseline and impacts after the target location is identified. Within the CPIU, the abovementioned experts will be responsible for ensuring that screenings of VLAPs are undertaken prior to implementation, and then mitigate for any medium-risk activities using the project ESMP and implementation safeguards documents developed during project implementation, based on the screening. The collaborative approach will allow for specificity under each project area and for the nature of associated activities, rather than blanketing all sites with the same mitigation measures. The Safeguards ITA, national safeguards specialist and Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist will manage the monitoring and evaluation (M&E) and reporting for the environmental and social safeguards aspects of the project, working closely with the project's M&E team.

57. **Stakeholder engagement and information disclosure.** The AE provides a summary of the stakeholder consultations and a stakeholder engagement plan (SEP) as part of the proposal in Annex 7. The SEP includes a stakeholder analysis, summarizes the consultations conducted with relevant institutions and communities during the concept and project preparation stages, and describes the principles, procedures and specific requirements for continued engagement and consultation with relevant stakeholders during the project implementation.

58. The SEP also outlines the requirements on information disclosure, considering the needs for marginalized groups and the challenges of potential illiteracy. To ensure that they are adequately informed and consulted throughout the project implementation process, the AE will (i) ensure effective communication and disclosure of project information to local stakeholders in their native languages, and (ii) disclose and disseminate project information in local languages through various media including announcements in community forums, market days, picture-based texts and through radio and television broadcasts.

59. **Grievance redress mechanism (GRM).** The project will follow four parallel GRM systems, namely: (i) a community-based system; (ii) a formal system designed specifically for the project; (iii) the AE's own institutional FAO complaints procedure through the Office of the Inspector General; and (iv) the GCF independent Redress Mechanism. While all four GRMs will be available to address any complaints related to the project that may arise during

implementation, the community-based GRM system will be used based on the existing traditional structures to facilitate grievance resolution at higher levels, including the court of law, where necessary. In line with the GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy, the GCF indigenous peoples focal point will be available for assistance at any stage, including before a claim has been made.

60. **Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH).** The revised GCF Environmental and Social Policy adopted by decision B.BM-2021/18 requires safeguarding from SEAH in GCF-financed activities. The accredited entity (AE) provided SEAH safeguarding in its submission for this funding proposal. The project identifies SEAH as a significant risk. As a mitigative measure, the AE outlines programme interventions to reduce SEAH-related risks, including the Dimitra Clubs and the Household Methodology. The proposed interventions will facilitate open discussions on gender-based violence (GBV) and SEAH in more particular within households and in the community. Other steps include interventions to improve environmental and social outcomes by reducing inequalities and eliminating gender-related barriers within the project through mainstreaming social inclusion and sensitivity towards vulnerable groups. With regard to a grievance redress mechanism (GRM) for SEAH, the AE will prioritize the needs of survivors and incorporate a gender-responsive perspective, and facilitate access to relevant services and redress mechanisms for those affected by SEAH. The AE will also implement a comprehensive GRM that comprises four parallel systems: (i) a community-based system; (ii) a project-specific formal system (project-level GRM); (iii) the approach of FAO to the GRM (FAO-level GRM); and (iv) the GCF Independent Redress Mechanism. Project-related SEAH and GBV grievances will be managed through the existing FAO GRM system, which will also be strengthened to include an inclusive, survivor-centred, and gender-responsive procedure for handling SEAH. This will be complemented by GBV referral pathways, established and operationalized under the project in collaboration with the United Nations Population Fund. These pathways will provide medical care, psychosocial support, legal assistance, and social/reintegration support. Risks and effectiveness of mitigation measures will be reviewed and monitored by tracking activities, assessing the project's progress, and providing guidance and recommendations.

4.2 Gender policy

61. The AE provided a gender assessment and action plan with the funding proposal and therefore, complies with the requirements of the updated GCF Gender Policy. The gender action plan has been integrated in the project's overall work plan to ensure that the gender mainstreaming approach is effective and to reduce the risk of treating gender equality and women's empowerment as an add-on. The gender assessment and its accompanying gender action plan build on primary data collected through community consultations. The main sectors of the project – agriculture, food security/nutrition, Water, Sanitation and Hygiene for All and policy are analysed through a gender lens. The project will take a more in-depth approach to the gendered dimensions of food insecurity and nutrition and includes actions to address the root causes of gender inequalities by engaging traditional and religious leaders. The risk of possible resistance to addressing sensitive topics such as hegemonic masculinity and patriarchy is recognized as a separate risk factor, and there is a clearer needs analysis which takes intersectionality and differences into consideration. Lastly, the results framework is revised to include indicators to measure qualitative changes related to gender equality and women's role in society.

4.3 Risks

4.3.1. Programme-specific execution risks (low risk)

62. Political risk: development priorities and policies may change after next elections in 2025 and if these changes materialize it will hamper the overall long-term project impact. The AE is responsible to notify the Secretariat during the life of the project of any material and adverse changes to the risk assessment, including changes in government policy and strategic directions, changes in the project governance, emerging risks that might have an impact on the project, its activities, and its implementation modalities.

63. Foreseeable extreme weather events: Malawi is prone to floods that may impact restoration efforts under component 1.2, but the AE adequately factored this risk into the project design.

64. Co-financing: The MoF co-financing through the Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise Programme (FARMSE) is significant and key to project impact and project sustainability after GCF exit, and the MoF has already provided evidence of committed financing. If committed financing does not become available, the AE will notify GCF and will use reasonable endeavours to seek alternative source of co-financing.

4.3.2. Compliance risk (medium risk)

65. Malawi is not currently subject to United Nations Security Council resolutions, nor is it currently identified on the Financial Action Task Force's lists of high-risk jurisdictions or jurisdictions under increased monitoring relating to anti-money laundering and countering the financing of terrorism (AML/CFT). In addition, the funding proposal assesses the risk of money-laundering and terrorist financing as low in terms of probability and impact, and the agreement between the AE and the Government of Malawi includes AML/CFT clauses. Annex 20 to the funding proposal – First level AML/CFT (KYC [Know-Your-Customer]) assessment – provides additional details regarding internal controls, including policies and procedures related to AML/CFT and prohibited practices. However, factors such as a largely cash-based economy and the country's porous borders with neighbouring countries contribute to heightened money laundering risks. As such, this project is deemed to be medium risk from a compliance perspective.

4.3.3. GCF portfolio concentration risk (low risk)

66. In case of approval, the impact of this proposal on the GCF portfolio concentration in terms of results area and single proposal is not material.

4.3.4. Recommendation

67. It is recommended that the Board consider the above factors in its decision.

Summary risk assessment	
Overall programme	Medium
Programme-specific execution	Low
GCF portfolio concentration	Low
Compliance	Medium

4.4 Fiduciary

68. FAO will serve as the accredited entity for this project. FAO via the FAO Representation in Malawi will also act as the executing entity (EE) and will ensure strong country-driven

execution of project activities and will oversee the execution of selected activities funded by GCF proceeds based on its comparative advantages.

69. FAO as the accredited entity of GCF will have overall responsibility for quality assurance and oversight of co-executing entities, and shall assume fiduciary responsibility in accordance with FAO standards and procedures. In addition to this, FAO will be responsible for the financial execution of GCF funds according to FAO rules and regulations mainly contained and detailed in the FAO Administrative Manual (including those referred to financial monitoring, audit, and procurement).

70. The MoF, MoA, and FAO will provide co-financing to the project in the form of cash (grant) for MoF, in-kind for MoA, and cash (grant) for FAO. The co-financiers are responsible for the reporting of co-financing activities and their disbursement amount to the AE in accordance with the detailed provisions outlined in the GCF policies as well as the accreditation master agreement (AMA), funded activity agreement between FAO and GCF, and the co-financing agreement signed between the co-financier and FAO in its capacity as AE.

71. GCF proceeds received by FAO in its capacity as accredited entity will flow to the co-executing entities, namely the FAO Representation in Malawi, MoA/Department of Land Resources and Conservation, National Local Government Finance Committee and MoF/FARMSE for the implementation of project activities. The provisions regarding MoF/FARMSE and MoA/Department of Land Resources and Conservation responsibilities, both as EEs and co-financiers, as well as National Local Government Finance Committee responsibilities as EE, together with all financial details, will be included in the project agreement, which will also serve as subsidiary agreement, signed by the Government of Malawi.

72. Financial management and control and procurement processes will be implemented as per FAO rules and regulations, which were certified as acceptable to GCF in the FAO accreditation process.

73. During implementation, FAO will provide oversight and quality assurance in accordance with its policies and procedures. This may include monitoring missions, spot checks and participation at project governance meetings. The project will be audited internally and externally following FAO's financial regulations.

74. The FAO Country Representative in Malawi is responsible for financial monitoring and is supported by a management team comprised of a Program Assistant, Management Assistant, and a Strategic Operations Officer. This team will interact and support the work of the CPIU.

4.5 Results monitoring and reporting

75. The funding proposal is based on a clear theory of change and logical framework, that together could facilitate effective results monitoring and reporting. These tools, along with the M&E plan that sets out the budget and data sources and data collection methods, are consistent with the requirements of the Integrated Results Management Framework and the GCF Evaluation Policy.

76. The theory of change illustrates how the combination of sustainable management of landscapes and watershed ecosystems improved the capacity of farmers to implement climate-resilient agriculture alongside improved access to markets, and policies that are conducive to climate change adaptation and climate finance could lead to improved climate resilience for rural communities and reduced GHG emissions. Critical assumptions that underlie this relationship have been identified and include the uptake of integrated landscape management by farmers, engagement of the financial and private sectors, enabling sociocultural factors for women and youth, and recovery of the country from the COVID-19 pandemic. Hence, the assumptions captured the broader economic and political environment and cultural dynamics.

In the Malawian context where markets are thin and in places even non-existent, the role of the financial and private sectors to achieve the desired climate outcomes would be important.

77. The logical framework contains the main outcomes of interest such as GHG emissions reduced (core indicator 1), direct and indirect beneficiaries reached (core indicator 2), beneficiaries who adopted more climate-resilient livelihoods (supplementary indicator 2.1), and natural resources restored and brought under improved management (core indicator 4 and supplementary indicator 4.1). The means of verification have been improved to systematically include both primary and secondary data collection as well as qualitative and quantitative data sources. Some output-level indicators have been strengthened to demonstrate better the logical progression between results levels. However, some indicators (e.g. training delivered), which the AE decided to retain, are arguably activity-level indicators.

78. The M&E budget includes provision for important roles such as specialist skills on the Geographic Information System and additional M&E resources at the regional and national levels. The budget allocated for the interim and final evaluations as well as the collection of evaluative data complies with the requirements of the GCF Evaluation Policy and can realistically support evaluative activities in Malawi.

4.6 Legal assessment

79. The Accreditation Master Agreement was signed with the Accredited Entity on 8 June 2018 (the “AMA”), and it became effective on 4 October 2018. The Accredited Entity’s five-year accreditation term lapsed on 3 October 2023 but was extended by Decision B.37/18, paragraph (q), until the earlier of three years from the date of lapse of the five-year accreditation term or the date on which a revised accreditation framework is adopted by the Board. The Board approved the re-accreditation of the Accredited Entity pursuant to Decision B.37/18, and negotiation of the Amended and Restated Accreditation Master Agreement is ongoing.

80. The Accredited Entity has provided a legal opinion/certificate confirming that it has obtained all internal approvals, and that it has the capacity and authority to implement the project.

81. The proposed project will be implemented in the Republic of Malawi in which GCF is not provided with privileges and immunities. This means that, among other things, GCF is not protected against litigation or expropriation in this country, the risks of which need to be further assessed. The Secretariat submitted the first draft of the privileges and immunities agreement to Malawi in 2015. In 2023 Malawi expressed an interest in restarting the discussions on the Privileges and Immunities Agreement. The latest discussion in that regard was held in February 2023.

82. The Heads of the Independent Redress Mechanism and Independent Integrity Unit have both expressed that it would not be legally feasible to undertake their redress activities and/or investigations, as appropriate, in countries where GCF is not provided with relevant privileges and immunities. Therefore, it is recommended that disbursements by GCF are made only after GCF has obtained satisfactory protection against litigation and expropriation in the country, or has been provided with appropriate privileges and immunities.

83. In order to mitigate risk, it is recommended that any approval by the Board is made subject to the following conditions:

- (a) Signature of the Funded Activity Agreement in a form and substance satisfactory to the Secretariat within 180 days of the date of Board approval; and
- (b) Completion of the legal due diligence to the satisfaction of the Secretariat.

Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment of FP238

Proposal name:	Ecosystems-based Adaptation for Resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)
Accredited entity:	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)
Country:	Republic of Malawi
Project/programme size:	Medium

I. Assessment of the independent Technical Advisory Panel

1. This funding proposal¹ for a medium-sized cross-cutting project in environmental and social safeguards Category B is submitted by the Government of Malawi through the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) which will be the accredited entity (AE). The two executing entities (EEs) are FAO and the Government of Malawi acting through three state entities: the Ministry of Agriculture, the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs, and the National Local Government Finance Committee.
2. The total cost of the proposed project is USD 53.22 million, of which USD 42.81 million is proposed as GCF finance and USD 10.41 million is co-finance from FAO and the Government of Malawi (see section 1.6 below).
3. The project objective is to increase the climate-change resilience of the most vulnerable rural communities at watershed level in Malawi, in 11 districts (out of 28 districts in the country) that have a combination of high exposure and/or sensitivity to climate change, with low capacity to adapt positively to climate change impacts. These districts are: Dedza in the centre; Zomba, Mangochi, Thyolo, Neno, Mwanza, Nsanje in the south; and Nkhata Bay, Rumphu, Karonga and Chitipa in the north.
4. In these districts, increases in temperature, rainfall variability and intense precipitation events are leading to increased frequency and intensity of disasters such as floods, droughts and landslides, which are interacting with directly human-caused soil erosion and land degradation reducing agricultural productivity and causing human suffering. The project aims to be a catalyst for a shift for ecosystems, livelihoods and agriculture in the country, from their baseline states of high vulnerability to an alternative paradigm in which watershed ecosystems are conserved, restored and sustainably managed, enabling these systems to adapt to climate change and continue supplying services to rural communities as the climate evolves.
5. To achieve this, the project will promote an ecosystems-based adaptation (EbA) approach – within the framework of participatory planning for integrated landscape management – to repair degraded ecosystems, and promote low-carbon climate resilient agricultural practices. This involves working through existing local governance structures to develop integrated landscape/watershed management plans, already provided for in the legislation of Malawi, applying an ecosystems-based approach. The sub-catchment and village plans will then be implemented through a range of interventions on communal land, including: soil and water conservation for erosion and run-off control (with contour bunds, swales, brush fill, gully plugs and check dams); natural forest protection; assisted natural regeneration; community forest and woodlot management; pastureland management; riverbank protection;

¹ Funding proposal package for “Ecosystems-based Adaptation for Resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi”, received from FAO on 3 May 2024.

and off-farm economic activities (beekeeping, harvesting of forest products such as baobab, moringa and medicinal plants).

6. At farm level, technical assistance will promote agroecological approaches that can also be regarded as EbA, including: use of climate-resilient crop species/varieties which are local, native and/or well-adapted; crop diversification for better nutrition; agroforestry; integrated pest management; and agronomic techniques for soil and water conservation. The project will support producers in accessing markets and finance for further resilience investments, and will enhance the enabling institutional and financial environment for scaling up of EbA approaches nationally.

7. The project involves implementation of three interlinked technical components (as well as monitoring and evaluation, and project management, not shown below):

Component	Outcome	GCF funding	Co-finance
1. Integrated landscape management	Reduced greenhouse gas emissions from improved watershed ecosystems, and Increased climate resilience of watershed ecosystems	USD 4.29 million	USD 0.31 million
2. Resilient livelihoods and food systems	Stabilized productivity and farmers' incomes through more resilient livelihoods and food systems	USD 13.91 million	USD 8.61 million
3. Enabling institutional and financial environment	Enhanced enabling environment to sustain, replicate and scale up climate resilient watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices	USD 0.83 million	USD 0.36 million

1.1 Impact potential

Scale: Medium to High

8. The project is cross-cutting, with 95 per cent of GCF resources considered as contributing to adaptation to climate change, and 5 per cent towards climate change mitigation. The three targeted adaptation results areas are: enhancing the resilience of (i) most vulnerable people and communities; (ii) health and well-being, and food and water security; and (iii) ecosystems and ecosystem services.

9. **Adaptation impact.** The funding proposal highlights the vulnerability of Malawi to climate change, with drought caused by rising temperatures and more erratic rainfall; and floods, wind damage and landslides caused by the increasing frequency and intensity of tropical storms and cyclones. In all targeted districts, climate change effects will alter the onset of the rainy season, translating into limited water availability at key growing times, and increased water stress, with negative impacts on both cash and subsistence crops, and the overall rural economy and society.

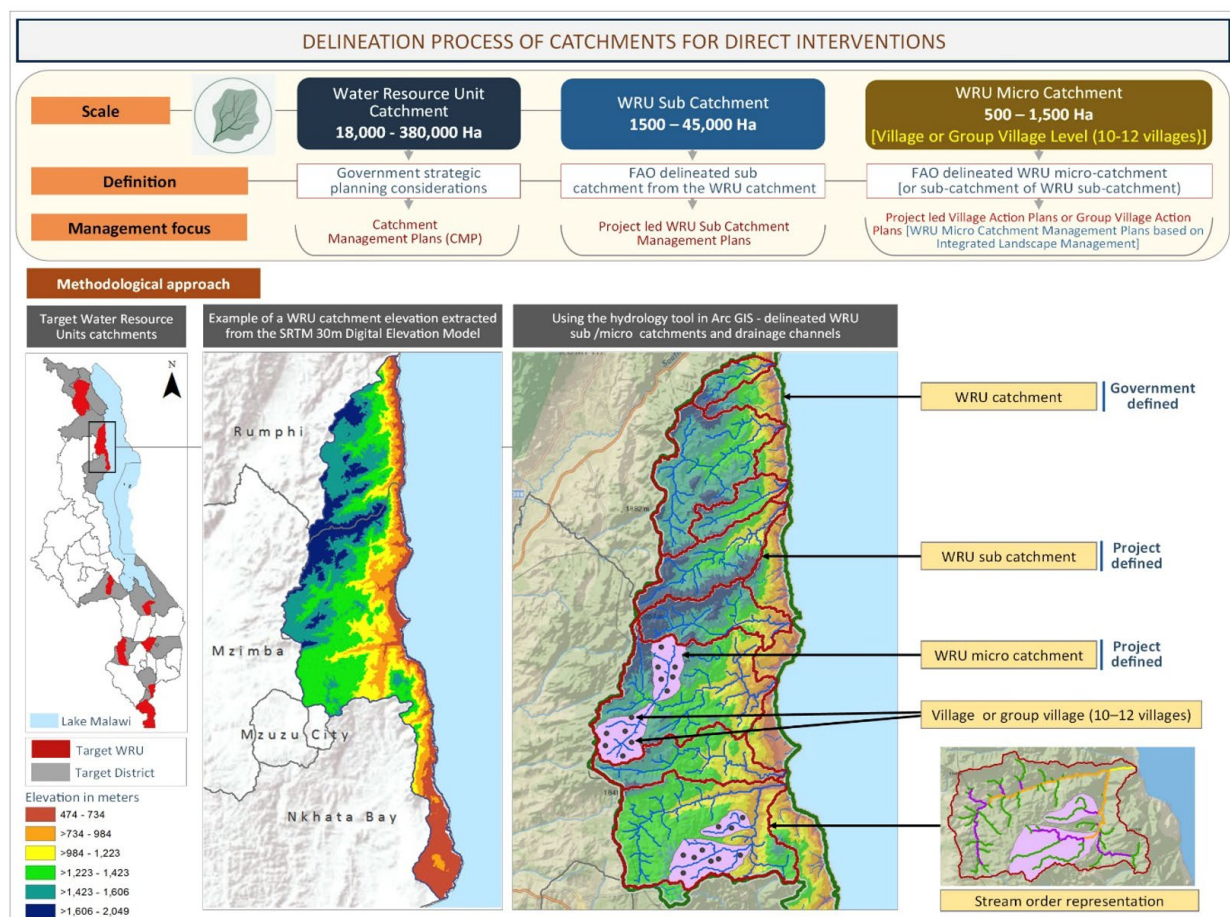
10. The project is expected to directly benefit around 270,820 members of smallholder farm households in the 11 districts pre-identified for their high vulnerability to climate change (methodology detailed in feasibility study, annex 2 to the funding proposal). These will be residents of the 111 micro-catchments to be selected according to hydrological, ecological and socioeconomic factors, from the 30 target Water Resource Unit sub-catchments within the prioritized districts. An average micro-catchment will contain 10 villages in a cluster (see Figure 8.3.4 from the funding proposal, reproduced below), so that they are ecologically linked and can benefit from interventions at the landscape scale.

11. Annex 2 to the funding proposal provides detail on how the projected number of beneficiaries for each of the various capacity-building and extension activities was calculated, and the assumptions made in these calculations. The vulnerability of these communities to drought and flood damage will be reduced through collective investments in the landscape, and

on-farm investments in productivity and diversification, with support on value addition and access to markets, will reduce their vulnerability to unpredictable growing conditions.

12. More than 300,000 people in villages that are not part of the targeted micro-catchments, but are included in the selected sub-catchments, are considered to be indirect beneficiaries of the project. Almost 70,000 households will not receive targeted support, but “will receive a measurable adaptation benefit thanks to well-functioning Sub-Catchment Management Committees and EbA Sub-Catchment Management Plans developed under Component 1”. Based on this, the total number of project beneficiaries is estimated at nearly 575,000 people, of which just over half are women. Neither the funding proposal nor annex 2 explain specifically what indirect benefits are expected to flow from this improved planning environment, but these could be assumed to include downstream benefits from catchment restoration, including reduced flood damage and siltation from erosion, and increased availability of groundwater from infiltration.

Figure 8.3.4 from the funding proposal: Delineation of micro-catchments within Water Resource Unit sub-catchments



13. The project’s adaptation impact has the potential to be significant, but the extent to which this can be quantified, measured and reported remains unclear, since the detailed monitoring and evaluation (M&E) framework will be developed only during project implementation, which poses some risks for fulfilling this potential. The indicators in the logical framework (funding proposal section E.6) are incomplete. In relation to resilient livelihoods and food systems, for example, no baseline information is yet in place for the indicators of stability of household income, stability of crop yields, or volume of crop sales, nor any clear methodology for assessing change, other than mentions of records, surveys and evaluations. For the number

of hectares to be brought under improved low-emission and climate-resilient management practices, the iTAP welcomes the inclusion of a specific means of verification for this indicator – through tracking the “land area showing an increase in Normalised Difference Vegetation Index” – to be determined through remote sensing data and ground truthing, though again it will be crucial to establish the baseline against which changes will be monitored, and to clarify the relationship between this top-down monitoring and the bottom-up monitoring of coverage of landscape interventions.

14. **Mitigation impact.** Climate change mitigation through anticipated avoided and reduced greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions as a result of project interventions, is expected to total 2,750,323 tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (t CO₂ eq) over 20 years, or an average of 137,516 t CO₂ eq per year, contributing to the GCF forestry and land-use results area. This will be achieved through communal landscape interventions and household on-farm interventions, both of which involve changes in how forest, cropland and grassland are managed, to capture and store more carbon above and below ground.

15. FAO’s own Ex-Ante Carbon Balance Tool (Ex-ACT) has been used to estimate in detail the anticipated impact over 20 years of the resultant carbon sequestration and avoided degradation, with results and methodology detailed in annex 22 to the funding proposal. In response to a written question from the iTAP about why there is only one sentence about monitoring, reporting and verification in annex 22, the AE elaborated on the planned process. The M&E Geographical Information Systems specialist in the central Project Implementation Unit will be trained on Ex-ACT, and will run the tool based on activity data collected through the M&E system, with an M&E manual detailing the system to be developed and disseminated at inception stage, describing the data sampling and analysis methodology.²

16. In response to a question from the iTAP about how precisely the list of landscape and on-farm interventions to be tracked by the M&E specialist and technical experts from non-governmental organizations will be related to the complex set of management changes quantified in the ex-ante estimates, the AE developed a more detailed table that is useful in clarifying these relationships as the basis for the detailed M&E plan (including mitigation monitoring, reporting and verification) that is still to be developed. The table shows, for example, that the Ex-ACT change in management from cropland under full tillage and low carbon input (business as usual) to cropland under improved management with reduced tillage and higher input of organic material (with project) is derived from Component 1 activities on soil and water conservation and agroforestry, as well as Component 2.1’s Farmer Field School support to conservation agriculture, manure management, reduced or zero tillage and the use of cover crops and residues. The iTAP trusts that, in developing the M&E plan, the AE will spell out these linkages in a clear system for tracking and reporting on parcels of land successfully brought under new management practices, such that the area under changed management practice can be taken as a proxy indicator of enhanced carbon sequestration/reduced emissions, as per the Ex-ACT calculator methodology.

17. The iTAP assesses the impact potential of the project as medium to high.

1.2 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: Medium

18. The proposed project aims to be a catalyst for a broad shift for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture in the country, from their baseline state of very high vulnerability to an alternative paradigm in which watershed ecosystems are conserved, restored, and sustainably managed, thus granting their adaptation to climate change and their supply of services to communities, people and their farming systems.

² Additional written responses from FAO to the iTAP on 24 May 2024.

19. **Upscaling and replication.** The project design includes several features to enhance sustainability, including using existing local governance structures and plans as the basis for planning village and catchment-level EbA interventions in Component 1, and integrating village plans into district plans. In response to a question from the iTAP on how replication will occur beyond the sites, the AE highlighted that each Sub-Catchment Management Plan (SCMP) under the project will cover beneficiary as well as non-beneficiary villages. Non-beneficiary villages will thus be exposed to and can learn from their neighbours' activities on village planning and natural resource management.³ This kind of learning – simply through proximity – seems optimistic, particularly given the scattering of the 111 micro-catchments across the country in 11 non-contiguous districts. This does not contribute to a clear pathway to scale, that is necessary for the country to eventually achieve wall-to-wall coverage of catchment and village plans and governance structures.

20. Component 2 supports upscaling through incentives to the private sector to partner with EbA producers, and uses government extension staff to support and learn from the implementation of agro-ecological approaches and Farmer Field Schools. Component 3 directly tackles the enabling institutional and financial environment, aiming to leverage climate finance and to mainstream EbA approaches and practices into policies, sectoral planning and financing, including government budgets, based on evidence generation on the benefits of EbA, best practices and cases studies, and the preparation and implementation of a policy-influencing plan. On the finance side there will be support to local financing institutions to develop new products for financing EbA, with assistance from the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs by integrating climate change responses into the existing “Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise” (FARMSE) project. These local financial institutions will be linked to sources of capital, helping to trigger investment into them, so that they can step up their EbA lending to smallholder producers.

21. **Sustainability of results.** Overall, the project relies heavily on temporarily funding a large number of facilitators and consultants to provide capacity development, input delivery and extension support. Although it is positive that these project-funded personnel will cooperate and share learning with Ministry of Agriculture extension staff and other officials, it may be difficult to sustain this level of support once the project implementation period ends. It seems likely that similar fiscal constraints to those highlighted in relation to the needs of the recipient country will still be in place after six years, making it difficult for government to absorb these posts into the public sector wage budget, and impossible to create these kinds of positions across the country. This means that sustaining results in the target districts and the scaling up of SCMPs and Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs) to other sub-catchments in the target districts, and to other districts in the country, may remain dependent on future donor investments.

22. Preparing to access voluntary carbon markets in future is presented as a part of the project's exit strategy, and this is welcomed by the iTAP, although the degree of success will depend on many factors beyond the project's control. The project itself will take only a limited step in this direction, developing a baseline by taking an inventory of carbon stocks in the project districts and catchments (including biomass measurements, forestry inventory, and soil testing), using an existing methodology developed through the Restore Africa Programme, and sharing lessons through a knowledge platform.

23. Also relevant are the project's efforts to leverage climate finance through support to the National Climate Change Fund (NCCF) and two conservation trust funds, but the strategy relies heavily on supporting NCCF to become accredited to GCF, and supporting the Malawi Environmental Endowment Trust to utilize the GCF Project Specific Accreditation Approach modality and/or become accredited. While the inclusion of feasibility studies on innovative financing instruments is welcomed, including debt for nature swaps for the Malawi

³ Written questions from the iTAP to FAO 17 May 2024; responses received 23 May 2024.

Environmental Endowment Trust, and a potential study for NCCF on green bonds, there is no discussion on specific potential long-term and sustainable domestic revenue sources for ongoing replenishment of the funds.

24. Overall, based on the above, the paradigm shift potential of the project is assessed as medium.

1.3 Sustainable development potential

Scale: High

25. The proposed project is aligned with the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, including contributions towards the country's efforts to meet Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) 1: no poverty; SDG 2: zero hunger; SDG 3: good health and well-being; SDG 5: gender equality; SDG 13: climate action; and SDG 15: life on land. Specific co-benefits anticipated from project interventions are discussed below.

26. **Socioeconomic benefits.** The project's farm-level EbA or agro-ecological approach through activity 2.1 intends to support small-scale farmers to improve soil fertility and increase crop yields, which can improve household nutrition levels, and potentially food security. Activities to increase yields of cash crops, and enable diversification to new products, should also contribute to poverty alleviation, as they increase household incomes. This is, of course, dependent on the success of activity 2.2. in supporting farmers to access markets through new offtake agreements and logistics support.

27. **Environmental benefits.** By scaling up EbA practices in the landscape through activity 1.2, the project will generate environmental benefits through better land and water use, improved soil quality and water conservation. Revegetation of slopes and riverbanks will reduce soil erosion, preventing downstream sedimentation of waterbodies and dams.

28. Although not specifically highlighted in section D.3 of the funding proposal, the project will also have significant biodiversity benefits. In response to a question on this from the iTAP⁴ the AE confirmed that "[t]hese benefits include: (i) increased availability of indigenous, "lost" plant species, and landraces, for their conservation and promotion. This will be achieved thanks to (a) the training of Farmer Field Schools facilitators on EbA practices (activity 2.1.1) such as agrobiodiversity and local knowledge; and (b) by establishing gene banks/nurseries at community level (activity 2.1.3) to improve agrobiodiversity in situ; (ii) restored or transformed watersheds and food production systems through the introduction of native and well-adapted varieties and species to increase biodiversity [in a system currently dominated by maize mono-production]; and (iii) farming practices based on agroecology, which do not rely on synthetic agrochemicals."⁵ In addition, it could be assumed that improved farming practices, including mulching and manuring, will increase soil organic matter and microbial biodiversity – critical for soil fertility and agricultural productivity.⁶

29. **Gender and social inclusion.** The project will contribute to gender equality and empowerment of women, helping to implement the National Gender Policy and address socioeconomic inequalities exacerbated by climate change. The project will incentivize women's access to labour-saving technologies, nutrition-sensitive and early maturing crop varieties, as well as productivity-enhancing assets. It will ensure the full engagement and participation of women in Farmer Field Schools, and will train extension workers on gender and social inclusion. GCF funds of USD 2.4 million (see annex 4 – sub-activity 1.1.2.2) will be used for the establishment of Dimitra Clubs, a significant investment in FAO's flagship programme for

⁴ Written questions from the iTAP to FAO 17 May 2024; responses received 23 May 2024.

⁵ Additional written responses received by the iTAP from FAO on 24 May 2024.

⁶ Microorganisms in soil regulate the flow of nutrients to plants, decompose organic matter, play a key role in nitrogen-fixing and help to detoxify pollutants. By colonizing plant roots and creating long fungal filaments called mycorrhizae, microbial fungi can massively extend the roots' reach – critical in conditions of water scarcity.

empowerment of women and youth, which will cover a challenging set of discussion topics – including gender-based violence and sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment, and masculinities and patriarchy. These funds also cover the application of the Household Methodology,⁷ a participatory methodology for family members to work together to improve their relations, decision-making and share of workloads. The project will facilitate participation of vulnerable groups such as female heads of household, female youth and girls, and persons living with HIV/AIDS.

30. The iTAP assesses the sustainable development potential of the project as high.

1.4 Needs of the recipient

Scale: High

31. As highlighted in the funding proposal, Malawi is a least developed country, ranks low in the United Nations Development Programme Human Development Index, and is among the 20 most vulnerable countries according to the Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative Index 2021. The high exposure of Malawi to climate change can be characterized by the rise of temperatures, rainfalls becoming more erratic, and increased frequency of climate-change induced disasters, including droughts and floods. Moreover, the country is very sensitive to climate change because of its high population density and growth, seriously degraded landscapes and ecosystems, and large rural population in deepening poverty with high food insecurity. Adaptive capacity is constrained by the limited literacy rate and low level of human development, including for youth and women who are subject to unemployment and economic exclusion, with women further subject to unwanted pregnancies, high maternal deaths, sexually transmitted infections and gender-based violence.

32. The project targets particularly vulnerable communities with severe adaptation needs in the 11 targeted districts, where climate change effects will alter the onset of the rainy season, resulting in limited and modified water availability and increased water stress. This will have negative impacts on both cash and subsistence crops, resulting in adverse effects on the overall rural economy and society. Production of the main staple crops in Malawi, including maize, cassava and pigeon pea, are expected to experience major annual decreases in yield, with corresponding loss of household nutrition.⁸ Communities under increased pressure from declining crop yields may resort to a vicious cycle of maladaptation, unsustainable land use, and harm to natural ecosystems. Shortages of vital ecosystem goods and services will, in turn, worsen agricultural production shortages.

33. The funding proposal states that the proposed 100 per cent concessionality of GCF funding for the project is motivated by the high risk of overall debt distress in Malawi. It is difficult for the country to meet its needs through debt finance for a paradigm shift towards climate-resilient agricultural practices and land restoration. Although the figures on the country's indebtedness in the funding proposal are three years out of date, the iTAP notes that the country had a debt-to-gross domestic product ratio of 74.5 per cent in 2023, while sovereign debt had increased to USD 10 billion.⁹

34. Overall, based on the above, the iTAP rates the needs of recipients as high.

1.5 Country ownership

Scale: High

⁷ Another name for the FAO Gender Action Learning System (GALS).

⁸ Hunter, R. *et al.*, 2020. *Climate Change and Future Crop Suitability in Malawi*. Rome: University of Cape Town and International Fund for Agricultural Development.

⁹ www.worlddeconomics.com/GrossDomesticProduct/Debt-to-GDP-Ratio/Malawi.aspx#:~:text=GDP%20in%20Malawi%20is%20officially,debt%20level%20is%20%2410%20Billion.

35. The design of the proposed project has been carried out hand-in-hand with a National Project Preparation Task Team (comprising several government staff and partners, see annex 7 to the funding proposal), with strong stakeholder engagement, and government will be closely engaged during implementation, as an EE. Community ownership, key for behavioural change and sustainability, is embedded in the project, notably through its participatory community engagement, locally-led climate adaptation approach and collective learning approaches.

36. **Policy and strategy alignment.** The proposed project is well aligned with the country's policies and strategies – including the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy III (2017–2022), the nationally determined contribution (NDC), the National Agricultural Investment Plan 2017–2023, the National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy (2017) and the National Resilience Strategy 2018–2030. By integrating climate change adaptation into SCMPs and VLAPs, the project will support implementation of the Decentralization Act (1998), which devolves powers and funding from the central government to districts. It is also consistent with the Environmental Management Act (2017), the National Water Resources Act (2013), the new National Disaster Risk Management Act of 2023 (the bill is referenced in the funding proposal) and implementation of the National Resilience Strategy (2018–2030).

37. For adaptation, the NDC of Malawi (as updated in July 2021) puts emphasis on EbA, integrated catchment conservation and management, and capacity development in resilient agronomic practices and water conservation technologies for smallholder farmers. These interventions are also in line with the country's national adaptation plan, currently under development with financial support from GCF. For mitigation, the updated NDC includes an indicative emissions reduction contribution from the forestry and land use sector, through implementation measures including afforestation, riparian restoration, agroforestry and sustainable forest and landscape management, with adaptation and resilience co-benefits highlighted. In the agriculture sector, dealt with separately, relevant practices are proposed under crop management, including efficient use of fertilizer (including crop residue and manure), crop rotation and improved tilling.

38. **Roles of key entities.** The two main EEs are FAO and the Government of Malawi. Approximately two-thirds of the GCF funding will be spent on activities executed through FAO Malawi, with a strict separation maintained between this role and the oversight role of FAO global as AE. Approximately one third of GCF funding will be spent on activities to be executed by the Government of Malawi acting through:

39. **The Ministry of Agriculture:** The ministry through its Department of Land Resources Conservation originated the project idea, and has been strongly engaged throughout. The ministry will be responsible for four planning sub-activities in Component 1 and for sub-activity 2.1.1.3 on extension support. Through its network of decentralized staff, the Ministry of Agriculture is in a good position to support FAO-executed parts of the project as well. It is also noted that FAO's Farmer Field Schools approach is already mainstreamed into national agricultural policy.

40. **The Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs:** The ministry is implementing the FARMSE initiative (funded by the International Fund for Agricultural Development), the framework of which is utilized by activity 2.3 to support community-based financial organizations in the project landscapes, and to strengthen support from local financial institutions to farmers and small and medium-sized enterprises.

41. **The National Local Government Finance Committee (NLGFC):** The NLGFC is the public body mandated to facilitate fiscal decentralization, financial management and local development in local government. The NLGFC will execute sub-activity 1.2.2.2, providing procurement services to the implementation of VLAPs, a key portion of the project.

42. **Engagement with stakeholders, including civil society.** Several stakeholder consultations were conducted during preparation, and are detailed in annex 7 to the funding

proposal, which also highlights how stakeholders will be engaged during implementation. Through national workshops, community engagement meetings at district level and field visits over 2021 and 2022, the wide range of stakeholders engaged included: the Director of the national designated authority; Government Ministries, including Agriculture, Finance, Climate Change and Natural Resources (10 relevant departments), the NLGFC; 8 non-governmental organizations; the Civil Society Network on Climate Change; international research institutions (including the Consultative Group on International Agricultural Research system); academia and knowledge centres; the private sector (National Smallholder Farmers' Association of Malawi, Illovo Sugar Company, Climate Asset Management, and Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation (HSBC)); conservation/environment trusts; savings and credit cooperatives, microfinance institutions, commercial and development banks; the National Water Resources Authority; other donor-funded projects; and agribusinesses and retail/distribution businesses.

43. The iTAP assesses country ownership of the project as high.

1.6 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: Medium

44. Of the project's total proposed budget of USD 53.22 million, 80 per cent (USD 42.81 million) is proposed to be a GCF grant, and 20 per cent (USD 10.41 million) is made up of co-financing to the project, closely woven into the project logic. The co-financing is as follows:

45. The Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs will provide USD 6.44 million in grant co-financing through the IFAD-funded FARMSE programme – supporting village savings and loans associations; linking commercial banks, microfinance institutions, savings and credit cooperative organizations, and insurance companies to climate financiers; and linking small and medium-sized enterprises to impact investors.

46. The Ministry of Agriculture will provide in-kind co-financing for a total amount of USD 2.95 million in the form of the time of district heads of agriculture, agriculture extension development officers and coordinators, and provision of venues for training of master trainers and facilitators.

47. FAO will provide USD 523,000 of grant co-financing through the Global Environment Facility -funded "Sustainable Forest Management, Dryland Sustainable Landscape Impact Programme" and USD 500,000 through FAO's Technical Cooperation Programme, covering elements serving both projects: a policy assessment and the preparation of a policy influencing plan; production of seeds and seedlings of native plant species; free, prior and informed consent consultations; and an environmental and social assessment. Through this co-financing, the project will form part of FAO's contribution to the long-term vision for complementarity between the Global Environment Facility and GCF.

48. The project also identified two opportunities for further leveraging of co-finance during project implementation. The first is the Restore Africa Programme (USD 17.5 million, started late 2022), financed by Climate Asset Management (joint venture between HSBC Asset Management and Pollination), and implemented by the Global Evergreening Alliance working through Catholic Relief Services in Malawi. The second opportunity is funding from the Malawi Agricultural and Industrial Investment Corporation for value addition to crops and forest products from the project landscapes.

49. **Economic rate of return.** The economic analysis conducted by the project proponents (see the economic and financial analysis in annex 3) quantifies societal benefits and weighs these against the costs of the project interventions. Benefits quantified include: (i) increased productivity on farmland, resulting from landscape restoration activities in Component 1 and support to producers in Component 2; (ii) additional post-production value through access to markets and finance, and entrepreneur development, in Component 2; (iii) a significant

reduction in greenhouse gas emissions as a result of improved management of croplands, grasslands and forest, as well as expansion of agroforestry; and (iv) additional benefits such as an increased production of non-timber forest products and provision of other ecosystem services.

50. The project as a whole is shown to have a positive return on investment, with a net present value of USD 68.5 million and an economic internal rate of return (EIRR) of 32.8 per cent, above the economic discount rate of 10 per cent. These results include the value of avoided GHG emissions using the low social carbon price. Using the high social price of carbon, the project EIRR increases to 54.6 per cent. Without the value of avoided GHG emissions, the project has a much lower, albeit still positive, EIRR of 12.7 per cent. The sensitivity analysis further shows that the project remains economically viable in different scenarios, including a decrease in benefits of 20 per cent and an increase in costs of 20 per cent.

51. **Financial rate of return.** The financial analysis considers the project investments in farmland (landscape restoration, promotion of climate-adaptive crop-farming, agroforestry and forest-based honey production) from the perspective of a beneficiary household. Costs and benefits are included in the activity models and valued at market costs or opportunity cost (for labour), with models created for each of the two main activity types in the two landscape types, as well as for honey production from beekeeping. Each of the five models compares the costs and benefits of the beneficiaries' activity with project and without project, and results are discounted using a discount rate of 14.2 per cent, based on the real interest rate paid by commercial or similar banks.

52. The analysis presents the internal rate of return (IRR) only for honey production, providing a high rate of return of 62 per cent, "because the investment in year 1 only amounts to producers' own capital contribution, since the rest is financed by a loan that is repaid in year 3". This loan is not mentioned in the funding proposal, or the feasibility study, though a proposed "payment for ecosystems services" approach to honey production is outlined, building on an interesting scheme piloted in Mitundu, Malawi, in which beekeepers lease trees from other farmers with forested land, with local chiefs as intermediaries, creating an incentive for these farmers to maintain the forest.¹⁰

53. No IRR is shown for the other four production models, with the funding proposal arguing that they represent shifts in agricultural practices based on annual crops with recurrent and variable costs, rather than a large upfront investment cost, without which "the return on investment is not a meaningful indicator". The results in annex 3 simply show that the other interventions would result in positive returns for beneficiaries, with net present values above zero. It is then somewhat confusing that the funding proposal states in paragraph 142 that "all financial models have... IRRs above the financial discount rate of 14.2 per cent". If this is in fact the case, then the provision of concessional loans rather than grants might have been more appropriate for some of the production activities, bearing in mind that FAO is not accredited with GCF for on-lending and/or blending (loans, equity and/or guarantees).

54. The funding proposal does not comment on the cost per tonne of CO₂ equivalent in avoided and reduced GHG emissions as a result of the project interventions. This is approximately USD 19 per tonne when considering the project as a whole, or USD 15 per tonne when considering only the GCF investment, which seems high for the type of interventions proposed.

55. The iTAP rates the project's overall efficiency and effectiveness as medium.

¹⁰ For leasing and maintenance of 50 trees, the Mitundu forest owners are paid USD 960 per year or USD 4,800 over five years. The trees are monitored, and can only be cut down in exceptional circumstances with the consent of the parties to the contract.

II. Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel

56. The iTAP believes that the project “Ecosystems-based Adaptation for Resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi” has been well planned, consulted and designed by FAO and the Government of Malawi. The project is an important one for reducing the vulnerability of small-scale farming households to climate change and contributing to the country’s goals for climate change mitigation in the agriculture, forestry and land use sectors.

57. The iTAP recommends that the Board approve this funding proposal.

Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment (FP238)

Proposal name:	Ecosystems-based Adaptation for Resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)
Accredited entity:	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)
Country:	Republic of Malawi
Project/programme size:	Medium

Impact potential
The AE would like to confirm that the detailed monitoring and evaluation (M&E) framework will be developed during FP implementation (at inception stage) in full alignment with the logical framework and internationally recognised tools/ guidance.
Paradigm shift potential
Climate-resilient investments in degraded watershed ecosystems are a priority in the country's policies and strategies, including the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy III (2017–2022), the nationally determined contribution (NDC), the National Agricultural Investment Plan 2017–2023, the National Forest and Landscape Restoration Strategy (2017) and the National Resilience Strategy 2018–2030. The EbA plans produced within the framework of the FP will be used to mobilize additional finance from the Central Government of Malawi to local governments, as per the 1998 Decentralisation Policy, to fulfil the above-mentioned priorities.
Sustainable development potential
The AE acknowledges that the overall sustainable development potential is assessed as high by ITAP.
Needs of the recipient
The AE acknowledges that the overall needs of the recipient is assessed as high by ITAP.
Country ownership
The AE acknowledges that the overall country ownership is assessed as high by ITAP.
Efficiency and effectiveness

As iTAP notes, FAO is not accredited for on-granting/loans. FAO FPs, like EbAM in Malawi, use GCF grant to provide support for farmers' transition to profitable climate resilient production activities, through interventions such as (but not limited to) preparation and implementation of Village Level Action Plans (VLAPs), and Farmer Field School (FFS). EbAM also provides, through FARMSE, technical support to financial institutions (banks, MFIs and community-based financial organisations - CBFOs) to develop suitable loan products for EbAM farmers to further invest in profitable climate adaptation solutions.

As per section A4, this FP is a cross-cutting project, primarily contributing to adaptation results areas. As such, it includes investment into participatory, community engagement, gender transformative and locally-led climate adaptation approaches (such as Integrated Land Management approach and VLAPs), as well as collective learning (such as FFS) which are included in the cost per tonne of CO₂ equivalent.

Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel:

The AE acknowledges iTAP overall assessment and recommendation for the Board approval.



**Food and Agriculture Organization
of the United Nations**

Annex 8

Gender assessment and project-level action plan

*For the GCF-FAO Project “Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds
and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)”*

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ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS

AEDC	Agriculture Extension District Coordinator
AEDO	Agriculture Extension Development Officer
AGRESSO	Agriculture Gender Roles Extension Support Services Offices
AIDS	Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome
ART	Anti-Retroviral Therapy
ASWAp	Agriculture Sector Wide Approach
BCC	Behaviour Change Communication
CAADP	Comprehensive Africa Agriculture Development Program
CBFOs	Community based financial organizations
CEDAW	Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women
CPR	Contraceptive Prevalence Rate
CRC	Convention on the Rights of Child
EbA	Ecosystems-based Adaptation
e-MTCT	Elimination of Mother to Child Transmission
DAES	Department of agriculture extension services
DAHLD	Department of Animal Health and Livestock Development
DPoA	Decade Plan of Action
GBV	Gender Based Violence
FFS	Farmer field schools
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
GDI	Gender Development Index
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GER	Gross Enrolment Rate
GHG	Greenhouse Gas
GII	Gender Inequality Index
GPI	Gender Parity Index
GNI	Gross National Income
HDI	Human Development Index
HHA	Household Approach
HIV	Human Immunodeficiency Virus
ICCPR	International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights
ICESCR	International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights
INC	Initial National Communication
INDC	Intended Nationally Determined Contribution
IFPRI	International Food Policy Research Institute
IHDI	Inequality-adjusted HDI

IPV	Intimate Partner Violence
HIS	Integrated Household Survey
JCE	Junior certificate education
LSMS	Living Standards Measurement Study
MANEB	Malawi National Examinations Board
MDHS	Malawi Demographic Heath Survey
MEGS	Malawi Economic Growth Strategy
MFIs	Microfinance Institutions
MGDS	Malawi Growth and Development Strategies
MICS	Multiple indicator cluster surveys
MIE	Malawi Institute of Education
MNLS	Malawi National Library Services
MoE	Ministry of Education
MoGCDSW	Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare
MPI	Multidimensional Poverty Index
MSCE	Malawi School Certificate of Education
NAIP	National Agriculture Investment Plan
NAP	National Adaptation Plan
NBSAP	National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan
NCCMP	National Climate Change Management Policy
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution
NEP	National Education Plan
NER	Net Enrolment Rate
NESIP	National education sector investment plan
NESP	National Education Sector Plan
NFAP	National Fisheries and Aquaculture Policy
NGO(s)	Non-Governmental Organization(s)
NLDP	National Livestock Development Policy
NPA	National Plan of Action
PAYE	Plan of Action for Youth Empowerment
PHC	Population and Housing Census
PICSA	Participatory integrated climate services for agriculture
PrEP	Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis
PMTCT	Prevention of Mother to Child Transmission
PSLC	Primary School Leaving Certificate
RHD	Reproductive Health Department
SACCOs	Savings and Credit Cooperatives
SADC	Southern African Development Community

SNC	Second National Communication
SRHR	Sexual Reproductive Health
SRHR	Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights
STI	Sexually Transmitted Infection
TAPE	Tool for Agroecology Performance Evaluation
TEVET	Technical, Entrepreneurial and Vocational Education and Training
TFR	Total Fertility Rate
TLMA	Traditional Land Management Areas
TNC	Third National Communication
TSC	Teaching Service Commission
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
UNFCC	United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
VMMC	Voluntary Male Medical Circumcision
WASH	Water Supply, Sanitation and Hygiene
WHO	World Health Organization

PART I: GENDER ASSESSMENT

1. INTRODUCTION

1. In Malawi, the agricultural sector accounts for about 42 percent of the country's Gross domestic product (GDP)¹. Whilst tobacco, tea and sugar represent important cash crops, about 80 percent of the food is produced by smallholder farmers². Smallholder production is characterized by low levels of inputs on small plots³ and low outputs. Livestock production is small compared to crops, and consists mainly of subsistence grazing of sheep, cattle, goats, poultry and pigs. The high reliance on natural resources makes Malawi particularly vulnerable to climate change. The climate crisis is already triggering more erratic and extreme weather, resulting in chronic water, food, and financial insecurity for millions. Over the past twenty years, droughts and floods have increased in intensity, frequency, and scale, causing devastating environmental, social, and economic damage⁴. Small scale farmers are most directly affected, although the influence of climate issues on food production and costs also impacts urban and non-farm households.

2. Women play a key role in Malawian agriculture. They account for 65 percent of smallholder farmers, perform between 50 and 70 percent of all agricultural tasks and produce 70 percent of locally consumed food⁵. Despite their high involvement in the sector, women face multiple constraints including very limited access and control over land, difficult access to farm inputs and labor-saving technologies and minimal access to financial resources. Women also have lower education levels and limited knowledge of improved agricultural practices, a situation that is worsened by limited access to information, inadequate provision of extension services to support their activities and less ability to practice more labor-intensive farming methods. Female-managed plots are, on average, 12 percent smaller than those of their male counterparts and 25 percent less productive⁶ as a result of differing levels of knowledge and access to inputs for improving farming efficiency⁷. The constraints and barriers highlighted above could also be exacerbated by climate change. Since water security is essential for agricultural production with around 9 out of 10 people in the country depend on rain-fed agriculture⁸, and since women generally have lower levels access to water technologies, such as irrigation, than men; women seems to be more affected by the country's critical water stress.

3. As it is the case for many countries in Sub-Saharan Africa, gender inequalities persist in Malawi. Given that patriarchy predominates, women have generally held a less privileged position compared to men. This situation is underpinned by different levels of education and knowledge, access to resources, decision-making authority and economic dependence. Gender roles are defined by traditional and cultural factors that intersect with other social identifiers, such as age, religion and ethnicity, and dictate the deemed appropriate behavior for men and women. Roles and relations are the results of social constructs, gender inequalities are reinforced by social norms, particularly in rural areas. The acceptance of male authority over women is transmitted

¹ Gender, agriculture and climate change in Malawi, Luanar, University of Leeds, Grantham Research Institute on Climate Change and the Environment, University of Kwazulu Natal, Kulima

² Ibid.

³ Over 75 percent of smallholder farmers cultivate less than one hectare (Ibid.)

⁴ Climate Change is Putting Women & Girls in Malawi at Greater Risk of Sexual Violence, Relief web, OCHA, August 2022

⁵ Gender, agriculture and climate change in Malawi, Luanar, University of Leeds, Grantham Research Institute on Climate Change and the Environment, University of Kwazulu Natal, Kulima

⁶ Levelling the Field: Improving Opportunities for Women Farmers in Africa, Michael O'Sullivan et al., World Bank, 2014

⁷ Caught in a Productivity Trap: A Distributional Perspective on Gender Differences in Malawian Agriculture, Policy Research Working Paper 6381, Kilic et al., World Bank, 2013

⁸ Climate Change is Putting Women & Girls in Malawi at Greater Risk of Sexual Violence, Relief web, OCHA, August 2022

both implicitly and explicitly through various institutions, including in homes, schools, churches and community gatherings.

4. One particular element to be considered in Malawian societies is the variation of succession pattern according to whether the district is governed by matrilineal or patrilineal system. In matrilineal system, women in the family inherit land and the man moves into the woman's family home after marriage. In patrilineal systems, inheritance is passed on to the sons and the woman moves in with her husband's family. Customary law in patrilineal system only gives women land-use rights acquired through kinship relationships and their status as wives, mothers, sisters and daughters. These rights are therefore linked to women's role as household food producers and do not grant enough security of tenure when marriage fails to subsist. Although women tend to have better access to land in matrilineal systems, men (wife's brothers in matrilineal societies) often remain the decision makers regarding access and control over land in both systems⁹. The patrilineal system is predominant in the Northern Region and two southern districts (Nsanje and Chikwawa), and the matrilineal system is prevalent in most of the central and Southern Region districts.

5. Awareness of the gender differences is essential to identify and address gender differences in agriculture and vulnerability to climate change. The combination of natural resource dependence and gendered challenges in terms of assets and resources' access shows that women are typically more vulnerable than men to climate change. Since the reality in the country could be more nuanced considering the existence of matrilineal and patrilineal societies, understanding prevailing gender context is necessary to determine the specific nature of men's and women's vulnerabilities and develop appropriate project interventions. Addressing gender inequality in agriculture in the context of climate change requires that project support, such as the promotion of integrated natural resources management and Ecosystems-based adaptation solutions, responds to the different needs of men and women farmers.

6. The Green Climate Fund (GCF) project, "Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi - EbAM," has the objective to increase climate-change resilience of rural communities at watershed level in Malawi. It aspires to be a catalyst for a broad shift for ecosystem, livelihoods and agriculture in the country, from their state of very high vulnerability to an alternative paradigm in which watershed ecosystems are restored, well-functioning and sustainably managed. The Gender Assessment conducted as part of the project design studies the socioeconomic conditions of women, men and youth targeted by the proposed project to shed light on gender-specific constraints, needs and opportunities for a strategic approach to the integration of gender dimensions into the project. The assessment has highlighted a number of climate change adaptation barriers facing women and youth that are of social, technical, commercial, financial and institutional nature; the project will address them to make sure that (i) women, men and youth have meaningful participation in the planning and implementation process to increase the climate resilience of integrated landscape/watershed ecosystem, (ii) women and female youth farmers' productivity and incomes are stabilized thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems, and that (iii) a gender-sensitive enabling environment (finance and policies) is enhanced to sustain and scale-up gender-sensitive and socially inclusive climate resilient landscape, watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices. To ensure gender mainstreaming is clearly visible in the design and implementation of project's activities and responses, a Gender Action Plan has been developed. It reinforces all project activities and sub-activities from a gender and social inclusion perspective, and includes clear

⁹ Country Profile Malawi, Landlinks, USAID, August 2010 (<https://www.land-links.org/country-profile/malawi/>)

targets, gender design features and measurable indicators ensuring women's participation and benefits.

7. The underlying theory of change is: the project will recognize the strengths, constraints and needs of the women and youth so that their potential as agents of change will be realized for achieving the best outcomes possible under the proposed project. It will necessarily entail changes in access to and distribution of resources and decision-making power between women and men in the targeted communities. Youth's participation will also be promoted since they could provide valuable contributions that will complement women's and men's inputs.

2. METHODOLOGY

8. The Gender Assessment seeks to understand the situation of women in agriculture, including natural resource management in the context of climate change, in areas targeted by the proposed project namely in the following districts: Karonga, Chitipa, Rumphi, Nkhata Bay, Dedza, Neno, Mwanza, Thyolo, Nsanje, Mangochi and Zomba. It also examines the situation of youth, who constitute another vulnerable social group and are likely to be affected and affect the project.

9. The Assessment has mainly relied on literature review and consultations. The outputs from literature review were discussed with relevant stakeholders and key informant persons through consultations that were held at national, district and field/village levels. The consultations focused on key issues pertaining to the lives of women, the core questions asked are included in Section 7.2. For districts and field consultations, 3 matrilineal and 3 patrilineal districts among the 11 targeted by EbAM considering the representativeness of the North, Centre and South regions were visited. The selection took into account the characteristics, cultural traditions and potential issues in terms of gender. Two other districts non-targeted by the project were also visited as they showcase interesting experiences on watershed and natural resource management that could be scaled-up by the project (Table 1).

Table 1: District and field consultations study areas

Region	EbAM targeted districts	EbAM non targeted districts	Target districts for the gender assessment consultations	Main characteristic
North	Nkhata Bay		Nkhata Bay	Patrilineal
	Rumphi		Rumphi	Patrilineal
	Chitipa			
	Karonga			
Central	Dedza		Dedza	Matrilineal
		Ntcheu	Ntcheu	Patrilineal
South	Neno		Neno	Matrilineal
	Mwanza			
	Nsanje		Nsanje	Patrilineal
	Mangochi		Mangochi	Matrilineal
		Chikwawa	Chikwawa	Patrilineal
	Zomba			
	Thyolo			

Source: Author

10. A total of 333 villagers in the target areas were consulted, of which 211 were women and about a hundred were young people¹⁰. Women's views were collected through women-only and mixed Focus group discussions (FGD). The same applied to youth. Institutional consultations were held at national and district levels. The list of stakeholders consulted are provided in Section 7.1. The results of literature review combined with consultation related information are summarized in this document.

11. To the best extent possible, the assessment is based on official statistics and published research results pertaining to the target regions and field consultations conducted in those regions. Where relevant information could not be found, it relies on that of the whole nation. Where no such information is available, the assessment may refer to the general consensus among the professionals in the field, or anecdotes.

3. LEGAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE FRAMEWORK

3.1 Equality, Inclusion and Protection: Women, Youth and Children

3.1.1 Treaties, constitution and laws

12. The Government of Malawi is a party to most of the International and regional instruments that promote human rights in general and women, youth and child rights in particular. Table 2 below summarizes the core international treaties Malawi legally ratified on the promotion of human rights, equal rights of women and men and the protection of women from all form of discrimination. The country also ratified most of the conventions and protocols designed to protect the rights of children, except the Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on a communication procedure, which ratification should have allowed the Committee that monitors States parties' compliance with the Convention to receive and consider complaints from a child's representative from its jurisdiction.

¹⁰ Aged 15-35

Table 2: International Treaties on Women, Youth and Children

Title	Description	Status for Malawi
<i>Universal Declaration of Human Rights</i> , adopted on December 10, 1948	Declares that all human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights and that they are endowed with reason and conscience. Sets a common standard of achievement to promote respect for these rights and freedoms.	Not part of the United Nations at the time of voting
<i>International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESCR)</i> , adopted on December 16, 1966	Ensures the equal right of women and men to the enjoyment of all economic, social and cultural rights.	Ratified in 1993
<i>International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR)</i> , adopted on December 16, 1966	Declares that all peoples have the right of self-determination. By virtue of that right they freely determine their political status and freely pursue their economic, social and cultural development. <i>Together with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, they make up the International Bill of Human Rights, which promotes, protects and monitor human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>	Ratified in 1993
<i>Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW)</i> , adopted on December 18, 1979	Eliminates discrimination against women in political and public life and promotes equal rights for women and men.	Ratified in 1987
<i>Optional Protocol to the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW-OP)</i> , adopted on October 6, 1999	A signatory state recognizes the competence of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women -- the body that monitors States parties' compliance with the Convention -- to receive and consider complaints from individuals or groups within its jurisdiction.	Ratified in 2000
<i>African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights</i> , ratified on November 17, 1989	Promotes and protects human rights and basic freedoms in the African continent.	Malawi is a State Party to this Charter
<i>Protocol to the African Charter on Human and Peoples Rights on the Rights of Women in Africa (Maputo Protocol)</i> , ratified on May 20, 2005	Ensures promotion, realization and protection of rights of women so that they can fully enjoy their human rights.	Signed as a State Party
<i>Solemn Declaration on Gender Equality in Africa</i> , adopted in July 2004	Accelerates the implementation of the Maputo Protocol in areas such as women's health, gender-based violence, gender parity and women's land and property rights.	Malawi is a State Party
<i>SADC Protocol on Gender Development</i> , adopted on August 17, 2008	Encompasses commitments made in all regional, global and continental instruments for achieving gender equality. Enhances instruments by addressing gaps and setting specific, measurable targets where those did not already exist and advances gender equality by ensuring accountability by all Community Member States. Provides a forum for the sharing of best practices, peer support and review.	Malawi is a State Party

Title	Description	Status for Malawi
African Youth Charter (July 2, 2006)	Aims to strengthen and consolidate efforts to empower young people through meaningful youth participation and their equal partnership in driving Africa's development agenda.	Ratified in 2010
Convention on the Rights of the Child , adopted on November 20, 1989	Guarantees the civil, political, economic, social, health and cultural rights that should be enjoyed by any human being under the age of eighteen, unless the age of majority is attained earlier under national legislation.	Ratified on January 3, 1991
Minimum Age Convention (with the specification that the minimum age is 14 for the country), 1979 (N° 138)	Sets the general minimum age for admission to employment or work at 15 years (13 for light work) and the minimum age for hazardous work at 18 (16 under certain strict conditions), with the possibility of initially setting the general minimum age at 14 (12 for light work) where the economy and educational facilities are insufficiently developed.	Ratified on November 19, 1999
Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the involvement of children in armed conflicts (2000)	A signatory state commits not to involve children under the age of 18 in armed conflicts.	Ratified on September 21, 2010
Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the sale of children child prostitution and child pornography (2000)	Strengthens implementation of the Convention and increases the protection of children from involvement in armed conflicts and from sale, prostitution and pornography.	Ratified on October 7, 2009
Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on a communications procedure (2011)	A signatory state recognizes the competence of the Committee on the Rights of the Child -- the body that monitors States parties' compliance with the Convention -- to receive and consider complaints from a child of her/his representative within its jurisdiction.	Not signed
African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child	Highlights the issues of greater importance to the African continent, such as child marriage and child soldiers, while building on the same basic principles as the Convention on the Rights of the Child.	Ratified in 1999

Sources:

- <http://www.claiminghumanrights.org>
- <http://www.africanchildforum.org>
- <https://www.acerwc.africa/ratifications-table>
- <http://www.policyproject.com>
- *Un résumé des Traités, Conventions et Accords de l'OUA-UA de 1963 à 2014*, African Capacity Building Foundation – African Union, June 2016

13. The Constitution of the Republic of Malawi of 1994 promotes equality between women and men. In its fundamental principles, it recognizes the dignity and worth of each human being and guarantees the protection of their basic rights, according to its terms: "... the inherent dignity and worth of each human being requires that the State and all persons shall recognize and protect human rights and afford the fullest protection to the rights and views of all individuals, groups and minorities whether or not they are entitled to vote...".¹¹ It also prohibits any discrimination based

¹¹ Malawi Constitution – Chap.I (Fundamental principles) - Section 12 (Constitutional principles) Al. 1.d

on “race, colour, sex, language, religion, political or other opinion, national, ethnic or social origin, disability, property, birth or other status or condition”¹².

14. The Constitution includes a bill of rights namely in its sections 23 and 24 which invalidate any practice that discriminates against women, and enshrine gender equity, inheritance and guidelines on family and marriage. Section 24 stipulates that “1. Women have the right to full and equal protection by the law, and have the right not to be discriminated against on the basis of their gender or marital status which includes the right: (a) to be accorded the same rights as men in civil law, including equal capacity [...], (b) on the dissolution of marriage [...]; 2. Any law that discriminates against women on the basis of gender or marital status shall be invalid and legislation shall be passed to eliminate customs and practices that discriminate against women, particularly practices such as - (a) sexual abuse, harassment and violence; (b) discrimination in work, business and public affairs; and (c) deprivation of property, including property obtained by inheritance”¹³.

15. The Amendment of Malawi’s Constitution in 2017 emphasized on raising the age of the child from 16 to 18 and testified the will to step towards ending child marriage. The Amendment followed the effort to harmonize all laws on the age of the child given that Malawi adopted in February 2015 the Marriage, Divorce and Family Relations Act which set the minimum age of marriage at 18 for boys and girls.

16. In addition to the Constitution and in order to accelerate progress towards meeting the Millennium Development Goals as well as the SADC Gender Protocol targets, the Malawi Government has reviewed, enacted and implemented several laws that lead to gender equity outcomes (Table 3). The laws essentially promote and protect women and children rights at all levels.

¹² Malawi Constitution – Chap. IV (Human rights) - Section 20 (Equality) Al. 1

¹³ Malawi Constitution – Chap. IV (Human rights) – Art. 24 (Rights of women)

Table 3: National Legislations on Women, Youth and Children

Title	Description
Prevention of Domestic Violence Act 2006	Provides a civil framework for addressing various acts of violence amongst people within a domestic relationship.
Gender Equality Act 2013	Promotes gender equality, equal integration, influence, empowerment, dignity and opportunities, for men and women in all functions of society. Prohibits and provides redress for sex discrimination, harmful practices and sexual harassment. Provides for public awareness on promotion of gender equality and provides for connected matters ¹⁴ .
Marriage, Divorce, and Family Relations Act 2015	Makes provision for marriage, divorce, and family relations between spouses and between married couples, their welfare and maintenance, and that of their children.
Deceased Estates (Wills, Inheritance and Protection) Act 2011	Provides for the making of wills and the devolution of property under a will; the inheritance to the estates of persons dying without valid wills; the protection of deceased estates; the administration of deceased estates; the prosecution of offences relating to deceased estates; the civic education of the public; the functions of courts in relation to deceased estates and for other connected matters
National Registration Act 2010	Provides for the registration of persons and registration of births, marriages and deaths of persons and to provide for matters connected therewith and incidental thereto
Child Care, Protection and Justice Act 2010	Consolidates the law relating to children by making provision for child care and protection and for child justice; and for matters of social development of the child and for connected matters ¹⁵
Education Act 2013	Provide for the establishment, organization, governance, control, regulation and financing of schools and colleges. Provides for the establishment of the Teachers Council of Malawi. Provides for the establishment of the Malawi Institute of Education. Provides for incidental matters thereto.
Trafficking in Persons Act 2015	Makes provision for the prevention and elimination of trafficking in persons. Provides for the establishment of the National Coordination Committee against Trafficking in Persons or the coordination and management of matters related to trafficking in persons; and provides for matters incidental thereto and connected therewith.

Source: Malawilii.org/akn/mw/act/

17. Considered as the most relevant national legislation relating to our assessment, the **Gender Equality Act 2013** is essentially the domestication of the Maputo Protocol. It aims at empowering women and providing opportunities to women to participate in all spheres of society. Part II of the act related to “Sex discrimination” prohibits discrimination of women on the ground of sex as well as harmful practices. It consists of “(art. 4.a) not treating another person less favourably than he or she would treat a person of his or her own sex; or (art. 4.b) applying to the other person an exclusion, distinction or restriction which applies or would apply equally to both sexes...” (art. 5) or “not committing, engaging in, subjecting another person to, or encouraging the commission of any harmful practice.” Sanctions for contraveners are also specified therein namely fine or imprisonment which value/duration varies depending on the offence.

18. The Gender Equality Act deals with sexual harassment, an act that is considered part of gender-based violence. Section .6.1 of the act defines sexual harassment as “any form of

¹⁴ Gender Equality Act N°3, 2013

¹⁵ Child Care, Protection and Justice Act N°22, 2010

unwanted verbal, non-verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature in circumstances in which a reasonable person, having regard to all the circumstances, would have anticipated that the other person would be offended, humiliated or intimidated” and announces the corresponding sanctions. The Act also proposes measures (art. 7) that the Government shall take to make sure employers develop and implement appropriate policy and procedures to eliminate sexual harassment in the workplace. They consist, among other things, of “entitling all persons who have been subjected to sexual harassment in the workplace to raise a grievance about its occurrence and be guaranteed that appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken against perpetrators”, “obliging the person in charge of the work place to implement the policy and procedures and impose disciplinary action against employees who do not comply”, establishing exhaustive internal sexual harassment procedures before prosecution of the offence can be commenced or civil proceedings can be instituted.

19. In terms of access to services, while the Act seeks to promote equal rights for girls’ and boys’ access to education and training (Sections 14 to 18), articles related to fairness in public service appointments could be questioned with the quotas setting of “no less than forty per cent and no more than sixty per cent of either sex in any department in the public service”, and exceptions related to the application of the quotas (Section 11). Part VI of the Act describes the right of women to sexual and reproductive health, and Part VII promotes public awareness of women’s rights.

20. The ***Prevention of Domestic Violence Act 2006*** shows the commitment of the State to eliminate gender-based violence that occurs within a domestic/family relationship. Though the provisions of the Act apply to both males and females, this law provides provisions to safeguard and offer redress to women, who are the main victims of domestic violence in the country.

21. The ***Deceased Estates (Wills, Inheritance and Protection) Act 2011*** makes provisions related to matters regarding inheritance and the administration of estates of deceased persons in Malawi. It applies to the administration of estates of all persons dying and residing, or leaving property in Malawi, on or after the date upon which the Act comes into operation. Except as provided for in this Act, no person shall be entitled under any other written law or under customary law to take by inheritance any of the property to which a deceased person was entitled at the date of his or her death. The Act provides with respect to the making of wills, inheritance in case of intestacy, powers of court, protection and administration of (small) estates, execution of wills and related matters¹⁶. The Act includes some provisions related to women’s right. It gives women legal authority to inherit land if widowed and provides women and girls with equal inheritance rights as male family members. Land grabbing is also considered as a criminal offence by the Act.

22. The ***Marriage, Divorce, and Family Relations Act 2015*** makes provision for marriage, divorce, and family relations between spouses and between unmarried couples, their welfare and maintenance, and that of their children. By enacting the law, Malawi made an important step toward preventing child marriage, and showed its willingness to protect girls from the abuse and exploitation that result from the issue. By setting at 18 the minimum marriage age for boys and girls, the new Marriage Act consolidates all laws on marriage and divorce. It includes a new requirement to register marriages with the government, and recognizes all marriages including civil, religious and customary and marriage by repute or permanent cohabitation. This law also contains strong protections for married women who may find themselves in a situation with no

¹⁶ FAOLEX Database: <https://www.fao.org/faolex/results/details/en/c/LEX-FAOC126344>

right to succession or inheritance or share of property, maintenance or even custody of children upon termination of family relationships.

23. The Marriage, Divorce and Family Relations Act was at the origin of the Constitution amendment by Malawi's parliament in 2017. The amendment removed the provision allowing children between the ages of 15 and 18 to marry with parental consent.

24. The **Child Care, Protection and Justice Act 2010** is aiming at preventing violence against children under the age of 16 by prohibiting child betrothal, forced child marriage, and harmful practices. Although the Act refers to the Constitution in its Section 3, the definition of "child" in the Act that consists of "a person below the age of sixteen years"¹⁷, is not in line with what the Malawian Amended Constitution calls "a child": "A child shall be a person under the age of eighteen years"¹⁸.

25. In its Part II, not only does the Act provide details about child care and protection by the family, but it also clarifies situations that are considered with substantial risks for children and which result in children needing care and protection. These include child neglect from parent or guardian, sexual abuse, child prostitution, involvement of child in illegal activities, etc. If on one hand the Act makes provision for child protection (Part II), it also includes on the other hand measures dedicated to children who are suspected to have committed offences (Part III). Besides, the Act contains sections related to the determination of age of a child that apply for the purposes of criminal responsibilities (Part IV) and to child legal representation (Part V). Mechanisms related to Child justice courts (Part VI), Child care review board (Part VII) and Reformatory centre and safety homes (Part VIII) are also described.

26. The **Education Act 2013** governs Malawi's education system and has the promotion of education as main objective. The minister in charge has the duty to "promote education for all people in Malawi; irrespective of race, ethnicity, gender, religion, disability or any other discriminatory characteristics", some provisions that are entirely consistent with what is stipulated in the Constitution. One of the education goals in Malawi is to "promote equality of educational opportunity for all Malawians by identifying and removing barriers to achievement" (Part II, Section 5). Equality is one of the principles frequently mentioned in the Act in terms of access to education, but no specific mention is made in relation to the access of girls and boys. The Government promotes a generalized access to education by providing free and compulsory primary education to every child aged under 18 through Government schools.

27. The **Trafficking in Persons Act 2015** focuses on the prevention and elimination of the issue and complements the provisions related to human rights. It pays particular attention to the protection of children. Considered as an offence, Trafficking in Persons is defined as "recruiting, transporting, transferring, harbouring, receiving or obtaining a person, within or beyond the territory of Malawi, through- (a) threats or use of force or coercion; (b) abduction; (c) fraud or deception; (d) abuse or threats of abuse of power or position; (e) abuse or threats of abuse of position of vulnerability; (f) abuse or threats of abuse of the law or legal process; or (g) giving or receiving of payments to obtain consent of a person having control of the trafficked person, for the purpose of exploitation of that person"¹⁹ by the Act. The law distinguishes different types of offences including trafficking in persons, trafficking in children and aggravated forms of trafficking. The penalties for trafficking in persons and trafficking in children are respectively 14 years and 21 years of imprisonment without the option of a fine. Aggravated forms of trafficking are subject to imprisonment for life without the option of a fine. Section 18 of the Act stipulates that a person

¹⁷ Child Care, Protection and Justice Act N°22 2010, Part I - Preliminary, Section 2

¹⁸ Malawi Constitution – Chap. IV (Human rights) – Art. 23 (Rights of children)

¹⁹ Trafficking in Persons Act 2015 (No.3 or 2015), Part I, Section 2

convicted of the offence of trafficking in persons or trafficking in children is ineligible to work in any capacity with children for a period of seven years following their conviction. A person who intentionally benefits from the exploitation of a trafficked person or causes or enables another person to benefit from exploitation of a trafficked person, commits an offence and shall be liable to five years of imprisonment. Any person suspecting existing or potential offence on trafficking in persons should report it to the Police; any failure to do so is liable to a fine of K500,000 and a year of imprisonment.

3.1.2 Policy Commitment covering Key Domains of Gender and Youth Outcomes

28. As part of the process of implementing the existing laws, the Government of Malawi's efforts to improve gender equality and youth empowerment can be seen through policy commitments that cover key domains leading to gender and youth outcomes.

a. Gender Policy

29. The first Gender Policy 2000-2005 was launched in March 2000 and resulted in increased efforts on promotion of gender equity and equality. It led to some good achievements including (i) the development and implementation of gender mainstreaming guidelines and national strategy to combat gender based violence and national gender programme; (ii) capacity building in gender mainstreaming for public, private and civil society organizations; (iii) an increased number of women in parliament and decision making positions; (iv) the enactment and enforcement of Acts related to Domestic Violence; Deceased Estates (Wills, Inheritance and Protection); Marriage, Divorce, and Family Relations; Child Care, Justice and Protection; and Trafficking in Persons; and (v) the development and review of legislations with a gender perspective²⁰.

30. Despite the results achieved, a need to review the 2000-2005 Policy was noticed since it did not address a number of challenges and emerging issues such as high HIV and AIDS infection rates especially among women and girls, increasing cases of Gender based violence (GBV), human trafficking, increased environmental degradation, climate change, and high poverty levels particularly among women, etc. The review and the development of the revised National Gender Policy took into consideration the Malawi Constitution with its gender equality principles and related provisions, as well as various international and regional instruments on gender equality and women empowerment to which Malawi is a party. It also has strong linkages with several national policies namely the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy II (2011-2016), the Reproductive Health Policy (2017-2022), the Education policy 2013, the National HIV and AIDS Policy 2003, the National Agriculture Policy 2016, the National Environment Policy 2004 and the National Youth Policy 2013.

31. The purpose of the National Gender Policy 2015 is "to strengthen gender mainstreaming and women empowerment at all levels in order to facilitate attainment of gender equality and equity in Malawi" and the policy's goal is "to reduce gender inequalities and enhance participation of women, men, girls and boys in socio economic development processes". The Policy has targeted six priority areas: (i) education and training; (ii) health; (iii) agriculture, food security and nutrition; (iv) natural resources, environment and climate change management; (v) economic development; and (vi) governance and human rights; and puts an emphasis on gender perspective in GBV as well as on the capacity of the national structures involved in the implementation of the gender policy. In terms of outcomes, the Policy aims at the following:

²⁰ National Gender Policy, 2015 (Second Edition), Ministry of Gender, Youth and Community Service, Foreword

- Increased meaningful participation of women, men, girls and boys in decision making, wealth creation and poverty reduction;
- Reduced gender-based violence at all levels;
- Enhanced gender mainstreaming across all sectors; and
- Enhanced institutional capacity of the National Gender Machinery.

32. The Policy recognizes that climate change management is important in the lives of women. It considers as new major challenges: HIV and AIDS; GBV; human trafficking; increased environmental degradation and climate change; and high poverty level. As for agriculture, the Policy aims to ensure to women and other vulnerable groups access to and control over agricultural resources, technologies and markets for cash crops. Under natural resources management, environment and climate change management, the Policy sees that the impacts of deforestation are amplified by gender inequality in decision-making power and access to information. The Policy aims to mainstream gender in natural resources management.

33. The Ministry responsible for Gender is the one in charge of coordinating and providing oversight regarding the implementation of the Gender Policy across all sectors.

b. The National Plan of Action to Combat Gender Based Violence (2014-2020)

34. Considered as the most recent National Plan of Action (NPA) and developed in the framework of the National Gender Policy, the NPA to Combat Gender-Based Violence 2014-2020 has followed the national gender-based response initiatives that consist of the 2002-2006 Strategy to Combat GBV and the 2008-2013 National Response to GBV, and provided comprehensive, multi-sectoral and sustained blueprint for ending violence against women, men and children. The NPA draws heavily on lessons learned from the implementation of its two predecessors and identified the remaining challenges in GBV programming across all sectors, namely:

- Lack of Sufficient Data and un-coordinated research, monitoring and evaluation of outputs and outcomes of GBV interventions;
- Community mobilization behaviour change communication to prevent GBV;
- Limited dissemination and outreach;
- Weak problem and results analysis and lack of results based approach in the implementation of activities
- Failure to include the private sector as a partner with established programmes on gender equality and HIV and AIDS prevention;
- Failure to address violence against children which has risen to unprecedented levels.

35. The 2014-2020 NPA aimed to provide a strong framework for sustainable intervention to prevent and effectively respond to GBV, to increase recognition and unacceptability of GBV, and to improve the quality of services responding to GBV by 2020. The five priority areas of the NPA have been: (i) the prevention of GBV by addressing the root causes and promoting transformation of harmful social norms; (ii) the promotion of an early referral system that identifies violence and thus reduces its impact and continuation; (iii) the creation of an effective response mechanism supporting the survivors of GBV; (iv) the coordination, implementation and sustainable financing of the NPA; and (v) research, data collection, monitoring and evaluation. In order to overcome the weak coordination of the 2008-2013 National response, the 2014-2020 NPA emphasized on the importance of activity coordination and results based approach. The implementation of the Plan relied on the strong leadership of the Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare (MoGCDSW) using existing coordination and implementation structures. The particular attention was mentioned on the use of the Gender, Children, Youth and Sports sector Working Group: Joint

Sector Strategic Plan (JSSP) 2013-2017 and the non-governmental organisations (NGOs) coordinated by the NGO Gender Coordination Network (NGOGCN). The MoGCDSW was also expected to rely on the Gender Technical Working Group at national level, the Gender and Integrated Community Development at district levels and the existing Government recognized community structures.

c. National HIV/AIDS Policy (2003)

36. The National HIV/AIDS Policy 2003 came as a response to the identification of HIV/AIDS as one of the key development challenges of Malawi as per the UNDP Country Development Report in 2001. It aimed at enabling the high-level engagement, strong cross-sectoral collaboration and sustained action that the HIV/AIDS challenge requires. Among other points, the Policy recognized in its Preamble: (i) the unequal position of girls and women in society; and that women are more likely to become infected and can be more adversely affected by HIV/AIDS than men due to biological, social, cultural and economic factors, (ii) the discrimination and marginalization of people living with HIV/AIDS which lead to a lack of individual and collective well-being, development and human security, and (iii) the strong influence culture and religion have on lifestyle and choices.

37. The Policy's goal was therefore "to prevent HIV infections, to reduce vulnerability to HIV, to improve the provision of treatment, care and support for people living with HIV/AIDS and to mitigate the socio-economic impact of HIV/AIDS on individuals, families, communities and the nation"; the Policy pursued the following objectives:

- "Prevent HIV infections;
- Improve delivery of prevention, treatment, care and support services;
- Mitigate the impact of HIV/AIDS on individuals, the family and communities;
- Reduce individual and societal vulnerability to HIV/AIDS through the creation of an enabling environment;
- Strengthen the multi-sectoral and multi-disciplinary institutional framework for coordination and implementation of HIV/AIDS programmes in the country".

38. Apart from strengthening and sustaining a comprehensive multisectoral response to HIV/AIDS and promoting HIV/AIDS prevention, treatment, care, and support and impact mitigation; the Policy in its Chapter 4 made some provisions related to the rights of people living with HIV/AIDS stipulating that:

- "Government shall respect, protect and fulfil the rights and dignity of people living with HIV/AIDS;
- Government and partners shall ensure a conducive legal, political, economic, social and cultural environment in which the rights of people living with and affected by HIV/AIDS are respected, protected and fulfilled;
- Government and partners shall ensure the effective participation of people living with HIV/AIDS in all decision making in relation to the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of HIV/AIDS related policies and programmes;
- Government shall ensure that people living with HIV/AIDS are not discriminated against in access to health care and related services and that respect for privacy and confidentiality are upheld;
- Government and partners shall ensure that HIV/AIDS, whether suspected or real, is not used as a reason for denying an individual access to social services, including health care, education, religious services and employment;

- Sector policy makers, including labour, corporate and social service sectors shall ensure that sectoral policies are put in place that effectively address discrimination on the basis of HIV/AIDS and take steps to effectively eliminate stigma and discrimination in their institutions and in the implementation of their sectoral mandates;
- Government shall ensure that people living with HIV/AIDS, whose rights have been infringed, have access to independent, speedy and effective legal and/or administrative procedures for seeking redress;
- Government and other institutions shall establish mechanisms and services to protect those who choose to disclose their HIV status at family, community or national levels, as well as their families and communities;
- Government shall ensure that orphans living with HIV are not discriminated against access to health care, education or access to be fostering in adoption or placement in institutions.”

39. Chapter 5 of the Policy also made specific provisions towards several vulnerable groups that are considered “underprivileged socially, culturally and economically or legally less able to fully access education, health care and social services and means of HIV prevention and less able to enforce HIV prevention options and to access needed treatment, care and support”. These groups included among other women and girls, orphans, widows and widowers, children and young people, the poor, mobile populations and people with disabilities. Policy statements related to women and girls were as followed:

- “Government shall ensure that women and girls, regardless of marital status, have equal access to appropriate, sound HIV-related information and education programmes, means of prevention and health services including women specific and youth friendly sexual and reproductive health services for all women of reproductive age, including women living with HIV/AIDS;
- Government shall protect the rights of women to have control over and to decide freely and responsibly, free of coercion, discrimination and violence, on matters related to their sexuality, including sexual and reproductive health;
- Government shall ensure that women and girls are protected against violence, including sexual violence, rape and other forms of coerced sex, as well as against traditional practices that affect the health of women;
- Government shall ensure women’s rights to legal capacity and equality within the family, in matters such as divorce, inheritance, child custody, property and employment rights, in particular, equal remuneration of men and women for work of equal value, equal access to responsible positions, measures to reduce conflicts between professional and family responsibilities and protection against sexual harassment in the workplace;
- Government and partners should ensure that women enjoy equal access to benefits of scientific and technological progress so as to minimise risk of HIV infection;
- Government shall ensure that young girls and boys, both in and out of school, have access to life skills education, which addresses unequal gender relations, to enable them to protect themselves from HIV infection or live positively with HIV/AIDS if they are already infected;
- Government and partners shall develop and implement gender sensitive HIV/AIDS care programmes that ensure the continuation of care between hospital, clinic, community care and family or household and hospice.”

40. One important point covered by the Policy is the consideration of how customary practices can increase the risk of HIV infection. These practices include “polygamy, extra marital sexual relations, marital rape, first aid to snake bite victims, ear piercing and tattooing and customary practices such as widow and widower inheritance, death cleansing (kupita kufa), forced sex for

young girls coming of age (fisi), new born baby cleansing (kutenga mwana), circumcision (jando/mdulidwe), ablution of dead bodies, consensual adultery for childless couple (fisi), wife and husband exchange (chimwanamaye), temporary husband replacement (mbulo), and tattoos (mphini)²¹. Provisions are made on the involvement and contribution of Government, traditional and religious leaders in the fight against HIV. The Policy also clarifies the implication of Traditional Healers and Traditional Birth Attendants.

41. Several plans and strategies have been developed to support the implementation of the Policy:

- The Malawi HIV and AIDS Extended National Action Framework (NAF), 2010-2012,
- The National Strategic Plan (NSP) for HIV and AIDS 2015-2020,
- The National HIV Prevention Strategy 2015-2020,
- The Malawi National Strategic Plan for HIV and AIDS 2020-2025.

42. Despite that the NSP 2015-2020 had by far fallen short to achieving its prevention goals of reducing new infections from 56,000 in 2010 to 11,000 in 2020 (with 33,000 new infections estimated in 2019), the ongoing Strategic Plan has taken stock on the progress achieved through the NSP 2015-2020. This included among others the tremendous progress towards the 90:90:90 testing and treatment target²², the expansion of the condom and lubricant programming, the availability of Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis (PrEP) at selected service delivery points in Lilongwe and Blantyre districts which is considered as an additional prevention intervention, the delivery of a comprehensive package of services²³ that goes beyond the health sector to address the structural inequalities that impact both Adolescent Girls and Young Women's (AGYW) and Adolescent Boys and Young Men's (ABYM) vulnerability to HIV, interventions focusing on Adolescent Girls and Young Women (AGYW), the Elimination of Mother to Child Transmission (e-MTCT) program, and improvements in the health system.

43. The goal of the NSP 2020-2025 is to contribute towards ending AIDS as a public health threat in Malawi by 2030, and its overall objective are to (i) reduce new HIV infections from 33,000 in 2019 to 11,000 in 2025; (ii) reduce HIV and AIDS related morbidity and mortality; (iii) reach 95-95-95 treatment targets; (iv) improve the quality of HIV services; and (v) build resilient health and social welfare systems for effectively responding to the HIV and AIDS epidemic. The Plan has the National AIDS Commission as one national coordinating authority and features a unique agreed monitoring and evaluation system at country level.

d. Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights Policy

44. The adoption of a comprehensive and integrated approach to Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) in Malawi constitutes a necessary response to expanding needs that includes increased demand for family planning, increased maternal and neonatal morbidity and mortality, and a growing burden of reproductive ill health²⁴. The National Health Policy of 2012 presents a framework that articulates issues that are central to the development of health delivery systems in Malawi. The Policy serves as a point of reference in the provision of sound foundation for the

²¹ National HIV/AIDS Policy (2003), Chapter 6

²² Referring to the UNAIDS treatment target to help end the aids epidemic by 2020: 90% of all people living with HIV knowing their HIV status, 90% of all people with diagnosed HIV infection receiving sustained antiretroviral therapy, 90% of all people receiving antiretroviral therapy will have viral suppression (<https://www.unaids.org/en/resources/909090>)

²³ The package consists of information and delivery of HIV prevention interventions, reproductive health services, post-GBV care, violence prevention and perceived HIV risk determination, social asset building, back to school support, and village savings and loans programming. (Malawi National Strategic Plan for HIV and AIDS 2020-2025, Sustaining gains and accelerating progress towards epidemic control, National AIDS Commission, 2020)

²⁴ National Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy 2017-2022, Ministry of Health, 2017 - Preface

successful provision of a comprehensive range of health services, which includes the sexual and reproductive health services.

45. In Malawi, the first Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy was formulated in 2002 and revised in 2009. The development of the ongoing National Sexual Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy (2017-2022) built on the success of the 2009-2016 SRHR Policy and responded to the need to incorporate emerging issues in the various components of SRHR namely: Basic Emergency Obstetric and Neonatal Care (BEmONC), Community Based Neonatal Care, Cervical Cancer Screening, Youth Friendly Health Services, Anti-Retroviral Therapy (ART), Voluntary Male Medical Circumcision (VMMC) and Prevention of Mother to Child Transmission of HIV (PMTCT). In terms of legislative framework, the Policy is aligned to the Health Sector Strategic Plan (2017-2022) which prioritizes Reproductive and Adolescent Health and acknowledges that adolescent health indicators remain poor. The SRHR Policy is also linked to the Malawi National Youth Policy and Youth Friendly Health Services National Standards, the HIV and AIDS policy and the Malawi Gender Policy.

46. The overall goal of the SRHR Policy has been to provide a framework for provision of accessible, acceptable and affordable, comprehensive SRHR services to all women, men, and young people of Malawi through informed choice to enable them attain their reproductive rights and goals safely. The Policy objectives are as follow:

- “Provide direction to decision makers and programme managers for effective implementation of SRHR services;
- Provide guidelines for capacity building for provision of quality SRHR services;
- Attain equivalence, harmonization, and standardization of guidelines for provision of SRHR services;
- Inform and guide stakeholders and partners on SRHR issues”²⁵.

47. In its purpose to address the prevalent SRHR problems (maternal and neonatal health, family planning, teen age pregnancies and domestic violence), the SRHR Policy considers the different age groups and diverse groups of Malawians. For instance, the policy addresses sexuality education that is provided to youths in schools and youth clubs in the communities. To other groups such as the mentally disturbed and disabled persons, like for every other person, the policy addresses SRHR issues of pregnancy, family planning, STIs and HIV and AIDS. Similarly to the Malawi Health Policy, the SRHR Policy follows the principles of human rights and equity based approach, gender sensitivity, ethical considerations, efficiency, accountability, community participation, evidence-based decision making, partnership and multi-sectoral collaboration, decentralisation, appropriate technology, and responsiveness²⁶. Six topics among the 10 covered by the Policy are particularly relevant to our assessment: (i) family planning, (ii) maternal and neonatal health, (iii) sexually transmitted infections and HIV/AIDS, (iv) young people in reproductive health, (v) Harmful Practices/Domestic Violence, and (vi) Male Involvement in Reproductive Health. The Policy makes provisions related to policy goal, statements and strategies for each topic.

48. The implementation of the SRHR Policy goes through the national RH Programme coordinated by the Reproductive Health Department (RHD), which operates under the guidance of the SRHR Technical Working Group at the policy/technical level. The Policy implementation relies on community participation as well as a comprehensive Behaviour Change Communication (BCC) Strategy covering all aspects of SRHR. Other institutions involved in the implementation

²⁵ National Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy 2017-2022, Ministry of Health, 2017 - 2.4 Policy objectives

²⁶ National Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) Policy 2017-2022, Ministry of Health, 2017 - 2.5 Guiding Principles

include: the Ministry of Health; the Ministry of Agriculture; the Ministry of Economic Planning and Development; the Ministry of Education; the Ministry of Information; the Ministry of Local Government; the Ministry of Women and Child Development; the Ministry of Labour, Youth, Sports and Manpower Development; the Department of Energy; the Parliamentary Committee on Health; the Development Partners, the Nurses' and Midwives' and Medical Councils of Malawi; the Training Institutions; the Professional Associations; the Christian Health Association of Malawi (CHAM); and the Civil Society Organisations.

e. National Male Engagement Strategy for Gender Equality, GBV, HIV and SRHR (2022-2027) (Draft)

49. The formulation of the Male Engagement Strategy for Gender Equality, GBV, HIV and SRHR reflects Malawi's recognition of the needs of men, women, boys and girls' participation to achieve gender equality. The Strategy acknowledges that rigid gender norms about masculinity: (i) act as barriers to achieving gender equality; (ii) encourage behaviours and attitudes of adults and young men that put women and girls at risk of GBV; (iii) contribute to the risk of exposure for men and their partners to HIV and other Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs), and (iv) undermine efforts aimed at improving SRHR, including HIV treatment and care. As men and boys still occupy positions of power and influence in both private and public sphere and since their decisions, attitudes and behaviours impact women and girls' lives, male engagement is a critical area of intervention to achieve gender equality. While efforts to engage men and boys have been ongoing in Malawi, many have been sporadic and small-scale without considering the individual, societal, service and policy barriers that limit men's involvement in gender equality, HIV and SRHR. Therefore, the MoGCDSW initiated the process of developing a male engagement strategy in order to provide strategic direction for engaging men and boys and enhancing male participation in gender equality, HIV and SRHR programming in Malawi.

50. In order to develop the Strategy, the Government took stock of promising initiatives that have been engaging men and boys for gender justice. Summarized in Table 4 below, these initiatives have been initiated and implemented through some UN agencies, development partners and civil society.

Table 4: Promising initiatives engaging men and boys for gender justice

Institution	Interventions /strategies	Year	Strategic interventions
Malawi Human Rights Resource Centre in partnership with the Ministry of Gender with support from Royal Norwegian embassy and UNFPA	Launch of the Men for Gender Equality Now (MEGEN)	2003	- Peer education through Men Travelling Conferences, Rapid response, Media - Engagement and capacity building of Male champions in addressing issues of GBV, SRHR and Gender Equality as well as encouraging men's participation in care work, - Health including mental health, responsible parenthood, SRHR, HIV and AIDS - Men advocating for women's participation in decision making by deconstructing societal barriers
Ministry of Health with support from UNFPA and UNICEF	Male Champion Model	2004	The MCM works by training male motivators to reach out to men within their communities to encourage them to accompany their wives to get tested for HIV. Since its inception it has

Institution	Interventions /strategies	Year	Strategic interventions
			trained over 3,000 motivators in six districts in Malawi. ²⁷
Save the Children	Male Motivator Initiative	2008	The project used male motivators (married men chosen from the local community) to target husbands in order to increase uptake of family planning knowledge and contraception. Men were provided with information on modern family planning methods and local facilities offering these methods. The men were also instructed on the correct condom use. After the project, 78% of participants started using family planning with their wives. ²⁸
Ministry of Gender and the Gender Equality and Women Empowerment Programme	Men to men groups	2015	Men-to-men groups were set up to engage men and boys in prevention of Gender Based Violence; promotion of Sexual Reproductive Health Rights for women and girls including male involvement in parenthood. Community-based campaigns worked with local leaders and other gate keepers to critically examine and eliminate some of the harmful cultural practices that impinge on women's rights.
UN Women in collaboration with the Ministry of Gender	Launch of the HeForShe campaign	2015	A global campaign for engaging men and boys through mobilization of leadership (head of states, MPs, Ministers, traditional leaders, councilors, religious leaders, community leaders and youth leaders) to champion issues of GBV and deconstruct negative socialization
Active Youth Initiative for Social Enhancement (AYISE)	Launch of the youth Work Camps and Boys Brigade programme	2015	Engaging boys and young men for gender transformation and construction of the new forms of positive masculinities in Blantyre, Thyolo, Mulanje and Mangochi through work camps and Husbands schools- Men's SRHR and Responsible parenthood capacity building
SAFAIDS and COWHLA	Stepping stones and Rock Leadership Models	2015	Engaging men and boys in order to reduce HIV and GBV incidences, including SRHR, policies and laws that protect women and girls and gender norms. The group further mobilized men's groups in target areas in order to educate men and capacitate their roles in reducing GBV and HIV. ²⁹
Malawi Council of Churches with support from World Council of Churches	Transformative Masculinities using contextual bible studies	2016	Capacity building of religious leaders to interpret and apply scriptures from a gendered perspective and prevent use of holy scriptures to entrench negative notions of masculinities.

²⁷ Dral et al. 2018

²⁸ Shattuck et al. 2011

²⁹ ALIGHT project report 2017

Institution	Interventions /strategies	Year	Strategic interventions
UN Women Iceland in partnership with Ministry of Gender	Barbershop toolbox.	2018	The toolbox is dialogue-based manual for initiating deliberations between men and women, girls and boys in order to help them examine harmful masculinities, social norms and harmful traditional practices and to advocate for gender equality.
UN Women in partnership with Ministry of Gender, National AIDS Commission and Men for Gender Equality (Now)	Men's Spaces programme- (modelled on the The Tarven Programme of the Episcopal Conference of Southern Africa)	2019	Engaging men to challenge toxic masculinities that predispose men and their families to HIV and AIDS, SRHR issues and GBV by working with men in Blantyre, Mulanje, Zomba and Mangochi where HIV prevalence is higher than the national prevalence rate
World University Service of Canada	Positive Masculinities Platform	2019	Aims to engage men and boys to combat widespread inequality, deep rooted patriarchal traditions and negative cultural norms through advocacy, peer to peer education, and communities in Lilongwe, Msundwe.
Christian AID	Side by Side with Men	2021	Working with male and female religious leaders- Engaging men and women for transformative scripture interpretation.

Source: National Male Engagement Strategy for Gender Equality, GBV, HIV and SRHR (2022-2027) (Draft)

51. Building on these tested models and urging all partners to buy them in and scale them out, the Strategy aims at guiding and standardizing the planning, implementation, coordination and monitoring of programs for engaging men and boys.

52. The Strategy has highlighted the barriers to men's engagement which are patriarchy and masculinities; cultural, traditional and dominant societal norms and religion. From there, it has identified six key areas of focus: (i) challenging of male stereotypes, (ii) male involvement, (iii) increase of male engagement in GBV to HIV and SRHR services, (iv) transformative masculinity, (v) enforcement of an enabling policy and legal framework, and (vi) strengthening of coordination mechanisms. The strategy objectives are:

- "To challenge male stereotypes, dominant negative social norms and construct transformative masculinities that shape male behaviors and attitudes;
- To ensure reinforcement of legal frameworks and implementation of policies;
- To promote male involvement in accessing SRHR services, eradicating GBV and reducing the risk of HIV;
- To enhance coordination of Male Engagement activities at National, District and Community levels; and
- To encourage research, learning and knowledge management on male engagement."

f. National Strategy on Ending Child Marriage (2018-2023)

53. In 2018, the government launched the National Strategy on Ending Child Marriage 2018-2023. The strategy advocates for a multi sectoral approach to reduce the prevalence of child

marriage by 20 percent before 2023. Yet, early marriage has continued to be pervasive in Malawi which has one of the highest rates of child marriage in the world.³⁰

g. National Education Policy (2016)

54. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2016 was developed to provide proper guidance in the education sector given that no comprehensive policy framework was available to guide the successive education planning. The latter included the Education Development Survey (1964), the first Education Plan (1973-1980) and the second Education Sector Development Plan (1985 - 1995), the Free Primary Education (FPE) Policy in 1994, the Policy and Investment Framework (PIF) (2000), and the National Education Sector Plan (NESP) 2008-2017 that had helped fulfill the aspirations of the national education's long-term vision and provision of guidelines for education development³¹. The NEP was intended to stand out as one guiding living document to inform the education system in all its obligations to achieving relevant and equitable education.

55. The Policy had the purpose of “guiding and providing a coordinated approach to the development of the education system for relevant knowledge, skills, competencies and values necessary for the socio-economic development of the nation”. Its goal was “to promote equitable access to education and improve relevance, quality and governance and management of the education sector”. The NEP outlined 7 priority areas that should guide the development of the education sector in Malawi:

- “Quality, accessible and equitable basic education including early childhood development and education, out-of-school youth education, adult literacy and primary education;
- Accessible and quality secondary education;
- Quality teacher education (primary and secondary);
- Quality and equitably accessed Technical, Entrepreneurial and Vocational Education and Training (TEVET);
- Quality and equitably accessed higher education;
- Quality and equitably accessed open and distance learning; and
- Enhanced Science, Technology and Innovation in Education”.

56. The Ministry of Education, Science and Technology is in charge of the coordination of the NEP planning and implementation. Several other institutions were involved in the implementation such as the Malawi Institute of Education (MIE) for the development and evaluation of the school curriculum and the coordination of in-service teacher training; the Malawi National Examinations Board (MANEB) for the administration of national examinations and development of examination syllabuses for all examinable subjects; the Malawi National Commission for UNESCO for linking government ministries, intellectual and civil societies with UNESCO; the Malawi National Library Services (MNLS) for promoting, establishing, equipping and managing national libraries; the Teaching Service Commission (TSC) for professional development programs, teacher recruitment, promotions, and discipline. The Policy implementation also involved the following Ministries and public Departments: Ministry of Health; Ministry of Information and Civic Education; Ministry of Youth Development and Sports; Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare; Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs; Ministry of Local Government and Rural Development; Ministry of Lands and Housing; Office of the Director of Public Procurement; National Audit Office.

³⁰ Policy Paper, Realizing the African Union Campaign to End Child Marriage: Emerging Lessons from Child Marriage Programming in Malawi and Zambia, IBSA, UN Women, 2020

³¹ National Education Policy, Ministry of Education, Science and Technology, October 2016 - Preface

57. Developed in the framework of the NEP 2016, the National education sector investment plan (NESIP) 2020-2030 is the fifth formal education plan for the sector. It builds on the achievement of the National Education Sector Plan (NESP) 2008-2017, the first comprehensive plan developed by the Ministry of Education, takes into account the NESP challenges and defines what needs to be addressed between 2020 and 2030. The NESP achievements includes among others the overall increase in access to education across all levels of education; the review of curricula linkage to Malawi's socio-economic development; and the review of the legal and policy framework, specifically, the development of the National Education Act and the National Education Policy.

58. The NESIP is a long-term strategic document for the education sector and it sets objectives and results, and guides the implementation of key activities to achieve national and international commitments from 2020 to 2030. Taking into account all the subsectors and implementation structures of the entire education sector, it is considered as a tool to bring all education stakeholders together and improve coordination across all levels of education. Relying on the goal defined in the NEP, the NESIP has defined 3 following thematic objectives:

- "Increase access to equitable education programs at all levels of the education system;
- Enhance the quality of learning outcomes that are relevant to Malawi's socio-economic development; and
- Strengthen effective, efficient and accountable governance and management of the education system."

59. The NESIP has been elaborated into 7 sub-programmes related to various levels of education, each sub-programme featuring a general objective relying on priority strategic objectives that are aligned to the below thematic objectives and accompanied by priority actions. Among 3 other sub-programmes, inclusive education, gender and other cross-cutting issues constitute a sub-programme with the general objective of ensuring that inclusive education, gender SHNHA and other crosscutting issues are integrated across all levels of the education system.

60. As it is the case for the NEP, the MoE will lead the implementation of the plan with support from all stakeholders in the education sector.

h. National Youth Policy

61. Drawing from the 1996 National Youth Policy that had guided previous youth programmes and services, the National Youth Policy 2013 considered new challenges and emerging issues that youth had to face in Malawi. Established in accordance with the international commitments to which Malawi is signatory (the African Youth Charter, the Commonwealth Plan of Action for Youth Empowerment (PAYE), the African Youth Decade Plan of Action (DPoA), the SADC Youth Protocols, etc.), the Policy sought to provide a framework with guidelines for the facilitation of meaningful youth development programs and services with full participation of the youth themselves at all levels. Its goal consists of "creating an enabling environment for all young people to develop to their full potential in order to contribute significantly to personal and sustainable national development"; and it sought of fulfilling the following objectives:

- "Guide policy makers on issues relating to young people;
- Mainstream youth development agenda in all national development programmes;
- Provide guidance on minimum standards for the design of programmes for youth;
- Guide the adequate allocation and prudent use of resources (financial, human, and material) to youth programmes;

- Provide guidance for the protection of young people;
- Advocate for the active participation of young people in the formulation of legislation and policies affecting the youth at all levels;
- Mainstream gender equity and equality in all youth programmes;
- Provide guidelines for monitoring and evaluation of youth programmes and ensuring youth are included as active participants; and
- Provide for the establishment of multi-sectoral and multi-disciplinary institutional framework for coordination and implementation of youth programmes”.

62. While clarifying the rights of youth as enshrined in the Convention on the Rights of Child (CRC), the constitution of the Republic of Malawi, the African Youth Charter, the CEDAW, etc., the Policy exposes the responsibilities of youth in terms of health; education; economic, social and cultural responsibilities; environment; as well as other responsibilities. It also described the roles of adults towards the Youth. One particular aspect of the Policy is its advocacy for the review of legislations that do not adequately address the needs of the youth, myths and beliefs on youth with disabilities such as the National Youth Act, National Sports Council Act and Alcohol Policy; it also pled for the enactment of specific legislation to protect youth in specific circumstances namely: prostitution; impregnating school girls that involves other males apart from teachers; sexual abuse/harassment/incest; harmful cultural practices; corporal punishment; drug, alcohol and substance abuse; early, forced, and arranged marriages; universal primary and increased access to secondary school education; juvenile justice; and child trafficking.

3.2 Gender and Youth and Sectoral and Climate Change Policies

3.2.1 Women and Youth and National Climate Change Investment Plan (2013-2018)

63. Considering the adverse impacts of climate change on food security, water availability and quality, and energy that affect mostly rural community’s livelihoods, the formulation of the National Climate Change Investment Plan (NCCIP) responded to the need to develop well researched plans of activities to provide the foundation and basis for implementing comprehensive and coordinated actions geared towards arresting climate change and its hazards.

64. The NCCIP identified four key priority areas to promote climate change management that are adaptation; mitigation; climate change research, technology development and transfer; and capacity building. As shown in the table below, eleven programmes will be pursued to implement concrete actions in the 4 priority areas.

Priority area	Related Programmes
Adaptation	- Integrated Watershed Management Programme; - Improving Climate Change Community Resilience through Agriculture Production; - Climate Change Proofing of Infrastructure Development; - Enhancing Disaster Risk Management
Mitigation	- Enhance Reduction of Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (REDD+); - Waste Management and Pollution Control Programme; - Enhancing Energy-Saving Technology Programme

Priority area	Related Programmes
Climate change research, technology development and transfer	- Climate Change Adaptation Technology Development (CCATD); - Malawi's National Climate Change Investment Plan - Climate Change Mitigation Technology Development (CCMTD); - Adaptation and Mitigation Technology Transfer (AMTT)
Capacity building	Capacity Development in Climate Change

65. The NCCIP ensured that the key priority areas of the actions to address climate change and their effects are timely and sufficiently supported with resources in order to ensure that the economy and society in Malawi develop to their full potential within a well-protected and sustainable environment, safeguarded from major climate change effects, and with responsibility towards present and future generations. The NCCIP was expected to guide the Government to allocate budgetary resources based on corresponding requirements and the optimal contribution of the sector to the key priorities of the MGDS II. It also provided a framework for monitoring, reporting and accounting for the resources allocated to the sector by clearly providing strategic priorities and targets. The Plan took stock of existing investment portfolios in climate change and assessed related challenges and gaps.

66. The NCCIP considered gender among the challenges that limit the country's response to the impacts of climate change. At the same time, social, cultural and gender issues are cited among the plan's sustainability factors as the Plan recognized the importance of the participation of key target groups, such as women and the youth, in all parts of the programme cycle. The NCCIP also referred to the need to draw from the experience in mainstreaming HIV/AIDS and gender, through the allocation of a minimum percentage of budget to climate-related activities.

3.2.2 Women and Youth and the National Climate Change Management Policy (2016)

67. The Government of Malawi has taken important steps to address climate change issues by signing and ratifying the UNFCCC and its Kyoto Protocol in recognition of the country's vulnerability to adverse effects of climate change. It developed the National Climate Change Management Policy (NCCMP) 2016 to assist the country achieve its long-term goal for climate change management which is to reduce the socioeconomic impacts of adverse effects of climatic change.

68. The Policy's goal was to promote climate change adaptation, mitigation, technology transfer and capacity building for sustainable livelihoods through Green Economy measures for Malawi; and its medium-term outcome consisted of improved community resilience to climate change through the development of sustainable livelihoods and reduced emissions of GHGs. In terms of objectives, the NCCMP aimed to:

- "Build and sustain the social and ecological resilience of all Malawians;
- Contribute towards the stabilization of greenhouse gas concentrations in the atmosphere at a level that would prevent dangerous human-induced interference with the climate system within a timeframe that enables social, economic and environmental development to proceed in a sustainable manner;

- Integrate climate change into planning, development, coordination and monitoring of key relevant sectors in a gender sensitive manner; and
- Integrate cross-cutting issues into climate change management through an appropriate institutional framework.”

69. By articulating the goals and objectives for climate change management in Malawi, the Policy stood as a mechanism for harmonizing and enhancing the planning, development, coordination, financing and monitoring of climate change initiatives and programmes in the country.

70. Gender equality is considered among the Policy’s guiding principles given that women and girls are disproportionately affected by climate change and are more vulnerable to its impacts. Gender equality must therefore be promoted as a response both in terms of mainstreaming as well as through specific focused interventions. The Policy also relies on the principle of equitable development pointing out the will to address poverty reduction and equity. The notion of inter-generational equity refers to the right of future generations to enjoy a fair level of the common patrimony, while intra-generational equity relates the right of all people within the current generation to fair access Earth’s natural resources. As the participation of vulnerable groups are stated under this principle, specific mention is made to children and the disabled. Special needs and circumstances are also considered as one of the Policy’s guiding principles since the adverse effects of climate change may imply specific constraints and needs to the vulnerable groups such as women - especially poor and/or rural women, children - especially infants and child-headed families; the aged; the sick; and the physically challenged.

71. The NCCMP identified 6 Priority Areas namely (i) climate change adaptation; (ii) climate change mitigation; (iii) capacity building, education, training and awareness; (iv) research, technology development and transfer, and systematic observation; (v) climate change financing; and (vi) cross-cutting issues. This last Priority Area focused on cross cutting issues that may exacerbate vulnerability to climate change and variability or may undermine effectiveness of adaptation programmes. While gender consideration are explicitly mentioned in the Crossing-cutting issues Priority Area, no specific mention on youth is made. The way the document is written makes wonder though if the Policy does not assimilate youth with children. Another cross-cutting issue raised is the population dynamics but it mostly refers to population density, urbanization, reproductive health and family planning. Policy statements related to cross-cutting issues are as follows:

- “Mainstream gender and issues affecting the disadvantaged groups into all climate change strategies, plans and programmes;
- Integrate population issues into climate change management in the development agenda through an integrated approach which would reduce poverty, protect natural resources and reduce inequality;
- Incorporate HIV and AIDS as well as gender considerations in all climate change interventions including adaptation, mitigation, capacity building and technology development and transfer.”

72. Besides, the first Priority Area on Climate Change Adaptation considered women and girls’ participation in the planning and implementation of climate change adaptation interventions, and made it one of its 3 Policy Statements.

73. Key stakeholders for Policy implementation include: government, non-governmental organizations and civil society, the private sector, academia, development partners, local communities, faith based organizations and identified vulnerable groups.

3.2.3 Women and Youth and Malawi's National Adaptation Plan Framework (2020)

74. The national Adaptation Plan (NAP) Framework is intended to guide the country in advancing its NAP process. It constitutes the guiding structure of Malawi's efforts on the development and implementation of its National Adaptation Plan, and outlines how to integrate climate change adaptation into relevant new and existing sectoral and national planning structures³². Its elaboration is part of the NAP process initiated by the Government in September 2014, with the aim to reduce vulnerability to the impacts of climate change by building adaptive capacity and resilience.

75. The NAP Framework builds on the NAP Roadmap developed and adopted in 2016, and validates the vision identified which is "A country with people, ecosystems and infrastructure that are resilient and have adaptive capacity to the impacts of climate change". It also validates the 5 NAP Mandates:

- Improve community resilience to climate change through enhanced agricultural production, infrastructure development and disaster risk management;
- Enhance sustainable utilization of natural resources especially forest, water, fisheries and wildlife resources;
- Improve environmental management especially soil and land management;
- Enhance conservation and/ or restoration of biodiversity and ecosystems; and
- Provide climate change adaptation advocacy to policy-makers and other stakeholders with a view to enacting, updating and enforcing laws and by-laws on climate change as well as environmental and natural resource management.

76. The 4 building blocks for the NAP process are identified in the NAP Roadmap namely: national development strategies; capacity development; knowledge and information management; and sustainability and partnerships.

77. The NAP Framework is designed to maintain the momentum of the NAP process in advance of receiving adaptation planning readiness funding from the Green Climate Fund (GCF). It provides a basis for engaging stakeholders in the NAP process, presenting an overarching framework for adaptation planning processes to be undertaken by government ministries and sub-national authorities, as well as for dialogue with non-governmental stakeholders.

78. The Framework considers gender in multiple ways. It relies on the NAP Stocktaking which provided the baseline upon which the NAP process is built, and which recommended considering the "inclusiveness of gender, disability and other socially excluded vulnerable groups in the implementation of climate change adaptation interventions" among the thematic areas to be taken into account for the medium- and long-term adaptation planning horizon of the NAP process. Besides, while aligning to the Republican Constitution of Malawi and the country's National Gender Policy (2015), the Framework also emphasizes on the use of gender and human rights approach in the process of formulation and implementation of the NAP. This will be done by ensuring the inclusion of ultra-poor, women, youth and disadvantaged groups in program design as well as their participation in program's implementation at community level. The Malawi NAP also considers the key points highlighted in the Framework for Gender-Responsive National Adaptation Plan³³ and ensure that women's voices are heard and taken into consideration in planning and implementation of the NAP. Gender inclusiveness including gender parity, women's

³² Malawi's National Adaptation Plan Framework, Ministry of Natural Resources, Energy and Mining Environmental Affairs Department, March 2020

³³ A Framework for Gender-Responsive National Adaptation Plan (NAP) Processes, Dazé & Dekens, NAP Global Network, 2017: <http://napglobalnetwork.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/10/napgn-en-2017-gender-considerationsadaptation-planning.pdf>

empowerment and upholding of women's rights, is therefore considered as a critical guiding principle of the NAP process. This inclusiveness also includes youth who are already engaged through various climate change networks. Through the NAP's guiding principle on uplifting the poor and vulnerable, women and children are also considered among the targeted vulnerable groups that should benefit from the planning and implementation of climate change adaptation interventions.

3.2.4 Women and Youth and the 3rd National Communication of the Republic of Malawi to the Conference of the Parties of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (2021)

79. The Third National Communication (TNC) of Malawi was an improvement, follow-up and continuation of activities under the Initial National Communication (INC) and the Second National Communication (SNC) completed in 2003 and 2011 respectively. It aimed at:

- Enhancing the visibility and impact of climate change issues through increased involvement of all relevant stakeholders in the process;
- Enhancing general awareness and knowledge of climate change related issues in Malawi and enabling their incorporation into national planning and policy frameworks as well as helping in building national capacities for participation in climate change activities;
- Contributing to global efforts in better understanding the various sources and sinks of greenhouse gases, potential impacts of climate change, and effective response measures to achieve the ultimate goal of UNFCCC of stabilizing greenhouse gas concentrations in the atmosphere to a level that would prevent dangerous anthropogenic interference with the climate system;
- Proposing climate change projects aimed at finding solutions to climate change problems that communities can adapt and/or use to mitigate climate change;
- Strengthening dialogue, information exchange, networking and cooperation among various stakeholders in the public and private sector organizations, including NGOs, and the university, involved in climate change studies in accordance with Article 6 of the UNFCCC.

80. The TNC comprised a stocktaking exercise of the INC and SNC and set priorities for implementation in a manner that ensures effective allocation of resources. The communication focused on:

- Describing the national circumstances that are relevant to climate change;
- Conducting national greenhouse gas inventory in the areas of energy, agriculture, forestry and other land-use, industrial processes and product use, and waste management;
- Conducting Vulnerability and Adaptation (V&A) Assessments that gave detailed overview of various measures and strategies that can be used by vulnerable communities to adapt to the adverse impacts of climate change (in the areas of agriculture, water, human health, energy, infrastructure, land resources, fisheries, forestry, tourism, industry, wildlife and gender);
- Conducting mitigation analysis that provided information on measures and strategies for mitigating climate change (in the areas of energy, agriculture, forestry and other land-use, industrial processes and product use, and waste management);
- Providing additional information that are considered relevant to the achievement of the objectives of the Convention;
- Identifying constraints and gaps, and related financial, technical and capacity needs; and
- Proposing climate change projects.

81. The Communication dealt with gender by considering the issue as one of the thematic areas of the V&A assessments. The related section provided some highlights on gender and its link to climate change, a description of the gender context in the country and the importance of gender when dealing with climate change issues, some elements on vulnerability in terms of gender mostly for women, and the potential adaptation strategies namely gender mainstreaming, civic education and public awareness and climate financing. The same chapter on Vulnerability and Adaptation (V&A) Assessments also touched upon women in the assessment related to human health and wildlife.

3.2.5 Women and Youth and the Updated Nationally Determined Contributions (2021)

82. As part of its commitment to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and the Paris Agreement, Malawi submitted and communicated in 2015 its commitment to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and scale-up adaptation actions through the Intended Nationally Determined Contribution (INDC). The Government's vision is that the implementation of the Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) is building Malawi's resilience to overcome challenges of climate change and is embracing the opportunities available to enable the country lay a solid foundation for a sustainable and prosperous Malawi in line with the Malawi Vision 2063. The Updated NDC represents the first revision of Malawi's 2015-2040 NDC. Through the revision, the NDC outlines the country's climate change priorities for the period from 2020-2040 and articulates areas of priority for climate change management through both mitigation and adaptation measures. Being prepared together with accompanying documents that facilitate its implementation, mainstreaming, monitoring and reporting including: Implementation Plan; Mainstreaming Guidelines; Monitoring, Reporting and Verification Framework; and Resource Mobilization Strategy; the NDC provides concrete strategies for addressing the causes of climate change and responding to the adverse effects and impacts in line with provisions established under the Paris Agreement.

83. The updated NDC builds upon the NCCMP in its commitment to tackling climate change through the development of both mitigation and adaption responses, as well as other key national guiding documents including Malawi 2063, the Malawi Economic Growth Strategy (MEGS), and the Malawi Growth and Development Strategies (MGDS) III. It also aligns with Malawi's NAP Framework. As do these reference documents, the updated NDC also indicates gender among the sectors most affected by climate change. Treated with social protection, gender is therefore one of the socio-economic sectors considered in the sectoral vulnerability assessment for the identification, assessment, and prioritization of adaptation actions and measures. As a result from the process, gender has been included in the thematic area of "Healthy and protected people" that aims at promoting public health and social protection in the face of climate change. Treated with the issues of social support, the gender adaptation actions and measures' focus are put on the mainstreaming of the issue in policies, programmes and projects; capacity building programmes for vulnerable groups, civic education and public awareness are also to be supported.

84. The focal point line ministry for the implementation of gender measures of the NDC is the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Welfare. The roles of NGOs/CSOs including gender network are also highlighted. In terms of capacity building for implementation, climate change adaptation measures planned with a gender lens, and capable of tracking and progress and outcomes by gender are needed. The updated NDC has an improved Monitoring and Evaluation framework that includes engendered measure-specific indicators allowing to track the integration of gender and vulnerability across sectors for adaptation activities.

3.2.6 Women and Youth and the National Environmental Policy

85. The Government of Malawi adopted a National Environmental Policy in 1996 to provide guidance and set standards for development of sector policies in environment and natural resources. It provided an overall framework against which relevant sectoral environmental policies were revised and adopted to ensure that these were consistent with the principles of sustainable development. The adoption and enactment of many sectoral environment and natural resources policies and legislation in successive years revealed some policy gaps, conflicts and duplications that adversely affected the effective implementation of the policies; and which combined with the occurrence of new national economic instruments and strategies, prompted the Government to revise the National Environmental Policy.

86. Responding to new challenges and incorporating lessons learned, the revised National Environmental Policy of 2004 recognized the importance of (i) creating an enabling policy and legal framework for cross sector coordination, participation of non-state actors, (ii) strengthening the enforcement machinery, and (iii) decentralizing natural resources and environmental management and governance. Its overall goal consisted of promoting sustainable social and economic development through the sound management of the environment and natural resources. It also defined 12 specific goals focusing on environment and natural resources management, preservation and restoration; enhancement of public education and awareness on various environmental issues as well as public participation in addressing them; integration of sustainable environment and natural resources management into the decentralized governance systems; promotion of local community, Non-Governmental Organisations (NGO) and private sector participation in environment and natural resources management; promotion of the use and application of local knowledge and norms; development and regular update of environmental information systems; facilitation of development and regular review of policies and legislation as well as development of mechanisms for management of conflicts in the environment and natural resources sector.

87. Three of the Policy's guiding principles are oriented on children, youth, women and communities. These principles emphasized on:

- Children and youth awareness of environmental issues to facilitate their participation in the conservation, protection and management of the environment as future custodians;
- Women's effective participation in policy, program and project design and implementation to enhance their role in natural resource use and management activities; and
- Community-based management and revenue sharing from the sustainable utilization of natural resources on customary and public lands.

88. Among its 12 cross-sectoral policy objectives, six subjects are particularly relevant to the project seen from gender and social inclusion perspective: environmental and public awareness; private sector and community participation; gender, youth and children; demographic planning; human settlements and health; and land tenure and land use. The Policy specified proper objective, guiding principles and strategies for each policy objective. The sectoral policy objectives included several areas covered by the project including agriculture and livestock, forestry and fisheries.

3.2.7 Women and Youth and National Land Resource Management Policy and Strategy (2000)

89. Malawi adopted the National Land Resources Management Policy and Strategy in 2000. Its overall goal was to promote efficient, diversified and sustainable use of land-based resources

for both agriculture and other uses so as to avoid sectoral land-use conflicts and ensure socio-economic development. In terms of outcomes, the Policy was developed to assist in:

- “Balancing requirements for different land uses and regulating the competing demand for land by different sectors;
- Designating the best use of land for optimal socio-economic development;
- Providing guidelines and strategies for the sustainable utilization of the land resource base;
- Defining roles of different players in land resources management issues, guide the formulation and review of sectoral policies and legislation related to land use and its management; and
- Enabling the country to determine the priority application of both internal and externally provided resources.”

90. The Policy considered among its guiding principles the full involvement of community based organizations and local communities; the equitable and secure tenure over land and resources for users as a fundamental requirement for promoting the adoption of sustainable natural resource management; the inclusion of women and youth in policy, programme and project design and implementation; and the need to manage the population growth that threatens the carrying capacity of environment, natural resources and the economy; among others.

91. The policy outlined 16 specific objectives in different areas including women and gender. The objective of the policy is to integrate gender issues in policy and decision making on land so that men and women as equal partners have a shared responsibility over sustainable use and management of land resources. To this end, the policy provided for the utilization of positive traditional knowledge of women in sustainable land use and management; the development and implementation of policies that recognize and enshrine the legal rights of women to land on an equitable basis; and the promotion of women’s perspectives, especially women and children, in all programmes addressing land use and management issues.

92. The specific objective on institutional capacity building also highlighted among its strategies the empowerment of rural community to allow these latter effectively manage their land resources.

3.2.8 Women and Youth and the National Forest Policy (2016)

93. The National Forest Policy of 2016 took over from the National Forest Policy of 1996 and the National Forest Programme formulated in 2000 to guide the implementation of the 1996 Policy. The 2016 National Forest Policy aimed at providing guidance to the management of forests, offering an enabling framework for all stakeholders participating in the management of forests, and sustaining the contribution of the national forest resources for the upliftment of the quality of life.

94. “The goal of the National Forest Policy is to improve provision of forest goods and services to contribute towards sustainable development of Malawi through protection and conservation of forest resources.” The Policy aspires to control deforestation and forest degradation and promotes strategies that contribute to increased forest cover by 2% from the current 28% by 2021 as well as to sustainable management of existing forest resources. The overall objectives of the Policy are to:

- “Provide an enabling framework for promoting the participation of local communities, the civil society and the private sector in forest conservation and management;

- Promote the establishment of forest based small and medium scale industries;
- Promote the growing of trees by all sections of the communities in order to achieve sustainable self-sufficiency of wood and forest derived products and services;
- Promote sustainable management of forests for the protection of the environment, conservation of biodiversity and climate change management;
- Promote the development of initiatives for adequate and sustainable short, medium and long term financing mechanisms for the forestry sector and its contribution to GDP;
- Enhance the development of requisite human resource commensurate with the implementation of the policy;
- Promote the sustained management and utilization of forest resources based on research findings and recommendations;
- Promote a well regulated, compliant and monitored forestry sector with clearly defined forest standards and guidelines; and
- Enhance cooperation in forestry related issues at national, regional and international levels to maximize resources and information flows into the forestry sector.”

95. To address sustainable forest management, the Government identified 10 Priority Areas namely: (i) Community Based Forest Management; (ii) Indigenous Forests, Forest Reserves, and Ecosystem Management; (iii) Forest Plantations and Estates Management; (iv) Forestry Regulation and Quality Control; (v) Forestry Knowledge Acquisition and Management; (vi) Capacity Development for Forestry Sector; (vii) Biomass Energy Development; (viii) Development of Forest Based Industries; (ix) Regional and International Cooperation; and (x) Financing Mechanisms. Sustainable Forest Management will ensure continuous provision of forest goods and services, increased forest cover and climate change management.

96. While the only priority area that emphasized on the participation of local communities was the first one related to Community Based Forest Management, the involvement of women or youth was not specified. Priority areas 5 and 6 related to knowledge acquisition and capacity development for the forest sector also related the needs to develop the human resources required for the sector but this mention remained vague. Although the Policy was well developed from a technical point of view, insufficient provisions were made from a gender and youth perspective.

3.2.9 Women and Youth and the Malawi National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (2015-2025)

97. The National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan II (NBSAP II) is a framework for action that will guide Malawi to sustainably manage its biodiversity. The Strategy outlines the status of the biological resources in Malawi and provides strategies, targets and actions to be taken to ensure their sustainable management. The strategy is in line with the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy II, which prioritizes biodiversity management programs among other socio-economic and environmental issues.

98. The goal of the strategy is to enhance the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity for the environment and human well-being. This goal will be achieved through the attainment of the following specific strategic objectives that rely on 16 targets and a set of actions:

- Improved capacity and knowledge on biodiversity issues;
- Increased mainstreaming of biodiversity management into sectoral and local development planning;
- Reduced direct pressures on biodiversity;

- Improved status of biodiversity by safeguarding ecosystems, species and genetic diversity; and
- Enhanced access and benefit sharing from biodiversity and ecosystem services.

99. The strategy refers to gender roles and responsibilities of the youth in the strategic objective 5 on the enhancement of access and benefits sharing from biodiversity and ecosystem services. Related Target 15 supports in enhancing the participation of vulnerable groups, the youth, and women in biodiversity management and in ensuring that these groups benefit fully from the ecosystem services that biodiversity provides.

3.2.10 Women and Youth and the National Agriculture Policy (2016)

100. The National Agriculture Policy 2016 sought to sustainably transform the agriculture sector from subsistence to market-oriented in order to increase agricultural production, marketed surpluses of commodities, and real incomes. Since the principal responsibility of agriculture is to produce sufficient diverse and nutritious foods, provide reliable food markets, and increase agricultural incomes; the vision of the NAP to assuring food security and nutrition is based on a more coordinated and diversified approach through the commercialization of agriculture products. A particular focus had also been put on smallholder farmers involved in commercialization in order to optimize resources that go to smallholder subsector, although the policy recognized all types of entrepreneurial farmers and supported them to increase the scale and quality of their production. Pro-poor linkages between large-scale estates and smallholder farmers were also promoted. Since the agriculture sector may not be able to absorb all the skilled and unskilled labor available in the sector, the Government may need to develop accompanying strategies that enable many Malawians to leave the agriculture sector and move into remunerative non-agricultural employment, and provide social protection services for the most vulnerable. The NAP was based on spirit of inclusiveness and coordinated partnerships, and relied on the key consideration related to the place of smallholder farming in the development pathway of agricultural transformation.

101. Standing as a clear and comprehensive policy guidance for the agricultural sector, the Policy aimed to ensure continued and increasingly positive contributions to agricultural development and to the economy as a whole by farmers, processors, and traders. Its main operational rationale was to improve coherence across the wide range of agricultural sub-sector policies that are in place and to better coordinate their implementation.

102. The Policy identified eight priority areas that are: (i) Sustainable Agricultural Production and Productivity; (ii) Sustainable Irrigation Development; (iii) Mechanization of Agriculture; (iv) Agricultural Market Development, Agro-processing and Value Addition; (v) Food and Nutrition Security; (vi) Agricultural Risk Management; (vii) Empowerment of Youth, Women and Vulnerable Groups in Agriculture; and (viii) Institutional Development, Coordination and Capacity Strengthening. While Policy priority Area 1 on Sustainable Agricultural Production and Productivity raised women and youth's inadequate access, control, and utilization of productive assets, such as land and water; Policy Priority Area 4 on Agricultural Market Development, Agro-processing and Value Addition made provisions on the promotion of women and youth's access to financial services and agricultural credit. Policy Priority Area 7 related to the Empowerment of Youth, Women and Vulnerable Groups in Agriculture emphasized on the high involvement of women and youth in the agricultural sector, as well as their inability to effectively contribute to the agricultural growth given their limited access to, ownership and control of finances and productive assets in the sector. The Policy statements and related objectives are as follows:

Table 5: Policy Statement and Objective of Policy Priority Area 7 on Empowerment of Youth, Women and Vulnerable Groups in Agriculture

Policy statements	Policy objectives
3.7.1. Increase women's and youth's access, ownership and control of productive agricultural assets by 50 percent by 2020	Increase profitable participation of youth, women and vulnerable groups in agricultural production
3.7.2. Promote agricultural education and technical training for women, youth, and vulnerable groups particularly those living with disabilities	Improve capacity of youth, women and vulnerable groups to effectively participate in agricultural development
3.7.3. Support agribusiness entrepreneurship among women, youth, and vulnerable groups particularly those living with disabilities	Improve agribusiness skills of women, youth and vulnerable groups
3.7.4. Facilitate access to finance for women, youth and vulnerable groups in agriculture	Reduce gender, age and other inequalities in access to finance
3.7.5. Promote participation of women, youth and vulnerable groups in agro-processing, value addition and agricultural exports	Reduce gender, age and other gaps in agriculture

Source: National Agriculture Policy, 2016

103. In terms of implementation arrangements, the Malawi Government recognized the importance of partnerships involving different stakeholders including various ministries; statutory corporations, trusts, councils, and boards; presidential and cabinet initiatives; farmer-based organizations; the private sector; civil society and development partners. A particular attention is put on the critical role farmer-based organizations play in empowering women, youth and vulnerable groups. The Policy's monitoring and evaluation plan included an indicator on the increase of women's and youth's access, ownership and control of productive agricultural assets by 50 percent by 2020.

3.2.11 Women and Youth and the National Agriculture Investment Plan (2017/18- 2022/23)

104. The National Agriculture Investment Plan (NAIP) is a medium-term investment framework for the agricultural sector covering a five year period. Aligned to the Comprehensive Africa Agriculture Development Program (CAADP), the African Union Malabo Declaration on Accelerated Agricultural Growth and Transformation for Shared Prosperity and Improved Livelihoods, and the national development policy blue print, the Malawi Growth and Development Strategy (MGDS III), it built on achievements and lessons from its predecessor, the Agriculture Sector Wide Approach (ASWAp) implemented between 2010/11 and 2014/15. The NAIP serves as the main implementation vehicle for the 2016 National Agriculture Policy (NAP), and provides a framework to coordinate and prioritize investments by government agencies, development partners, and non-state actors (civil society, farmer organizations and the private sector).

105. The goal of the NAIP consists of sustainable agricultural transformation that will result in significant growth of the agricultural sector, expanding incomes for farm households, improved food and nutrition security for all Malawians, and increased agricultural exports. It has three mutually reinforcing impact-level objectives that are: (i) broad-based and resilient agricultural growth; (ii) improved well-being and livelihoods of Malawians; and (iii) improved food and nutrition security.

106. Estimated at 3.219 billion US\$, the NAIP is structured around four programs and 16 Intervention areas (IAs). The four programs and related objectives are summarized in the below table.

Program	Objective
A. Policies, institutions and coordination	To improve policy and regulatory environment, stakeholder coordination and accountability
B. Resilient livelihoods and agricultural systems	To strengthen resilience of livelihoods and natural resource base for agriculture.
C. Production and productivity	To increase production and productivity of a more diversified agricultural sector
D. Markets, value addition, trade and finance	To enhance market access, value addition, trade, and access to finance

107. Cutting across the four programs, the following 16 IAs are needed to achieve the objectives of the NAIP: (i) Policy, Program and Stakeholder Coordination; (ii) Farmer Organisations; (iii) Public agricultural services delivery; (iv) Food and Nutrition Security; (v) Food safety and quality standards; (vi) Empowerment and tenure security; (vii) Disaster risk management; (viii) Pest and disease management; (ix) Agricultural innovation systems; (x) Access to inputs; (xi) Natural resource management and Climate Change; (xii) Irrigation development; (xiii) Mechanisation; (xiv) Agricultural markets and trade; (xv) Investments in agribusiness; (xvi) Access to financial services.

108. With regards to gender, the description of the country and sector context gives visibility to women and youth, by highlighting the challenges they have to face in terms of livelihoods. The NAIP also recognizes through its second impact-level objective on improved well-being and livelihoods, the heterogeneous nature of rural communities and the importance of tailoring specific measures to address the needs of vulnerable/poor sub-groups (eg. for closing the gender gap in agriculture, supporting youth employment and entrepreneurship, support labour-constrained households such as those affected by HIV/AIDS, etc.). Besides, the NAIP consider gender and youth as an additional strategic consideration that should be mainstreamed in all parts of the NAIP given women's pivotal role in agricultural production and considering the serious disadvantages both women and youth in rural communities experienced. The NAIP various interventions are therefore expected to properly target the participation of at least 50 percent of women and the occupation of decision-making positions by at least 40 percent of women.

109. Under the IA on farmer organizations, the output contributing to Program A on addressing capacity gaps in gender related aspects; and output contributing to Program B on the establishment of formalized farmer organizations with a particular focus on women and youth, and their capacity building; would support the outcome on strengthening the performance and outreach of farmer organisations at all levels.

110. The IA on empowerment and tenure security clearly identified a gender outcome on "women and youth empowered and land tenure security enhanced" and a gender intermediate outcome on "increased participation of women and youth in agricultural value chains and institutions". This outcome will be achieved through the combined effects of outputs related to Program A: (i) Government staff trained on gender, and (ii) update of agricultural curricula on gender, HIV/AIDS and youth issues; Program B: (i) Intra-household gender relations improved, (ii) women and youth groups strengthened and empowered in relation to land tenure security; and Program D: (i) agribusiness SMEs owned/operated by women and youth trained on various technical and business aspects, and (ii) youth and women agribusiness entrepreneurs receiving business mentorship.

111. Intervention area on access to financial services is also elaborating on women's and youth's improved access to agricultural finance through their capacity strengthening in financial literacy and financial management (contributing to Program C) and support to youth and women start-up activities and adoption of innovative technologies (contributing to Program D).

112. Some examples of gender and youth mainstreaming measures to encourage participation of women and youth include: promotion of gender and youth responsive extension approaches, review of the agricultural sector gender and HIV strategy, training for Government staff in gender and youth mainstreaming, gender and age disaggregation of all performance targets and indicators, targets for gender and youth participation in training programs.

3.2.12 Women and Youth and the Agriculture sector, Gender, HIV and AIDS strategy (2012-2017)

113. The Agriculture Sector, Gender, HIV and AIDS strategy 2012-2017 took over from the first strategy developed in 2003 and implemented between 2003 and 2008. Building on the gaps and lessons identified from the evaluation of the strategy in 2009, the Ministry in collaboration with various stakeholders developed the Strategy to guide the implementation of gender, HIV and AIDS responsive programs and projects in the Agriculture Sector.

114. The empowerment of women was at the core of the strategy goal which consist of "contributing to sustainable and equitable food, nutrition and income security at national, community and household level through the empowerment of women and other vulnerable gender categories". The purpose of the strategy was "to promote gender equality, prevent the spread of HIV and mitigate the impacts of AIDS in order to increase agricultural productivity in line with ASWAp priorities". The Strategy had 3 pillars namely: i) Quality participation of women and other vulnerable gender categories in ASWAp focus areas and key support services; ii) Gender, HIV and AIDS responsive technology generation and dissemination; and iii) Effective coordination, capacity building and resource mobilization. Specific objectives of the Strategy included:

- "To improve food and nutrition security and agro-based income among vulnerable groups, in order to reduce gender disparities and contribute to HIV prevention and mitigation of impacts;
- To strengthen women's access to and control over agriculture resources, opportunities, benefits and decision making processes at household, community and national levels;
- To reduce factors that promote gender inequality and spread of HIV due to agricultural related mobility and migration;
- To promote generation and dissemination of gender, HIV and AIDS responsive technologies and information;
- To strengthen leadership and coordination of the Gender, HIV and AIDS Strategy for harmonized and decentralized implementation;
- To mobilize, track and effectively utilize financial and technical resources for the implementation of Gender, HIV and AIDS Strategy;
- To strengthen the gender, HIV and AIDS responsiveness of agriculture sector monitoring and evaluation system for enhanced accountability, learning and sharing;
- To build and sustain capacity of agriculture sector institutions and vulnerable groups to effectively mainstream gender, HIV and AIDS issues and actions."

115. In terms of implementation, the Ministry of Agriculture and Food Security was in charge of providing policy guidance in the implementation of the strategy through the Executive Management Committee of ASWAp at national level. The Technical Working Group on Gender, HIV and AIDS was responsible of technically guiding the implementation of the strategy. At district

level, the strategy was implemented through the District Agriculture Extension Services System with collective efforts of all stakeholders.

116. Various groups were mentioned as focus of the strategy implementation: Women, Female Headed Households, Orphans and other Vulnerable Children, Child Headed Households, People with Disabilities, People Living with HIV, Mobile and Migrant Workers and the Elderly. Although the Strategy did not explicitly mention Youth, these various women groups could also include young women. The reference the Policy made to Children may also consider Youth since many Acts consider people under the age of 18 as children.

4. GENDER AND YOUTH

4.1 Basics Statistics

4.1.1 Gender Parity

117. With a Human Development Index (HDI) of 0.483 in 2019, the Human Development Report of the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)³⁴ ranked Malawi 174th out of 189 countries and territories and classified the country among the ones in the low human development category. Malawi's HDI increased by 45 percent between 1990 and 2019 with an increase of 18.2 years of life expectancy at birth and an increase of mean years of schooling and expected years of schooling of 2.3 years and 5.8 years respectively. The Gross National Income (GNI) per capita decreased by about 26.3 percent on the same period. Malawi's 2019 HDI is below the average for countries in the low human development group and for countries in Sub-Saharan Africa, which are 0.513 and 0.547 respectively.

118. When it comes to Inequality-adjusted HDI (IHDI) - an indicator that takes into account inequality in the three dimensions of HDI by "discounting" each dimension's average value according to each level of inequality, Malawi's HDI stood at 0.345 which represented a loss of 28.6 percent in human development due to inequality (after discounting the 2019 HDI of 0.483 for inequality). The Malawi's Human inequality coefficient of 28.6 percent appears to be lower than the average loss due to inequality of 31.4 percent for low HDI countries and of 30.5 percent for Sub-Saharan Africa.

119. In 2019, the value of the UNDP's Gender Development Index (GDI) - an indicator that considers sex-disaggregated HDI and which is defined as a ratio of the female to the male HDI - was of 0.986 for Malawi with the HDI value of 0.493 for females and 0.500 for males. The GDI value of 0.986 placed the country into Group 1, a category that includes countries with absolute deviation from gender parity of 2.5 percent or less³⁵, considering the three basic dimensions of human development, which are health, education and command over economic resources.

Table 6: Human Development of Women and Men in Malawi in 2019³⁶

Human Development Index	Life Expectancy at Birth	Expected Years of Schooling	Mean Years of Schooling	Gross National Income per capita
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³⁴ UNDP, 2020. Human Development Report 2020, The next frontier – Human development and the Anthropocene, Briefing note for countries on the 2020 Human Development Report Malawi."

³⁵ Malawi National Human Development Report 2021, Delivering Sustainable Human Development and Accountability at the local level: the experience of decentralisation in Malawi, UNDP, 2021

³⁶ UNDP, 2020. Human Development Report 2020, The next frontier – Human development and the Anthropocene, Briefing note for countries on the 2020 Human Development Report Malawi

Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male
0.493	0.500	67.4	61.1	11.2	11.3	6.9	5.2	838	1,237

Source: UNDP, 2020

120. Assessing gender-based inequalities in reproductive health, empowerment, and economic activity, the Gender Inequality Index (GII) of the UNDP ranked Malawi 142th out of 162 countries in 2019³⁷. This ranking can be illustrated by (i) a maternal mortality ratio that equals to 349 deaths per 100,000 live births, (ii) an adolescent birth rate of 132.7 births per 1,000 women aged 15-19, (iii) 22.9 percent of parliamentary seats held by women, (iv) 17.6 percent of adult women having reached at least a secondary level of education compared to 26.1 percent of their male counterparts, and (v) a female labour market participation of 72.6 percent compared to 81.1 percent for men. Malawi's GII of 0.565 is slightly better than the average of 0.570 for Sub-Saharan Africa and 0.592 for low HDI countries.

³⁷ Ibid.

Table 7: Malawi's Gender Inequality Index in 2019

Gender Inequality Index Ranking	Maternal Mortality Ratio	Adolescent Birth Rate	Female Seats in Parliament (%)	Population with at least some secondary education (%)		Labor Force Participation Rate (%)	
				Female	Male	Female	Male
142 out of 162	349.0	132.7	22.9	17.6	26.1	72.6	81.1

Source: UNDP, 2020

4.1.2 Population

121. Malawi's population increased from 3.6 million in 1960 to 19.6 million in 2021³⁸, and women account for 50.7 percent³⁹. The 2018 Malawi population and housing census reports (2018 PHC) reported a population size that is almost 4 times higher than that of the first census of 1966, and 1.3 times higher than that of the 2008 census. With an intercensal growth rate of 2.9 percent per annum, the total population increased by 35 percent between the 2008 and 2018. When the 2018 PHC estimated the sex ratio - defined as the number of males per 100 females, at 94.2 at national level, four cities were identified with more males than females namely Lilongwe, Blantyre, Mzuzu and Zomba. The Southern region had the highest population with 44 percent of the total population, followed by the Central and Northern Regions which had 43 percent and 13 percent of the total population respectively. From 2008 to 2018 census, the population density for the country increased from 138 to 186 persons per square kilometer. The Southern region had the highest population density (244) followed by the Central (211) and the Northern region (84). The share of population residing in the rural areas of the country amounted to 84 percent in 2018. In urban areas, 12 percent of the total population lived in the four major cities of Blantyre, Lilongwe, Mzuzu and Zomba, and 4 percent resided in other towns and Bomas. The population of the EbAM targeted districts are shown in Table 8.

³⁸ <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=MW>

³⁹ <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL.FE.ZS?locations=MW>

Table 8: Population in Target Districts

Region	Districts	Population	Male	Female
Northern Region	Chitipa	234,927	114,392	120,535
	Karonga	365,028	176,197	188,831
	Nkhata Bay	284,681	139,341	145,340
	Rumphi	229,161	112,652	116,509
Central Region	Dedza	830,512	395,882	434,630
Southern Region	Mangochi	1,148,611	545,500	603,111
	Zomba	746,724	356,718	390,006
	Mwanza	130,949	63,534	67,415
	Thyolo	721,456	340,759	380,697
	Nsanje	299,168	143,578	155,590
	Neno	138,291	67,357	70,934
Total		5,129,508	2,455,910	2,673,598

Source: National statistical office, 2018 MPHCS

122. The fifth integrated household survey 2019-2020 (IHS5) reported an average household size of 4.4 persons, with an average of 4.2 persons in urban areas and 4.4 persons in rural areas⁴⁰. Across regions, the household size for Southern Region was lower than other regions (4.3 persons) while it was the highest for Northern region (4.5 persons). Male-headed households had a higher average household size (4.6 persons) than female-headed households (3.9 persons). Female-headed households in the country represented 27.5 percent of all households. In urban areas, 80.6 percent of the households were headed by males and 19.4 headed by females. Across rural areas, female-headed households accounted for 29 percent and male-headed households for 71 percent. The Southern Region had more female-headed households (33.9 percent) than the Central and Northern Regions (22.6 percent and 22.5 percent respectively). Mangochi was the district with the highest proportion of households headed by females (43.3 percent).

123. As for population age distribution, the 2018 PHC reported 2.6 million people aged under five years, 6.3 million people aged 5-17 years, and about 8.7 million aged 18 years or more. The median age of the population in Malawi is 17 years⁴¹.

124. Malawi has a larger population in the younger age groups. The national youth policy defines youth as a person aged between 10 and 35 years⁴². The fifth integrated household survey 2019-2020 (IHS5) estimated that 49.26 percent of the population representing 8, 778,539 persons fell into this age group: young people aged 10-14 accounted for 15.1 percent, those aged 15-19 for 11.9 percent, those aged 20-24 for 8.5 percent, those aged 25-29 for 6.9 percent, those aged 30-34 for 5.6 percent⁴³ and those aged 35 for 1.26 percent⁴⁴. The 2018 PHC reported a higher percentage of youth in urban areas (55.2 percent) compared to rural areas (49 percent)⁴⁵.

125. The 2018 PHC reported some information on tribes. Mainly Bantus, the people of Malawi are divided into several ethnic groups: 6.0 million people (34.4 percent) were Chewa, 3.3 million people (18.9 percent) were Lomwe, 2.3 million people (13.3 percent) were Yao, 1.8 million people

⁴⁰ The fifth integrated household survey (IHS5) 2020 report, National Statistical office, November 2020

⁴¹ 2018 Malawi population and housing census, Main report, National statistical office, May 2019

⁴² National youth policy, Ministry of youth and sports, August 2013

⁴³ The fifth integrated household survey (IHS5) 2020 report, National Statistical office, November 2020

⁴⁴ https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Demographics_of_Malawi#Age_structure

⁴⁵ 2018 Malawi population and housing census, Children and youth report, National statistical office July 2020

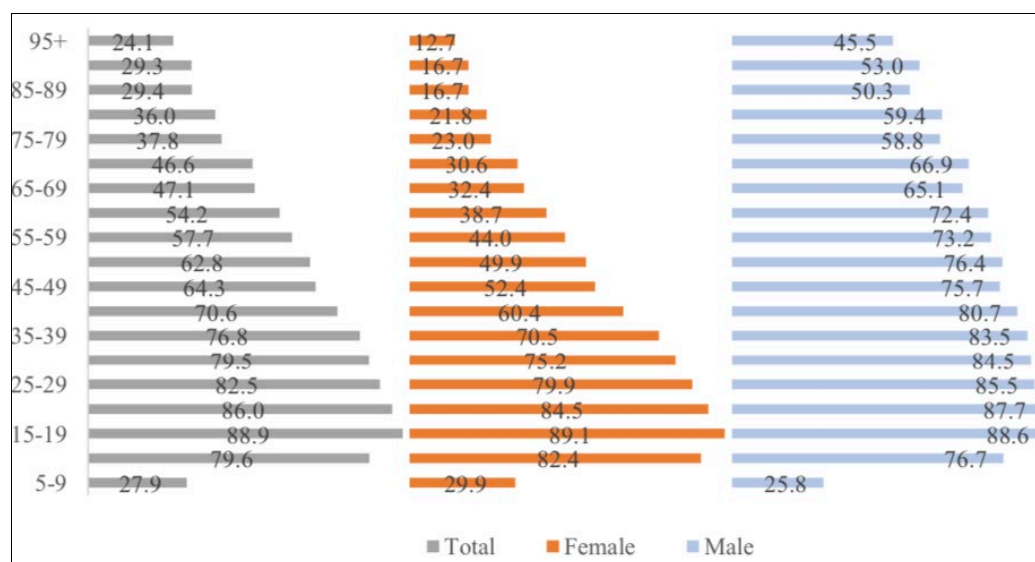
(10.4 percent) were Ngoni and 1.6 million people (9.2 percent) were Tumbuka. English is the country official language but other ethnic languages are used⁴⁶.

4.1.3 Literacy and education

126. **Literacy.** The Education report of the 2018 PHC described literacy as the ability to read and write a simple sentence in any language. Malawi's literacy rate for persons aged 5 years and above was 68.6 percent in 2018. Literacy levels showed an effective improvement based on the increase of 46.6 percentage difference compared to the rate of 22 percent recorded in the 1977 PHC, and of 4.7 percentage difference compared to the rate of 63.9 percent recorded in the 2008 PHC. The literacy rate for females increased more than that of males. The rates for males increased from 69.4 percent in 2008 to 71.6 percent in 2018 (2.2 percentage point difference) whereas the rates for females increased from 58.7 percent in 2008 to 65.9 percent in 2018 (7.2 point difference). The literacy gap between males and females also decreased between 2008 and 2018 considering the 10.7 percentage point difference in 2008 and the 5.7 percentage point difference in 2018. The tremendous improvement in female literacy rate by 2018 could be attributed to the various education initiatives that encourage education for females (UNICEF, 2017)⁴⁷.

127. In terms of age distribution, the national literacy level for the population in the country tended to decrease with the increase of age, regardless of sex. The literacy rate for 95 years and over is the lowest at 24.1 percent, then for the age group of 5 to 9 years old at 27.9 percent. Besides, the literacy gaps between females and males increased as the age increased, with the proportion of literate women decreasing with age, and the trend for men being not as steep as for women.

Figure 1: Proportion of the literate population by sex and age groups, Malawi 2018



Source: 2018 PHC, Education report

128. For youth aged 10-35 years, the national literacy rate estimated at 83.3 percent was higher than the national average. Young men and women literacy rates were estimated at 83.9 percent

⁴⁶ <https://www.worldatlas.com/articles/ethnic-groups-of-malawi.html>

⁴⁷ 2018 Malawi population and housing census, Education report, National statistical office July 2020

and 78.2 percent respectively. Literacy rate is higher among young people in urban areas (95.6 percent) than in rural areas (80.7 percent). The Northern Region (91.9) had a higher literacy rate compared to Central Region (81.3 percent) and Southern Region (82.7 percent). Available data on children and youth in the 3-35 age group showed a contrasted situation between cities and non-cities districts. The four cities of Malawi, Mzuzu, Lilongwe, Zomba and Blantyre had literacy rates ranging from 81.8 to 85.6 percent and some districts namely Mangochi and Nsanje had the lowest literacy rate of 50.6 percent and 55.1 percent respectively⁴⁸.

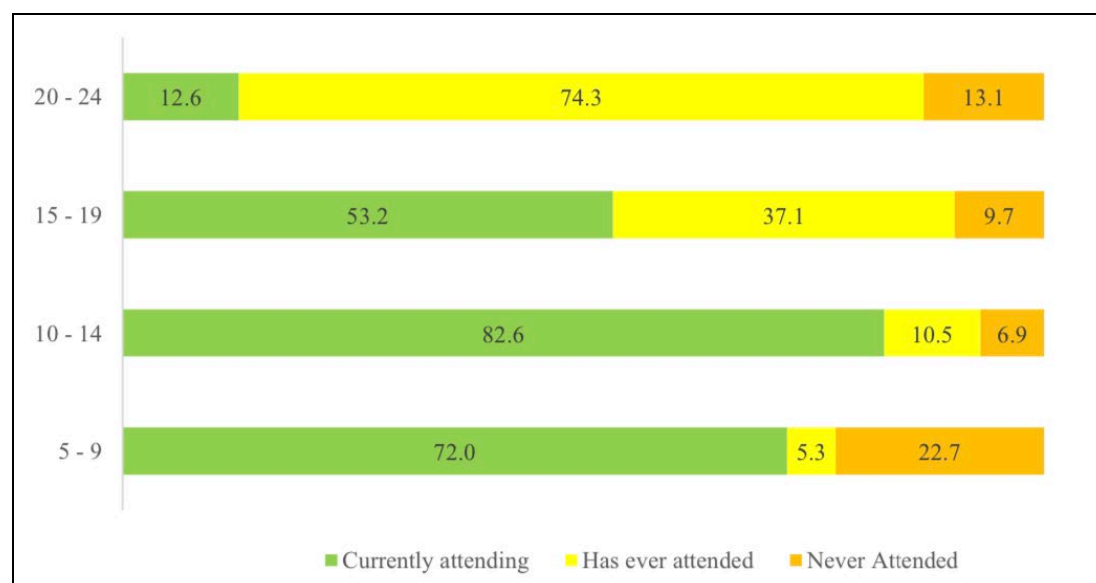
129. **Education.** In Malawi, the formal education includes 8 years of primary school, 4 years of secondary school and another 4 years of university-level education. The official school going ages are 6 to 13 years for primary school level, 14 to 17 years for secondary school level and 18 to 24 years for post-secondary school level.

130. The 2018 PHC observed school attendance for population aged 5-24 years old since some learners enter school at the younger age of 5 years. The school age population was estimated at 47 percent of the total population of which 23.2 percent were primary school age population, 9.5 percent were secondary school age population and 14.6 were post-secondary school age population. No major differences in distributions of these categories were noted by sexes, place of residence or regions.

131. In terms of school attendance, the 3-5 year old children attending preschool represented 29.7 percent in 2018. More children in the urban areas (47.3 percent) attended than in rural areas (27.0 percent). With 34.1 percent, the Northern Region had the highest proportion of children attending pre-school, followed by the Southern Region (32.9 percent) and the Central region (25.1 percent). For persons aged 5 to 24 years old, the highest proportion of population who had never attended school was observed in the 5-9 age group (22.7 percent) compared to the other age groups. The population of those who has ever attended school was highest for youth aged 20-24 years and the highest proportion of those currently attending school was among the 10-14 age group (Figure 2). The proportion of population currently attending school increased from 27.9 percent in 2008 to 34.9 percent in 2018, while those who had ever attended and who never attended school both decreased from 50.5 percent in 2008 to 46.8 percent in 2018 and from 21.6 percent in 2008 to 18.3 percent in 2018 respectively. The Southern and Central regions had the same highest proportions of population that never attended school (19.7 percent), whereas the Northern region had the highest proportion of those who ever attended (53.3 percent) and those currently attending school (37.5 percent). In the three regions, more females than males never attended, and there are more males than females among those who had ever attended and currently attending. School attendance analysed by religion showed that the highest proportion of people (49.3 percent) who never attended school were traditional believers.

⁴⁸ 2018 Malawi population and housing census, Children and youth report, National statistical office July 2020

Figure 2: Percentage of persons aged 5 to 24 years by school attendance status within age groups, Malawi 2018



Source: Malawi Population and Housing Census 2018

132. In 2018, primary school enrolment by age groups revealed that 72.6 percent of learners (74.1 percent were female and 71.1 percent male) fell under the appropriate primary school age range of 6-13 years old, under-aged learners and over-aged learners represented 4.8 percent (5.1 percent female and 4.5 percent male) and 22.7 percent (20.9 percent female and 24.5 percent male) respectively. The Gender parity index (GPI) for primary education remained at 1.0 or slightly above between 2008 and 2018, where some cases showed more girls as reflected in the population gender split in the country. The presence of under-aged and over-aged learners was reflected in the national Gross enrolment rate (GER) of 107.2 percent, which measures the proportion of children enrolled in primary school expressed as a percentage of the total number of children aged 6-13 years old. National GER was 106.4 percent for females and 108.1 percent for males. As for the national primary school Net enrolment rate (NER) that measures the proportion of children of appropriate age enrolled in primary school expressed as a percentage of the total number of children in the same age group, the rate of 77.8 percent (78.8 percent per females and 76.8 percent for males) showed that some children of official primary school age are not accessing primary education. Although the dropout rate for primary education significantly decreased from 11.7 percent in 2009 to 3.2 percent in 2018⁴⁹, retention remains a challenge. Primary completion rate was estimated 52 percent with fewer girls compared to boys completing primary. In addition, since it takes 13 years on average to graduate from the 8-year primary school program, the high repetition rate of 24.5 percent eventually led to dropout and low completion rate that increases the out-of-school children population.

133. Secondary school enrolments depend on primary school education completion and transition rates. In 2018, transition rate from primary to secondary school was at 38.3 percent. Secondary school enrolment rate for the ideal secondary school enrolment age of 14 to 17 years was 40.2 percent, and it was 3.8 percent for young people less than 14 years old and 56 percent for those aged 18 years old or more. Female and male school enrolment rate for youth aged 14-

⁴⁹ Malawi education sector analysis, Ministry of Education, Science, and Technology, 2019

17 were at 47.7 percent and 33.7 percent respectively. The GPI in secondary level enrolment had raised from 0.88 in 2014 to 0.92 in 2017. The proportion of males of the over-aged was 29.9-percentage point higher than for males aged 14 to 17. The national secondary GER was 40.5 percent with a higher percentage for male (43.1 percent) than for female (37.1 percent). The distribution of GER by sex followed the same trend in all three regions. Considering the youth of appropriate secondary school age of 14 to 17 years old, the NER was 16.3 percent. NER for females was consistently higher (18.1 percent) than that for males (14.5 percent). The 24.2 percentage point difference between the secondary GER and NER confirmed the predominance of over-aged youth among those enrolled. No data on the proportion of GER and NET by place of residence were available.

134. In terms of higher learning (tertiary), 89,665 students were enrolled in 2018 of whom 58.7 were male and 41.3 percent female. 2.6 percent of those who were enrolled were aged below 18 years, 62.4 percent were between 18 and 24 and 35.0 percent were over 25 years. Females have higher proportions than males in the younger ages: 71.7 percent of females enrolled in higher learning are below 25 years old while this percentage is at 60.3 for males. In rural areas, female's proportion for those under 25 years old was at 70.8 percent and males' proportion at 57.1 percent. In urban areas, female and male's proportions are 71.9 percent and 62.1 respectively. Male's proportion is higher than for females for those over 25 years both in rural and urban areas and at national level.

135. In 2018, about 70 percent of the national population had not attained any formal education qualification. This percentage had decreased of 3 percentage point from that of 2008, and the same percentage points of decline are observed both in rural and urban areas. Despite the decrease, the proportion of the rural population with no education attainment remained higher than that of the urban population (76.3 percent versus 44.5 percent in 2018). About 12 percent of the population aged 10 years and older have the Primary School Leaving Certificate (PSLC) of Education, the certificate validating the completion of 8 years of primary school. Females with PSLC were 12.1 percent and males were 12.5 percent. The slight difference of 0.4 percentage point observed between males and females for the PSLC increased for diplomas of higher level. The distribution for males of 8.2 percent was higher of 1.2 percentage point compared to those for females for the Junior certificate education (JCE), the diploma obtained after completing two years of secondary education; and males are approximately twice as likely to hold the Malawi school certificate of education (MSCE), the certificate provided after another two years of upper secondary school education.

4.1.4 Health

a. General health

136. Malawians' total life expectancy at birth has continuously improved from 45 years in 2000 to 65 years in 2020⁵⁰. In 2020, female life expectancy at birth estimated at 68 years exceeds that of men by 6 years. Adult mortality rates have also decreased since 2002, with a reduction of more than half for both male and female between 2002 and 2020⁵¹. According to both indicators, the situation in Malawi in 2020 is worse than the world average. Life expectancy at birth of Malawians and mortality rate for female adults are better than the Sub-Saharan Africa average, but male adult mortality rate is worse than those of sub-Saharan Africa and the world. In 2020, the causes of death in Malawi followed the same trends as in Sub-Saharan Africa: 50 percent of the deaths were due to communicable diseases and maternal, prenatal and nutrition conditions, 40 percent

⁵⁰ World Bank, 2021, "Data on health"

⁵¹ World Bank, 2021, "Data on health"

to non-communicable diseases and 10 percent to injury. While the proportion of deaths caused by communicable diseases had decreased significantly by 24 points of percentage from 74 percent in 2000 to 50 percent in 2019, deaths caused by non-communicable diseases had increased from 22 percent in 2000 to 40 percent in 2019⁵². The proportion of deaths by communicable diseases and maternal, prenatal and nutrition condition in Malawi is far above the world average.

Table 9: Basic Health Statistics⁵³

Indicator	Year	Female (Malawi/ Sub-Saharan Africa/World)	Male (Malawi/ Sub-Saharan Africa/World)	Total (Malawi/ Sub-Saharan Africa/World)
Life expectancy at birth (years)	2000	48/52/70	43/49/65	45/50/68
Life expectancy at birth (years)	2020	68/64/75	62/60/71	65/60/73
Mortality rate, adult (per 1,000 adults)	2002	543/380/146	640/434/210	
Mortality rate, adult (per 1,000 adults)	2020	202/236/119	313/295/172	
Death by communicable diseases and maternal, prenatal and nutrition conditions (% of total deaths)	2019	50/54/18		
Death by non-communicable diseases (% of total deaths)	2019	40/36/74		
Death by injury (% of total deaths)	2019	10/10/8		

Source: World Bank, 2021

137. The latest data published by the World Health Organization (WHO) in 2020 ranked HIV/AIDS as the main cause of deaths in Malawi (13.32 percent of total deaths), followed by influenza and pneumonia (8.03 percent), malaria (6.54 percent), road traffic accidents (6.45 percent), stroke (6.16 percent) and diarrhoeal diseases (6 percent)⁵⁴.

Table 10: Prevalence of Major Diseases⁵⁵

Indicator	Year	Malawi	Sub-Saharan Africa
Prevalence of HIV, total (% of population ages 15-49)	2019	8.5	3.6
Prevalence of HIV, female (% of population ages 15-24)	2020	3.7	1.7
Prevalence of HIV, male (% of population ages 15-24)	2020	1.9	0.7
Women's share of population ages 15+ living with HIV (%)	2019	64	n.a
	2016	63	60
Children (0-14) living with HIV	2019	69 000	n.a
Incidence of HIV, ages 15-49 (per 1,000 uninfected population ages 15-49)	2019	2.4	1.3
Incidence of HIV, ages 15-24 (per 1,000 uninfected population ages 15-24)	2019	2	1
Adults (ages 15+) and children (ages 0-14) newly infected with HIV	2019	22 000	n.a
Adults (ages 15-49) newly infected with HIV	2019	18 000	n.a
Children (ages 0-14) newly infected with HIV	2019	2 700	n.a
Young people (ages 15-24) newly infected with HIV	2019	7 800	n.a
ARI Treatment (% Of Children Under 5 Taken To A Health Provider)	2016	77.6	n.a
Incidence of malaria (per 1,000 population at risk)	2019	205.9	214.1

⁵² World Bank, 2021, "Data on health"

⁵³ World Bank, 2021, "Data on health"

⁵⁴ <https://www.worldlifeexpectancy.com/country-health-profile/malawi>

⁵⁵ World Bank, "Data on health."

Diarrhea treatment (% of children under 5 receiving oral rehydration and continued feeding) - Malawi	2016	56.7	n.a
	2017	n.a	38

Source: World Bank, 2021

b. HIV/AIDS and related knowledge and behaviour

138. Although Malawi has made significant progress in reducing the number of HIV infection over the last decade - namely with the number of adults aged 15-49 newly infected with HIV falling from 39 000 in 2010 to 17 000 in 2020, HIV/AIDS remains the number one killer in the country. In 2020, 8.1 percent of the population aged 15-49 years were infected with HIV, a percentage that is higher by 4.9 percentage point compared with the Sub-Saharan Africa average of 3.6. The HIV prevalence among men and women aged 15-49 decreased continuously between the three successive Malawi demographic health surveys (MDHS) of 2004, 2010 and 2015-16 with the rates of 11.8 percent, 10.6 percent and 8.8 percent respectively. The 2015-16 MDHS described the prevalence among women to be higher than among men (10.8 percent versus 6.4 percent). The prevalence for young women aged 15 to 24 is almost double that for young men (3.7 versus 1.7 percent in 2020). HIV prevalence among men increases with age from 1 percent for those aged 15-19 to 9 percent in men aged 30-34, with the highest prevalence of 20.5 percent among men aged 50-54. The same trend is observed for women from age group of 15-19 to age group of 40-44 with a prevalence ranging from 3.3 to 19.8 percent, but then a decrease is noted among those aged 45 to 49 (16.9 percent). HIV prevalence was twice as high in urban areas as compared to rural areas for both women and men in 2020: 17.8 percent among women and 11.0 percent among men in urban areas and 9.2 percent and 5.4 percent respectively for women and men in rural areas. Estimated at 12.8 percent, the prevalence in the Southern region was the highest, this percentage is reduced by more than half for the Central and Northern regions where the prevalence is at 5.6 and 5.1 percent respectively. Women in the highest wealth quintile have higher HIV prevalence (14.7 percent) than women in lower wealth quintiles (9.3 percent). HIV prevalence is also influenced by marital status with a higher prevalence among men and women who have ever been married compared to those who have never been for whom the prevalence was estimated at 3 percent. For women and men reporting ever being married, it was at 9.8 for those who were married or living together as married at the time of the survey, 19.1 percent for those who were divorced or separated and 32.3 percent of widowed women and men. Those in polygynous union had also higher HIV prevalence. While HIV prevalence is higher among women who had first sex before age 16 (13.9 percent) compared to those who had sex at an older age (10.4 percent for women who had their first sexual intercourse at age 16 or 17, 9.9 percent for those who had first sex at age 18-19), this trend is reversed for men with a lower prevalence for those who initiated sexual activity before age 16 than for those who had their first sex at older ages (6 percent, 7.8 percent and 8.1 percent respectively for those who had their first sex before 16, at 17-18 and at 19-20). Women and men having a Sexually transmitted infection (STI) or symptoms of an STI had a higher HIV prevalence than those who did not (14.8 percent versus 9 percent). The number of new HIV infections on adults between 15 and 49 years old were estimated at 17 000 in 2020, of which 7 300 concerned young people aged 15-24. HIV and AIDS orphaned 460 000 children who lost their mother or both parents in 2020.

139. With respect to HIV/AIDS related knowledge and attitudes, about three-quarters of women and men aged 15-49 know that using condoms consistently can reduce the risk of HIV. More than eight in ten women and men (86 percent of women and 89 percent of men aged 15-49) know that limiting sexual intercourse to one uninfected partner who has no other partners can also reduce the risk of HIV. The higher education men and women have, the more informed on prevention methods they are: 64 percent of women and men with no education recognised that using condoms and limiting sexual intercourse to one uninfected partner is a way to avoid getting HIV compared with 74 percent of women and 78 percent of men with more than secondary education.

The percentage of young people aged 15-24 with comprehensive knowledge of HIV appears low compared to the average in the 15-49 age group, and it was slightly higher for men (44 percent) than for women (41 percent) with no significant change noted between the two MDHS of 2010 and 2015-16. Young women and men in urban areas are more likely than their counterparts in rural areas to have comprehensive knowledge about HIV: 47 percent of young women and 54 percent of young men in urban areas compared with 40 percent of young women and 42 percent of young men in rural areas. The behaviour of young people to be with multiple sexual partners also increases the risk of getting HIV. The 2015-16 MDHS estimated at 10 percent the proportion of men who had more than one partner in the last 12 months before the survey, compared with 1 percent of women. Condom use was more common among young men who had more than one partner (52 percent) than among their female counterparts (36 percent).

140. The 2015-16 MDHS found that overall 19 percent of women and 14 percent of men have discriminatory attitudes towards people living with HIV, these attitudes can adversely affect people's willingness to be tested and treated if they are tested positive. Discriminatory attitudes decrease with level of education and wealth. While a vast majority of women (95 percent) and men (96 percent) knew where to obtain an HIV test, women are more likely than men to have ever been tested for HIV (83 percent versus 70 percent). A substantial increase in HIV testing among both women and men of 37 percentage point ranging from 7 percent to 44 percent were noted from 2004 to 2015-16. The highest HIV testing coverage were observed in the Northern region (50 percent) followed by those of the Southern (44 percent) and Central regions (42 percent). HIV testing coverage among young people aged 15-24 who had had sex in the past 12 months before the survey were 53 percent for women and 45 percent for men.

c. Reproductive health

141. The Malawi Demographic and Health Survey (MDHS) 2015-16 reported that 66 percent of women and 57 percent of men aged 15-49 were married or living together with a partner as if they are married during the survey period. While the percentage of women married or living together had declined from 72 percent in 1992 to 68 percent in 2010 and to 66 percent in 2015-16, the decrease for men between 1992 and 2010 was very significant: ranging 74 to 57 percent but no change were noted since 2010. Women tend to marry well earlier than men. The median age at first marriage for women aged 25-49 is 18.2 years and it is at 23 years for men within the same age groups. Between the MDHS of 1992 and 2015-16, the median age at first marriage for women aged 25-49 had increased slightly from 17.8 to 18.2 years while no significant variation was observed for men. In 2015-16, urban women married later than rural women with a median age at first marriage of 19.7 and 18 years respectively. Age at first marriage is also influenced by the level of education and poverty. The median age at first marriage for women aged 25-49 with no education was reported to be at 17.6 years while it was at 24.8 years for women with more than secondary education. Women aged 25-49 in the highest wealth quintile first marry at 19.6 years while those in other quintiles do so at 17.8-18.0 years.

142. Thirteen percent of women reported to be in polygynous marriage and the percentage of men who reported to have multiple wives was about half that of women (7 percent). Women living in the rural areas are more likely to report co-wives (14 percent) compared with their counterparts living in the urban areas (5 percent). The Northern region had the highest percentage of women reporting polygyny (18 percent) followed by the Central (14 percent) and the Southern (11 percent) regions. Less educated women are more likely to have co-wives. 21 percent of women with no education reported that their husband has other wives compared with only 3 percent of women with more than secondary education.

143. Comparison of median ages at first sex and first marriage showed that in general both women and men in Malawi have sex before marriage. On average, men initiate sexual intercourse at slightly older ages than women, the median age at first sex for women and men aged 25-49 were 16.8 and 18.5 years respectively and it remained unchanged between 2000 and 2015-16. Rural women aged 25-49 begin having sex about a year earlier (16.7 years) than urban women (17.6 years). The percentages of women aged 25-49 who had first sex at earlier age were higher than for men: 19 percent of women aged 25-49 had first sex before age 15 and 64 percent before age 18 compared to 11 percent and 42 percent for their male counterparts. By age 20, 85 percent of women and 66 percent of men had experienced sexual intercourse. Since the median age at first sexual intercourse for women aged 25-49 is 1.4 years younger than the median age at first marriage (16.8 years versus 18.2 years), many women engage in sex before marriage and may be exposed to the risk of pregnancy and childbearing at an earlier age before getting married. The median ages at first sex and first marriage for men aged 25-49 (18.5 years versus 23 years) show that men are initiating sexual activity five years before marriage. Age at first sexual intercourse increases with level of education and household wealth both for men and women: there is a gap of 3.7 years and a gap of 1.8 years in the median age of first sex between women aged 25-49 with no education and those with more than secondary education and between men aged 25-54 with the same characteristics. Median age at first sex for women aged 25-49 in the lowest wealth quintile was 16.5 years compared to 17.8 years for those in the highest quintile. For men aged 25-54, the median age at first sex in the lowest quintile is 1.1 years younger than in the highest wealth quintile (18.2 years versus 19.3 years).

144. Total fertility rate (TFR) in Malawi declined markedly from 6.7 in 1992 to 4.4 children per woman in 2015-16⁵⁶ and further to 4.1 in 2020⁵⁷. Malawian TFR was lower than the Sub-Saharan Africa average of 4.6 in 2020⁵⁸. Women in rural areas have higher fertility, on average, than women in urban areas (TFR of 4.7 versus 3.0 children in 2015-16). Education level affects the number of children per woman. Women with no education had an average of 5.5 children compared with 2.3 children for women with more than secondary education. TFR also varies with the level of poverty, women in the lowest wealth quintile had an average 2.8 more children than women in the highest wealth quintile (TFR of 5.7 versus 2.9 children).

145. Median age at first birth in Malawi had changed little over the last two decades and it was 19.1 and 19 years respectively among women aged 20-49 and 25-49 in 2015-16. Women aged 25-49 in urban areas had had their first birth, on average, 1 year later than women in rural areas (19.9 years versus 18.9 years). The level of education influences the median age at first birth with women, a difference of 6.3 years were observed among women aged 25-49 with no education and those with more than secondary education (median age at first birth of 18.6 and 24.9 years respectively).

146. With regards to contraception, the MDHS 2015-16 reported that contraceptive knowledge is almost universal in Malawi. 98 percent of women and nearly 100 percent of men aged 15-49 knew at least one method of contraception. Contraceptive prevalence rate (CPR) describing the percentage of women between 15 and 49 years old practicing (or whose sexual partners are practicing) any form of contraception was 59 percent for currently married women, this percentage was at 44 percent for sexually active unmarried women. Nearly all married women and sexually active unmarried women using contraception used a modern method⁵⁹, 58 and 43 percent respectively. The use of modern contraceptive by married women showed a significant increase

⁵⁶ MDHS 2015-16

⁵⁷ <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.DYN.TFRT.IN?locations=MW>

⁵⁸ <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.DYN.TFRT.IN?end=2020&locations=ZG&start=2010>

⁵⁹ Modern methods include male and female sterilisation, injectables, intrauterine devices (IUDs), contraceptive pills, implants, female and male condoms, the standard days method, lactational amenorrhoea, and emergency contraception (MDHS 2015-16)

from 7 percent in 1992 to 58 percent in 2015-16 while the use of traditional methods declined from 4 percent to 1 percent over the same period. Overall, 68 percent of all women currently using modern contraceptives were informed at the time they started the current episode of method use about the side effects of the method, what to do if they experience side effects, and other available methods. Contraceptive use increases with household wealth, fifty-three percent of women in the lowest wealth quintile use any modern method compared with 61 percent of women in the highest quintile in 2015-16. Total demand for family planning among currently married women aged 15-49 had increased over time, rising from 50 percent in 1992, to 61 percent in 2000, 63 percent in 2004, 72 percent in 2010, and 78 percent in 2015-16. The difference between the percentage of married women aged 15-49 who wanted to space births and those willing to limit births representing 37 percent and 41 percent respectively (representing the total demand of 78 percent), and those already using contraceptive methods of 59 percent highlighted some family planning unmet need of 19 percent. The percentage of demand satisfied was higher for married women than for sexually active unmarried ones (76 percent versus 53 percent). Eight in ten married women using family planning reported its use as a joint decision between wife and husband, 13 percent stated it as the wife's decision, and 7 percent mentioned it to be the husband's decision.

d. Teenage pregnancy

147. Teenage pregnancy and child marriage are highly correlated in Malawi. Girls who marry at early age are more likely to become pregnant, and those who become pregnant are often forced to marry. Cultural practices play a significant role in teenage pregnancy as many ethnic groups still rely on gendered expectations regarding women's responsibilities to marry and bear children⁶⁰.

148. Teenage childbearing representing the percentage of women aged 15-19 who have given birth or are pregnant with their first child, were estimated at 29 percent in 2015-16. The proportion of women who began childbearing in rural areas of 31 percent exceeds ten percentage point the proportion of those in urban areas. Teenage pregnancy is affected by household wealth with the percentage of women aged 15-19 who have begun childbearing decreasing from 44 percent among women in the lowest wealth quintile to 15 percent of women in the highest wealth quintile. Among women and men aged 15-19, 13 percent of women and 22 percent of men had their first sexual intercourse before age 15. One percent of women and no men in the same age group gave birth or fathered a child before age 15⁶¹.

149. The teenage years are a critical period in a woman's life when she makes choices that will have long-term implications for her future well-being and productivity. Decisions such as whether and when to drop out of school, get married, or have a child significantly impact women's labor market outcomes later in life - an aspect that has been confirmed by the young ladies members of a fish processing group⁶². Women who begin childbearing at a young age are likely to have more children throughout their lifetime, are less likely to continue their education, and as a result, have worse economic outcomes.⁶³ Low awareness among girls regarding harmful social norms, early marriage and related issues contributes to increased teenage pregnancy.

⁶⁰ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

⁶¹ MDHS 2015-16

⁶² Focus group discussions with fish farmers in Masasa, Monkey bay, Mangochi District, Southern region, 1st October 2022

⁶³ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

e. Maternal, neonatal and child health

150. In Malawi, the maternal mortality ratio indicating the number of women who die from pregnancy-related causes while pregnant or within 42 days of pregnancy termination per 100,000 live births, had been reduced by more than half from 749 in 2000 to 349 in 2017. Although the ratio of 349 deaths per 100,000 live births is still considered as high, it remains very low compared to that of sub-Saharan Africa. Neonatal, infant and under-5 mortality rates were slightly higher than those in the world but stayed far behind the average rates in Sub-Saharan Africa. The causes of neonatal mortality (19 per 1,000 live births in 2020) include birth asphyxia, premature birth, and infection; and the under-5 mortality estimated at 39 per 1,000 births are due to malaria, diarrhoea, and pneumonia⁶⁴.

Table 11: Maternal and Children Mortality⁶⁵

Indicator	Year	Malawi	Sub-Saharan Africa	World
Maternal mortality ratio (modeled estimate, per 100,000 live births)	2017	349	534	211
Mortality rate, under-5 (per 1,000 live births)	2020	39	73	37
Mortality rate, infant (per 1,000 live births)	2019	29	50	27
Mortality rate, neonatal (per 1,000 live births)	2020	19	27	17

Source: World Bank (2021).

151. Malawi has made great improvements in maternal and child health. In both rural and urban areas, very high proportions of pregnant women are receiving prenatal care (98 percent in 2017 compared to 91 percent in 2000) and benefitting from skilled birth assistance (90 percent of births attended by skilled health staffs in 2016 compared to 55 percent in 2000). Institutional deliveries increased from 55 percent in 1992 to 91 percent in 2015-16 while home deliveries decreased from 43 to 7 percent over the same period⁶⁶. The 2015-16 MDHS reported the proportions of mothers and new-borns who received a postnatal check in the first 2 days after delivery or birth at 42 percent and 60 percent respectively. Postnatal check in the first 2 days after birth for new-borns and after delivery for mothers is positively correlated with the mother's level of education. Improved access to sexual and reproductive health services has also contributed to the improvements in maternal health. Contraceptive prevalence rate for married women aged 15-49 -indicating the percentage of women who are practicing or whose sexual partners are practicing any form of contraception, nearly doubled from 31 percent in 2000 to 59 percent in 2016. Knowledge of family planning is almost universal in Malawi with 98 percent of women and nearly 100 percent of men aged 15-49 knowing at least one method of contraception. The most reported problems for women to access health care are the distance to health facility and the payment for advice or treatment⁶⁷.

152. Under-5 mortality rate showed significant decrease ranging from 234 deaths per 1,000 live births in 1992 to 63 deaths per 1,000 live births in 2015-16. Infant mortality (infant under one year) declined from 135 deaths per 1,000 live births in 1992 to 42 deaths per 1,000 births in 2015-16; and neonatal mortality (within the first month of life) fell from 41 deaths per 1,000 live births in 1992 to 27 deaths per 1,000 births in 2004 for mortality within the first month of life and remained unchanged from 2004 to 2015-16. Under-5 mortality rate was higher in rural areas than urban

⁶⁴ <https://www.usaid.gov/malawi/global-health/maternal-neonatal-and-child-health>

⁶⁵ World Bank, "Data on health."

⁶⁶ MDHS 2015-16

⁶⁷ Ibid.

areas (77 deaths per live 1,000 births versus 61 deaths per 1,000 live births in 2015-16) and it declines with increasing level of the mother's education and household wealth⁶⁸. Most children in Malawi are being vaccinated with 76 percent of children aged 12-23 months reported to have received all basic vaccinations by the 2015-16 MDHS and 70 percent having received the basic vaccinations by the age of 12 months. The same survey described fever to be the most common illness affecting children under the age of 5: 29 percent had fever, 22 percent had a diarrhoeal episode and 5 percent had symptoms of Acute Respiratory Infections in the 2 weeks before the survey. Children with ARI symptoms were most often taken to a health facility or provider for advice or treatment (78 percent) compared to children with fever (67 percent) or diarrhoea (66 percent).

153. With respect to nutrition, the 2015-16 MDHS reported that 37 percent of children under age 5 are stunted (too short for their age), 3 percent of children under age 5 are wasted (too thin for their height), 5 percent of children under age 5 are overweight and 12 percent are underweight (too thin for their age). Stunting is a sign of chronic undernutrition, wasting a sign of acute undernutrition and overweight a sign of over nutrition. The prevalence of stunting and underweight decreased significantly from 55 percent in 1992 to 37 percent in 2015-16 and from 24 percent in 1992 to 12 percent in 2015-16 respectively. The decrease in wasting and overweight had been small over the same period. Stunting prevalence was higher among children in rural areas (39 percent) than in urban areas (25 percent) in 2015-16, and it declines with increasing mother's level of education and household wealth. As for women's nutritional status, 72 percent have a normal weight, 21 percent are overweight or obese and 7 percent are thin. While the proportion of overweight or obese women increased markedly between 1992 and 2015-16 (from 10 percent to 21 percent), the percentage of thin women showed only a slight decrease of 2 percentage point over the same period (from 9 to 7 percent). The proportion of overweight or obese urban women is almost the double of that in rural areas, 36 percent and 17 percent respectively. Overweight/obesity increases with education and wealth.

f. Water supply, sanitation and hygiene

154. In 2019-20, seventy-four percent of households in Malawi had access to improved sources of drinking water. Ninety-one percent of households in urban areas had access to improved water sources compared to 71 percent of households in rural areas. Fifteen percent of rural households travel more than 30 minutes round trip to fetch drinking water compared to 7 percent of urban households. The percentage of rural households using unimproved sources of water (unprotected dug wells and unprotected springs) of 11 percent exceeds that of urban households by 9 percentage points. Direct collection of water from surface waters such as rivers, lakes or irrigation channels concerns only rural households (3 percent)⁶⁹.

155. Regarding sanitation, Multiple indicator cluster surveys (MICS) 2019-20 reported that 46 percent of Malawian households used improved toilet facilities (43 percent of urban households vs. 46 percent of rural households), which are those designed to hygienically separate excreta from human contact and include: flush/pour flush to piped sewer system, septic tanks or pit latrines; ventilated improved pit latrines, composting toilets or pit latrines with slabs. They can reduce the transmission of cholera, typhoid, and other diseases. The use of shared toilet facilities of an otherwise acceptable type are also common, especially for 49 percent of urban households compared with 32 percent of rural households.

⁶⁸ Ibid.

⁶⁹ Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS), National Statistics Office, USAID, UNICEF, German Cooperation, Norwegian Embassy, Gavi, 2019-20

156. As for hygiene, twenty eight percent of the population had basic hygiene services referring to the availability of a handwashing facility on premises with soap and water: slightly above 1 in 2 urban and 1 in 4 in rural areas. 46 percent of the households had limited hygiene service with significant gap between rural and urban areas (48 percent and 36 percent respectively)⁷⁰.

157. The gender implications of water and sanitation go beyond the safety and adequacy of drinking water and personal hygiene. In fact, since women are much more likely than men to be tasked with collecting water when it is not available on the premises, the time and energy spent on collecting water negatively impact their availability⁷¹ to engage in economic activities. In terms of human capital, lack of Water Supply, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) in school settings has been correlated with lower educational attainment for girls as girls may miss school due to menstruation⁷². In addition, lack of access to WASH at home, in clinics, and in hospitals is highly correlated with increased infections that may increase maternal mortality rates.⁷³

4.1.5 Food security and nutrition

158. The 2023 IPC analysis for Malawi indicates that 3 million people are experiencing high acute food insecurity IPC Phase 3, Crisis⁷⁴. No improvement seems to be recorded since the World Food Program reported in its January 2024 Country Brief an acute food insecurity for 4.4 million Malawians, representing 22 percent of the population⁷⁵. As per the latest available national health survey (2015-16)⁷⁶, the nutritional status of children is characterized by 37 percent of children under age 5 stunting (short for their age), 3 percent wasting (thin for their height), 12 percent underweight (thin for their age) and 5 percent overweight (heavy for their height). Levels of child malnutrition are influenced by the mother's Body Mass Index (BMI), mother's level of education, place of residence and household wealth. With regards to feeding practice, only 8 percent of children aged 6-23 months meet the minimum acceptable dietary standards. As to anemia, sixty-three percent of children aged 6-59 months and 33 percent of women aged 15-49 are anemic. These data highlight the need to set up immediate measures to reduce food consumption gaps.

159. The important role that gender plays in accessing affordable healthy diets and its contribution to food and nutrition security is well recognized⁷⁷. Traditional gender norms predict the roles that men and women are expected to play in the household food security and nutrition. Women's contribution consists of productive and reproductive dimensions: (i) a productive dimension referring to women's farming and income generating activities contributing to food production and purchase, (ii) a reproductive dimension, entailing multiple responsibilities such as cooking, processing food, drawing water, cleaning, and collecting firewood, which have direct impact on household food security, but which are often unpaid and less valued. Access to clean water, an important factor that influences children's nutrition, health, and sanitation, and ultimately, the health of the household environment; has also always been considered as women and girls' responsibility. *"Historically, women's productive and reproductive work has been heavier*

⁷⁰ Ibid.

⁷¹ Focus group discussions with women involved in soap making, VNRMC, farming and VSL, Makwezu, Kapalapata Village, T/A Timbiri, Nkhata-Bay District, Northern region, 13th October 2022

⁷² Malawi Gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

⁷³ Ibid

⁷⁴ IPC Integrated Food Security Phase Classification. IPC Acute food insecurity analysis July 2023-March 2024. Published on 18 August 2023

⁷⁵ World Food Programme Country Brief, WFP, January 2024

⁷⁶ Malawi Standard Demographic Health Survey, 2015-16

⁷⁷ The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2023. Urbanization, agrifood systems transformation and healthy diets across the rural-urban continuum, FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP and WHO, 2023

than men's"⁷⁸. Men's involvement in household feeding is essentially a matter of putting food on the table. They also contribute to decisions around food choices. During lean season with lack of access to food, coping mechanisms are made by default such as reducing the number of meals, since there is no choice in the matter. The way to prepare food are extremely limited due to limited access to additional ingredients and flavouring. A gender analysis for the GIZ Food and Nutrition Support Programme reported the use of alcohol as a significant gender issue in Salima and Dedza districts⁷⁹. The analysis raised some concerns about men's drinking that includes impacts on nutrition due to misuse of family income, wastage of food since men eat little while drinking and so food are thrown away, increase in GBV, as well as concerns about men's health. Although little evidence of specific gendered norms or cultural beliefs exists around the food that should be eaten by men/women, there are social norms which put women at a disadvantage when it comes to diet (e.g. in times of difficult access to food, women must sacrifice themselves to give priority to eating to other household members; women are not supposed to cook high value food (meat or food which uses a lot of oil such as chips) when their husband is away, etc.).

160. Some evidence from a discussion paper published by IFPRI shows the influence that men and women could have on the household food and nutrition status⁸⁰: households headed by a sole male adult have the lowest Household Dietary Diversity (HDDS) whereas households headed by a sole female adult have the highest levels of food insecurity. As observed in dual-headed households, men and women's joint access to information have appeared to be significant driver of food security than only women's access⁸¹. It is therefore acknowledged that eliminating structural gender inequalities and improving men and boys involvement and knowledge on food and nutrition related issues could be a good entry point to improve household food and nutrition security.

4.1.6 Poverty

161. Poverty levels in Malawi remain high and pervasive. Since 1995, Malawi's annual economic growth has averaged about 5.3 percent. With population growth of close to 3 percent, per capita GDP is growing at 2.2 percent. Malawi's inability to reduce poverty reflects its lack of robust economic growth. With a GDP per capita of US\$ 603 in 2020⁸² and a HDI of 0.483⁸³ in 2019 which is below the average of 0.513 for countries in the low human development category and below the average of 0.547 for Sub-Saharan Africa (SSA)⁸⁴, Malawi is one of the poorest countries in the world. The country is categorized among least developed countries by the classification of the Organization for economic cooperation and development (OECD), among low-income countries by the classification of the World Bank and among low human development nations by the classification of the United Nations. Based on data from IHS5 2019/2020, the Malawi Poverty Report 2020 estimated that 50.8 percent of the population lived below the national

⁷⁸A qualitative assessment of gender roles, in child nutrition in Central Malawi; Elizabeth Mkandawire et al., 2022.

⁷⁹Gender Analysis for the Food and Nutrition Support Programme, C12 Consultants, June 2023

⁸⁰Does providing agricultural and nutrition information to both men and women improve household food security? Evidence from Malawi, Catherine Ragasa, Noora-Lisa Aberman, Cristina Alvarez Mingote, IFPRI Discussion Paper 01653, IFPRI, June 2017

⁸¹ *ibid*

⁸² National Planning Commission, Malawi 2063, Lilongwe, 2020

⁸³ UNDP, 2020. Human Development Report 2020, The next frontier – Human development and the Anthropocene, Briefing note for countries on the 2020 Human Development Report Malawi."

⁸⁴ Malawi National Human Development Report 2021, Delivering Sustainable Human Development and Accountability at the local level: the experience of decentralisation in Malawi, UNDP, 2021

poverty line⁸⁵ and 20.5 percent were considered ultra-poor⁸⁶. While the proportion of poor showed a slight decrease compared to what was reported during 2016/2017 IHS4 (51.5 percent), the proportion of the population living in extreme poverty increased by 0.4 percentage point. Analysis by place of residence shows that 56.6 percent of people from rural areas were poor compared to 19.2 percent in urban areas, the trend with ultra-poverty was the same with a proportion of ultra-poor of 23.6 percent and of 3.3 percent in rural and urban areas respectively. Prevalence of poverty is higher among female-headed-households than male-headed households⁸⁷. Poverty has remained widespread and persistent particularly among female headed households. Indeed, fifty-eight percent of households headed by women are poor compared to 49 percent of those headed by men⁸⁸. Analysis of poverty by region showed that the Central region had the highest percentage of poor and ultra-poor at 55.8 percent and 25.4 percent respectively, followed by Southern region with 51 percent of poor and 19.1 percent of ultra-poor, and Northern region with 32.9 percent of poor and 8.6 percent of ultra-poor⁸⁹.

162. Income inequality as measured by Gini coefficient showed an improvement by decreasing from 0.423 in 2016/17 to 0.379 in 2019/2020. This value means that 38 percent of national income would have to be redistributed to attain income equality. The richest 20 percent of the population controls 51.7 percent of total income while the poorest 20 percent control 6.4 percent of total income⁹⁰.

163. Through the UNDP global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI), deprivations affecting individuals are measured across 10 indicators in three equally weighted dimensions of health, education and standard of living. Referring to 2019/2020, the most recent survey data available for Malawi's MPI estimation revealed that⁹¹ 49.9 percent of the population in Malawi is multidimensionally poor⁹² while an additional 27.5 percent is classified as vulnerable to multidimensional poverty⁹³. The intensity of deprivations in Malawi, which is the average deprivation score among people living in multidimensional poverty, is 46.3 percent. Malawi's MPI value was estimated at 0.231 in 2019/2020. This represented the share of population that is multidimensionally poor adjusted by the intensity of the deprivations.

4.1.7 Employment

164. Estimated around 77 percent between 1990 and 2019⁹⁴, the overall labour force participation rate in Malawi remained relatively stable and exceeded by about 10 percentage points the Sub-Saharan Africa average⁹⁵. If the overall rate fell by two percentage point in 2020 as an impact of the Covid-19 pandemic, it showed a modest increase of one percent in 2021. The labour force participation rate observed among men and women do not follow the same trend.

⁸⁵ "Malawi poverty line considered the cost of meeting basic nutritional needs (food poverty line) and the allowance for other basic needs (non-food poverty line). If a person's total expenditure is below the poverty line, the person is considered poor." Malawi poverty report 2020, National Statistical Office, August 2021

⁸⁶ "An individual with consumption below the food poverty line is considered ultra-poor." Malawi poverty report 2020, National Statistical Office, August 2021

⁸⁷ Malawi National Human Development Report 2021, Delivering Sustainable Human Development and Accountability at the local level: the experience of decentralisation in Malawi, UNDP, 2021

⁸⁸ Malawi national gender statistics assessment, UN Women

⁸⁹ Malawi poverty report 2020, National Statistical Office, August 2021

⁹⁰ World Bank (online), World Development Indicators

⁹¹ Multidimensional Poverty Index 2022, Unpacking deprivation bundles to reduce multidimensional poverty, Briefing note for countries on the 2022 MPI Malawi, UNDP, 2022

⁹² With a deprivation score between 33.3 percent and 50 percent

⁹³ With a deprivation score between 20 percent and 33.3 percent

⁹⁴ Labor force participation rate, total (% of total population ages 15+) (modelled ILO estimate) - Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.TLF.CACT.ZS?locations=MW>

⁹⁵ Labor force participation rate, total (% of total population ages 15+) (modelled ILO estimate) - Sub-Saharan Africa, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.TLF.CACT.ZS?locations=ZG>

Male rate has always been higher than for females; it raised from above 78.5 percent in 1990 to 83 percent in 2013, decreased to 81 percent in 2019 then to 79.5 percent in 2020 and slightly rose to 80 percent in 2021⁹⁶. In contrast for Malawian women, the same rate showed a gradual decline from 75.7 percent to 73 percent between 1990 and 2019, fell sharply by 2.5 percentage points in 2020 and rose to 71.6 percent in 2021⁹⁷. In 2019, Malawi's employment-to-population ratio stood at around 72 percent, women's employment-to-population ratio (68 percent) was significantly lower than men (77 percent). Youth⁹⁸ employment-to-population was estimated at 56 percent with no significant difference between men and women youth. The overall employment-to-population ratio and the ratios for women, men and youth appeared relatively higher than the Sub-Saharan averages estimated at 64 percent, 69 percent, 59 percent and 44 percent respectively⁹⁹.

165. Highlighting the percentage of people of working age who are without work, are available for work, and have taken specific steps to find work, the overall "strict" unemployment rate in Malawi was relatively stable at about 5.8 percent between 1991 and 2019, before raising from 5.8 percent in 2019 to 7 percent in 2021 due to the Covid-19 pandemic¹⁰⁰. Male unemployment rate has been lower than female, it decreased from 5 percent in 2013 to 4.3 percent in 2019 before increasing at 5.2 percent in 2021¹⁰¹. Unemployment for women had gradually increased from 6.5 to 7.3 percent between 1991 and 2019 and reached 8.9 percent in 2021¹⁰². Indicatively, as per the 2013 Malawian National Labour Force Survey, urban areas, Southern region and people with primary and secondary education are the most affected by unemployment. The shares of unemployed women both in urban and rural areas of 15.6 and 7 percent respectively, were higher compared to that of men of 8.2 and 4.9 percent respectively¹⁰³. Youth aged 15-34 unemployment rate was 7.9 percent and this rate was higher (8.9 percent) for younger persons aged 15-24. Female youth unemployment rate of 9.5 percent exceeded that of male of 3.3 percentage points. The percentage of person underemployed¹⁰⁴ were estimated at 26.8 percent, youth aged 15-34 underemployment rate was 12.2 percent in 2013. As for formal and informal employment, 89 percent of employed persons worked in informal employment setups, and women were more likely to be informally employed (93.6 percent) than males (83.8 percent). People engaged in informal employment in rural areas represented 91 percent compared to 69 percent in urban areas¹⁰⁵.

166. The 2013 National Labour Force Survey reported that 64 percent of employment were in the agricultural sector, 7 percent in the industry sector, and 28 percent in the service sector. The agriculture sector had the highest ratio of women (58 percent) followed by the service sector mainly in trade, restaurant and hotel activities (57 percent). As for status in employment, paid employees represented 38 percent, employers 1.1 percent, own-account workers 53.6 percent and contributing family workers 7.2 percent¹⁰⁶. Some significant differences were observed in the

⁹⁶ Labor force participation rate, male (% of male population ages 15+) (modeled ILO estimate) – Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.TLF.CACT.MA.ZS?locations=MW>

⁹⁷ Labor force participation rate, female (% of female population ages 15+) (modeled ILO estimate) – Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.TLF.CACT.FE.ZS?locations=MW>

⁹⁸ The Labour Market Profile Malawi observed youth aged 15-24

⁹⁹ Labour Market Profile Malawi – 2022/2023, Danish Trade Union Development Agency

¹⁰⁰ Unemployment, total (% of total labor force) (modeled ILO estimate) – Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.UEM.TOTL.ZS?locations=MW>

¹⁰¹ Unemployment, male (% of male labor force) (modeled ILO estimate) – Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.UEM.TOTL.MA.ZS?locations=MW>

¹⁰² Unemployment, female (% of female labor force) (modeled ILO estimate) – Malawi, World Bank, from ILOSTAT database, June 2022, <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SL.UEM.TOTL.FE.ZS?locations=MW>

¹⁰³ Malawi Labour Force Survey 2013, National Statistical Office, April 2014

¹⁰⁴ Those aged 15-64 who worked less than 48 hours and were willing and available to work additional hours than they were currently working in their present jobs

¹⁰⁵ Malawi Labour Force Survey 2013, National Statistical Office, April 2014

¹⁰⁶ Labour Market Profile Malawi – 2022/2023, Danish Trade Union Development Agency

shares of men and women employees of 43.8 and 32.1 percent respectively, and the proportions of women and men own-account workers of 58.7 and 48.7 percent respectively. This situation may reflect women's interest in engaging in their own business considering that household's care and responsibilities require flexibility. Women's self-employment rate of 59.5 percent exceeds that of men by 9 percentage points. Indicatively, self-employment is higher in rural than urban areas, and among persons with less education than among those with more education. Women engaged in wage employment in non-agricultural sector increased from 30 percent of total wage employment in the sector¹⁰⁷ in 2013 to 48.5 percent in 2019¹⁰⁸. The percentage share of women in wage employment in non-agriculture in rural areas was higher than in urban areas. The 2013 MLFS reported that women's and men's shares of employment in senior and middle management were very low at 0.07 percent for women and 0.32 percent for men. The proportions of women and men in senior and middle management positions were higher in urban areas than in rural areas. Representation of women and men in high status occupations was positively related to one's level of education.

167. In terms of earnings, the average monthly mean and the median gross incomes in 2013 are 41,643 and 13,600 Malawi Kwacha respectively¹⁰⁹ (approximately 114.34 and 37.34 US\$). Significant differences are observed between male and female median monthly gross wage of 16,000 MK and 10,514 MK respectively (approximately 43.93 and 28.86 US\$), as well as on male and female average monthly gross wage of 50,253 MK and 30,548 MK respectively. People in urban areas have higher earnings than those from rural areas, their mean monthly gross incomes are estimated at 88,043 MK and 34,182 MK respectively (approximately 242.29 and 93.85 US\$). Earnings are positively correlated with high level of education¹¹⁰.

168. **Wage work.** Due mostly to women's care responsibilities and differences in educational attainment between men and women, women are less likely to participate in the labour market, and have access to lower-quality employment opportunities than men.

169. In Malawi, women are less likely to be engaged in wage work and often receive lower pay when they are. The latest LSMS data for Malawi shows that 9.6 percent of the labour force was engaged in wage, salary, or commission activities. The proportion of men salaried workers of 12 percent is higher than that of women of 4 percent¹¹¹. Individuals with tertiary education are more likely to participate in wage work (63.3 percent) than those without any education (5.6 percent)¹¹². For women employed in agriculture, only 36 percent receive payment for their work. Women are much less likely than men to be employed in unskilled manual labour: about 2 percent of the female labour force compared to 25 percent of the male labour force¹¹³. However, women and men are equally likely to be employed in professional, technical, or managerial occupations (7 percent)¹¹⁴. Women in urban areas are most likely to be employed in the sales and services sector (26 percent), or in the professional, technical, or managerial sector (26 percent), while men in urban areas are most likely to be employed in the skilled manual labour sector (31 percent). Women who have more than a secondary level of education are more likely to work in professional, technical, or managerial positions. Women in rural areas and who are uneducated work mostly in the agricultural sector and are often unpaid.

¹⁰⁷ Malawi Labour Force Survey 2013, National Statistical Office, April 2014

¹⁰⁸ Malawi national gender statistics assessment, UN Women

¹⁰⁹ Average exchange rate in 2013: 1 US\$=364.20 MWK

¹¹⁰ Malawi Labour Force Survey 2013, National Statistical Office, April 2014

¹¹¹ Malawi Fifth integrated household survey, 2019-2020

¹¹² *ibid*

¹¹³ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹¹⁴ Malawi Standard Demographic Health Survey, 2015-16

170. In terms of gender pay gap, the average difference of monthly earnings between men and women is 36.2 percent, women wage workers earning about 64 cents for each dollar earned by men¹¹⁵. Women's lower earnings in wage employment may be partly due to time constraints related to domestic chores, such as collecting water or gathering firewood, and childcare responsibilities. Indeed, women are more likely to work fewer hours in paid jobs and are willing to accept lower quality jobs than men in exchange for the flexibility they need to fit domestic work around paid work. Better quality jobs in the formal sector, with fixed schedules or full-time work may require a redistribution of domestic responsibilities. Analysis of the latest LSMS data for Malawi finds that women wage workers work fewer hours than men and that women spend more time on non-market activities.

4.1.8 Migration

171. The IHS5 observed the geographic movement of people across rural and urban areas, districts and abroad (outside Malawi) to establish a new residence within the last 5 years. The results show that 8.3 percent of the population moved from one area to another. Migrants in urban and rural areas represented 17.0 percent and 6.7 percent of the population respectively. The proportion of migrants in the Northern Region was the highest (13.0 percent) compared to Central (8.4 percent) and Southern (6.8 percent) Regions. Migrants in male-headed household (9.2 percent) were higher than in female headed households (6 percent). It was observed that the higher the level of education of the household head, the higher the proportion of migrants: migrants represented 23 percent of household head with tertiary education while household head with no education had only 6.3 percent of migrants. In terms of marital status of the head, the higher proportion of migrants were among households whose heads were never married (19.8 percent) followed by households whose heads were either married (8.9 percent), divorced/separated (5.8 percent) and widowed (5.3 percent). Reasons for migrating were mainly parents/family move, marriage, start of work/business/farming, return from work/job transfer. The proportion of male migrants of 22 percent who moved to start a business/work exceeded of 15.2 percentage points that of female migrants moving for the same reason. Percentage of migrants who migrated due to marriage were higher for females (38.6 percent) compared to males (15 percent).

172. Looking at the movement patterns of migrants, the majority of the migrants moved from rural areas to other rural areas (59.0 percent), followed by those who moved from rural areas to urban areas (24.0 percent) and those who moved from urban areas to rural areas (6.1 percent). The same trend was observed for both sexes and for different age groups. Among migrants living in urban areas, 74.8 percent originated from rural areas, 23.6 came from other urban areas and 1.6 were from outside Malawi. 86.9 percent of migrants in rural areas were from other rural areas, 8.9 came from urban areas and 4.1 came from outside Malawi.

4.2 Labour division, decision making and access to economic opportunities

4.2.1 Household labour division

173. In Malawi, social cultural patterns nurture an unequal gender division of labour devoting some tasks as being specific to men and women. Men are mostly involved in intermittent household chores and concentrate much on outdoor productive and money making tasks such as constructing houses, kholas for livestock, or rearing animals¹¹⁶. Women bear the heavy burden of time-consuming routine tasks, which include house cleaning, meal planning and cooking,

¹¹⁵ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹¹⁶ Gender analysis report, Moyo and Satali, December 2020

laundry, fuel and water collection, yard sweeping and other type of household maintenance. Societal norms also assign to women the reproductive tasks of looking after children as well as caring for the elderly or sick family members. Women are therefore stuck with unpaid domestic work while men tend to specialize more on paid work and are considered to be the bread winners of most families¹¹⁷.

174. Despite the fact that women from matrilineal systems are somewhat spared in certain tasks, studies have shown that household tasks are considered to be for women¹¹⁸. The socialization process in the country has also impacted the division of labour as illustrated in community task sharing for which men are mainly entrusted with administrative activities and women are given the other duties. Within the household, children are raised with the thought that household tasks are for women and girls, and that money and decision making tasks are for men with the help of boys. The Chewa culture from the most predominant ethnic in the country (34.4 percent)¹¹⁹ considers the performing of domestic duties by girls as their preparation for marriage. In contrast to this, the majority of boys grow up in families where fathers would always be away from home or rest when mothers are performing domestic work and small activities to provide for the household's needs. Boys are involved in tasks undertaken by their fathers such as the handling of finance. These boys reproduce the patterns where they have always seen their fathers giving out money to their mothers and children¹²⁰.

175. The significant involvement of women in household tasks does not exclude their participation in income-generating activities with their husbands. Rural women also often apply diversification and multiple livelihood strategies (agricultural crop production, livestock breeding, working for wage in agriculture or other rural enterprises, etc.) in order to increase income and improve the household's well-being. Consequently women working hours per day far exceed those of men. In the context of climate change coupled with population pressure, deforestation and lack of clean water oblige women and girls to walk longer distance and allocate more time to firewood and water collection. Women are also more likely to work fewer hours in paid jobs and are willing to accept lower quality jobs than men in exchange for the flexibility they need to fit domestic work around paid work. Women's time poverty greatly impacts their economic productivity and so their bargaining power within the household¹²¹.

176. Although the majority of women expressed their need in males helping them on household chores and their will for a more balanced distribution of domestic work, voicing out their need remains difficult. Indeed requesting men to contribute to household tasks may be considered disrespectful and may constitute grounds for divorce. In addition, women hardly find support at community level on this issue as society leaders are mainly men, and even when the tradition leader is a woman, men are always consulted¹²².

177. Women and men are triggered to perform their gender roles as per society's expectations. While men get criticized for not being able to provide for the family's needs, women get punished for not fulfilling their domestic and reproductive work. For instance, women can and do get beaten or sent away from their marital home for not performing their gender roles such as not cooking or

¹¹⁷ Gender division of household labour in rural households, M. M. Mambiya, Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources, August 2015

¹¹⁸ *ibid*

¹¹⁹ 2018 Malawi population and housing census, Education report, National statistical office July 2020

¹²⁰ Gender division of household labour in rural households, M. M. Mambiya, Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources, August 2015

¹²¹ Factors driving the gender gap in agricultural productivity: Malawi, UN Women, UNDP, Poverty-Environment Initiative, UN Environment, 2018

¹²² Gender division of household labour in rural households, M. M. Mambiya, Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources, August 2015

burning food, not taking care of children, etc. Social norms could therefore play a role in perpetuating gender-based violence by approving the unequal gender division of labour that has always existed and by continuously giving the power to those who are in charge of money-making within the household¹²³.

178. Apart from societal norms, other factors may also influence women's ability to reduce the time they allocate to household and childcare responsibilities and increase the time allocated to paid economic activities. These includes access to education, higher-paid employment, productive inputs and ability to move. Government policy can also alleviate gender differences, for examples by promoting paid maternity leave or supporting affordable childcare services¹²⁴.

4.2.2 Division of labour in agriculture

179. Both men and women contribute their labour in farming but their roles are clearly differentiated. While men perform roles that are physically demanding like digging, ploughing and making ridges, women play roles like planting, weeding, harvesting and processing, men typically control marketing of the crops than women. There is some little interchange of roles, with both men and women share the roles in some cases but the clear pattern of gender-based division of roles stand. Men dominate productive roles, the economic roles that generate money or gain in return for productivity such as fishing, producing cash crops or trading hence their work attracts more value and is more visible than women's work. The work in which women dominate tend to be of small-scale in nature whether it is related to crops (maize, groundnuts, beans, etc.) or livestock (chickens, pigs, goats)¹²⁵.

4.2.3 Decision making

180. The 2015-16 MDHS considers that women are participating in household decisions if they are involved in sole or joint (with their husband) decision-making within the household in all the three areas of women's health care, major household purchases and visits to women's family or relatives. The survey reported that less than half of women (47 percent) participate in all three decisions while 15 percent participate in none of them. The most common decision on which women exclusively decide or are involved in are on family and relatives' visits (78 percent), followed by decisions about their healthcare (68 percent) and major household purchases (55 percent). Employed women, especially those employed for cash (54 percent), are more likely to be involved in all three decisions compared with unemployed women (39 percent), and so are urban women compared to rural women (56 percent versus 45 percent). The number of women reporting participation in the three decision areas increased from 2010 to 2015-16, and the increase concerns mostly women's involvement in joint decision-making. On women's exclusive decision-making, no improvement was observed in the areas of healthcare and major household purchases and women's sole decision to visit family even decreased from 25 percent in 2010 to 18 percent in 2015-16. Women's participation in decision-making rises with increasing levels of education and wealth. If to some extent, a woman's ability to consensually decide having sexual relations with her husband might reflect in part their ability to choose and enforce their choices within the couple, the survey found that less than half of Malawian women (46 percent) can refuse to have sexual intercourse with their husbands. The World Bank reported the same proportion of women making their own informed decisions regarding sexual relations, contraceptive use and reproductive health care in 2016¹²⁶.

¹²³ Gender analysis report, Moyo and Satali, December 2020

¹²⁴ Malawi Gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹²⁵ Gender analysis report, Moyo and Satali, December 2020

¹²⁶ <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SG.DMK.SRCR.FN.ZS?end=2020&locations=MW&start=2000&view=chart>

181. Since the culture in Malawi expects men to look for household needs - a fact that leads to male domination in money-making tasks, decision making power and control over household resources are generally left in men's hands. A study conducted by the Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources in 2015 showed that 70 percent of men are handling the household finance, which is the main determinant in decision making, access and control over resources¹²⁷. Field consultations confirmed that decisions related to expensive goods' purchase are made by men^{128 129}. Women's access and control over financial resources coming from the family farm are limited. Customarily, while gender roles force women to perform domestic and reproductive tasks, they must also help and assist their husband in the whole farming process. When they face the challenge of finding the balance and distributing their time among the various tasks, they in return have little or no access to the money gained from the farming activities once the products are sold.

182. With respect to income, women who work and are paid in cash have some control over their earnings. Their involvement in decisions about their earnings has increased over time; 58 percent had a role in decision making in 2010 compared with 76 percent in 2015-16. The 2015-16 MDHS reported the proportions of women with sole decision making over their own earnings to be at 28 percent, those who decide jointly with their husband at 47 percent and those for whom husbands control such decisions at 24 percent. Women who earn more than their husband¹³⁰ are more likely to make/contribute in decision-making on the use of their own wages (43.2 percent making their own decision and 40.5 percent deciding jointly with their husband) and that of their husband (21.9 percent deciding solely and 46.8 deciding jointly on husband's cash earnings), than those who earn less than their husband (70 percent of women) of whom 31.1 percent make their own decision and 42.1 decide jointly with their husband on their own wages. For women who earn as much as their husbands (14 percent of women), just under two-thirds of women are involved in joint decisions with their husbands about the use of their cash income (64.3 percent) and that of their husbands (63.8 percent), but the proportion of women who make sole decision on their cash earnings (10.6 percent) is reduced by a third compared to the proportion of men who decide themselves on the use of their cash income (31.6 percent). Younger women, women without higher than secondary school education, and women in the lower wealth quintiles are least likely to have control over their earnings; their husbands are more likely to be the sole decision maker on their wife's cash-earnings. As for control over men's earnings, only 36 percent of men reported to exclusively control their earnings compared with 44 percent of women reporting husband controlling himself his earnings. Some difference was also noted on joint decision on the use of husband's earnings reported by men and women and estimated at 57 percent and 48 percent respectively. Rural residence increases the likelihood of husband's control over his earnings both among men and women: for 38 percent of men and 47 percent of women in rural areas, the husband decides independently on how his earnings and that of his wife will be used compared with 28 percent of men and 31 percent of women in urban areas.

183. In terms of decision-making implications, a World Bank analysis found that women who stand as main or joint decision-maker are less like likely to experience emotional, physical or sexual intimate partner violence, a situation that highlights the positive impact of husbands agreeing on engaging their wife as sole or joint-decision maker. Besides, women participating in decision-making process are more likely to access prenatal services and receive childbirth

¹²⁷ Gender division of household labour in rural households, M. M. Mambiya, Lilongwe University of Agriculture and Natural Resources, August 2015

¹²⁸ Focus group discussions with various committee members and community leaders in Sorgen (Magoti EPA) in a patrilineal community, Nsanje District, 3rd October 2022

¹²⁹ Focus group discussions with various committee members and community leaders in Kapingiri Village, Lundu section, Bolero EPA in a patrilineal community, Rumphi District, 14th October 2022

¹³⁰ The majority of women (70%) earn less than their husbands, and 14% earn about the same amount (MDHS 2015-16)

assistance, and are less likely to have unmet family planning or to have their children stunted or malnourished.

4.2.4 Entrepreneurship

184. Women represents a significant part of the entrepreneurial workforce in Sub-Saharan Africa. Many women are constrained to engage in entrepreneurship compared to men as they meet some limitations in pursuing wage work or other economic opportunities due to low level of education and skills and given their time-consuming domestic responsibilities.

185. In Malawi, cultural beliefs and norms that are gender biased against women create stereotypes that continue to hinder more women to engage in business ventures. Pre-established cultural norms include women's reduced likelihood to operate enterprises in more profitable male dominated sectors, lack of exposure to good business practices, lack of credit and other business development services that respond specifically to the needs of women, and limited capacity to adopt advanced business practices, to innovate, or to formalize their business¹³¹. Women owned enterprises are therefore entrenched to produce lower returns than those owned by men.

186. Within the entrepreneurial sector, business inputs used by women and men managers differ significantly. Men's start-up capital usually comes from agriculture saved earnings. In fact, since male plot managers get greater returns to agricultural work, they are able to earn, save and reinvest more money in their business. Women, on the other hand, are more likely to use start-up capital gifted to them from family or friends. Household burdens also widen the gender gap since women dedicate much time that they could allocate to productive activities to household and childcare. Other inputs that may disadvantage women entrepreneurs are workers and wages paid to workers. Unlike men who are more likely to hire male workers and pay higher wages, women are forced to rely on family male and female labour with limited productivity. Women's barrier in hiring more productive workers may also lead them to operate in lower-value sectors that require less skilled workers¹³².

187. Due to cultural norms, women are also constrained to set their business in more traditional locations such as their house or the roadside compared to their male counterparts, since they must fulfil care work and domestic responsibilities and have to operate their enterprises in locations that are considered safer or gender appropriate by the society.

188. The Covid-19 pandemic has been expected to affect more women-led than men-led businesses because (i) women owned firms in Malawi are on average smaller and have lower sales and profits, (ii) women's ability to cope with the crisis may be hindered by their weak professional network and limited access to knowledge, and (iii) school closures and childcare responsibilities prevented women from continuously running their activities¹³³. A World Bank survey also highlighted that women are concentrated in consumer-facing sectors which experienced a more severe demand shock from the pandemic, 93 percent of women's businesses sell to final consumers compared to 87 percent of men's businesses¹³⁴.

¹³¹ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022.

¹³² Ibid.

¹³³ Ibid.

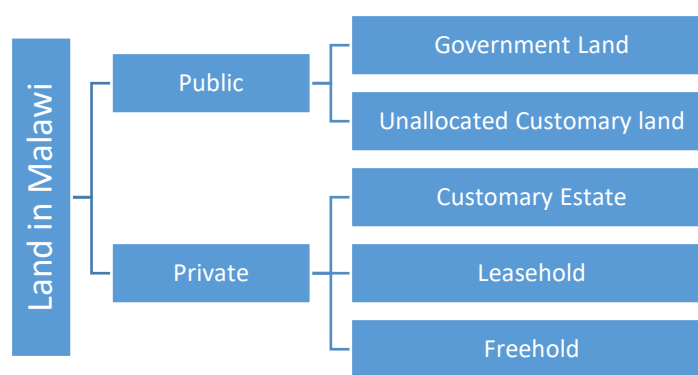
¹³⁴ Ibid.

4.3 Access to and control of resources, assets and services

4.3.1 Land

189. The 2016 Land Act regulates two categories of land: public land that comprises Government or unallocated customary land and private land that includes customary estate, leasehold or freehold (Figure 3). Often acquired in the colonial era through alienation of customary land, private land was used for large-scale production of export crops, such as tea and tobacco. While these estates were favoured in agricultural policy with the privileged right to produce crops for export, smallholder farmers were only allowed to sell their crops at lower prices for local consumption. From Independence in 1964 when these estates passed into the hands of Malawian elite until 1994, the regime of Malawi's first president Banda reinforced the colonial-era dual structure of an agriculture sector made up of large estates and smallholders.

Figure 3: Contemporary categorization of land in Malawi



Source: Land Act 2016

190. The share of agricultural land with respect to total land was at 59.9 percent in 2018. Smallholder farmers are responsible for most agricultural production but most of them are subsistence farmers. More than 40 percent of rural households produce food on less than half a hectare, combining the staple crop maize with a wide array of legumes, gourds and leafy vegetables. Wetland gardens are also cultivated to grow vegetables and fruit. 70 percent of the land cultivated by small farmers is devoted to maize. Rural households hold between one to ten plots, with an average of two plots per household. High annual population growth combined with a limited land base and few fallow periods have led to soil erosion, severe deforestation, pollution of water resources, and general degradation of the natural resource base¹³⁵.

191. Malawians access land through inheritance (52 percent) and marriage (18 percent)¹³⁶. A higher proportion of females were reported to own land nationally (58 percent) compared to males (53 percent), with variations on the regions. Males dominate land ownership in the North with 40.9 percent versus 34.6 percent for females, Central Region has very small gender disparities (38.0 percent for males versus 38.1 percent for females) but the Southern Region has more pronounced gender based disparities since 46.6 percent females own land compared to 37 percent for males. Rights to land through marriage and inheritance are governed by one of two existing family systems in the country: the patrilineal system predominant in the Northern Region and two southern districts (Nsanje and Chikwawa), and the matrilineal system prevalent in most of the central and Southern Region districts. A mixed system borrowing from the two systems is practiced in some areas. In matrilineal system, women in the family inherit land and the man

¹³⁵ Country Profile Malawi, Landlinks, USAID, August 2010 (<https://www.land-links.org/country-profile/malawi/>)

¹³⁶ Ibid.

moves into the woman's family home after marriage. In patrilineal systems, inheritance is passed on to the sons and the woman moves in with her husband's family. Customary law in patrilineal system only gives women land-use rights acquired through kinship relationships and their status as wives, mothers, sisters and daughters. These rights are therefore linked to women's role as household food producers and do not grant enough security of tenure when marriage fails to subsist. Although women tend to have better access to land in matrilineal systems, men often remain the decision makers regarding access and control over land in both systems.¹³⁷ A study conducted in four rural areas of Malawi under matrilineal system showed in 2018 that 69 percent of the farm managers were men. Even in matrilineal societies, men still "own" the land¹³⁸. Besides, in the two systems, land registration and titling for women are not granted and depend much on the interpretation of local customary system. As an example, lead farmers consulted in Ngwere Village in a matrilineal community of Dedza District reported that "Women have more access to land than men"¹³⁹. Women and men farmers met in Mungoti Village in a patrilineal community of Rumph District said: "land belongs to men, it is allocated to sons because all daughters get married"¹⁴⁰.

192. Other means to access land includes allocation from traditional leaders, land leasing, government resettlement programs, and land purchase. An estimated 20 percent of landholders obtain land from traditional authorities, roughly 1 percent of landholders obtain land through purchase¹⁴¹.

193. Tenure insecurity is evident for women moving to patrilineal societies, men moving to matrilineal societies and orphans. These groups may be forced to leave the land in case of divorce or death of their spouse. The high prevalence of HIV/AIDS among the adult population exacerbates the degree of insecurity a spouse may experience¹⁴².

194. With the 2016 Land Act, the 2016 Customary Land Act and the 2016 Registered Land Amendment Act constitute a set of mutually reinforcing laws that were developed and enacted for effective land administration and more equitable access. The 2016 Land Act enables the conversion of customary land into customary estates (private land) and set the foundation of a new land administration framework through the establishment of Traditional Land Management Areas (TLMA) responsible for allocated and unallocated customary estates for communal land. The Customary Land Act (2016) elaborates the legal responsibilities of local land committees established at Group Village Headman level to manage the land within the general boundaries of the TLMA. The Act empowers land committees to allocate customary estates to citizens and corporate bodies if they remain unworked after five years. The Registered Land Amendment Act (2016) provides for title registration throughout the country for all land categories but there is a lack of state capacity to implement this in practice. No specific mention for access and control of land by men and women is observed in legislation.

4.3.2 Agricultural inputs and assets

195. In Malawi, more than 80 percent of the gender gap in productivity is owing to women's low use of inputs such as improved seeds and fertilizers. Although women and men farmers are aware of the importance of their use, women have more difficulty than men in accessing the quality

¹³⁷ Country Profile Malawi, Landlinks, USAID, August 2010 (<https://www.land-links.org/country-profile/malawi/>).

¹³⁸ Factors driving the gender gap in agricultural productivity: Malawi, UN Women, UNDP, Poverty-Environment Initiative, UN Environment, 2018

¹³⁹ Focus group discussions with lead farmers in Ngwere village in a matrilineal community, Dedza District, 17th October 2022

¹⁴⁰ Focus group discussions with lead farmers in Mungoti village in a patrilineal community, Rumph District, 14th October 2022

¹⁴¹ Country Profile Malawi, Landlinks, USAID, August 2010 (<https://www.land-links.org/country-profile/malawi/>)

¹⁴² Ibid.

inputs needed. A recent study of maize fields in Malawi found that female farmers are significantly more likely to use lower quality seeds, less fertilizer, and farm on lower quality soil than their male counterparts¹⁴³. When female farmers and male farmers use the same quantity of inputs, the former fail to take full advantage and get lower return from them due to inadequate knowledge and skills (for example, incorrect use or use of fertilizer at the wrong time)¹⁴⁴.

196. As for physical assets, the level of access and control men and women have over them varies. Higher value assets such as ploughs, animal carts, fishing boats, etc. are generally owned and controlled by men while women have access to lower-value tools and assets such as hand hoes and knives. Given the difficulties women face to access productive male labour and considering their time poverty due to unpaid care and domestic work, the use of labour-saving technologies and agricultural mechanization may constitute an alternative solution to increase women's agricultural productivity. However, this option remains difficult to implement given the high cost of farming equipments and mechanization, and the restricted access to finance that represent a significant barrier to women's empowerment.

197. The non-availability of male labour to work on female-managed farm plots accounts among the most important contributors to gender gap in farm productivity¹⁴⁵. Indeed, women plot managers deploy fewer household male laborers on their plots than their male counterparts as most of them are not married (70 percent of them being either widowed, divorced or separated in contrast to only 3 percent for men), have smaller household sizes and fewer male household members that could provide labour on their farm. They have no choice but to use less productive available family labour, which includes themselves and their children. Furthermore, the few female plot managers that could afford hiring male labour may not afford better quality labour and may experience lower labour-productivity since hired male workers may work less hard for female plot managers than for male due to cultural bias¹⁴⁶.

4.3.3 Extension services

198. Through the Ministry of Agriculture namely the Department of agriculture extension services (DAES), Malawi has a demand-driven and pluralistic agricultural extension system. The system's vision is that "all farmers demand and access high quality agriculture extension and advisory services from those best able to provide them"¹⁴⁷. The DAES relies on various approaches to ensure that farmers of all gender categories have access to extension services including: the model village approach in which villages are committed to working together with various service providers to achieve their vision; the clusters and Mindandandas¹⁴⁸ used as platforms for technology dissemination where a collection of farmers manage similar agricultural enterprises in the same catchment area or locality; the Farmer field schools (FFS) to enhance the adoption of technologies and practices through training and self-discovery; the Farm business schools (FBS) to promote market-oriented production among smallholder farmers; the Lead Farmer¹⁴⁹ approach to increase extension coverage for the adoption of improved practices and technologies using farmer to farmer extension approach; the Agriculture Resource Centers that ensure recommended practice, technology and information dissemination for easy and equitable

¹⁴³ Malawi Gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹⁴⁴ Ibid.

¹⁴⁵ Factors driving the gender gap in agricultural productivity: Malawi, UN Women, UNDP, Poverty-Environment Initiative, UN Environment, 2018

¹⁴⁶ Malawi Gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹⁴⁷ <http://www.daes.gov.mw/who-are-we/index.php>

¹⁴⁸ A Mindandanda is a stretch of well managed fields of different crops, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁴⁹ A lead farmer is described as a farmer who has mastered a specific technology and is willing to support fellow farmers, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

access to farmers and other stakeholders; the Multimedia agricultural campaigns involving the use of different channels for disseminating agricultural information to farmers (radio, mobile vans, drama, flyers etc.); the Household Methodology (called “Household Approach” in Malawi, and also in the rest of the Annex) to promote power relations among adult and youth household members in order to promote equitable access to and control over resources, assets and benefits; the Participatory integrated climate services for agriculture (PICSA) approach that facilitates farmers’ informed decisions based on accurate, location-specific, climate and weather information; locally relevant crop, livestock and livelihood options; and with the use of participatory tools to aid decision making. The Department has five technical branches that are (i) Extension Methodology and Systems¹⁵⁰, (ii) Food and Nutrition¹⁵¹, (iii) Agribusiness Development¹⁵², (iv) Agriculture Gender Roles Extension Support Services¹⁵³ and (v) Agriculture Communication¹⁵⁴. The Department’s structure extends to Agriculture Development Division (ADD) level and District agricultural Extension Services System, where each branch has offices and officers to implement its interventions. ADDs are located in the eight ecological zones of the country namely Lilongwe, Blantyre, Salima, Kasungu, Machinga, Shire Valley, Karonga and Mzuzu and the District agricultural Extension Services Systems cover the 28 districts of the country. Local delivery of extension services is ensured by Agricultural extension development officers (AEDOs).

199. The Household and Community Surveys conducted by the International food policy research institute (IFPRI) in 2017¹⁵⁵ stated that AEDOs remain the dominant players in agricultural extension service provision although farmers also reported receiving advice from other stakeholders such as non-governmental organizations (NGOs), community-based or farmer-based organizations. Ninety-nine percent of group villages indicated the visits by government agents and only 15 percent of group villages mentioned the visits by non-government agents or workers. The non-state service providers are dominated by international NGOs that mostly function on external fundings from donors and operate through short-term projects. The few local organizations involved in the provision of extension service need to be strengthened to become effective service providers. Contrary to what was foreseen in the National extension policy, extension service provision is heavily supply-driven, a significant proportion of farmers who received advice did not request for it. Three-quarters of the households involved in the surveys reported having received some advice on agriculture in the past two years, this percentage was about the half in the last 12 months.

200. The agriculture topics of advice reported included crop production practices, mainly on weather forecasts, early or timely planting, improved varieties, soil fertility management practices, and water harvesting practices. Male respondents were more likely to receive advice on weather/climate forecasts, external inputs use (improved varieties and chemical fertilizer), crop disease control, and irrigation and water harvesting practices. Advice on health, nutrition and dietary diversity (six food groups) in food consumption, washing hands before and after consuming food, and general hygiene and cleanliness were also provided. A quarter of respondents in the IFPRI surveys obtained advice on postharvest practices, a quarter on

¹⁵⁰ Responsible for developing extension approaches and systems for extension delivery, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁵¹ Responsible for ensuring that households achieve food and nutrition security through diversified production and diets, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁵² Responsible for promoting commercialization of agriculture, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁵³ Responsible for mainstreaming gender, HIV and AIDS in Agricultural policies, programs and projects, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁵⁴ Responsible for developing and distributing print and electronic agricultural messages, <https://agriculture.gov.mw/index.php/departments/agricultural-extension-services>

¹⁵⁵ Malawi Strategy Support Program, The State of Agricultural Extension and Advisory Services Provision in Malawi, Insights from Household and Community Surveys, Catherine Ragasa and Chiyu Niu, IFPRI, February 2017

livestock, fifteen percent on marketing, and 5 percent on aquaculture practices. Males are more likely to receive advice on agriculture than females. Female members in male-headed households have a lower likelihood of receiving agriculture advice than females who are household head. Females are less likely to receive advice on weather or climate forecasts, external inputs (improved varieties and chemical fertilizer), crop disease control, and irrigation and water harvesting techniques. Females and youth are also less likely to participate in Village Agricultural or Development Committees than males and are therefore less likely to be aware and adopt improved technology. Access to advice is positively correlated to level of education and wealth. Overall, farmers gave very high ratings and are satisfied with the advice that they receive.

201. As for information dissemination, the most common method for disseminating information on agricultural technologies consists of community or group meetings, followed by the use of radio, face-to-face visits, short-term trainings and farm demonstrations facilitated by government or NGO workers. Field consultations also confirmed these information¹⁵⁶. Only 1 to 2 percent of farmers reported accessing information from other sources or through other approaches including farmer field schools, farmer field days, farmer phone or SMS messaging, mobile vans, listening clubs, television, or internet.

4.3.4 Credit

1. Financial service providers in Malawi include commercial banks, Savings and Credit Cooperatives (SACCOs), licensed microfinance institutions (MFIs) and payday lending companies (PLCs). SACCOs provide basic savings and small working capital/consumer loan products, MFIs and PLCs provide small credit only. Basic mobile money services, particularly money transfers are also available through two mobile network operators TNM and Airtel¹⁵⁷. Although some of the SACCOs operate in smaller towns, no notable agricultural financial products are offered at scale. The FinScope Consumer Survey Malawi 2014 reported the percentage of adults served by formal financial institutions to be at 40 percent¹⁵⁸; this proportion is the highest in urban areas (73 percent), followed by peri-urban areas (54 percent) and rural areas (34 percent). Access to formal financial products/services by gender shows a better access among males (55 percent) compared to females (51 percent). As for access to informal financial services, the same survey indicated its use by 28 percent of adults. As an example, the Community based financial organizations (CBFOs) account among informal service providers and allowed the financial inclusion of 1.1 million members from urban and rural areas, of which about 47 percent are women¹⁵⁹. Both estimated at 5 percent, the proportion of persons who used informal services in urban and peri-urban areas represented about one third of those who accessed informal financial services in rural areas (16 percent). Informal access to finance concerned 16 percent of women and 12 percent of men¹⁶⁰. Farmers are the largest users of informal financial services; they also account for the largest number of adults without access to financial services (35 percent)¹⁶¹. The share of people financially excluded in rural areas (50 percent) is more than double that in urban areas (22 percent). The proportion of women excluded from the financial system of 49 percent exceeded that of men by 4 percentage points.

202. The IHS5 2019-2020 estimated at 23.3 percent the proportion of households that had interactions with credit market, out of which 17.7 percent successfully obtained credit or loans - 18.4 percent for male-headed households and 16.0 percent for female-headed households. 81.4

¹⁵⁶ Focus group discussions with cooperative/community members in Mpamba, T/A Timbiri, Nkhata-Bay District, 12th October 2022

¹⁵⁷ FARMSE Final Project Design, IFAD, Republic of Malawi, February 2018

¹⁵⁸ FinScope Consumer Survey Malawi 2014, Republic of Malawi, FinScope, Finmark Trust, 2014

¹⁵⁹ FARMSE Final Project Design, IFAD, Republic of Malawi, February 2018

¹⁶⁰ FinScope Consumer Survey Malawi 2014, Republic of Malawi, FinScope, Finmark Trust, 2014

¹⁶¹ FARMSE Final Project Design, IFAD, Republic of Malawi, February 2018

percent of credit/loan beneficiaries used the credit/loans to set up businesses and 14.4 percent used them to purchase agricultural inputs for food crops in urban areas. In rural areas, 47.5 percent of beneficiaries invested in business set up, 32.9 percent, 8.4 percent and 5 percent contracted credits/loans for the purchase of agricultural inputs in food crops, cash crops and tobacco respectively. The percentage of women headed households contracting credits/loans for business start-up and agricultural input purchase for food crops, of 59.9 percent and 31.8 percent respectively, are higher than that of men headed households estimated at 49.9 percent and 29.6 percent respectively. Main sources of credit/loans mentioned by recipients were village banks, relatives, neighbours, lenders and NGOs. Loans obtained from village banks were higher in rural areas (42.9 percent) compared to urban areas (37.9 percent). Relatives were a source of credit for 16.3 percent of households in rural areas compared to 8.9 percent in urban areas. Neighbours as a source of credit was higher in urban areas (19.8 percent) compared to rural areas (12.5 percent). No significant difference was observed according to the sex of household head. Households that never applied for a loan represented 76.9 percent; their proportion is lower in rural (75.8 percent) than in urban (82.7 percent) areas. The first reason raised by 22.2 percent of rural households as well as 22.6 percent of households run by women which never applied for a loan is the difficulty caused for what it is worth. Other reasons included absence of need, will to not go into debt, suspicion of a refusal, high cost of service, inadequate collateral and lack of knowledge on lenders. 41.3 percent of urban households indicated the absence of need compared to 21.7 percent of rural households. The percentage of rural households mentioning inadequate collateral of 8.3 percent exceeds that of urban households by 3.4 percentage points, female headed households mentioning inadequacy of collateral (9.8 percent) were higher than male headed households (6.8 percent). While the first reason for not applying for a loan accounting for 41.3 percent of urban households and for 26.8 percent of male-headed households is the lack of need; 22.6 percent of female-headed households and 22.2 percent of rural households reported not willing to engage in a cumbersome process that is not worth it.

203. If the rural poor are usually placed at disadvantage in accessing financial services due to the remote areas they reside in, women's situation is worse. Indeed, women's financial inclusion is constrained by their financial capability as well as social and environmental factors¹⁶². Financial capability encompasses the knowledge (literacy), attitudes, skills and behaviours consumers have about managing their resources, and understanding, selecting, and making use of financial services that fit their needs¹⁶³. It may constitute a barrier given women's very limited knowledge of available financial products and ways to engage with the financial system (for examples: short-term, medium-term and long-term financial savings and investment products, loan products, insurance products, etc.) and affect their attitude towards risks and general financial behaviour.

204. Societal factors consider socio-economic and welfare characteristics such as demographic characteristics, household size, gender, education, economic activity and incomes of individuals, intra-household resource allocation rules, etc. For instance, being a woman may limit the chances to access credit considering the difficulties to present collateral or personal guarantees¹⁶⁴. Indeed, the limitations for women to own, manage, control, or inherit property compared to men may constitute a legal discrimination for their access to finance. Women's lack of formal education also qualifies them as less attractive clients and reduces the interest of formal financial institutions to provide services for them, as opposed to men mostly involved in high-value sectors and enterprises¹⁶⁵. Regarding incomes, people with higher income are more likely to open a bank account to save part of their income, are therefore more likely to use other financial

¹⁶² Determinants of Financial Inclusion in Malawi, Malawi Journal of Economics, 2(1): 1-22, Nkuna et al., 2021

¹⁶³ World Bank, 2013

¹⁶⁴ Ibid.

¹⁶⁵ Malawi Gender assessment, Eastern and Southern Africa Gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

products and be financially included compared to low-income earners. The study of financial inclusion in Africa¹⁶⁶ found that being a man, richer, more educated and older favours financial inclusion with a higher influence of education and income. Women's low earnings which impede their ability to save prevent them from accessing financial services and investing in businesses and interesting economic opportunities. Most Malawian rural women entrepreneurs are thus forced to start their business with capital gifted to them by their families, unlike men who are more likely to use their savings. Women consulted in Ngewere village in a matrilineal community reported the lack of working capital among their biggest concerns.¹⁶⁷

205. As for environmental factors, the availability and accessibility of financial products and services are worth mentioning. Since most financial institutions in Malawi are located in urban-cities and urban-district towns and considering the stage of development of formal financial sector in rural areas which leaves much to be desired, women are certainly disadvantaged because of travel and mobility restrictions due largely to care and household responsibilities¹⁶⁸. Women also mentioned the lack of financial products designed to meet their needs during field consultations.

206. Regarding the use of technology to access financial services, men and women's overall use of bank accounts and ownership of mobile phones are low. The 2015-16 MDHS reported men as more likely to own a bank account (17 percent) and mobile phones (52 percent) than women (10 percent and 33 percent, respectively). The likelihood for men and women in urban areas to use a bank account, own a mobile phone and use the phone for financial transactions is higher than for men and women in rural areas. For example, 28 percent of urban women use a bank account compared with 5 percent of rural women; 64 percent of urban women own a mobile phone compared with 26 percent of rural women, and 39 percent of women in urban areas use their phone for financial transactions compared with 21 percent of women in rural settings¹⁶⁹.

4.3.5 Access to markets

207. The gender-based division of assets, commodities and existing market organization allocate to women the less profitable products and markets. In addition, women's access to market is inhibited by several factors including limited access to information, restricted mobility due to household and childcare responsibilities and cultural norms that give men more power and voice in marketplaces. Women have also to bear the consequences of the gender inequalities affecting them all along the production chain. In fact, women have less products due to gender productivity gap related to choice of crops, size of plots, unequal use of inputs such as labour, labour-saving technology, improved seeds, etc.

208. Most of the women involved in FGD commercialize their products and access to markets through producers organizations that collectively sell products on irregular basis in markets located further away from the production site. Few women groups mentioned engaging in commercial agreement with off-takers.

209. Barriers mentioned by most women and youth farmer groups met during field consultations are related to the lack of knowledge on the identification of profitable business, the difficulties to identify buyers and conclude formal agreements, a situation that creates an unwholesome dependence on middlemen and commercial intermediaries. In addition, most women and youth farmers reported the difficulties to comply with the process of certification with the Malawi Bureau of standards. As a result, although few groups were able to identify market

¹⁶⁶ The determinants of financial inclusion in Africa, Zins and Weill, August 2016

¹⁶⁷ Focused group discussions with lead farmers in Ngewere village in a matrilineal community, Dedza District, 17th October 2022

¹⁶⁸ Determinants of Financial Inclusion in Malawi, Malawi Journal of Economics, 2(1): 1-22, Nkuna et al., 2021

¹⁶⁹ MDHS 2015-16

niches, they lose the opportunity to explore them and fail to compete with certified traders who are in most cases international traders in Malawi.

4.3.6 Access to information

210. As per the Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey 2019-20, women and men in Malawi had low access to the three forms of mass media (newspaper, radio and television), their exposure were at 2 percent and 5 percent respectively. The proportion of men exposed to radio of 59 percent was significantly higher compared to that of women of 38 percent. Men's exposure to television and newspaper of 22 percent 11 percent respectively, exceeds women's exposure by 7 and 3 percentage points respectively. Apart from gender difference, huge differences were noted in terms of exposure to the three mass media by place of residence for both men and women: 1 percent of women in rural areas vs. 9 percent of women in urban areas, and 3 percent of men in rural areas vs. 15 percent of men in urban areas. Exposure is positively correlated to increasing levels of education and wealth¹⁷⁰.

211. The same survey (2019-20) reported that fifty eight percent of households owned a mobile phone. Household ownership in rural areas (52 percent) was low compared to that in urban areas (88 percent). The percentage of men and women who reported the use of mobile phone the last 3 months preceding the MICS was of 71 and 53 percent respectively. Place of residence also accentuated the gender disparities in the use of mobile phone: 47 percent of rural women use mobile phone compared to 80 percent of urban women, and 67 percent of rural men use mobile phone compared to 86 percent of urban men¹⁷¹.

212. Regarding access to information on agricultural technologies, the survey conducted by IFPRI in 2017 highlighted as most common means of information community or group meetings, radio, face-to-face visits, short-term trainings and farm demonstrations facilitated by government or NGO. A very small proportions of farmers reported accessing information from other sources¹⁷².

4.4 Social participation of rural women

4.4.1 Political voice and leadership

213. In Malawi, contemporary formal state politics is constructed as a masculine domain in which women can only participate to a limited extent. Traditional cultural beliefs relegate women to non-political roles, the society assigning them to roles in the private and domestic sphere rather than in public life. The entire socialisation process prevents women's participation in politics. Girls are treated differently from boys and the focus of their upbringing is on domestic tasks; a setting that limits time available for education, blunts ambition and lowers self-esteem. Women's lack of resources and lower economic status compared to men hold them back from political leadership¹⁷³.

214. Since female voice and leadership are needed in government to promote and enforce policies pertaining to women, women's participation in national as well as local government is essential to creating opportunities for women to articulate their needs and concerns. Even though Malawi engaged in numerous international and national commitments to gender equality and equal representation through quotas, elected political representation in the country remains

¹⁷⁰ Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS), National Statistics Office, USAID, UNICEF, German Cooperation, Norwegian Embassy, Gavi, 2019-20

¹⁷¹ Ibid.

¹⁷² Malawi Strategy Support Program, The State of Agricultural Extension and Advisory Services Provision in Malawi, Insights from Household and Community Surveys, Catherine Ragasa and Chiyu Niu, IFPRI, February 2017

¹⁷³ Malawian women's participation in State politics: what are the constraints?, Alinane Priscilla Kamlongera, October 2008

unequal and female political participation has seen little progress. Indeed, at central government, Malawi has had only one female president (Joyce Banda, 2012-2014) among six presidents since its independence in 1964. As of 2019, only 23 percent of elected parliamentarians were female¹⁷⁴. Within local government, as the system in Malawi includes local councils that are responsible for proposing activities, examining government policies, and overseeing their implementation, women elected to local councils can advance and advocate women's interests, concerns and issues. Available data shows a different situation because few women have been elected to local government councils since 1998, when local government councils were created through decentralization. The proportion of women elected to local councils has not changed significantly from 2014 when it stood at 13.4 percent, to 2019¹⁷⁵ when it was estimated at 15 percent¹⁷⁶ (67 seats for women among 460 elected seats¹⁷⁷). This proportion remains low compared to the Sub-Saharan Africa average of 25.3 percent¹⁷⁸. Low female participation at the local level has a negative impact on female representation at the national level as local government is a valuable path to gaining political experience before running national campaigns. In addition to unequal representation in elected positions, 60 percent of positions with decision-making responsibilities in the public sector are held by men. The persistence of gender inequity within ministries are motivated by the lack of qualified women available¹⁷⁹.

215. Another significant barrier that is also worth mentioning for women to access elected positions is the cost of campaigning. Male candidates were found to spend 14 percent more money than their female counterparts in electoral campaigns¹⁸⁰.

4.4.2 Women's participation in community-based and farmer organizations

216. The National Smallholder Farmers' Association of Malawi (NASFAM) which is the largest smallholder owned membership organisation in Malawi, registers 36 percent of female members. This low proportion of female membership translates well the crop production patterns of NASFAM's members that include 60 percent of cash crops and 40 percent of food crops. A case study analysing gender equality in co-operatives in Malawi reported that traditions holding back women in business participation, lack of information as well support from their life partners are the causes of non-participation in cooperatives¹⁸¹.

217. The FGD have shown that existing farmers organizations support smallholder farmers in providing essential services all along value chains (access to inputs, marketing, etc.) that would otherwise be not affordable to them. Although the FGD did not allow assessing their effectiveness in managing to serve and deliver services to poor and vulnerable people (including women and youth), these organizations seem to constitute a good mean to enhance the inclusion of women and youth within farmers' communities.

218. In terms of natural resource management, various natural resources committees could exist, function in an isolated manner or collaborate in a coordinated/integrated way. Women are usually active in natural resource management committees where they usually assume the role

¹⁷⁴ Information on Head of State and Government as of 24 October 2022, Data on share of women in the single/lower chamber of parliament as of 1 January 2022, Data on share of women in ministerial positions as of 1 January 2021, Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU) and UN Women: <https://localgov.unwomen.org/country/MWI>

¹⁷⁵ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹⁷⁶ Data on share of women in local government as of 1 January 2022, UN Women

¹⁷⁷ Data compiled by UN Women in partnership with UN Regional Commissions, 2022, <https://localgov.unwomen.org/sdg-551b-country-ranking>

¹⁷⁸ Ibid.

¹⁷⁹ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹⁸⁰ Ibid.

¹⁸¹ Gender equality in co-operatives: A case of selected agricultural and marketing co-operative societies in Malawi, Nyanjige Mbembela Mayala & Neema Penance Kumburu, European Journal of Business, Economics and Accountancy, 2018

of Secretary. Men often occupy the positions of President or Treasury considering their level of literacy compared to women. [To be completed].

4.5 Gender-based violence and other harmful practices

4.5.1 Gender-based violence including sexual violence

219. The UN Declaration on Violence against Women 1993 defined violence against women as “acts that inflict physical, mental or sexual harm or suffering, threats of such acts, coercion and other deprivations of liberty whether occurring in public or in private life.” Gender-Based Violence (GBV) is not only manifested as physical and/or domestic violence, but also as structural violence that excludes women, girls and children from acquisition and control over resources such as land, jobs, education, credit and other goods and services based on their sex and statistics¹⁸². Despite the number of interventions the Government has taken to address GBV, the four main types of GBV (physical, sexual, emotional or psycho-social and economic) are still prevalent in varying degrees in Malawi. Several factors influence the relatively high prevalence of GBV including early child and forced marriage, harmful cultural practices, patriarchal systems, rigid gender roles, religious beliefs, illiteracy and low education levels, and low economic empowerment of women, imbalance of power in intimate relationships among others¹⁸³.

220. The most common form of physical violence among both females and males in Malawi was beating, hitting or battering¹⁸⁴. According to the 2015-16 MDHS: 34 percent of women aged 15-49 experienced physical violence since age 15 and 5 percent of women aged 15-49 who had ever been pregnant reported experiencing physical violence during pregnancy. Youngest women aged 15-19 are less likely to experience physical violence than the other age groups. The proportion of 38 percent women experiencing physical violence in urban areas was higher than that in rural areas (33 percent). By region, the highest percentage of physical violence on women was observed in the Northern region (40 percent), then in the Southern (34 percent) and Central regions (33 percent). Perpetrators of physical violence against ever-married women were current and former husbands (53 percent and 31 percent respectively); nearly all never-married women reported perpetrators to be family members (including mothers and step-mothers, fathers or step-fathers, sisters or brothers, and other relatives), current boyfriend for 6 percent and teacher for 6 percent¹⁸⁵.

221. With regards to sexual violence, the Gender Based Violence Survey¹⁸⁶ reported unwanted touch, marital rape, sex deprivation, forced early marriage, attempted rape, incest, defilement and the exchange of sex for coupons as the most common form of sexual violence in Malawi in 2013. The most prevalent form of sexual violence experienced by males was sexual deprivation, while the most prevalent form experienced by females was marital rape. As per the 2015-16 MDHS, 14 percent of women experienced sexual violence the year before the survey and 21 percent of women experienced sexual violence at some point in their lives (including 4 percent who experienced it before the age of 18). The lowest proportion of sexual violence on women were observed among the 15-19 age group, and highest proportion among the 25-29 (13.5 and 27.2 percent respectively). Women's experience with sexual violence had a non-linear relationship with age. As for family status, divorced, separated, and widowed women are most at risk (31 percent) compared to never-married women (10 percent). This category includes women

¹⁸² National Plan of Action to Combat Gender-Based Violence in Malawi 2014-2020, Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare, July 2014

¹⁸³ Ibid.

¹⁸⁴ Ibid.

¹⁸⁵ Malawi DHS, 2015/16

¹⁸⁶ Gender Based Violence Survey: A baseline report of 17 districts in Malawi, MoGCDSW, NSO, UNFPA and UN Women, 2013

as employees in the workplace facing sexual harassment and other forms of violence. The proportion of sexual violence was higher in rural (21 percent) than in urban areas (17 percent). The prevalence of sexual violence varies by region with the highest rates reported in the Central region, followed by the Northern Region and Southern Region (24.5, 20.8 and 17.1 percent respectively). Regarding perpetrators of sexual violence, 63 percent of ever-married women indicated current husband, 31 percent former husband and 5 percent strangers. As for never-married women, current or former boyfriend is the most common perpetrator¹⁸⁷.

222. Never-married women were less likely to experience physical and sexual violence (23 and 10 percent respectively) compared to married women (33 percent and 22 percent respectively). The experience of physical and sexual violence was more common among employed than unemployed women. While sexual violence declines with increasing level of wealth, its variation with women's level of education was non-linear.

223. Overall, 40 percent of all women who ever experienced any type of physical or sexual violence sought help to stop violence, and 49 percent never sought help. Women who experienced both physical and sexual violence were more likely to have sought help (55 percent) than women who have experienced only physical violence (35 percent) or only sexual violence (30 percent). Sources of help could be woman's own family (62 percent), husband's family (33 percent) or a friend (10 percent). At institutional level, 10 percent of women solicited the police and 2 percent turned to religious leader or doctor/medical personnel. Help seeking is more common in the Central Region than either the Northern or Southern Regions¹⁸⁸.

224. Under the umbrella of GBV, Intimate partner violence (IPV) constitutes a serious concern, with over 40 percent of ever-married women having experienced physical, sexual, or emotional violence¹⁸⁹. An important aspect of IPV is the attitudes of both men and women about the justification of husbands beating their wives. The Malawi DHS 2015-16 highlighted that 16 percent of women and 13 percent of men found justifiable husband beating his wife in certain circumstances. Attitudes towards acceptance of wife beating are higher in rural areas than in urban areas. Tolerance of wife beating decreases with increasing levels of wealth and education. Husbands' alcohol consumption is a significant factor that increases the risk of IPV, 79 percent of women whose husbands are often drunk have experienced IPV, compared to 34 percent of women whose husbands do not drink. IPV also demonstrates intergenerational effect since women whose father beat her mother are more likely to experience IPV themselves.

225. Despite increased legal protections, GBV continues to be a significant challenge throughout the country. Even though Malawi has referral guidelines on child protection and gender-based violence developed in July 2020, victims of domestic violence demonstrate a continued preference for seeking help through informal channels rather than reporting to formal authorities, such as the police. Women met during field consultations said that "Vyakumdima tuwulura yayi", meaning literally that "these are marriage's secrets" and that GBV is one of the things that happen in darkness. They also reported to sometimes have the chance of questioning their husbands when the latter are not treating them well, but once women tell them about their misconduct, women get beaten up¹⁹⁰. These women mentioned to know the differences between the various GBV cases and where to report them to (marriage counselors, community leaders, police, etc.). The preference for informal versus formal reporting is likely due in part to a low

¹⁸⁷ Malawi DHS, 2015/16

¹⁸⁸ Ibid.

¹⁸⁹ Ibid.

¹⁹⁰ Focus group discussions with members of various farming groups, lead farmers, committee members in patrilineal community, Mungoti Village, Rumphi District, Northern region, 14th October 2022

understanding of women's rights and is likely indicative of women's lack of confidence in formal recourse.

4.5.2 Child marriage

226. Malawi has one of the highest rates of child marriage in the world with about half of girls married before their 18th birthday, and 12 percent of girls married before their 15th birthday¹⁹¹. A significant gender gap is observed between the women and men's first age of marriage estimated at 18.2 and 23 years respectively¹⁹². Women in urban areas marry later than women in rural areas, and women in the Central region marry at a slightly later age than those in the Northern and Southern regions. Women from poorer households and uneducated women are more likely to engage in marriage earlier than educated and wealthier women. The circular relationship between marriage and education is worth noting since women who marry early often drop out of school and the likelihood for women who are not in school to marry at a younger age is very high¹⁹³.

227. Early child and forced marriage are a deeply embedded practice in Malawian society. Child marriage is underpinned by traditional customs. Girls undergo a common practice of initiation into adulthood upon reaching puberty¹⁹⁴, a practice that is often considered as encouraging early sexual activity. In fact, young girls are viewed as ready for marriage at an early age and are pushed to get married since marriage is also seen as a financial insurance mechanism considering the payment of a dowry to the bride's family. Some families may therefore use child marriage as a coping mechanism that helps reduce the burden of feeding their family following any shock. Aside from social norms, poverty is one key driver of child marriage, with children from poorer families being twice as likely to marry early than children from less poor ones. As confirmed during field consultations, men are in general (husbands in patrilineal societies and brothers in matrilineal societies) the ones who decide on the marriage of family members^{195 196 197}.

228. Early marriage has significant and long-term consequences for girls and women: high probability of school drop-out that would significantly (i) lead girls to give birth at a young age, present higher risk for complications during pregnancy and before and during childbirth, and increase the likelihood to have more children throughout their lifetime, (ii) limit women's level of literacy and economic opportunities and become more dependent on their husbands, (iii) reduce women's decision making power within their homes and increase the likelihood of experiencing IPV.

4.5.3 Child labour

229. Although the laws prohibited all forms of child labour in Malawi, for instance the employment act which provides a list of hazardous work for children accompanied by a fine or imprisonment for violations, sets the minimum age for employment at 14, and prevent children between 14 and 18 from working in hazardous jobs; the country is characterized by extensive

¹⁹¹ National Plan of Action to Combat Gender-Based Violence in Malawi 2014-2020, Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare, July 2014

¹⁹² Malawi DHS 2015-16

¹⁹³ Ibid

¹⁹⁴ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

¹⁹⁵ Focus group discussions with committee members, lead farmers and FFS beneficiaries in matrilineal community, Lisungwi, Neno District, Southern region, 5 October 2022

¹⁹⁶ Focus group discussions with lead farmers in matrilineal community, Ngwere Village, Dedza District, Southern region, 17th October 2022

¹⁹⁷ Focus group discussions with members of maize groups and cooperative members in patrilineal community, Mpamba Village, T/A Timbiri, Nkhata Bay District, Northern region, 12th October 2022

child labour¹⁹⁸. One out of two (52 percent) Malawian children is a working child and most of them (58 percent) started to work before the age of ten years old¹⁹⁹. High prevalence of child labour is due to high levels of poverty and difficulties to access education at intermediate and above levels. Many children are therefore forced to engage in child labour in the informal economy. Child labour is much higher in rural areas (15 percent) than in urban areas (7 percent)²⁰⁰. Eighty-eight percent of the children engaged in child labour live in rural areas and the remaining 12 percent are in urban areas²⁰¹. The significant gap is related to the dominating agricultural sector in Malawi's employment structure.

230. Child labour was most prevalent with tea, tobacco and livestock herding, brickmaking and construction, and domestic service. Forced child labour also occurred, particularly in agriculture, construction, forced begging and street work, illicit activities, and commercial sexual exploitation. Children often worked 12-hour days, frequently for little or no pay. Many boys worked as vendors, and young girls in urban areas often worked outside their families as domestic servants, receiving low or no wages. Further analysis and development on child labour are available in Annex 6 on Environmental and Social Management Framework.

4.6 Coping with Hardships

231. Most groups met during field consultations have mentioned that economic hardships are due to heavy family responsibilities - particularly for women head of households (high number of children, care to extended families, etc.), increasing cost of living and price volatility. The financial problems reported are related to school fees, food items, access to sanitation materials and farm inputs. The most critical times during the year are the rainy season corresponding to the planting and cultivating season, the irrigation season and after school holidays when students need to be sent back to school. To respond to these constraints, one of the most frequently used strategy to deal with subsistence and daily economic constraints is the sale of small livestock.

232. The second coping mechanism mostly reported by the FGD participants is the "ganyu". Described as a range of short-term rural labour relationships, the most common of which is piecework weeding or ridging on the fields of other smallholders, or on agricultural estates; "ganyu" constitutes the most important coping strategy and source of livelihood for most poor households in the crucial hungry period between food stores running out and the next harvest.²⁰² While ganyu labour participants in Malawi may have better access to food as a result of cash income from the ganyu²⁰³, the need to do ganyu to obtain an immediate supply of food may conflict with own-farm production that could lock poor households into a vicious cycle of food insecurity. Ganyu may also constitute a response to address an immediate crisis or to handle various structural anomalies such as small land sizes, credit constraints and labour and fertilizer shortages²⁰⁴. Less educated males are more likely to supply ganyu labor. Ganyu labor supply increases with household size, while it decreases with the level of crop farming and size of land owned.²⁰⁵

¹⁹⁸ "The prohibition of child labour does not apply to work done in homes, non-commercial farms, vocational-technical schools, or other training institutions." Labour Market Profile Malawi – 2022/2023, Danish Trade Union Development Agency

¹⁹⁹ Labour Market Profile Malawi – 2022/2023, Danish Trade Union Development Agency

²⁰⁰ Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey (MICS), National Statistics Office, USAID, UNICEF, German Cooperation, Norwegian Embassy, Gavi, 2019-20

²⁰¹ Labour Market Profile Malawi – 2022/2023, Danish Trade Union Development Agency

²⁰² Ganyu labour in Malawi and its implications for livelihood security interventions - an analysis of recent literature and implications for poverty alleviation, Martin Whiteside, January 2000

²⁰³ Informal "Ganyu" Labor Supply, and Food Security: The Case of Malawi, Sitinei et al., January 2016

²⁰⁴ Ganyu Labour in Malawi: Understanding Rural Households' Labour Supply Strategies, Dimova et al.

²⁰⁵ Informal "Ganyu" Labor Supply, and Food Security: The Case of Malawi, Sitinei et al., January 2016

233. Village savings and loans associations (VSLAs), a transparent, democratic and structured version of the informal savings groups²⁰⁶, are also considered by some poor and less poor as a mechanism that helps face economic hardships. In fact, such groups allow their members to save their own money in safe place, to access loans and to obtain emergency insurance. Members can take out loans to cover expenses such as school fees and medical bills without selling productive assets, or they can use the loans to invest in income generating activities to raise household income. As a result, VSLA members experience significant improvements in household health and wellbeing, and an overall improved quality of life.

234. Another coping strategy some women reported during the FGDs is the diversification of income generating activities. This option cannot be accessible to the most vulnerable since its implementation requires fairly consistent inputs. For instance, women engaged in soap making diversification activities mentioned the need to invest in 10 large soap moulding trays of 10m by 5 meters, one big 3 metres long wooded stick for stirring, 2 drums of 200litres for storage of water, etc. as well as some capacity strengthening on how to make soap²⁰⁷. This strategy is obviously difficult to implement for the poorest who cannot invest in the medium/long term and who are less educated.

5. GENDER INEQUALITIES EXACERBATED BY CLIMATE CHANGE

235. Most of the women, men and youth farmers and community members consulted during the project design process indicated to have noticed changes in the frequency or severity of climate related disasters (drought, diseases, floods etc.) that have affected their area over the past years. Gender inequalities exist in all societies in the country and shape the ways in which climate change impacts play out in society. Climate change could be considered as a “threat multiplier” that exacerbates existing social systemic inequalities. Although most communities must face climatic risks and hazards, vulnerability of individuals varies depending on their gender, geography, class, ethnicity, and age.

236. Global warming and environmental damage are gendered because the ability of women to adapt is hampered by several factors. Women are more likely to live in poverty than men and commonly have lesser access to information, livelihood resources, extension services, improved technologies, income and decision-making authority to be able to cope with climate shocks and stresses. Women and men have different social status and different access to physical resources like land, social resources such as networks, and financial resources like income generating activities and credit. Therefore, men usually have multiple strategies and options for coping with climate change effects; women are faced with a weak asset base and are less able to adapt to climate change issues. Besides, since women are often more dependent on natural resources, loss of assets due to climate change impact also weakens their bargaining position in the household as their assets are depleted, their income-earning options become inferior. This situation leaves men in a stronger “fall-back position” during crisis²⁰⁸.

237. Women are considered responsible for food security in Malawian societies. When food is limited due to climate change impacts and families must restrict consumption by adults for the benefit of children; it is women who get the smaller food portions within the family and mothers are the ones most likely to miss out on a nutritional diet in favour of children. When the women taking the food and dietary cuts are those in their childbearing age, a cyclic process is kicked in

²⁰⁶ <https://www.vsla.net/>

²⁰⁷ Focus group discussions with women engaged in soap making, Makwezu, Kapalapata Village, T/A Timbiri Nkhata-Bay District, 13th October 2022

²⁰⁸ Gender Analysis Report, A comprehensive data collection and analysis of gender In the context of climate change adaptation and mitigation, Wezi Moyo & Leonard Satali, December 2020

motion where women who were themselves stunted in childhood will be unable to meet the food needs of their children and thus condemn their growth, creating an intergenerational cycle of poverty and reduced human capital that is difficult to break²⁰⁹.

238. When climate change leads to lower yields and crop productivity, poor and subsistence farmers have little or no surplus to sell to earn money for purchasing basics like medicine, clothes, sanitary products, schooling, as well as agricultural inputs for bolstering farming production. Food production for family feeding or income generation becomes a challenge that puts women head of households or simple member of households under intense pressure to find alternative sources of income. This renders them more susceptible to sexual exploitation, which can take various forms such as transactional sex in exchange for goods or being trafficked into commercial sexual exploitation. Girls are also frequently pressured and are disproportionately affected by family financial hardship compared to boys. They are forced to drop out of school to take care of domestic work and to find paid employment. In addition, girls are often victims of early and forced child marriage as parents may view marriage as a coping strategy to overcome monetary difficulties. It is estimated that around 1.5 million girls in Malawi are at risk of becoming child brides as a direct result of climate change²¹⁰.

239. As is the case across sub-Saharan Africa, gathering water and firewood is widely deemed the responsibility of women and girls in Malawi. Since environmental degradation leads to a lack of clean water and depletion of natural resources, women and girls have to travel further to acquire scarce resources and see their exposure to rape and sexual assault heightened. In some cases, they must contend with sexual exploitation and abuse by those who control access to limited natural resources, for instance at water collection points²¹¹.

240. The impacts of climate change also increase women's burden within the household. With natural resources degradation, water and fuel wood collection becomes more challenging and impacts women's time management. In addition, as the traditional configuration of gender roles attributes to women the task of caring for the sick, climate related disasters worsen their workload considering that the number of persons injured or becoming ill grows as a result of epidemics increase. Women are therefore highly disadvantaged since they must fulfil reproductive and caring tasks to the detriment of beneficial activities such as income generation or education. To access better income opportunities, especially in times of crisis, men migrate to urban areas, other cities or to other countries. In addition to the labour constraints this situation entails, women are forced to become heads of households and must care for children and earn a living on their own, often without the help of their migrant husbands who rarely send remittances²¹².

241. Climate change also adversely affects women's sexual and reproductive health and rights. Extreme weather events exacerbated by climate change often disrupt water systems or sources, as well as sanitation facilities, leading to clean water shortages and water pollution²¹³. In these circumstances, women are inclined to save water for household use for the detriment of appropriate daily hygiene practices. They may also not be able to fulfil their personal needs, particularly those related to menstruation. Family cut of food consumption may also affect general and maternal health.

²⁰⁹ Ibid.

²¹⁰ Climate Change is Putting Women & Girls in Malawi at Greater Risk of Sexual Violence, OCHA, August 2022

²¹¹ Ibid.

²¹² Gender Analysis Report, A comprehensive data collection and analysis of gender in the context of climate change adaptation and mitigation, Wezi Moyo & Leonard Satali, December 2020

²¹³ Ibid.

242. Although women smallholder farmers are considered vulnerable to climate change, they are at the core of the fight against climate change. Women account for 65 percent of smallholder farmers and stand as active actors and agents of change in relation to both climate change adaptation and mitigation²¹⁴.

6. TAILORING PROJECT ACTIVITIES BASED ON THE GENDER ASSESSMENT

243. The field consultations conducted in the project area during the design process which involved potential project beneficiaries and partners including Government representatives, ongoing project, non-governmental agribusiness association, social enterprise acting as demonstration and training center to promote EbA solutions; confirmed the existing gender inequalities and barriers facing women that have been highlighted by the literature review and described in the above sections. These barriers are summarized as follows.

244. **Social barriers and human capital.** The cultural norms and the socialization process in the country nurture an unequal gender division of labor. Women and girls basically bear the heavy burden of unpaid domestic and reproductive tasks, and men and boys are mainly entrusted with outdoor productive and money-making tasks. As men are generally considered as the head of household and given their domination in money-making tasks, decision making power and control over household resources are left in their hands. Besides, women and girls are equally limited by other social factors: women's lower level of literacy and education compared to that of men, increased number of school drop-out driven by early marriage and teenage pregnancy and vice versa, time poverty resulting from time-consuming domestic workloads that prevents them from exploring economic opportunities. Women's lack of economic independence plays in turn a role in exposing them to more unequal and riskier sexual relationships that in turn increase their exposure to GBV and HIV²¹⁵.

245. Women involved in VNRMC, farming and VSL in Makwezu Kapalapata village confirmed women's roles in domestic tasks such as fetching water and cooking fuel²¹⁶. They shared their main challenge in having their sources of water at 2 km walk from their village.

²¹⁴ African Gender, Climate Change and Agriculture Support Program (GCCASP), GCCASP of Malawi, NEPAD, September 2014

²¹⁵ Malawi gender assessment, Eastern and southern Africa gender platforms, World Bank Group, March 2022

²¹⁶ Focus group discussions with women involved in soap making, VNRMC, farming and VSL, Makwezu, Kapalapata Village, T/A Timbiri, Nkhata-Bay District, Northern region, 13th October 2022

“A women fetching water in a beautiful borehole with inside a deep forest”



246. Some young ladies met in Masasa Monkey Bay reported that their source of motivation for starting a group business was that most of the group members were school drop outs for different reasons like early pregnancies, lack of motivation for higher education and lack of school fees due to poverty²¹⁷.

247. **Knowledge and technical barriers.** Although both women and men in Malawi generally have low access to information through the various forms of mass media, a significant gender gap is noted (e.g. proportion of men exposed to radio was 59 percent compared to that of women of 38 percent in 2019-20). In terms of advisory services, females are less likely to receive advice on weather or climate forecasts, external inputs, crop disease control, and water harvesting techniques. Women's limited access to information and extension services results in lower level of awareness and knowledge (e.g. limited knowledge of CCA and catchment/landscape, especially among the vulnerable) and weak technical capacity (e.g. limited capacity to integrate catchment into VLAPs). Knowledge and technical barriers combined with limited access to inputs prevent women from implementing new techniques such as EbA solutions.

248. **Market and financial barriers.** Gender-based division of assets, commodities and existing market organization allocate to women the less profitable products and markets. In addition, several shortcomings have been identified in women's marketing skills and knowledge namely in terms of identification of profitable business as well as identification of buyers and conclusion of formal agreements. Cultural norms and household and childcare responsibilities limit women's mobility, a situation that gives men more power and voice in marketplaces. Another constraint raised by most women and youth farmers is the difficulty to understand and comply with the process of certification with the Malawi Bureau of standards. Besides, women's access to finance constitutes also a significant barrier that is worsen by factors like low level of formal education, difficulties to present collateral or personal guarantees, etc. Many women, men and

²¹⁷ Focus group discussions with fish land ladies in Masasa, Monkey bay, Mangochi District, Southern region, 1st October 2022

youth involved in FGD mentioned not to be interested in accessing formal financial services as they do not want to be trapped with formal financing institutions and their tedious procedures.

249. Women farmers in matrilineal Mpalale village shared their biggest concern on their poor access to land compared to men, lack of working capital, high cost of farming and poor access to markets²¹⁸.

250. **Institutional barriers.** Women's and youth's effective involvement and participation in policy elaboration process and consultations appear limited, due in part to insufficient mechanism in place to take the vulnerable's point of view into account. Policy drafters and approvers and law makers do not seem to be fully aware of the importance of social inclusion in sustainability.

251. The analysis of the CCA barriers in the gender assessment has thus contributed to the construction of the project's theory of change. The identification of upstream barriers helps ensuring that the project's activities and responses proposed through the components are relevant to the context and potential beneficiaries' constraints and needs.

252. Field consultations also allows to identify lessons learnt and opportunities that the project can explore and put at scale. For instance, women's knowledge on interesting local species for CCA, existing adaptation coping mechanisms, improvement resulting from capacity strengthening on gender and social inclusion, etc.

“The woman farmer explaining more about the a precious tree known as Mng’ona tree”



253. FGD with women members of VNRMC in Makwezu, Kapalapata Village²¹⁹ shedded light on a precious tree called Mng’ona tree that has special roots with a very good soil and water holding capacity along river banks and in catchment areas.

²¹⁸ Focus group discussions with fish farmers in Mpalale village in a matrilineal community, Dedza District, Central region, 17th October 2022

²¹⁹ Focus group discussions with women members of VNRMC, Makwezu, Kapalapata Village, T/A Timbiri, Nkhata-Bay District, Northern region, 13th October 2022

254. Women involved in NRM reported using alteration of practices/crop types and occupation as adapted coping mechanism.²²⁰

255. The FGD conducted with fish farmers in Mpalale village in a matrilineal community confirmed that gender trainings have improved men's and women's controls over assets, while men were still dominating in the past few years²²¹.

256. Under Component 1, EbAM will promote socially inclusive and meaningful participation of the vulnerable in the planning and implementation processes of Integrated Landscape Management (ILM). To this end, the project will promote the use of the Dimitra Clubs as an entry point for mobilizing and engaging women, men, female and male youth community members in the entire catchment/landscape management process. In addition to capacity building activities that are related to climate change adaptation and the integration of catchment/landscape into village-level action plans, the project will support the evolvement of societal norms by (i) improving the skills of the vulnerable and (ii) promoting equitable sharing of decision-making power at household and community levels. The use of Dimitra Clubs and household approach (HHA) will create space for dialogues both in the households and communities that will allow discussing and challenging gender and social norms as well as other issues and challenges and finding solutions; and will promote effective participation of all community members including the vulnerable. Gender and social inclusion issues will be discussed with a specific focus on (i) gender and sex; (ii) advantages and disadvantages of gender-specific roles and tasks; (iii) gender-based violence (GBV) and Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), including masculinities and patriarchy; (iv) origin/history and merits/demerits of social inclusion Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process; (v) examples, motives and results of gender discrimination and social exclusion; and (vi) gender and social inclusion in community development and welfare, including food and nutrition security. The Clubs will also facilitate information sharing and knowledge dissemination within the community. The project will support 1 110 clusters of Dimitra Clubs and implementing the HHA through the training of 30 ILM facilitators on Dimitra Clubs facilitation and Household methodology, to support the spread of the approach at village level through "Dimitra Clubtakers". Some religious and traditional leaders will also participate in the trainings. Besides, the processes for VNRC and SCMC revision charter, member selection and capacity development will include awareness raising on gender and social inclusion including SEAH and GBV. The project will make sure that the EbA-based ILM Plans or VLAPs and catchment management plans are gender and youth sensitive and socially inclusive. For the implementation of the plans, the project has also to secure the vulnerable's effective participation, and make sure that they benefit from the project's technical as well as inputs and equipment support.

257. Under Component 2, from a gender and social inclusion perspective, EbAM will promote resilient livelihoods and food systems by (i) ensuring the use of gender/youth sensitive mechanisms and inclusive approaches in the promotion of EbA-based production systems, (ii) enhancing the business and market access conditions for better participation of EbA-trained women, men and youth farmers and strengthening their entrepreneurship and marketing skills, and (iii) developing and delivering financial services that are adapted to the various project's target groups.

258. For the promotion of EbA-based production systems, the project will ensure gender balance among extension workers and FFS facilitators for the delivery of EbA agricultural extension services. In addition, the project may need to consider implementing women-only/youth-only FFS and pay particular attention on how to better involve the vulnerable (ultra-

²²⁰ Focus group discussions with women involved in Masasa, Monkey bay, Mangochi District, Southern region, 1st October 2022

²²¹ Focused group discussions with fish farmers in Mpalale village in a matrilineal community, Dedza District, 17th October 2022

poor, poor, widows etc.) in the FFS to facilitate exchanges and acquisition of knowledge. Similarly for exchange visits, the project will ensure affinity links between group members in order to facilitate exchanges and sharing of experience. Women, men and youth who self-targeted themselves in plant and crop genetic material availability and multiplication will be involved in these activities as appropriate. To address food and nutrition insecurity, the impact of integrated mix-farming systems on food diversity and availability, and on food and nutrition security will be discussed in the FFS. The project will rely on the Dimitra Clubs to facilitate flow of information and knowledge dissemination within the community. Dimitra clubs solar powered radios will be connected to local community radios to enhance communication.

259. In terms of market access and entrepreneurship development for EbA producers, EbAM will target women, men and youth groups that are interested and have the potential to develop into commercial entities²²². Priority will be given to women and youth farmers groups which will be supported in the identification of common economic and commercial interests, the definition of common objectives, the development of business plans, and in PO's management and daily operations. Women and youth farmers groups that have the potential to engage in 4Ps will also be prioritized. The provision of technical assistance under the 4Ps will consider women and youth's specific needs. Through the 4Ps and commercial group activities, women and youth will also see their marketing/commercial skills (identification of good business opportunities (high margin, sustainable, ...), negotiation, etc.) strengthened. Since the project will also support the development of an "EbA" brand, products labelling will create a high-value niche markets for women and youth. The brand development will also offer to youth the opportunity to engage in other food system activities beyond production, such as marketing and communication related to the EbA brand. Women can also engage in food system transformation initiatives that could add value to their business such as linking EbA produce to traditional cuisine.

260. Regarding access to financial services, EbAM will build upon FARMSE's targeting strategy which key element is inclusion. It will proactively reach out to individuals, households or groups/associations to ensure women and youth have access to the financial opportunities offered by the project, and will make sure that project interventions are sensitive to the needs and aspirations of women and youth. Through MoF/FARMSE which is one of EbAM's co-financier, EbAM will support the effective participation of the vulnerable in Community based financial organizations (CBFOs), which are informal organizations formed and managed by individuals coming together voluntarily and commonly referred to as Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs), to facilitate their access to savings and loans products. As part of capacity building and apart from financial literacy, the project will also strengthen women, men, female and male youth financial knowledge through the HHA. EbAM's comprehensive package to support CBFO members will include group governance and dynamics; savings and loans group best practices; economic activity selection / Business planning and management; market linkage with off-takers; suppliers and service providers; financial literacy; linkage with Formal Financial Institutions (FFI) and mobile money banking; Gender Action Learning System (GALS) and Household (HH) methodology; and promotion of environmentally friendly agricultural production. On the supply side, EbAM will support Formal Financial Institutions (FFIs) to develop and deliver adapted financial services for smallholder farmers engaged in commercial activities for investments in EbA solutions. Particular attention will be given to the development of specific products tailored to women and youth's needs. The project will also ensure that the various studies related to the development of various financial instruments and knowledge dissemination products are gender-sensitive and socially inclusive. Financial implementing partners that are offering financial and

²²² Any commercial organisational development, which could be a cooperative, association or a commercial company, or an informal commercial entrepreneurial group

non-financial services will be assessed for their gender sensitivity and their awareness on the project's priority groups.

261. Under Component 3, gender sensitive and socially inclusive activities related to enabling institutional and financial environment include assistance to NCCF to develop its gender strategy as well as capacity strengthening for NCCF's women and men's staff on EbA, climate risk analysis and carbon balance analysis trainings. National Conservation Trust Funds including MEET will also be supported on its gender strategy and M&E trainings. Women's participation in the various process and studies will be given particular attention. As for the scaling up of EbA and ILM in national policies, women's participation in policy dialogue will be promoted. Gender principles will be considered in the update of policies and key frameworks. Specific economic analysis looking at return for women-led farms will also be conducted.

262. To ensure gender mainstreaming is clearly visible in the implementation of project's activities, a Gender Action Plan (GAP) has been developed. It reinforces all project activities and sub-activities from a gender and social inclusion perspective, and includes clear targets, gender design features and measurable indicators ensuring women's participation and benefits.

7. PRINCIPLES OF PROJECT FORMULATION AND IMPLEMENTATION

7.1 Guiding FAO and GCF Policies and Frameworks

263. The following FAO and GCF policies and frameworks specifically guide the above assessment and project Gender Action Plan (refer also to other policies and framework in the Environmental and Social Management Framework in Annex 6). Gender equality is a result that the project aims to achieve, in addition to climate change adaptation and mitigation outcomes.

- **FAO Policy on Gender Equality 2020-2030** strives to achieve equality between women and men in sustainable agriculture and rural development for the elimination of hunger and poverty.
- **GCF Updated Gender Policy (2019)** reinforces the responsiveness of GCF to the culturally diverse context of gender equality to better address and account for the links between gender equality and climate change.
- **FAO Protection from sexual exploitation and sexual abuse (PSAE) N° 2013/27.** The principles of integrity, professionalism, respect for human rights and the dignity of all peoples underpin FAO's commitment to preventing and addressing acts of sexual exploitation and abuse (SEA).
- **FAO Policy on the prevention of harassment, sexual harassment and abuse of authority** N° 2015/03 (2015) and FAO policy on sexual harassment (13 February 2019) which states Sexual Harassment in all its forms is contrary to the United Nations Charter, the Staff Regulations and Staff Rules of the Organization and the Standards of Conduct for the International Civil Service.
- **GCF Revised Environment and Social Policy and Policy on the Prevention and Protection from Sexual Exploitation, Sexual Abuse, and Sexual Harassment (2021)** sets clear obligations for GCF-project related persons to prevent and respond to SEAH and to refrain from condoning, encouraging, participating in, or engaging in SEAH.
- **FAO Environmental and Social Management Guidelines (2015)** that include general principles and nine environmental and social standards (ESS), with 1) **ESS 8 - Gender equality**: the fight against discrimination, practices; Equal opportunities for men and women

to take part and to benefit; and 2) **ESS 7 – Decent Work**: Creation of better employment opportunities, particularly for women and young people; Non-discrimination and equal opportunities; Occupational health and safety; Prevention of child labor; Forced labor; Workers' and producers' organizations.

- These ESS are consistent with the objectives of GCF adopted Performance Standards, **PS 1** - Assessment and Management of Environmental and Social Risks and Impacts; **PS 2** – Labour and Working Conditions; **PS 4** – Community, Health, Safety, and Security and **PS6** - Biodiversity conservation and sustainable management of living natural resources.

7.2. Principles of Project Formulation and Implementation

7.2.1 Social Acceptance of Gender and Youth Empowerment

264. The project will promote approaches that enhance the social acceptance of gender and youth empowerment both at household and community levels. At household level, the household approach shifts the focus from what women do not possess to what the family members aspire to, in particular, what they want to become, what they want to be engaged in and how they can achieve these goals. The approach's objective is for family members to create a common vision for the household through guided dialogues among them, which allow women and men to understand and challenge gender norms and their connection to food and nutrition security as well as poverty. The approach facilitates reflection, behavioral change and household planning through gender-sensitive participation. The project proposes applying the household approach in households where household member participation remains uneven and where the household head or some household member(s) concentrate decision-making power. The former will be supported to initially engage in wife and husband discussions, and the latter can aim at engaging youth, boys and girls family members in developing their household vision.

265. At community level, an important mile in ensuring sustainable behavioral change is that the religious, traditional and community leaders and other key figures give a stamp of approval to the changes that have taken place, especially among men, who need to be reassured that their masculinity is not threatened and that the changes are welcome to the entire community. The religious, traditional and community leaders will be sensitized on the positive effects of gender empowerment at the household and community levels, some will also participate in the ILM facilitators' trainings as trainers on Dimitra Clubs facilitation and household methodology; so that their capacity to play active roles in social mobilization are strengthened and they may effectively endorse the changes in behavior. The Dimitra Clubs used by the project to mobilize and engage communities also constitutes an important tool for dealing with gender and social inclusion issues.

7.2.2 Interventions Based on Custom-fit Context Analysis

266. Understanding the social and cultural context of a society is crucial to ensure the adequacy of a proposed intervention. Malawi's traditional and social framework is characterized by the existence of two societies: a patrilineal society that discriminates exclusively against women, and a matrilineal society that gives more power to women but in which they may still be disadvantaged in some respects.

267. Although vulnerable groups were pre-identified at design stage, the project will ensure during implementation that operational context is re-evaluated and that necessary supports are provided to promote the participation and inclusion of individuals and groups who effectively need this support. It is therefore possible, in contrast to what we are usually used to seeing, that in

some societies and specific activities, gender mainstreaming targets men who are more disadvantaged than women. Besides, similarly to the targeting process conducted during the formulation process, the project will continuously consider the differentiated profiles, constraints, needs and opportunities of the different target groups (women, female youth, male youth and others), for equality, effectiveness and impact.

7.2.3 Inclusive and Collaborative Process for Mutual Benefits

268. The proposed project will rely on community-based approaches that encourages the participation of all community members, with a particular attention on the participation of vulnerable groups namely women, youth and the poor. The project's self-targeting mechanism will ensure the consideration of the different groups' aspirations. The project will fully integrate inputs from women and youth and engage them as much as possible in project activities. While addressing these groups' vulnerability, the project will also lean on the strengths of various groups to ensure that project results and benefits contributed to and are distributed for the well-being of the entire society.

7.2.4 Women and Youth Empowerment for Meaningful Participation

269. Climate change is a social challenge profound enough that it does not allow leaving human capital underutilized as it has been to date. It demands both women and men to make strategic decisions at all levels so that their livelihoods are well adapted to the changes. Women and young people, however, have not had the experience or been given the power to make such decisions. The proposed project strengthens the capacity of women and youth so that they will be able to effectively and strategically plan for the future. Empowerment of women and youth needs to be accepted at home and in the community; men and community gatekeepers will be sensitized on the issue and will participate in the Dimitra Clubs facilitation and Household methodology trainings for their acceptance, ownership and the important role they have to play in social mobilization.

270. To make full use of the human capital in the country, the proposed project will compensate for the investment that the society had the tendency to neglect; it will provide technical and marketing and financial trainings to women and youth. The skills will encourage them to venture into the formal sector and capture the market segments that are more profitable, as they are already equipped with some business acumen. All trainings and consultations under the proposed project will have slots reserved for women and youth.

271. Trainings for government officials and technicians will similarly consult women officials and technicians and include female youth participants. They will also be trained on gender issues so that they can more effectively accompany the process of gender empowerment.

7.2.5 Ensuring Sustainability through Ownership

272. Stakeholders' involvement has been at the core of the project development process whether at identification stage, all along the design process as well as during implementation. Government authorities have provided policy orientations and potential beneficiaries particularly women and youth have been consulted to ensure the project considers their knowledge, needs and aspirations. Their participation in the project development process aims at fostering the ownership of the project. In fact without ownership, beneficiaries put themselves in the position of being assisted during the project lifetime and do not feel responsible for the results achieved and their sustainability once the project has ended. The more the proposed project promotes stakeholder's participation including that of women and youth potential beneficiaries; the more

the stakeholders are likely to own the project, engage and take responsibility in its implementation, and are mindful of the sustainability of project activities and outcomes.

7.2.6. Preventing Increased Risks of GBV including Sexual Exploitation, Sexual Abuse and Harassment

273. Gender mainstreaming and women's empowerment could exacerbate existing risks of GBV and sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH) within households and communities as those with power may feel threatened with losing it to those who have been empowered. It is therefore important that the project raises the awareness of involved communities, particularly the sub-groups at risk including women and girls, female head of households, and persons living with HIV/AIDS, on these issues and strengthens their capacity to become fully involved in preventing and responding to GBV and SEAH related issues. Capacity building should allow community members to access information on the basics of GBV and SEAH, the prevention and mitigation measures, the mechanisms to file complaints related to GBV and SEAH using existing channels (marriage counselors, community leaders, police, etc.) and also the comprehensive Grievance redress mechanisms (GRM) developed and implemented by the project, details of the process in terms of procedures and possible outcomes²²³ [OBJ].

274. Since GBV and SEAH are fueled by deep rooted and persistent cultural mindsets and social norms, it is important that the project gets the buy-in of community leaders and traditional gatekeepers on these issues. They are the ones who should convey the message on GBV and SEAH as well as GRM to communities and train them to inculcate local values that negate GBV²²⁴.

275. The project will adopt a 'zero-tolerance approach to SEAH. It must ensure the availability of effective grievance mechanisms accessible to women, girls and the vulnerable groups at risk which minimize the reporting burden on victims, offer gender-sensitive services and minimize the risk of retaliation. Those mechanisms should contain specific procedures for GBV and SEAH, including confidential reporting with secure and ethical documentation. With identified cases, the project should orient GBV and SEAH victims towards existing support services, including health services, psychosocial support, legal advice, police surveillance, and shelters. The project will also disseminate information on the country referral guidelines on child protection and GBV²²⁵.

²²³ 5 steps to prevent the risks of sexual and gender-based violence in projects, Maria Amelia Vileri, May 2022: <https://blogs.iadb.org/sostenibilidad/en/5-steps-to-prevent-the-risks-of-sexual-and-gender-based-violence-in-projects/>

²²⁴ National Plan of Action to Combat Gender-Based Violence in Malawi 2014-2020, Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare, July 2014

²²⁵ Child protection and gender-based violence referral guidelines for Malawi, Government of Malawi, UNICEF, UNFPA, July 2020

8. FIELD CONSULTATIONS: PARTNERS AND QUESTIONS

8.1 Consultation Partners

276. The consultations of government representatives, development partners and community members during field mission are also documented in Annex 7 (Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan).

Table 12: Consultation Partners

Date	Region	District	Village/City	Type of Stakeholders	Participants	
					Female	Male
30 September 2022	Central Region	Ntcheu	Bemvu Hill	Good example of restoration work 12 villages, 22 ha, VSLA	7	6
30 September 2022	Central Region	Ntcheu	Kachimanga Village	VNRMC, Energy serving stoves (Chitetezo Mbaula) and VSLA	18	1
30 September 2022	Central Region	Ntcheu	Gongolo VNRMC	VNRMC & value chain activities: VNMRC, Bee-keeping and VSLA	20	9
30 September 2022	Central Region	Ntcheu	Chipusire VNRMC Block	Bad example of restoration work: Block Committee	5	4
1 October 2022	Southern Region	Mangochi	Kacheta women cooperative and Fish land ladies	Women cooperative , Household Approaches mentors, and Youth cooperative fish traders	16	1
2 October 2022	Southern Region	Mangochi	Nsauka Village	Dimitra, VNRMC, VAC, FFS, VSLA, Irrigation and Fish trading, AEDIC, Agriculture extension worker	8	4
03 October 2022	Southern Region	Nsanje	Sorgern	VDC, VNRMC,VAC, AEDO,AEDIC	3	11
05 October 2022	Southern Region	Neno	Lisungwi	Youth Group (VSL, Farming, Agribusiness)	6	4
05 October 2022	Southern Region	Neno	Lisungwi	VAC, VDC, FFS, Community leaders, ADC and VSLA	21	7
12 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Mpamba	Chinganya VNRMC and VSLA	4	3

Date	Region	District	Village/City	Type of Stakeholders	Participants	
					Female	Male
12 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Mpamba	Mbwadu cooperative	3	4
12 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Mpamba	Mpamba community maize mill representatives	2	3
13 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Kapalapata village Makwezu	Makwezu Youth club representatives	4	3
13 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Kapalapata village Makwezu	Makwezu Kuja-Nkujaliana women's soap making group	12	0
13 October 2022	Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	Kapalapata village Makwezu	Makwezu community leaders	5	6
14 October 2022	Northern Region	Rumphi	Mungoti	Mungoti Local Leaders	0	5
14 October 2022	Northern Region	Rumphi	Mungoti	Goat farming club, VSLA, LEAD Farmers, Paprika& pepper farming, VNRMCS, bee keeping group	12	14
14 October 2022	Northern Region	Rumphi	Lundu – Bolero	Lundu farmers	30	13
14 October 2022	Northern Region	Rumphi	Lundu – Bolero	Lundu community leaders	0	4
17 October 2022	Central Region	Dedza	Mpalale	Ngwere farmers	9	2
17 October 2022	Central Region	Dedza	Mpalale	Youth Fish farmers	3	0
17 October 2022	Central Region	Dedza	Ngwere model village	Lead farmers	9	2
Total					197	106

Region	Location	Institution	
		Name	Description
Central Region	Lilongwe	MoF/ FARMSE	IFAD-funded programme under the Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs - The programme works to support the graduation of poor Malawians along the poverty spectrum from ultra-poor to a productive pathway on a sustainable basis. The programme also supports household economic development through access to financial services that are appropriate to each socio-economic level of poverty including ultra-poor, poor but food secure, vulnerable to poverty, and resilient to poverty.
		NASFAM	Non-Governmental Agribusiness Association - The National Smallholder Farmers' Association of Malawi (NASFAM) is the largest smallholder owned membership organization in Malawi. It is founded on the principles of collective action and is democratically governed by its members.
Central Region	Lilongwe	Ministry of Gender	Government Body-The Ministry of Gender, Children Disability and Social Welfare is mandated to promote gender equality and protect the welfare of Malawian women, men, girls and boys to become self-reliant and active participants and beneficiaries of the national development agenda
Central Region	Lilongwe	Ministry of Lands	Government Body-The mandate of the Ministry is to provide land and housing management services to the general public, stakeholders and parties seeking the services in a manner that ensures that physical development takes place in an orderly and sustainable manner
Central Region	Mchinji	Permaculture Paradise Institute	Social enterprise, demonstration and training center that promotes permaculture systems
Central Region	Ntcheu	District Council	Government Body-District Councils facilitate the development of rural areas in Malawi. District councils make policy and decisions on local governance and facilitate (on delegated authority from central government) the provision of local services and development for the Districts.
Southern Region	Mangochi	District Agriculture and Fisheries Office	Government Body-The Mangochi District Fisheries Office is the government side in this participatory management arrangement. It is directly responsible for field implementation of the various

Region	Location	Institution	
		Name	Description
			components of the programme that come under the responsibility of the Fisheries Department.
Southern Region	Nsanje	District Agriculture CAENRO Offices	Government Body-The Chief Agriculture Environmental and Natural Resources Office is responsible for organizing, planning and implementation of agricultural extension programs. The extension program has 6 technical offices. The extension services, crops development, animal health& livestock development, research, planning services, land resource conservation and irrigation. The CAENRO coordinates and collaborates with officers from other key sectors within the District.
Southern Region	Neno	District Agriculture CAENRO Offices	Government Body-The Chief Agriculture Environmental and Natural Resources Office is responsible for organizing, planning and implementation of agricultural extension programs. The extension program has 6 technical offices. The extension services, crops development, animal health& livestock development, research, planning services, land resource conservation and irrigation. The CAENRO coordinates and collaborates with officers from other key sectors within the District.
Northern Region	Mzuzu	Mzuzu ADD	Government Body-Responsible for crop production, animal health and veterinary services, agricultural extension support services, research and technical services, and land resources conservation.
Northern Region	Nkhata-bay	District Agriculture CAENRO Offices	Government Body-The Chief Agriculture Environmental and Natural Resources Office is responsible for organizing, planning and implementation of agricultural extension programs. The extension program has 6 technical offices. The extension services, crops development, animal health& livestock development, research, planning services, land resource conservation and irrigation. The CAENRO coordinates and collaborates with officers from other key sectors within the District.
		District Forestry Office District Forestry Office	Government Body-The Department of Forestry is the lead agency <i>in the administration of the National Forest Policy and the Forestry Act in Malawi.</i>
Northern Region	Rumphi	District Agriculture CAENRO Offices	Government Body-The Chief Agriculture Environmental and Natural Resources Office is responsible for organizing, planning and implementation of agricultural extension programs. The extension program has 6 technical offices. The extension services, crops development, animal health& livestock development, research,

Region	Location	Institution	
		Name	Description
			planning services, land resource conservation and irrigation. The CAENRO coordinates and collaborates with officers from other key sectors within the District.
Central Region	Dedza	District Agriculture CAENRO Offices	Government Body-The Chief Agriculture Environmental and Natural Resources Office is responsible for organizing, planning and implementation of agricultural extension programs. The extension program has 6 technical offices. The extension services, crops development, animal health& livestock development, research, planning services, land resource conservation and irrigation. The CAENRO coordinates and collaborates with officers from other key sectors within the District.
		Human/ Child Rights Activists	NGO-Responsible for promoting child and human rights
		Find Your Feet	NGO - Find Your Feet Malawi (FYF) is a leading local non-governmental organisation focused on agriculture, agri business and value chains, strengthening local governance systems and health as the precursor for growth and rural livelihoods improvement.

8.2 Consultation Questions

8.2.1 Core Consultation Questions for Institutions

Gender and youth

- Understanding of gender/youth issues, including legislations, regulations and international conventions
 - Are you aware of the international agreement commitments made by the government pertaining to equal rights, access to resources and opportunities?
 - Are you aware of the National Gender Policy and Gender Action Plan?
 - Which components of the National Gender Policy and Action Plan does your office support?
 - Does your work take various policies, regulations and international conventions into account?
 - Do you make specific efforts to consider issues faced by gender/youth?
- Knowledge of formal rights, laws, regulations, and commitment of the country to international conventions and agreements
 - The country has policies, laws and regulations to safeguard the rights of all persons, regardless of gender, belief and age, including National Gender Policy and Gender Action Plan. Are you aware of them?
- What are the problems that rural women face in Malawi today?
- Do you have information indicating that women's conditions and needs are different from men's?
- Do you promote your gender concerns at meetings, internal and external?
- Do you work with private commercial entities? How do you encourage them to consider the needs of women at all stages of their operation?
- Do you consider gender aspects when assessing and monitoring your programmes by differentiating the impacts on women and men? Are the assessment results used in future programming?
- Do your publications clearly state your focus, priorities and activities on women and youth?
- Have the objectives led to improved situations for women and youths?

Governance and grievance resolution

- What is the mechanism for the community members to communicate the problems under your jurisdiction?
- How do you ensure community trust in these mechanisms?
- Do you think the community members are well aware of the relevant laws and your mandate?
- How are the problems brought to you solved? How do you handle internal and external grievances?
- What are the timelines in resolving complaints?
- How do you monitor whether the solutions that you provide are well implemented?

8.2.2 Core Consultation Questions for Female Farmers

Roles and responsibilities in production and livelihood systems

- Types of livelihoods: agriculture, livestock, fishery, others
 - What is the main source of livelihood of your household?
 - What is your work (activity to be performed by the interviewee) ?
 - What is the work of other household members?

- What is the biggest problems related to your work?
- Are you part of producers' groups or cooperatives?
- What are the benefits of being part of producers' groups/cooperatives? Drawbacks?
- Management of various natural resources: responsibilities and resultant social status
 - What are the crops cultivated for consumption at home? For sale?
 - Which livestock is raised for consumption at home? For sale?
 - Who is responsible for drinking water, including animals? How far/close do they fetch the water? What challenges do they face in fetching water?
 - Who is responsible for cooking fuel?
 - Are there some resources that are jointly exploited by the community? If yes, are there clear rules for this?
 - How resources have evolved since your parents/grandparents' generation?
 - How do you think resources will evolve for your children/grandchildren's generation?
- Food security and other basic needs (to clothe, etc.): financial and procurement responsibilities
 - Who is responsible for finding/purchasing food? Who pays for it?
 - Who is responsible for finding/purchasing clothes? Who pays for it?

Access to and control of resources

- Productive and household assets: ownership, access and control
 - What are the assets that are used to generate income (e.g., land, livestock)?
 - Who owns those assets?
 - Who controls those assets?
 - Should each asset belong to one family? Or are there assets that can be jointly exploited?
- Income and expenditure: primary and secondary sources, items and control
 - What are the main sources of income in the household?
 - Who are responsible for raising the household income?
 - Who decides on how to spend income?
 - Do items of expenditure vary according to the person who decides?
- Access to resources: land
 - Who has access to land? Under which conditions?
 - Do the modalities of access to land influence its exploitation?
- Access to resources: water
 - What is the source of drinking water (e.g., well, river, pond)?
 - Is it shared by livestock and other animals?
 - Do people and animals bathe in the water used for drinking?
 - What do you think about water quality?
 - Do you have enough water for all your needs?
 - Has the amount of available water changed?
 - Who frequently use the water source? Who control the water sources?
 - How far is the water source?
 - What challenges do you face in accessing water?
- Access to resources: fuel
 - What is the source of cooking fuel?
 - If you use charcoal, which trees are used?
 - From whom do you buy them?
- Access to agricultural services: extension, (rural) finance, (agricultural) marketing, etc.
 - Is extension service (agriculture, livestock) available? Is the service useful? Are these services free or at a cost?

- Have trainings already been organized in your village/the surrounding villages/the vicinity? Who could participate?
- How do you finance your activities?
- Is there enough information on what sells, why, where and when?
- Access to markets: purchase and sale
 - Who goes to the market for purchase?
 - Who goes to the market for sale?
 - Who has the control of the income from the sales?
- Access to means of transportation: service frequency, cost, possibility of independent travel
 - What kind of transportation is available? For what purpose? For women/handicapped?
 - Is the frequency of the available transportation satisfactory?
 - Is the cost of the available transportation reasonable? Who pays transportation costs?

Skills, knowledge and information

- Knowledge on health, sanitation and nutrition
 - Do you think there is a link between what we eat and our health?
 - Do you think eating variety of food items improves our health?
 - Do you think there is a link between how we keep things clean and our health?
 - Do you think there is a link between health of the animals that we keep and our health?
- Access to electronic devices for information
 - Do you have a mobile phone? A smart phone?
 - Do you have access to the internet?
 - Does their use support your activity?

Decision-making and governance

- Roles in decision-making: home, groups, community, producer and community-based organizations, and local government
 - Who makes what kind of decisions at home?
 - ... in the community?
- Nature of decision-making: income use, commons use, means of income generation, food distribution, marriage, number of children, inheritance, etc.
 - Who decides on purchases of goods for the entire family?
 - Who decides how to distribute food among family members?
 - Who decides on the marriage of family members?
 - Who decides who inherits what and how much?
- Conflict resolution mechanism: among individuals and different social groups, including violence
 - What are the common sources of conflict in the household? How are conflicts resolved within the family?
 - What are the common sources of conflict in the community? When you have a problem in the community, to whom do you go?
 - Are the solutions provided satisfactory to all parties?
 - What are the differences between problem solving by communities and formal institutions?
 - Are women/youth involved in providing solutions or mediating?

Living conditions

- Main health problems
 - What are the main health problems?

- What may be the causes?
- Health services: public/private, number of nurses/doctors per population, distance to nearest hospital, affordable medicine, number of medical specialists
 - Do you access health services there? Are these services free or at a cost?
 - How many public clinics/hospital are there in the vicinity?
 - How far are they from the community?

Economic hardship

- Events leading to economic hardship: frequency, cause, nature (loss/damage of house/boat/ landing facilities/hatchery/crops/livestock), predictability
 - What are the events that cause financial problems?
 - How frequent are they?
- Coping mechanism: use of event-specific/all-purpose saving, borrowing from relatives/friends/ informal lender/formal lender, monetary/non-monetary aid from charity/government/NGO, sale of land/house/livestock/other, premature termination of schooling, change in food intake/expenses/living arrangement/occupation, migration
 - How do you cope with financial difficulties?
 - What kind of opportunities are good (e.g., aquaculture, craft making)?

Climate change

- Changes observed on the ground: temperature, water availability, floods/droughts, weather patterns, crop flowering/maturing, insect egg-laying/hatching/maturing, non-crop plants, plant/animal diseases, effects on product quality/quantity
 - Has there been any change in the weather/climate in the past years? If yes, what are the changes?
 - What are the effects on crop development? Animal behavior?
 - What are the effects on crop diseases? Animal diseases?
 - How is crop production affected? Milk/egg/meat production?
- Changes learned through other sources: mass media, communication with CBO/NGO staff/local government officials, participation in trainings/meetings
 - Do you hear about changes in weather/climate?
 - From which sources?
 - Do you think the climate will go back to what it was during your grandparents' time?
- Adapted coping mechanism: alteration of practices/crop types/occupation, migration
 - How do you deal with changes in weather/climate?
 - Have you received any support (advice, training, endowment) in this regard?
 - Are the measures effective? If yes/no, why?
 - If the weather/climate keeps on changing, will that affect the availability of food?

8.2.3 Core Consultation Questions for Youth

Vocation

- Job opportunities
 - Have you done any studies?
 - What kind of work do you do?
 - What is the biggest problems related to your work? Is your current work different from your ideal occupation?
 - Do you undertake other activities to generate additional income?
 - Does the urban areas or foreign countries offer good opportunities?

Economic hardship

- Family responsibility
 - How is your family status?
 - What are the events that cause financial problems to the family?
 - How frequent are they?
 - What is expected of you during such times?
- Coping mechanism: use of event-specific/all-purpose saving, borrowing from relatives/friends/
informal lender/formal lender, monetary/non-monetary aid from charity/government/NGO, sale of land/house/livestock/other, premature termination of schooling, change in food intake/expenses/living arrangement/occupation, migration
 - How do you cope with financial difficulties?
 - What makes you take up new opportunities to increase household income?
 - What kind of opportunities are good?

Climate change

- Changes observed on the ground: temperature, water availability, floods/droughts, weather patterns, crop flowering/maturing, insect egg-laying/hatching/maturing, non-crop plants, plant/animal diseases, effects on product quality/quantity
 - Has there been any change in the weather in the past years?
 - What are the effects on crop development? Animal behavior?
 - How is crop production affected? Livestock activities?
- Changes learned through other sources: mass media, communication with CBO/NGO staff/local government officials, participation in trainings/meetings
 - Do you hear about changes in weather/climate?
 - From which sources?
 - Do you think it is affecting your livelihood?
 - Do you think the climate will go back to what it was during your grandparents' time?
- Adapted coping mechanism: alteration of practices/crop types/occupation, migration
 - How do you deal with changes in weather/climate?
 - Are the measures effective?

Community and society

- Contribution of the youth
 - Are the contributions of young people different from that of their elders?
 - What are the strength of youth? Weakness?
 - How can they best contribute to household/community/society?
 - What do you think is the common aspiration for Malawian male youth? Female youth?
- Future and pathways
 - What kind of community is best for Malawi? Society?
 - What are the pathways for creating such communities? Society?

8.2.4 Consultation Questions for Community Leaders

Current perception

- How is women's participation in community life? In income generating activities?
- How is female youth's participation in community life? In income generating activities?
- How is male youth's participation in community life? In income generating activities?
- Are there mechanisms in place to engage women and youth?

Access to resources

- How do women access to land?
- How do female/male youths access to land?
- How does the community access drinking water?
- What is the source of cooking fuel? How does the community access it?
- Are there measures in place for community-based management of natural resources? If yes, do these measures involve women, young women, young men?

Access to agricultural services: extension, (rural) finance, (agricultural) marketing, etc.

- Is extension service (agriculture, livestock) available? Is the service useful?
- How do community members get information on what sells, why, where and when?

Concerns and aspirations

- What is the biggest concern of your community with respect to women?
- ... female youths?
- ... male youths?
- Are the concerns shared by all in the community?
- How do you think the concerns can be resolved?
- How do you think they may be related to the project?
- What is your future aspiration for the community with respect to women?
- ... female youths?
- ... male youths?
- Are the aspirations share by all in the community?
- How do you think they can be achieved?
- How do you think they may be related to the project?

Governance and grievance resolution

- Are women involved in community decision making?
- If not, what will be the benefits from involving them?
- Are youths involved in community decision making?
- If not, what will be the benefits from involving them?
- How are the grievances in the community solved?
- Are the decisions different if the case is solved in the community or brought to the local official court?
- What are the benefits of each one?

Climate change

- Changes observed on the ground: temperature, water availability, floods/droughts, weather patterns, crop flowering/maturing, insect egg-laying/hatching/maturing, non-crop plants, plant/animal diseases, effects on product quality/quantity
 - Has there been any change in the weather in the past years?
 - What are the effects on crop development? Animal behavior?
- Changes learned through other sources: mass media, communication with CBO/NGO staff/local government officials, participation in trainings/meetings
 - Do you hear about changes in weather/climate?
 - From which sources?
 - Do you think it is affecting communities' livelihoods?
- Adapted coping mechanism: alteration of practices/crop types/occupation, migration
 - How do you deal with changes in weather/climate?
 - Are the measures effective?

PART II: GENDER ACTION PLAN

1. INTRODUCTION

277. The Gender Action Plan (GAP) is the project tool which ensures that gender mainstreaming is clearly visible in the implementation of project's activities. The GAP reinforces all project activities and sub-activities from a gender and social inclusion perspective, and includes clear targets, gender design features and measurable indicators ensuring women's participation and benefits.

2. GENDER AND SOCIAL INCLUSION APPROACHES, TARGETING AND IMPLEMENTATION MECHANISMS

278. **EbAM's gender and social inclusion approaches.** The project will rely on the use of the Dimitra Clubs and the Household approach (HHA), two methodologies that have proven being effective in terms of community engagement, social mobilization and inclusion, collective action, gender equality and equitable sharing of decision-making power both at household and community levels.

279. At community level: Described as voluntary and informal groups of rural women, men, young women and young men which discuss common problems and seek solutions by acting together and using their own locally available resources/capacities, the Dimitra Clubs²²⁶ are an appropriate entry point to mobilize and engage all community members (women, men, female and male youth) in the entire catchment management process. Set-up and operationalized at village level, the Clubs stimulate active and voluntary participation of the whole community, whether it concerns discussions, decision-making or actions; and will allow each community member to become an agent of change. They will provide a space for consultation between the various technical committees existing at village level (Village Natural Resource Management Committee, Village Agriculture Committee, Village Development Committee, etc.), which will be a good starting point for the development of integrated VLAPs. The Clubs enable members to discuss any subject and access relevant information that responds to their needs. The approach contributes to improving ownership, autonomy and sustainability of the clubs' initiatives, and strengthens the willingness to make change and take actions. Indeed, the Clubs belong to their members, and it is they who manage them and decide how they should be run (e.g., subject to be discussed, frequency of meetings, types of monitoring, etc.). Since communication, interaction and networking are at the core of the approach, the Clubs will amplify the impact of capacity development, particularly those related to the adoption of EbA solutions in the EbAM context, whether carried out through the FFS or other channels. As the development and implementation of VLAPs advance, the Clubs will also give a space for redressing any grievance that may arise.

²²⁶ Dimitra Clubs: a unique approach, FAO, 2015

Box 1 – Dimitra Clubs

Dimitra Club consists of self-managed groups of various gender compositions, which organize meetings to discuss common problems and determine ways to address them by acting together and using local resources.^{cccxlii} The meetings are organized by Dimitra Club Caretakers (or Supervisors) who are chosen among the village residents for each Club. Agriculture, climate change, education, health, infrastructure, nutrition and women's status are some of the most common topics dealt with by the Clubs.^{cccxliii} Six thousand Clubs with 180,000 members have been established in the past ten years in Burundi, Burkina Faso, Central African Republic, Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mali, Niger and Senegal,^{cccxliiv} indicating the Club's wide applicability and replicability. They have had success in: reconciling long-standing political disputes; mobilizing to adapt to climate change; establishing credit cooperatives to avoid debt; and improving nutritional security by challenging dietary taboos.^{cccxliv}

In May 2022, the system was introduced to Malawi for piloting in 20 villages in the Districts of Mangochi and Kasungu. The changes observed so far in the involved communities are initiatives to: actively participate in natural resource and catchment management and engage in open discussions with other social groups (i.e., dialogues among women, men and youths). The Clubs have been considered a success beyond expectations by the Malawi press,^{cccxlv} and EbAM will put this successful approach at scale.

280. At household level: The household approach²²⁷ will be implemented within households engaged in farming for home consumption and income generation. The approach aims at empowering all household members (male and female, adults and youth) to have better gender or power relations that will enable equitable access to and control over resources, assets and benefits. In the Malawian context, the approach will also enable household members to identify and address HIV and other issues²²⁸ which results in improved livelihood of all household members. The purpose is to guide women, men and youth household members in participatory dialogues that help them understand their household livelihoods, needs, challenges, roles, gender norms and their connection to poverty. Family members develop a common vision that takes into account the aspirations of all as a family and whose implementation is carried out in a participatory manner. Since the methodology facilitates reflection, behavioural change and household planning through gender-sensitive participation; it is expected to particularly lead to the improvement of gender and power relations in the household, and also to the increase of household incomes and food and nutrition security as well as openness on HIV and AIDS and any other issues due to increased knowledge and skills for both women and men, and assertiveness of women and youth. HHA will promote the sustainable use of natural resources and the importance of adaptation to climate change in the household participatory need assessments, vision setting and planning. Lead families and male champions will promote gender equality through action learning.

²²⁷ Household Approach Implementation Manual for Extension Workers and Local Facilitators, Ministry of Agriculture, Irrigation and Water Development, Department of Agriculture Extension Services, 2016

²²⁸ HIV and AIDS issues are at the core of the HH approach promoted and institutionalized by the Ministry of Agriculture at country level

Box 2 – Household Methodology

Culturally prescribed roles along gender lines drive women and men to pursue different household strategies, often disjointed. The household methodology shifts our focus from what women do not possess to what the family members aspire to, in particular, what they want to become, what they want to be engaged in and how they can achieve these goals. The methodology's objective is for family members to create a common vision for the household through guided dialogues among them, which allow women and men to understand and challenge gender norms and their connection to poverty. The methodology facilitates reflection, behavioral change and household planning through gender-sensitive participation.

One of the tools for such participation is a roadmap for realizing the family vision. The exercise of elaborating a map brings family members together to share ideas on what a better life consists of and how they can work together to escape poverty. It includes analysis of the present and the past, as well as opportunities and challenges that the family faces. Another tool is a gender balance tree. Collective tree drawing by family members directs their attention to household roles and responsibility related to production, reproduction, assets and decision-making, in addition to the benefits that the arrangement accords to each member. A social empowerment map invites participants to analyze the relationships of the stakeholders with the family vision and to identify the flow of power, money and love. For ensuring effective results, implementation of the methodology typically lasts three years or more.

The methodology has been adopted by various agencies, including IFAD, Oxfam Novib, World Food Programme, UN Women and FAO, in Uganda, Zambia, Sierra Leone, Malawi, Nigeria, Rwanda, Congo, Tanzania, Kyrgyzstan, Nicaragua and so on.^{cccdvii} The results obtained include not only gender empowerment, but also diversification of income, acquisition of household assets, improvement in education, decrease in conflicts and increase in savings.^{cccdviii}

Household methodology is widely used in Malawi and reported quite successful. Some of the most prominent cases are: Ministry of Finance and Economic Affairs' Financial Access for Rural Markets, Smallholders and Enterprise Programme (FARMSE; 2018-2025, USD 57.7 million); and FAO/IFAD/WFP's Joint Programme on Gender Transformative Approaches for Food Security, Improved Nutrition and Sustainable Agriculture (JP GTA; 2019-2022, EUR 5 million). At the same time, informal reporting indicates that there is room for improvement in implementation in Malawi, e.g., engage household members in dialogues, instead of raising awareness of just one household member. The Sub-Activity fills this gap.

281. Apart from climate change adaptation issues which are at the core of the project, the use of the clubs and the household approach will help address gender and social inclusion related issues that constitute core barriers to adaptation. A specific focus will be put on (i) gender and sex; (ii) advantages and disadvantages of gender-specific roles and tasks; (iii) gender-based violence (GBV) and Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH), including masculinities and patriarchy; (iv) Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process; (v) teenage pregnancy/marriage and school dropout; (vi) examples, motives and results of gender discrimination and social exclusion; and (vii) gender and social inclusion in community development and welfare, including food and nutrition security. For the latter, the implementation of FFS under Component 2 will also allow discussing the impact of integrated mix-farming systems on food diversity and availability, and on food and nutrition security.

282. The project will adopt a 'zero-tolerance approach' to SEAH. It will give specific attention on mitigating risk of GBV and SEAH, particularly on vulnerable groups including female-headed households, women and children, and persons living with HIV/AIDS. Mitigation measures to prevent and grievance redress mechanisms to respond to arising issues will be developed in close consultation with the identified at-risk groups. The project will set up a comprehensive GRM comprising four parallel systems: (i) a community-based system, (ii) a project-level GRM, (iii) the FAO-level GRM and (iv) the GCF Independent Redress Mechanism (IRM). This will allow individuals to select a community based (usually considered as the channel preferred by women as less formal) or more formal channel to lodge a grievance and file complaints. It must ensure the availability of effective grievance mechanisms accessible to women, girls and the vulnerable groups at risk that minimize the reporting burden on victims, offer gender-sensitive services and minimize the risk of retaliation. Those mechanisms should contain specific procedures for GBV and

SEAH, including confidential reporting with secure and ethical documentation. SEAH complaints will be monitored and information will be compiled in progress reports. The effectiveness of mitigation measures will also be assessed. With identified cases, the project should orient GBV and SEAH victims towards existing support services, including health services, psychosocial support, legal advice, police surveillance, and shelters. A series of capacity buildings and awareness-raising activities that consider GBV and SEAH issues are planned to strengthen stakeholders' capacity at various levels: trainings of ILM facilitators, traditional and community leaders; preparation and implementation of safeguards document at VLAP level in alignment with the project ESMP; awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV in the VNRMC and SCMC charter revision and member selection processes; mainstreaming of Gender and Social Inclusion including a focus on SEAH and GBV into the trainings of VNRMC and SCMC members. The use of Dimitra Clubs and Household approach will also promote open discussions on these subjects at both community and household levels. With the collaboration of the National Environmental and Social Safeguards specialist and Environmental District Officers, the Gender and Social Inclusion specialist will be in charge of the monitoring, reviewing, improving and reporting the progress in addressing GBV and SEAH. The project staff will also be trained to raise their sensitiveness on the subject and support the zero-tolerance approach to SEAH promoted by the project.

283. Project beneficiaries and targeting. The project is expected to directly benefit about 61,549 households and about 270,820 individuals (considering the 2018 Population and Housing Census estimates of 4.4 person per rural household) vulnerable to climate-change. Women located in the project areas represent 52 percent of the total population, and the quota of women directly targeted in project activities is 60 percent. The project targets as a priority smallholder farmers living in rural areas, women, men, female and male youth, who are considered the most vulnerable to climate change. The targeting approach is combined with criteria of local vulnerability to climate change, poverty and specific criteria according to the activity promoted.

284. The project will specifically target:

- Vulnerable households living in targeted catchments including poor rural households of farmers, households headed by young women, widows or women abandoned by their husbands;
- Farmers' organizations and associations in the intervention zone, which will be identified in each village under selected micro watersheds and involved in VLAPs development process;
- Women farmers' groups and associations living in the intervention area and involved in VLAPs development process;
- Young women and men and youth groups in the intervention area who are interested in participating in project activities, particularly in public works, digitalization and agriculture related services;
- Middle-income and better-off farmers living in targeted catchments;
- SMEs present in the targeted areas, working on identified value chains under the market analysis and preferred crops identified by EbAM.

285. The selection of beneficiary households and individuals will be made: (i) at geographic level of intervention (village) following communication and awareness-raising operations undertaken by the project's implementing partners; and (ii) on the basis of specific criteria developed in participatory manner for each activity. EbAM implementation approach will thus be essentially demand-driven: beneficiaries will be identified based on their interest and motivation to engage in project activities.

286. EbAM will ensure that the identified target groups participate and benefit from the project activities. It will combine various targeting mechanisms including geographic targeting, direct targeting, community-based targeting and self-targeting.

287. **Geographic targeting** includes different stages (detailed in section 1.4 from the Feasibility Study):

- Identification of the districts and Water Resource Units (WRU) (that are on average more than 150,000 ha) based on the climate vulnerability analysis (see section 1.4 for details). These are the higher administrative and watershed level areas identified;
- Identification of sub-catchments inside the WRUs. This level coincides with approximately TA level (1,500-45,000 ha). This is the level where sub-catchment committees (SCMC) will be supported, and SCMP formulated;
- Identification and consultation of villages and communities part of the watersheds as possible project beneficiaries, at micro-catchment level (500-1,500 ha). This is the level where VNRCs will be supported, and VLAPs formulated and implemented.

288. EbAM's **direct targeting** will orient project supports to specific groups (e.g. poor households, young women who dropped out of school due to teenage pregnancy/early marriage, young men candidates for immigration, etc.) based on vulnerability criteria and technical criteria specific for each activity. The setting of quota will also help in this regard, notably the project ambitions to reach 60 percent of women among directly targeted individuals for sub-activities. More widely, EbAM will directly and indirectly benefit 52% women. Vulnerability and poverty criteria will be established at the start of the project, to ensure that the most vulnerable (low income, less educated, female heads of households) benefits from the project. EbAM will also put in place empowerment measures to secure vulnerable groups' participation (inclusive social engineering process, capacity building, etc.).

289. In line with the community-based natural resource management approach, the project will also rely on **community-based targeting mechanism**. This approach implies consultations with the relevant communities and other local stakeholders (community leaders, etc.) in the selection of project potential beneficiaries. The use of the Dimitra Clubs' approach will support the project community-based targeting.

290. The project will also consider **self-targeting** approach which includes the provision of goods and services that are aligned with the priorities, needs, assets, capacities and livelihood strategies of identified differentiated target groups. Self-targeting relies on the knowledge of project areas of intervention and allows individuals, producer organizations and entrepreneurs to decide for themselves whether to participate in the various project activities or request support from the project. The following points relate to some self-targeting elements identified during design field missions and gender assessment consultations: interest of women, men and community members in climate change adaptation activities; women and young people's will to run their own business/income generating activities; micro and small enterprises' interest in receiving technical and financial support from the project; producer/women organizations 'will to participate and create commercial relationships with other market players; small entrepreneurs who show interest in developing opportunities and services that can contribute to local pro-poor economic and social development dynamics; etc.

291. **Implementation mechanisms.** The coordination of the day-to-day implementation of the Gender Action Plan will be the responsibility of a Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist, who will be recruited by the project. The Specialist will work as part of the Central Project Implementation Unit (CPIU) within FAO (as Executing Entity - EE) and under the direct supervision of the Project

Coordinator. The Specialist will closely collaborate with other project-recruited staff responsible for the implementation of project activities at national and regional levels. The Specialist will also collaborate with other EEs and implementing partners to ensure adequate integration of gender-differentiated needs as well as those of youth into the complementary support that the Entities provide for the project.

292. Regarding project management, the Specialist must ensure that the planning, implementation of all project activities, monitoring and evaluation and reporting are gender sensitive and socially inclusive, and consider GBV and SEAH issues. EbAM's logical framework and monitoring and evaluation system includes recommended measurable indicators for women and youth that allow assessing the sensitivity of project's component and sub-component to these groups. Data collection during project implementation will be gender and age disaggregated. The various technical and progress reports should consider gender-disaggregated information and analysis. At mid-term and project completion, the co-benefit on "Gender equality, women empowerment and inclusion" relating the qualitative change on GEWE will be monitored. It will be measured through the percentage of women perceiving improved support for women's empowerment from men.

293. As for gender and youth specific activities, the implementation of the Dimitra Clubs approach will be carried out by 30 ILM facilitators recruited through NGOs (see Annex 2, sub-component 1.1). Facilitators as well as some traditional/community leaders and other key figures (who will be trained on the Dimitra Clubs Approach) will be in charge of sensitizing local authorities and communities on the approach, setting-up the clubs and train Dimitra "caretakers" from the communities. Regarding health issues such as HIV and AIDS, apart from their consideration at the core of the household approach, the project will involve Community Health Committee members in the Dimitra clubs and will refer beneficiaries to the health surveillance assistants working in the localities. As for the household approach, EbAM will work closely with the Ministry of Agriculture for its implementation. Within DAES, the Agriculture gender roles extension support services offices (AGRESSO) will take the lead through Agricultural extension development officers (AEDO) who have already been trained on the methodology. Extension officers will work with local male and female farmers called local facilitators and will train them on the HHA as well as on the HHA's facilitation methodology. These local facilitators will then promote the use of HHA to peer households. The AEDOs should monitor the implementation of the approach both for local facilitators and peer households.

294. With regards to the budget allocated for gender and youth mainstreaming activities, budget provisions have been affected in the various sub-components. They are summarized in the Gender Action Plan table (Table 13), with the details indicated in the project budget. The budget column below indicates the amounts that are to be spent directly on women and female youths. Budget for activities that indirectly benefit them is not included. In other words, the total amount of funds that women and female youths benefit from is larger than what is shown in the table below.

2. GENDER ACTION PLAN

Table 13: EbAM Gender Action Plan

Gender Action Plan of the project " Ecosystems-based Adaptation for resilient Watersheds and Communities in Malawi (EbAM)"				
Project Expected Results	Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibility	Budget
GCF x level: Reduced emissions and increased resilience				
Core Indicator 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached	Number of direct and indirect beneficiaries. <u>Direct:</u> <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 270,820 (140,826 women, including female youths)</i> <u>Indirect:</u> <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 304,035 (158,098 women, including female youths)</i>	By end of Project Year 6	FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist	Reaching women beneficiaries requires 52% of total project budget i.e. US\$ 26,652,738.84
	Percentage of direct beneficiaries relative to total population. <u>Direct:</u> <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 1.54 % (1,55% of total women, including female youths)</i> <u>Indirect:</u> <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 1,73 % (1,74% of total women, including female youths)</i>	By end of Project Year 6	FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist	
Supplementary 2.1: Beneficiaries (female/male) adopting improved and/or new climate-resilient livelihood options	Number of beneficiaries adopting EbA solutions. <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 270,820 direct beneficiaries (140,826 women, including female youth)</i>	By end of Project Year 6	FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist	Reaching women beneficiaries requires 52% of total project budget i.e. US\$ 26,652,738.84, 80 percent of them are expected to adopt EbA solutions.

Supplementary 2.2: Beneficiaries (female/male) with improved food security		Number of beneficiaries adopting EbA solutions. <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 270,820 direct beneficiaries (140,826 women, including female youth)</i>			By end of Project Year 6						FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist		Reaching women beneficiaries requires 52% of total project budget i.e. US\$ 26,652,738.84, 80 percent of them are expected to adopt EbA solutions.	
Core indicator 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed/sequestered		Sequestration of tons CO2e (net balance) <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: -2,750,323 tCO2eq</i>			In 20 years						FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist		Reaching this indicator requires 100% of the budget i.e. US\$ 51,255,267	
Core indicator 4: Hectares of natural resources brought under improved low-emission and/or climate-resilient management practice		Hectares of farmland cropped with EbA measures. <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 83,240 Hectares</i>			By end of Project Year 6						FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist		Reaching this indicator requires US\$ 32,857,094	
Co-benefit 24: Gender equality, women empowerment and inclusion		% of women perceiving improved support for women's empowerment from men <i>Baseline: 0</i> <i>Target: 60%</i>			At mid-term and project completion						FAO (as Executing Entity), particularly National M&E Specialist		Reaching this indicator does not require additional budget.	
GAP Expected Outcomes, Activities and Targets													Cost	
Project activity/ sub-activity	GAP activity	Indicator	Baseline	Target	Y 1	Y 2	Y 3	Y 4	Y 5	Y 6	Responsibility	Exclusively dedicated for GAP	Included in Project Activity	
Component 1: Integrated Landscape Management Component's Outcomes: GHG emission reduction from improved watershed ecosystems & Climate resilience of watershed ecosystems is increased <i>Expected gender outcomes: Women and female youth have meaningful participation in the planning and implementation process to increase the climate resilience of integrated landscape/watershed ecosystem. This outcome will be achieved through capacity strengthening of women and female youth on EbA, capacity strengthening of all stakeholders on gender and social inclusion, establishment of a gender-sensitive support mechanisms (facilitators, technical assistance, etc.), promotion of participatory approach in the different processes (catchment selection, resource inventorying, charter revision, etc.), promotion of women's engagement in various resource management structures (VNRC, SCMC), facilitation of women's access to inputs and equipments for the implementation of EbA based VLAPs.</i>														

Sub-Component 1.1 Support to Village Natural Resources Management Committees (VNRMCs) and Sub-Catchment Management Committees (SCMCs) on EbA Planning GAP Output 1.1 Gender sensitive and socially inclusive integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are developed												
Act 1.1.1, Sub-Act 1.1.1.1	Consider socioeconomic and cultural factors in sub-catchment rapid assessment	Percentage of sub-catchment rapid assessment considering socioeconomic and cultural factors	0	100% of 30 sub-catchments rapid assessment consider socioeconomic and cultural factors						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management specialist EE: MoA/DLRC		US\$ 283,317.32
Act 1.1.1, Sub-Act 1.1.1.2	Consider socioeconomic and cultural factors in strategic selection and phasing of sub-catchments and micro-catchments	Percentage of sub-catchments and micro-catchments selection considering socioeconomic and cultural factors	0	100% of 30 sub-catchments and 111 micro catchments selection consider socioeconomic and cultural factors						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: MoA/DLRC		US\$ 8,625.24
Act 1.1.2, Sub-Act 1.1.2.1	Consider gender specific and social inclusion issues in EbA and ILM trainings	Percentage of training time spent on EbA and ILM from gender and social inclusion perspective	0	40% of training time dedicated to EbA and ILM from gender and social inclusion perspective						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 125,836.95
Act 1.1.2, Sub-Act 1.1.2.2	Strengthen the capacity of ILM facilitators, Dimitra Club Caretakers, Gender and social inclusion/HH approach facilitators, local government officials and TAs on gender and social inclusion, including on GBV and SEAH issues	Percentage of ILM facilitators, Dimitra Clubs caretakers, local government officials, TAs participating in gender and social inclusion trainings	0	100% of targeted actors participate in gender and social inclusion (including GBV and SEAH issues) trainings						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO	US\$ 1,979,521.73	

Act 1.1.3, Sub-Act 1.1.3.1	Promote women/female youth's participation in VNRMC Charter revision and member selection	Percentage of women/female youth participating in VNRMC Charter revision and member selection	TBD	60%/15% of participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
	Ensure VNRMC Charter elaboration/revision include discussions on NRM gender specific issues, gender sensitive member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership	Percentage of discussion time spent on NRM gender specific issues, gender sensitive member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership	TBD	40% of discussion time are spent on NRM gender specific issues, member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership								
	Ensure VNRMC charter elaboration/revision and member selection processes integrate awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV	Percentage of VNRMC charter revision and member selection processes integrating awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV	0	100% of VNRMC charter revision and member selection processes integrate awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV								
	Promote women's engagement in VNRMC	Percentage of women/female youth among VNRMC members	TBD	35%/20% of VNRMC members are women/female youth								
Act 1.1.3, Sub-Act 1.1.3.2	Apart from EbA implementation trainings, ensure that VNRMC members' capacity in gender and social inclusion are strengthened	Percentage of VNRMC members participating in gender and social inclusion trainings	0	100% of VNRMC members participate in gender and social inclusion trainings							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO	US\$ 190,162.66
Act 1.1.3, Sub-Act 1.1.3.3	Promote women/female youth participation in the drafting and finalizing of EbA-based VLAP process	Percentage of women/female youth participating in the drafting and	TBD	60%/15% of participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration	US\$ 96,903.00

		finalizing of EbA-based VLA process									with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		
	Ensure the process of drafting and finalizing of EbA-based VLAP include discussions on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective	Percentage of discussion time spent on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective	TBD	40% of discussion time are spent on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective									
Act 1.1.4, Sub-Act 1.1 4.1	Promote women/female youth's participation in SCMC Charter revision and member selection	Percentage of women/female youth participating in the discussions	TBD	60%/15% of participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
	Ensure SCMC Charter elaboration/revision and member selection include discussions on SMC gender specific issues, gender-sensitive member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership	Percentage of discussion time spent on SMC gender specific issues, gender-sensitive member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership	TBD	40% of discussion time are spent on SCM gender specific issues, gender-sensitive member selection methods and inclusive and meaningful membership									
	Ensure SCMC charter elaboration/revision and member selection processes integrate awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV	Percentage of VNRM charter revision and member selection processes integrating awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV	0	100% of VNRM charter revision and member selection processes integrate awareness raising on gender and social inclusion, including SEAH and GBV									
	Promote women's engagement in SCMC	Percentage of women/female youth among SCMC members	TBD	35%/20% of SCMC members are women/female youth									
Act 1.1.4, Sub-Act 1.1 4.2	Apart from EbA implementation trainings, ensure that SCMC members' capacity in	Percentage of SCMC members participating in	0	100% of SCMC members participate in gender and social inclusion trainings							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration		US\$ 17,200.76

	gender and social inclusion are strengthened	gender and social inclusion trainings									with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		
Act 1.1.4, Sub-Act 1.1 4.3	Promote women/female youth participation in the drafting and finalizing of EbA-based SCMP	Percentage of women/female youth participating in process	TBD	60%/15% of participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
	Ensure the process of drafting and finalizing of EbA-based SCMP include discussions on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective	Percentage of discussion time spent on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective	TBD	40% of discussion time are spent on watershed management issues from gender and social inclusion perspective									
Sub-component 1.2: Implementation of VLAPs based on EbA													
<i>GAP Output 1.2: Gender sensitive and socially inclusive integrated landscape management plans that include watershed ecosystems and founded on EbA are implemented</i>													
Act 1.2.1, Sub-Act 1.2.1.1	Ensure ILM and technical facilitators recruited include women	Percentage of female ILM and technical facilitators recruited	TBD	25% of ILM and technical facilitators are female							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 2,161,612.81
Act 1.2.1, Sub-Act 1.2.1.2	Promote women/female youth participation in the planning process to initiate VLAP implementation	Percentage of women/female youth participating in process	0	60%/15% of participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: MoA/DLRC		US\$ 71,928
	Ensure the planning process to initiate VLAP implementation include discussions on gender sensitive division of labor and related inputs and equipments	Percentage of discussion time spent on gender sensitive division of labor and related inputs and equipments	0	40% of discussion time are spent on gender sensitive division of labor and related inputs and equipments									

Act 1.2.2, Sub-Act 1.2.2.1	Ensure that female VNRMC members participate in process of acquiring inputs and equipments (namely in the definition of technical specifications)	Percentage of female ²²⁹ VNRMC members participating in process of acquiring of inputs and equipments	TBD	100% of female VNRMC members							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: NLGFC	US\$ 5,253,591.58
	Ensure women receive inputs and equipments	Percentage of women ²³⁰ receiving inputs and equipments	0	60% of women receiving inputs and equipments								
Act 1.2.2, Sub-Act 1.2.2.2	Ensure that technical assistance provided considers women and youth specific issues	Percentage of ILM facilitators assisting in finding solutions for women and youth specific problems	0	100% of ILM facilitators							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with the Natural Resource Management Specialist EE: MoA/DLRC	US\$ 195,186
	Ensure women and female youth participate in the monitoring of VLAP implementation	Proportion of women/female youth participating in VLAP implementation participatory monitoring	0	52%/15% of women/female youth micro-catchment residents								
Component 2: Resilient livelihoods and food systems Component 2 Outcome: Productivity and farmers' incomes are stabilized thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems Expected gender outcomes: Women and female youth farmers' productivity and incomes are stabilized thanks to more resilient livelihoods and food systems. This outcome will be achieved through capacity strengthening of women and female youth on EbA solutions, business management and marketing; facilitation of women and female youth's access to climate information and adapted inputs (genetic materials, seeds, etc.); support to women and female youth on market access and entrepreneurship development as well as on access to adapted financial services for climate resilient investment solutions.												
Sub-Component 2.1: Promotion of EbA-based production systems GAP Output 2.1 Gender sensitive and socially inclusive EbA measures and inputs are promoted among women, youth and men farmers												
Act 2.1.1, Sub-act 2.1.1.1	Ensure master trainers and facilitators include women	Percentage of female ²³¹ master trainers and facilitators	0	60% of master trainers and facilitators are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO	US\$ 904,200

²²⁹ Including female youth

²³⁰ Including female youth

²³¹ Including female youth

Act 2.1.1, Sub-act 2.1.1.2	Implement women-only ²³² FFS	Percentage of women-only FFS implemented	0	40% of FFS implemented are women-only/female youth-only							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 1,192,661.60
Act 2.1.1, Sub-act 2.1.1.3	Consider women and youth specific issues in FFS rolling out	Percentage of AEDOs and AEDCs assisting in finding solutions for women and youth specific issues in the FFS	0	100% of AEDOs and AEDCs							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: MoA		US\$ 1,370,205
Act 2.1.2, Sub-act 2.1.2.1	Involve women/female youth in the development of knowledge management strategy and of EbA related knowledge products	Percentage of women/female youth beneficiaries and implementing partners consulted for the development of knowledge management strategy and EbA related knowledge products	0	60%/15% of women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.1.2, Sub-act 2.1.2.2	Promote women/female youth participation in visits and exchanges	Percentage of women/female youth participating in visits and exchanges	0	60%/15% of visit and exchange participants are women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 552,000
Act 2.1.2, Sub-act 2.1.2.3	Facilitate women ²³³ access to climate information	Percentage of women accessing to climate information	0	50% of women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 218,429

²³² Including female-youth only FFS

²³³ Including female youth

Act 2.1.3, Sub-act 2.1.3.1	Involve women/female youth in the selection/choice of genetic materials	Percentage of women/female youth participating in the selection/choice of genetic resources	0	60%/15% of women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO	US\$ 600,000
	Make sure genetic material promoted corresponds to women's interest ²³⁴	Percentage of genetic material corresponding to women's interest	0	50% ²³⁵ of genetic material corresponding to women's interest								
	Ensure women/female youth are involved in the multiplication and dissemination of genetic material	Percentage of women/female youth involved in the multiplication and dissemination of genetic material	0	60%/20% of women/female youth								
Act 2.1.3, Sub-act 2.1.3.2	Make sure endangered and native seeds and tree seedlings corresponds to women's interest	Percentage of endangered and native seeds and tree seedlings corresponding to women's interest	0	50% of endangered and native seeds and tree seedlings corresponding to women's interest							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.1.3, Sub-act 2.1.3.3	Prioritize women-sensitive ²³⁶ seed multipliers	Percentage of women seed multipliers	0	60% of seed multipliers are women-sensitive							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist EE: FAO	US\$ 234,000
Act 2.1.3, Sub-act 2.1.3.4	Involve women/female youth in discussions related to establishment of nursery and community seed bank	Percentage of women/female youth involved in discussions related to establishment of nursery and	0	60%/15% of women/female youth							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agro-Ecology & EbA Specialist	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring

²³⁴ Since men and women are interested in different crops, the project must ensure their interest are considered in the selection of genetic material. Men are more interested in cash crops and women have much interest in nutrition sensitive and medicinal crops

²³⁵ The remaining 50% should allow taking into account crops that are of men's interest

²³⁶ Women-sensitive relates to women individuals or women-only/female dominated groups

		community seed bank								EE: FAO		significant specific budget
	Involve women/female youth in the management of nursery and community seed bank	Percentage of women ²³⁷ involved in management of nursery and community seed bank	0	35% of nursery and community seed bank managers are women								
Sub-component 2.2: Market access and entrepreneurship development GAP Output 2.2 Private sector is incentivized to invest in gender-sensitive and socially inclusive climate-resilient agriculture; and women and female youth farmers have better access to markets												
Act 2.2.1, Sub-act 2.2.1.1	Encourage the expression of interest of 4P partners sensitive to gender ²³⁸	Percentage of 4P partners sensitive to gender	0	100% of 4P partners						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.2.1, Sub-act 2.2.1.2	Prioritize women sensitive ²³⁹ EbA farmer organizations which have the potential to engage in 4Ps	Percentage of women ²⁴⁰ engaged in the 4Ps	0	At least 50 percent of 4P members are women						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 60,200
	Ensure that the capacity of female 4P members in the process of 4P agreement and operations is strengthened	Percentage of female 4P members strengthened	0	100% of female 4P members are strengthened								
Act 2.2.1, Sub-act 2.2.1.3	Make sure that 4P Business Plans considers the constraints and needs of each player including	Percentage of women-sensitive 4P business plans considering women specific issues	0	100% of women sensitive 4P business plan						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness		US\$ 94,260

²³⁷ Including female youth

²³⁸ Sensitivity to gender relates to experience in promoting women 's business and activities

²³⁹ Women-sensitive relates to women individuals or women-only/female dominated groups

²⁴⁰ Including female youth

	women sensitive EbA farmer organizations										and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		
Act 2.2.1, Sub-act 2.2.1.4	Ensure that advisory support considers women and youth specific issues related to 4P arrangement and implementation	Percentage of 4P partner finding solutions for women specific problems in the 4P implementation	0	100% of 4P partners							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 77,280
Act 2.2.2, Sub-act 2.2.2.1	Promote women's involvement in the discussions related to MSMEs establishment	Percentage of women engaged in the discussions	0	60% of participants in the discussions are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 253,800
	Prioritize the establishment of women sensitive ²⁴¹ groups/MSMEs	Percentage of women in established groups/MSMEs	0	50% of group/MSME members are women									
Act 2.2.2, Sub-act 2.2.2.2	Make sure that Business Plans considers the constraints and needs of women involved in MSMEs	Percentage of women-sensitive business plans solving women specific issues	0	100% of women-sensitive business plans							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 174,900
Act 2.2.2, Sub-act 2.2.2.3	Ensure that support provided in consolidation of business operations considers women specific issues related to 4P	Percentage of institutional development experts assisting in finding solutions for women specific issues for consolidation of business operations	0	100% of institutional development experts							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		US\$ 178,200
Act 2.2.3, Sub-act 2.2.3.1	Consider highlighting/giving visibility to the contribution of women in EbA produce in the creation of the brand	Brand created giving visibility to women's contribution in EbA	0	1 brand created							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU in collaboration with Agribusiness		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring

²⁴¹ Women-sensitive relates to women individuals or women-only/female dominated groups

											and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		significant specific budget
Act 2.2.3, Sub-act 2.2.3.2	Convey the message on the added value of women's contribution in EbA produce in the marketing campaign	Number of marketing campaign conveying the message on the added value of women's contribution in EbA	0	At least 1 marketing campaign per year							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
	Make sure to reach out to women and youth audiences by ensuring the deployment of specific media best suited to that audience	Number of specific media deployed to reach out to women and youth audiences	0	At least 1 specific media reaching out to women audience and 1 specific media reaching out to youth audience									
Act 2.2.3, Sub-act 2.2.3.3	Give visibility to women's role while linking EbA produce to traditional cuisine	TBD	0	TBD							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Sub-component 2.3. Access to finance for climate resilient investment solutions													
GAP Output 2.3 Women and female youth's financial inclusion is enhanced and enable them to access adapted financial services for their EbA investments													
Act 2.3.1, Sub-act 2.3.1.1	Consider the experience of women and female youth sensitive VSLAs in the study on sustainability of the CBFO model	Study considering the experience of women and female youth sensitive VSLAs	0	1 study							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE		US\$ 1,915,469.59
	Adjust the VSLA model to integrate the results of the study and to overcome women and female youth's financial issues	Percentage of women and female youth members having solved financial problems through VSLA membership	0	80% of women and female youth VSLA members									
	Promote women and female youth's participation/membership in VSLAs	Percentage of women and female youth VSLA members	0	50%/15% of VSLA members are women/female youth									

Act 2.3.1, Sub-act 2.3.1.2	Consult women and female youth VSLA members in the study on VSLA members access to agriculture finance including linkages with formal financial institutions (FFIs)	Percentage of women female youth VSLA members consulted when conducting the study	0	60%/15% of VSLA members consulted are women/female youth						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.3.1, Sub-act 2.3.1.3	Consult women and youth VSLA members in in the elaboration of knowledge products	Percentage of women/ female youth VSLA members consulted in the elaboration of knowledge products	0	60%/15% of VSLA members consulted are women/female youth						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.3.2, Sub-act 2.3.2.1	Support FFIs to consider women and female youth's needs and constraints in the development of innovative and adapted financial services	Percentage of products that have adapted features for women and youths	0	100% of developed products						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.3.2, Sub-act 2.3.2.2	Support women and female youth access to formal financial services through supported FFIs	Percentage of women and female youth accessing formal financial services through supported FFIs	TBD	35%/15% of beneficiaries accessing formal financial services through supported FFIs are women/female youth						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE	US\$ 271,544.57
(still sub-activity 2.3.2.2)	Consult women and youth VSLA members in in the elaboration of knowledge products	Percentage of women/ female youth VSLA members consulted in the elaboration of knowledge products	0	60%/15% of VSLA members consulted are women/female youth						Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant

													specific budget
Act 2.3.3, Sub-act 2.3.3.1	Consider gender, female-youth and youth issues in the study of potential financial instruments providers that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with its partner FFIs	Study of potential financial instruments providers that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with its partner FFIs considering gender, female-youth and youth issues	0	1 study							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.3.3, Sub-act 2.3.3.2	Consider gender, female-youth and youth issues when linking partner FFIs with identified financial instruments providers	Percentage of gender and youth-sensitive partnership established	0	100% of partnership established are gender and youth-sensitive							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE		
Act 2.3.4, Sub-act 2.3.4.1	Consider gender, female-youth and youth issues in the study of potential impact investment funds that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with supported agri-SMEs	Study of potential impact investment funds that MoF/FARMSE could partner with for linkages with supported agri-SMEs considering gender, female-youth and youth issues	0	1 study							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 2.3.4, Sub-act 2.3.4.2	Consider women-led/owned SMEs when facilitating the link with impact investment funds	Number of women led /owned SMEs linked to Impact investment funds	0	At least 1 women led/owned SMEs linked to Impact investment funds							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU, in collaboration with Agribusiness and Finance Specialist EE: MoF/FARMSE		US\$ 5,026

Component 3: Enabling institutional and financial environment Component 3 Outcome: The enabling environment (finance and policies) to sustain and scale-up climate resilient landscape, watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices is enhanced. Expected gender outcomes: A gender-sensitive enabling environment (finance and policies) to sustain and scale-up gender-sensitive and socially inclusive climate resilient landscape, watershed ecosystems and agriculture practices is enhanced. This outcome will be achieved through support to the development of gender policy and action plan by main national partners, promotion of women's participation in the various capacity development activity, consideration of gender aspects and principles (including women's involvement in processes) in the conduct of various studies and assessment and development of policy briefs and policy plan, and promotion of women's participation in the implementation of PIP including policy dialogue.												
Sub-component 3.1. Leveraging public and private climate finance GAP Output 3.1: Sustainable and innovative gender sensitive and socially inclusive public and private climate financing are in place through NCCF, local trusts and the leveraging of private sector's experience on carbon credit												
Act 3.1.1. Sub-act 3.1.1.1	Support NCCF to develop a gender policy and action plan	Number of gender policy and action plan developed	0	1 gender policy and action plan developed							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO	US\$ 12,730
Act 3.1.1. Sub-act 3.1.1.2	Make sure the building of NCCF pipeline projects and project selection consider gender and social inclusion criteria	Number of technical note developed on the gender and social inclusion criteria to be considered in the building of NCCF pipeline projects and project selection	0	1 technical note							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO	Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 3.1.1. Sub-act 3.1.1.3	Promote women's ²⁴² participation in the capacity development on EbA	Percentage of women participating in EbA trainings	0	At least 30% of training participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO	US\$ 7,938
Act 3.1.1. Sub-act 3.1.1.4	Promote women's ²⁴³ participation in the capacity development on climate risk analysis	Percentage of women participating in climate risk analysis trainings	0	At least 30% of training participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO	US\$ 7,938
Act 3.1.1. Sub-act 3.1.1.5	Promote women's ²⁴⁴ participation in the capacity development on carbon balance analysis	Percentage of women participating in carbon balance analysis trainings	0	At least 30% of training participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU	US\$ 9,138

²⁴² Including female youth

²⁴³ Including female youth

²⁴⁴ Including female youth

											EE: FAO		
Act 3.1.2. Sub-act 3.1.2.1	Support MEET to develop a gender policy and action plan	Number of gender policy and action plan developed	0	1 gender policy and action plan developed							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 12,730
Act 3.1.2. Sub-act 3.1.2.2	Ensure that the study analyzes women's involvement and engagement for the development of innovative finance instruments	Number of study considering women's involvement and engagement for the development of innovative finance instruments	0	1 study considering women's involvement and engagement for the development of innovative finance instruments							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 3.1.2. Sub-act 3.1.2.3	Promote women's participation in the capacity development on M&E	Percentage of women participating in M&E trainings	0	50% of training participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 9,765
Act 3.1.3, Sub-act 3.1.3.1	Ensure gap analysis consider how women can benefit from carbon credits	Number of gap analysis continuously assessing how women can benefit from carbon credits	0	1 gap analysis continuously assessing how women can benefit from carbon credits							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 3.1.3, Sub-act 3.1.3.2	Promote women's involvement in the continuous learning process	Percentage of women involved during the learning process	0	50% of stakeholders involved are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Sub-component 3.2 Scaling-up in national policies GAP Output 3.2: Gender sensitive and socially inclusive EbA and ILM are scaled-up in national policies													

Act 3.2.1, Sub-act 3.2.1.1	Conduct specific economic analysis looking at return for women-led farms at project start-up, mid-term and completion	Number of specific analysis looking at return for women-led farms	0	3 specific analysis conducted							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 13,765
Act 3.2.1, Sub-act 3.2.1.2	Include women engagement indicators in the TAPE assessment	Number of TAPE assessment including women engagement indicators	0	1 TAPE assessment including women engagement indicators							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
Act 3.2.2, Sub-act 3.2.2.1	Ensure that policy recommendations resulting from in-depth policy review process to improve EbA mainstreaming consider gender principles	Number of policy recommendations to improve EbA mainstreaming considering gender principles	0	1 policy avec des priority							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 45,000
Act 3.2.2, Sub-act 3.2.2.2	Promote women's participation in the dissemination of PIP	Percentage of women participating in the national seminar for PIP dissemination	0	50% of seminar participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 30,000
Act 3.2.3, Sub-act 3.2.3.1	Promote women's participation in policy dialogue for PIP implementation	Percentage of women participating in policy dialogue for PIP implementation	0	50% of policy dialogue participants are women							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 108,832
Act 3.2.3, Sub-act 3.2.3.2	Consider gender principles in the update of policies and key frameworks	Number of policies and key frameworks revised considering gender principles	0	3 Policies							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		US\$ 11,428.00
Project management													

	Strengthen the PIU and implementing partners on gender and social inclusion (including GBV and SEAH) related issues and mediation skills	Number of trainings organized on gender and social inclusion (including GBV and SEAH) related issues and mediation skills	0	12 trainings organized (1 per region per year)							Responsible officer: Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist of PIU EE: FAO		Already included in the project budget, GAP activity not requiring significant specific budget
	Engagement of Gender and Social Inclusion Specialist										FAO	US\$ 255,384	
TOTAL												US\$ 2,234,905.73	US\$ 16,775,804.60
